



张巍GRE

填空机经 2000题

(2026年)
(难度分级版)

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张巍GRE填空机经2000题

(难度分级版·改革后)

编写说明：本资料是将之前最受欢迎的《张巍GRE填空机经1900题》进行了全新升级：

- 1, 新增了2025年和2026年的高频真题，删除了低频过时的考题。
- 2, 每个section以7道题为一组，完全按照改革后的题目数量和比重排版。每个section都进行了难度分级，根据学生做题正确率的大数据汇总分为了easy, medium, hard三种难度模式。方便同学们计时刷题，并适配不同刷题阶段和不同基础的同学。
- 3, 增加了等价题比重，改革后等价题占填空总题目比重增至50%，所以此资料也将等价题提升至和考试同样的比重。
- 4, 配备全套免费解析，解析全部由真经GRE名师团队教研撰写，可以说是家教辅导级别的答案，绝不是仅仅翻译题目。
- 5, 订正了之前的一些打印错误。

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高频题获取方式：关注公众号“张巍GRE”，每月更新，找小助手领取。



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谨防假冒：市面上有很多机构或个人直接把张巍的资料复制加上自己的水印就当成了自己的资料。更有甚者在此资料的基础之上加上一些OG和官方150真题等“伪机经”就构成了新的机经资料，还声称张巍抄袭。我相信考GRE的学生都是有自己的判断力的，此资料除了有2000题，更有接近40万字的解析，这些都是张巍团队辛勤劳动的成果，不容忍别人的亵渎。资料的唯一正版解析都在“张巍GRE”的公众号上，网上传的PDF版本是盗版，里面有一些打印和答案错误，希望大家能够支持正版。

真经GRE 资料一览图



GRE Verbal资料



《张巍GRE阅读机经440篇》
(2026年) (题型分类版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 按题型分类, 针对性训练, 市面唯一。



《张巍GRE填空机经2000题》
(2026年) (难度分级版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 最新机经难度分级, 配套最新最全解析。

GRE模考资料



《张巍GREVerbal模考套题50套》(改革后)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 难度系数标注, 真实考试高度还原verbal题目和出题顺序, 配套详细解析。备考必刷!



《真经GRE新版模考套题》
(3套) (改革后)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 改革后的考试套题, 自适应仿真结构。高度还原真实考试。

GRE数学资料



《张巍GRE最新数学机经900题》
(2026年) (难度分级版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 最新真题, 难度分级, 针对性训练。



《GRE数学170难题4.0》
(2026年版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 高分必备, 难题合集, 冲击170。



《GRE数学回忆版机经360》

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 考场回忆版真题, 贴近考试难度和思路。



《GRE数学满分宝典3.0》
(2026年版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 涵盖所有数学知识点考点, 最完整的数学知识体系教材。



《真经GRE| 数学考点分类真题练习册》

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 分最新真题收录、考点的模块化训练, 针对性训练。

GRE写作资料



《2026 issue官方题库》

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 官方最新题库汇总。



《GRE issue 范文精析》

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 高分范文的分析和梳理, 掌握写作逻辑。



《Issue万能素材》

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 扩充素材库, 深挖素材每个解析角度, 丰富论证过程!



《改革后issue题库公式匹配》

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: Issue题库中所有题目的公式匹配和题目思路, 秒出思路!

GRE单词资料



《GRE镇考3000词》
(2026年版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 紧跟考试趋势, 最新选词, 配备视频讲解。



《GRE镇考机经词7.0》
(2026年版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: GRE核心高频词, 真题机经答案词, 配套视频讲解。



《真经GRE等价词汇总》
(2026年版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

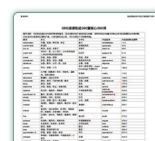
推荐理由: 六选二等价词必背词汇。



《真经GRE数学词汇汇总》

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: 按照知识点分类整理GRE全部数学专有名词。



《GRE阅读机经核心词汇》

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: GRE阅读中词汇扩展, 阅读必备词汇。



《张巍GRE熟词僻义汇总》
(2026年版)

推荐程度: ★★★★★

推荐理由: GRE常考的160多个熟词僻义。

01

王牌冲分班

性价比之王

COST PERFORMANCE



02

极速提分小班

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test 1 section 1 (easy)

1. It is a paradox of the Victorians that they were both _____ and, through their empire, cosmopolitan.

- A. capricious
- B. insular
- C. mercenary
- D. idealistic
- E. intransigent

2. The (i) _____ of molecular oxygen on Earth-sized planets around other stars in the universe would not be (ii) _____ sign of life: molecular oxygen can be a signature of photosynthesis (a biotic process) or merely of the rapid escape of water from the upper reaches of a planetary atmosphere (an abiotic process). 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. dearth	D. a controversial
B. presumption	E. an unambiguous
C. detection	F. a possible

3. The skin of the poison dart frog contains deadly poisons called batrachotoxins. But the (i) _____ of the toxins has remained an enigma, as the frog does not (ii) _____ them. Now an analysis suggests that the melyrid beetle is the source. Collected beetle specimens all contained batrachotoxins, suggesting that these beetles are (iii) _____ by the frogs.

A. effect	D. pressure	G. eaten
B. origin	E. produce	H. neutralized
C. purpose	F. suffer from	I. poisoned

4. The beauty of the scientific approach is that even when individual researchers do _____ bias or partiality, others can correct them using a framework of evidence on which everyone broadly agrees.

- A. overreact to
- B. deviate from
- C. succumb to
- D. recoil from
- E. yield to
- F. shrink from

5. The reconstruct known work is beautiful and also probably _____: it is the only Hebrew verse written by a woman.

- A. singular
- B. unique
- C. archaic
- D. counterfeit
- E. valuable
- F. fake

6. In a book that inclines to _____, an epilogue arguing that ballet is dead arrives simply as one more overstatement.

- A. pessimism
- B. misinterpretation
- C. imprecision

- D. vagueness
- E. exaggeration
- F. hyperbole

7. The political upheaval caught most people by surprise: despite the _____ warnings of some commentators, it had never seemed that imminent.

- A. stern
- B. prescient
- C. prophetic
- D. indifferent
- E. repeated
- F. apathetic

test 1 section 2 (easy)

1. My grandma has a strong belief in all things _____: she insists, for example, that the house in which she lived as a child was haunted. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. clamorous
- B. invidious
- C. numinous
- D. empirical
- E. sonorous

2. Among the Meakambut people of Papua New Guinea, legends are associated with specific caves in the Sepik region, and these legends are _____: only the cave owner can share its secrets.

- A. impenetrable
- B. immutable
- C. proprietary
- D. didactic
- E. self-perpetuating

3. Given the (i) _____ the committees and the (ii) _____ nature of its investigation, it would be unreasonable to gainsay the committee's conclusions at first glance.

A. sterling reputation of	D. superficial
B. lack of finding of	E. spontaneous
C. ad hoc existence of	F. exhaustive

4. Now that photographic prints have become a popular field for collecting, auctions are becoming more (i) _____. It is not just the entry of new collectors into the field that is causing this intensification. Established collectors' interests are also becoming more (ii) _____. Those who once concentrated on the work of either the nineteenth-century pioneers or the twentieth-century modernists are now keen to have (iii) _____ collections.

A. competitive	D. fickle	G. comprehensive
B. tedious	E. wide-ranging	H. legitimate
C. exclusive	F. antiquarian	I. impressive

5. Members of the union's negotiating team insisted on several changes to the company's proposal before they would support it, making it clear that they would _____ no compromise.
- A. disclose
B. reject
C. brook
D. tolerate
E. repudiate
F. weigh
6. Wilson is wont to emphasize the _____ of ants: how ants with full stomachs will regurgitate liquid food for those without, or how the old will fight so the young can survive.
- A. beneficence
B. altruism
C. unpredictability
D. intelligence
E. fecundity
F. fertility
7. During the Renaissance, the use of optical lenses, which were capable of projecting images onto blank canvases, greatly aided artists by allowing them to accurately observe and depict the external world; in other words, these lenses were instrumental in conveying _____.
- A. idealism
B. optimism
C. ambition
D. realism
E. sanguinity
F. verisimilitude

test 2 section 1 (easy)

1. We often regard natural phenomena like rainfall as mysterious and unpredictable; although for short time spans and particular places they appear so, in fact on a truly global scale, nature has been a model of _____.
- A. reliability
B. diversity
C. complexity
D. plasticity
E. discontinuity
2. The economic recovery was somewhat lopsided: (i) _____ in some of the industrial economies while (ii) _____ in others of them. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. unexpected	D. robust
B. feeble	E. turbulent
C. swift	F. predictable

3. Most capuchin monkey conflict involves such a (i) _____ repertoire of gestural and vocal signals that it is difficult for researchers to tease apart the meanings of the individual signals. This (ii) _____ is (iii) _____ by the fact that many signals seem to shift in meaning according to the context in which they are produced and the developmental stage of the individuals producing them.

A. precise	D. problem	G. augmented
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B. rich	E. opportunity	H. ameliorated
C. straightforward	F. oversight	I. anticipated

4. The professor's habitual air of _____ was misleading front, concealing amazing reserves of patience and a deep commitment to his students' learning. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. cordiality
- B. irascibility
- C. disorganization
- D. conviviality
- E. diffidence
- F. exasperation

5. In matters of taste, the art patron and collector Peggy Guggenheim was _____, she was for the strangest, the most surprising, the most satisfying, the best, the unique.

- A. a neophyte
- B. a novice
- C. a realist
- D. an extremist
- E. a pragmatist
- F. a zealot

6. The laboratory maze has grown ever less _____ since it was first invented instead of hoping to lose a rodent in a labyrinth; today's scientists design mazes to elicit a few simple, easily measured behaviors.

- A. intricate
- B. extensive
- C. effective
- D. convoluted
- E. useful
- F. prevalent

7. In mathematics, judgments about the validity of proofs are mediated by peer-reviewed journals; to ensure _____, reviewers are carefully chosen by journal editors, and the identity of scholars whose papers are under consideration are kept secret.

- A. timelessness
- B. originality
- C. fairness
- D. comprehensiveness
- E. objectivity
- F. novelty

test 2 section 2 (easy)

1. Though we live in an era of stunning scientific achievement, many otherwise educated people remain indifferent to or contemptuous of such achievement, even going so far as to _____ their ignorance of basic physics.

- A. decry
- B. condone
- C. remedy
- D. boast of
- E. downplay

2. Although trains may use energy more (i)_____ than do automobiles, the latter move only when they contain at least one occupant, whereas railway carriages spend a considerable amount of time running up and down the tracks (ii)_____, or nearly so.

A. lavishly	D. vacant
B. efficiently	E. unimpeded
C. routinely	F. overlooked

3. The great (i)_____ of most books that examine the American presidency is their ideological bias, but for most part, this volume on the presidency maintains an impressive degree of (ii)_____.

A. contribution	D. certainty
B. limitation	E. fluency
C. paradox	F. objectivity

4. Within the culture as a whole, the natural sciences have been so successful that the word "scientific" is often used in (i)_____ manner: it is often assumed that to call something "scientific" is to imply that its reliability has been (ii)_____ by methods whose results cannot reasonably be (iii)_____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. an ironic	D. maligned	G. exaggerated
B. a literal	E. challenged	H. anticipated
C. an honorific	F. established	I. disputed

5. Since some contemporary Western dieticians believe that the only function of food is to provide nourishment, these dieticians view an emphasis on the aesthetic dimension of the culinary arts as _____.

- A. unprecedented
- B. unwarranted
- C. illuminating
- D. groundless
- E. promising
- F. novel

6. Harper Lee's narration in *To Kill a Mockingbird* is _____, mixing an adult's and a child's perspective according to no logic other than the immediate exigencies of the plot.

- A. a paradigm
- B. a hodgepodge
- C. a model
- D. an innovation
- E. a patchwork
- F. an embarrassment

7. The employee had a reputation for fractiousness, but his coworkers found him to be, on the contrary, quiet _____.

- A. insightful
- B. affable
- C. sagacious
- D. capable
- E. easygoing

F. productive

test 3 section 1 (easy)

1. Slight but _____ variation in the timing of the star's pulses led astronomers to deduce that it was being pulled backwards and forwards by three planets orbiting around it.

- A. subtle
- B. regular
- C. undetectable
- D. inconsequential
- E. explicable

2. Many of the towns that have voted to keep incinerators in the county's solid waste plan have done so not because they necessarily (i) _____ incinerators, but because they are (ii) _____ to narrow their waste-disposal options. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. question	D. willing
B. favor	E. eager
C. oppose	F. loath

3. Just because, as a photographer, Friedlander (i) _____ places that most people consider ugly does not mean that he is out to prove they are beautiful. Instead, his work suggests that the photographer simply cannot ignore so much of the built American landscape but is obligated to (ii) _____ what we pass through day in and day out, regardless of (iii) _____.

A. tends to avoid	D. document	G. authenticity
B. is harshly critical of	E. emulate	H. truthfulness
C. is interested in	F. discredit	I. aesthetics

4. Even though women in the US would not gain the rights to vote until 1920, throughout the nineteenth century many feminist goals were gradually _____, especially the rights of married women to control their own property.

- A. realized
- B. abandoned
- C. eroded
- D. modified
- E. revised
- F. achieved

5. Edited collections of scholarly essays generally tend to be somewhat uneven: they suffer from the _____ subject matter of the various essays, the lack of an overarching and consistent thesis, and the variable quantity of the contributions.

- A. intriguing
- B. heterogeneous
- C. comprehensive
- D. disparate
- E. mediocre
- F. engaging

6. Miller reminded his clients that labor relationship are inherently _____: the interests of business owners are diametrically opposed to those of employees.

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- A. adversarial
- B. exploitative
- C. mercenary
- D. antagonistic
- E. variable
- F. changeable

7. Progressive and reactionary populist movements are not necessarily _____; each may, and usually does, possess features of the other.

- A. dichotomous
- B. untenable
- C. unsustainable
- D. contradictory
- E. subversive
- F. efficacious

test 3 section 2 (easy)

1. In the last two hundreds years, the practice of archaeology has changed greatly, from digging up ancient artifacts for use by wealthy individuals as art objects to analyzing the detritus of everyday life in the laboratory, and thus from _____ to data collection. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. supposition
- B. theorizing
- C. fact-finding
- D. treasure hunting
- E. scientific discovery

2. What they see in Tanaka is the one candidate capable of (i)_____ leadership, in direct contrast to Williamson , whose term in office has been marred by (ii)_____.

A. compassionate	D. grandstanding
B. decisive	E. partisanship
C. nepotistic	F. vacillation

3. Both very good and very bad books are easy to review. Praise and (i)_____ come easily. But what of books that contain a muddle of virtues and vices? Here the reviewer's task is more (ii)_____ : the author's useful and thought-provoking observations need to be (iii)_____ the useless and tedious.

A. ambivalence	D. evident	G. supplanted by
B. compliment	E. demanding	H. sifted from
C. censure	F. manageable	I. overshadowed by

4. Unambiguous texts can allow their readers to (i)_____ them quickly, but ambiguous texts can have the attractive (ii)_____ of multiple possible interpretations, all of which can be considered equally (iii)_____, and none of which is the single true meaning.

A. misunderstand	D. stigma	G. valid
B. comprehend	E. blemish	H. frank

C. complicate	F. allure	I. inveterate
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5. Although extreme and singular events occur in a black hole, its event horizon boundary is _____ space travelers; crossing it would be subject to the same physical laws that apply anywhere else.

- A. illusory
- B. obscure
- C. unremarkable
- D. immutable
- E. unchanging
- F. commonplace

6. The ocean's heat capacity (the amount of heat needed to change its temperature) is far greater than that of dry land and thus _____ the ocean's seasonal temperature changes.

- A. reflects
- B. mutes
- C. alters
- D. determines
- E. attenuates
- F. parallels

7. In the nineteenth century, the dish known as lobster Newburg was sometimes associated with the culinary accessory known as the chafing dish, but Welsh rarebit was considered the truly _____ chafing dish recipe. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. indigenous
- B. sumptuous
- C. ubiquitous
- D. paradigmatic
- E. newfangled
- F. archetypal

test 4 section 1 (easy)

1. History teaches us that science is not _____ enterprise; indeed, it is quite the opposite, a motley assortment of tools designed to safeguard researchers against their own biases.

- A. an opportunistic
- B. an anomalous
- C. a haphazard
- D. a collective
- E. a monolithic

2. Despite having only recently learned to walk, toddlers make the most (i) _____ dance students. Their joy in movement is so pure, so complete, and so (ii) _____.

A. skilled	D. futile
B. inattentive	E. irrelevant
C. delightful	F. contagious

3. Computers make it spectacularly easy to search for particular pieces of information in downloaded texts. And doing research in this strategic, targeted manner can feel (i) _____. Instead of (ii) _____ the organizing logic of the book you are reading, you can approach the book with your own questions and (iii) _____. You, not the author, are the master.

A. disorienting	D. disregarding	G. begin to discern the author's intent
B. humbling	E. surrendering to	H. glean precisely what you want from it
C. empowering	F. imitating	I. evaluate the book on its own terms

4. Although one can adduce myriad of examples of ecosystem disruption by nonindigenous species, nevertheless most introduced species that survive in fact appear to have quite _____ effects on the ecosystem they have invaded.

- A. minimal
- B. trifling
- C. marked
- D. conspicuous
- E. intriguing
- F. deleterious

5. Although field studies have linked inbreeding to declines among song sparrow populations, some researchers argue that, in nature, inbreeding proves _____ as a factor when compared with crushing blows from weather changes.

- A. hazardous
- B. momentous
- C. trivial
- D. significant
- E. precarious
- F. inconsequential

6. Since it was committed to the idea of science as an international, politically neutral enterprise, the Royal Society of London refused to _____ members from enemy nations during world wars of the twentieth century. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. betray
- B. expel
- C. endorse
- D. oust
- E. sanction
- F. condemn

7. Coagulation factors are useful proteins whose simple names—many are known only by Roman numerals—_____ their importance and the specificity of their roles in the thinning and clotting of blood.

- A. nullify
- B. obviate
- C. mitigate
- D. belie
- E. mask
- F. accentuate

test 4 section 2 (easy)

1. The Labrador duck is one of the most _____ extinct birds: although there are a fair number of specimens, few have yielded reliable data and little is known about the species' breeding patterns.

- A. anomalous
- B. controversial
- C. enigmatic

- D. misrepresented
- E. cherished

2. One view of historicism holds that systems of belief prevalent during different periods in history are _____ and therefore cannot be understood except in their own term.

- A. discriminatory
- B. incommensurable
- C. anachronistic
- D. cosmopolitan
- E. objective

3. Readers may initially be irked by the book's apparent (i) _____ but, once immersed in the author's prose, they may come to regard the work's (ii) _____ as an asset.

A. flippancy	D. subtlety
B. aimlessness	E. discursions
C. tendentiousness	F. exhaustiveness

4. Given our species' increasing numbers and appetites—which are reflected in and compounded by global climate change—even (i) _____ species are likely to become endangered within the foreseeable future. If we are to avoid a calamitous loss of biodiversity, according to Golbe, we cannot simply let nature take its course. Ongoing conservation management is (ii) _____, as we have, in a sense, become nature, and the responsibilities that come with the role cannot be (iii) _____.

A. exotic	D. ineffective	G. jettisoned
B. vulnerable	E. obligatory	H. assumed
C. now common	F. promising	I. contrived

5. Despite her rather _____ choices, Moreland was neither a rebellious spirit nor someone who saw herself as anything out of the ordinary. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. unconventional
- B. impractical
- C. quirky
- D. flamboyant
- E. successful
- F. lucrative

6. Despite their cultural and social significance, rapid growth, and widespread appear in China, video games—unlike traditional media—have received _____ attention from international communication researches.

- A. undue
- B. scant
- C. excessive
- D. focused
- E. limited
- F. dwindling

7. In Ramachandran's opinion, it is perfectly acceptable to propose bold speculations about the brain, even if these speculations seem _____; as Ramachandran frequently remarks, science thrives on risky conjecture.

- A. unfounded

- B. premature
- C. controversial
- D. verifiable
- E. testable
- F. baseless

test 5 section 1 (easy)

1. The company suffers from an almost total lack of _____: even the most innocuous communications between departments tend to devolve into acrimony.

- A. dissension
- B. variance
- C. comity
- D. conformity
- E. mordancy

2. Mr. Stevens found that home schooling, far from representing (i) _____ philosophy, (ii) _____ some of the most widely accepted education ideas: that children should be treated as individuals, taught in small numbers, and given a measure of discretion over their own learning.

A. a benign	D. overcomes
B. an orthodox	E. embodies
C. an anomalous	F. anticipates

3. Many fairy tales are complex narratives of wish fulfillment. They teach the reader that a struggle against severe difficulties in life is (i) _____, that it is an intrinsic part of human existence, and that if one does not (ii) _____, but steadfastly meets unexpected and often unjust hardships, one masters all obstacles and at the end (iii) _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. atypical	D. preserve	G. elicits adversities
B. unavoidable	E. improvise	H. emerges victorious
C. insurmountable	F. shy away	I. evades achievements

4. The concert hall's suspended ceiling is two-inch-thick plaster that reflects low-frequency sound energy; similarly, all wall surfaces are angled and shaped to _____ sound from the stage throughout the audience area.

- A. diffuse
- B. amplify
- C. spread
- D. dampen
- E. eclipse
- F. deaden

5. Any notion of justice in the fortunes of artists is _____: works of equal value and quality produce quite different returns or no returns at all.

- A. baseless
- B. cliché
- C. untenable
- D. insulting
- E. condescending

F. idealistic

6. Agencies responsible for protecting natural resources too often issue permits allowing exploitation of those resources, a process that remains _____ given that agencies have become experts at masking their decisions in the scientific terms.

- A. controversial
- B. exacting
- C. obscure
- D. onerous
- E. opaque
- F. misleading

7. Although legislators on both sides of issues have repeatedly _____ a desire to find a middle ground, until now no acceptable compromise has been achieved.

- A. discussed
- B. proclaimed
- C. professed
- D. rejected
- E. disowned
- F. betrayed

test 5 section 2 (easy)

1. The artist's career was remarkable partly because it was so _____: she died, with only a few paintings to her credit, while still in her twenties. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. felicitous
- B. prolific
- C. enduring
- D. conventional
- E. abbreviated

2. He was never (i) _____; he was nothing if not (ii) _____, so he forbore for the present to declare his passion.

A. chivalrous	D. boorish
B. impetuous	E. circumspect
C. thoughtful	F. spontaneous

3. One way to predict the effects of global climate change on an ecosystem is to extrapolate current trend in global change factors into the future. A (i) _____ of this method is that its predictions (ii) _____ actual observation, but the method also makes the questionable assumption that the future will resemble the present.

A. virtue	D. dispense with
B. drawback	E. derive from
C. peculiarity	F. improve upon

4. The writer argues that jewelry-grade diamonds, because they are both (i) _____ and (ii) _____, prove one of two conclusions; their purchasers have so much money they can spend it on goods that (iii) _____, or their purchasers are so committed to making others think they have such wealth that they are willing to go into debt to do so.

A. flawless	D. durable	G. may appreciate in value
B. fungible	E. useless	H. reflect the buyers' connoisseurship
C. expensive	F. irreplaceable	I. serve no practical purpose

5. The company is so old-fashioned and opposed to innovation that it can seem downright ____.

- A. antediluvian
- B. flighty
- C. archaic
- D. chauvinistic
- E. capricious
- F. patronizing

6. Estimating demographic parameters in marine mammals is challenging, often requiring many years of data to achieve sufficient precision to ____ biologically meaningful change.

- A. effect
- B. tolerate
- C. discern
- D. envisage
- E. withstand
- F. detect

7. Scientists should hope the faults in their theories will be ____ their peers since the refutation of one hypothesis can free its originator to develop a better one. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. discerned by
- B. disregarded by
- C. discovered by
- D. ignored by
- E. opaque to
- F. inspiring to

test 6 section 1 (easy)

1. The province has long claimed to be just another developing region, even as its economy ____ those of other regions and threatens to eclipse the rest of the country combined.

- A. parallels
- B. bolsters
- C. corroborates
- D. outstrips
- E. engages

2. So (i) ____ is the reputation of the city's police force for (ii) ____ that whenever a new police chief take office, he or she routinely promises to clean up the force.

A. persistent	D. corruption
B. recent	E. efficiency
C. discouraging	F. inexperience

3. In medieval Europe, watermills were more (i) ____ than windmills. It is true that windmills could be built virtually anywhere, whereas watermills (ii) _____. However, watermills' greater capacity and

reliability provided a better (iii) _____ the money required to build the mill.

A. problematic	D. were suitable only for certain locations	G. source of
B. profitable	E. inspired a variety of new technologies	H. adjunct to
C. versatile	F. required a good deal of upkeep	I. return on

4. Though Edmurd certainly had a dignified bearing and made a great first impression, those who became acquainted with him soon realized he had an essentially _____ nature.

- A. pugnacious
- B. deliberate
- C. punctilious
- D. courteous
- E. complacent
- F. truculent

5. The life of a secret agent is dangerous enough, but the life of a double agent is infinitely more _____: a single slip can send an agent crashing to destruction.

- A. arduous
- B. precarious
- C. clandestine
- D. perilous
- E. covert
- F. exhilarating

6. Natural causes nerves to die off and muscles to weaken, but regular exercise of muscle fibers enlarges and can _____ the decline by increasing the strengthen muscle you have left.

- A. speed up
- B. stave off
- C. forestall
- D. facilitate
- E. assist
- F. exploit

7. Creativity is no longer seen as _____ inspiration leading to poem or painting, it has come to be thought of as something permeating the whole of a person's life.

- A. a mundane
- B. a momentary
- C. an illusory
- D. an evanescent
- E. a metaphoric
- F. a prosaic

test 6 section 2 (easy)

1. Parker's model of human reflects a _____ outlook, in stark contrast to the generally pessimistic analyses of her colleagues in the economics department. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. prescient
- B. circumspect
- C. technical
- D. magisterial
- E. sanguine

2. Scientists said that cosmology was the field where the ratio of theory to data was (i) ____: there was an abundance of theories, but almost no data. Recently, however, that ratio has flipped. A huge and ever-increasing amount of data has (ii) ____ all theories but one.

A. completely unknown	D. eliminated
B. nearly infinite	E. supported
C. always variable	F. clarified

3. When the Agriculture Department (i) ____ its dietary guidelines, it laid down a challenge: Eat better, smarter, and healthier or else. The “or else” included a long list of (ii) ____ that (iii) ____ the developed world, from heart disease and osteoporosis to diabetes.

A. make public	D. intangibles	G. assuage
B. debunked	E. misconceptions	H. plague
C. refused to consider	F. maladies	I. ignore

4. The historian’s narrative of the dynasty’s decline is (i) ____, because though there is nothing (ii) ____ the account, largely parts of it rely on (iii) ____.

A. diffuse	D. psychologically penetrating in	G. plagiarism
B. reasonable	E. inherently implausible about	H. conjecture
C. questionable	F. fully documented in	I. pretense

5. In establishing that the dust she had observed constitutes two percent of the mass in the quadrant, the astronomer showed that the dust’s extreme visual prominence ____ its relatively minor contribution to the total mass of the region. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. belies
- B. masks
- C. highlights
- D. nullifies
- E. disproves
- F. accentuates

6. Writing about advances in climate science is often problematic, in part because the material is so ____: climate science is the study of shifting, interrelated, and sometimes paradoxical patterns.

- A. disheartening
- B. pedestrian
- C. complicated
- D. depressing
- E. knotty
- F. mundane

7. There are many insights in the essay collected in *Observations on modernity*, but they are embedded in a dense English translation of a dense German original that may make many of them ____ to most readers.

- A. vapid
- B. inaccessible
- C. sagacious
- D. banal
- E. distressing

F. opaque

test 7 section 1 (easy)

1. He was so _____ during the filming of the movie that crew members nicknamed him "The Angriest Man in the World"

- A. loquacious
- B. irascible
- C. perfidious
- D. sanguine
- E. voracious

2. Scholars have marveled over the (i) _____ that Shakespeare displays in his works, noting that such broad learning is all the more remarkable given that books were relatively (ii) _____ in Shakespeare's time.

A. meticulousness	D. edifying
B. humor	E. scarce
C. erudition	F. inexpensive

3. Galaxy Zoo set a standard for citizen-scientist participation project. Zealous volunteers (i) _____ the project's organizers by classifying an entire catalog of galaxies years ahead of schedule. (ii) _____ by the (iii) _____ of the volunteers, Galaxy Zoo team was inspired to pursue lines of research they had never even imagined. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. beguiled	D. baffled	G. insouciance
B. forestalled	E. buoyed	H. stoicism
C. astonished	F. embarrassed	I. alacrity

4. Noise suppression in phones can play an important role in making cellphone networks more efficient, since when sounds that are _____ to the meaningful signal are transmitted, precious network band width is wasted.

- A. unsuitable
- B. detrimental
- C. irrelevant
- D. confined
- E. limited
- F. extraneous

5. Changes made to ecosystem in order to achieve a goal, such as food production or flood control, often _____ significant unforeseen trade-offs between other important products and service the ecosystems provide.

- A. predict
- B. delay
- C. foretell
- D. obscure
- E. yield
- F. engender

6. The union states its position polemically; its leader say they are fighting to save good jobs while _____ corporations replace full-time workers with part-time ones in order to cut down on both wages and benefits.

- A. precarious
- B. enterprising
- C. rapacious
- D. troubled
- E. influential
- F. avaricious

7. When the atmosphere over the city is at its best, it is peculiarly _____, and this clarity seems to distill this very special beauty of the place. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. limpid
- B. acute
- C. calm
- D. sharp
- E. pellucid
- F. tranquil

test 7 section 2 (easy)

1. The film was a _____: its elements were assembled more or less haphazardly from a dozen of different sources.

- A. burlesque
- B. satire
- C. pastiche
- D. chronicle
- E. parody

2. Nylenna's study showed that errors in scientific manuscripts submitted for publication often escape reviewers' notice, results that were not _____: when Godlee conducted a study of the same phenomenon, her findings were similar.

- A. credible
- B. unwelcome
- C. anomalous
- D. quantifiable
- E. consequential

3. She was never (i) _____; she was nothing if not discreet, so she (ii) _____ for the present to declare her passion.

A. precipitate	D. pretended
B. tactful	E. decided
C. thoughtful	F. forbore

4. To label Hamilton a foreigner because he was born outside what later became the United States is to assume anachronistically the existence of the nation before the fact. It is true that Hamilton came to believe that he was a (i) _____ the United States, but his (ii) _____ was stemmed not from his (iii) _____ but from his confrontation with American democracy, which he considered to be a disease afflicting the nation.

A. symbol of	D. alienation	G. ideology
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B. stranger in	E. ambition	H. profession
C. citizen of	F. patriotism	I. birthplace

5. The book brings together many valuable reports on conservation projects, but with less variety than might have been wished: nearly half the contributions are from the same state, and consequently, the case studies are similarly _____ geographically.

- A. rudimentary
- B. interdependent
- C. interrelated
- D. complex
- E. heterogeneous
- F. dissimilar

6. For those of us who have been intoxicated by the power and potential of mathematics, the mystery isn't why that fascination developed but why it isn't _____.

- A. advantageous
- B. discounted
- C. prevalent
- D. undervalued
- E. celebrated
- F. widespread

7. The nation's robust economic performance could be _____ by the persistent flaws in its economic institutions and structure that are the result of half-finished and misguided government policies. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. neutralized
- B. concealed
- C. undermined
- D. impaired
- E. obscured
- F. outstripped

test 8 section 1 (easy)

1. The title of her final and unfinished film, *Escape*, was _____: indeed while shooting it, she was preoccupied with thoughts of desertion.

- A. quixotic
- B. apt
- C. misleading
- D. inconsequential
- E. uncharacteristic

2. Except for a few passages in the biography in which the subject's flaws are (i) _____, the author's treatment of her subject is (ii) _____.

A. too harshly judged	D. erudite
B. analyzed in depth	E. judicious
C. frankly acknowledged	F. acrimonious

3. In a view of 17 studies from 2008, Trudeau and Shephard concluded that reserving up to an hour a day for (i) _____ in school curricula does not (ii) _____ academic achievement. In fact, they

noted that more exercise often (iii) _____ school performance, despite the time it took away from reading, writing, and arithmetic.

A. physical activity	D. contribute to	G. diminished
B. leisure time	E. detract from	H. augmented
C. open study	F. correlate with	I. counteracted

4. An abundance of nutrient-rich pollution in estuaries causes algae to _____, much as houseplants grow better when their soil contains added fertilizer.

- A. abound
- B. proliferate
- C. stagnate
- D. coalesce
- E. collect
- F. diversify

5. Turning to the mountains to escape the chaos occasioned by the collapse of the ruling dynasty, artists looked to nature for _____ and a serenity not evident in human society.

- A. an order
- B. a stability
- C. a fragility
- D. a decadence
- E. an interaction
- F. a degeneracy

6. The Great Lakes wolf is a _____, stumping scientists as to whether it is a subspecies of the gray wolf or a distinct species. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. prototype
- B. riddle
- C. paragon
- D. model
- E. legend
- F. conundrum

7. The book aims to illuminate how science has changed the meaning of nothingness from _____ philosophical concept to something we can almost put under a microscope.

- A. a tangible
- B. a palpable
- C. a nebulous
- D. a nettlesome
- E. an incontrovertible
- F. a vague

test 8 section 2 (easy)

1. This is neither praise nor criticism, neither a compliment nor _____, just an observation.

- A. an exposition
- B. an elucidation
- C. an animadversion
- D. a culmination
- E. a divination

2. The history of the region's natural resources has been one of initial (i)_____ followed by (ii)_____; as such the region has over time gone from a resource-rich to a resource-dependent economy.

A. disappointment	D. growing interdependence
B. abundance	E. draconian regulation
C. conservation	F. rapacious depletion

3. Any account of experimental music in the United States that (i)_____ the predominantly African American bebop and free jazz movements is (ii)_____, since this body of music constitutes what is arguably the most influential African experimental music in the decades following the Second War War.

A. neglects	D. underappreciated
B. exaggerates	E. problematic
C. reinterprets	F. self-serving

4. Gravitational waves—ripples in the geometry of space-time—are analogous to electromagnetic waves. The challenge in trying to observe these waves directly is that they are extremely weak. To make waves large enough to be (i)_____, the most (ii)_____ events in the universe are required: supernova explosions, the formation of black holes, or the collision of stars. Even so, the effects are (iii)_____. The geometry changes so little that a distance of several kilometers changes by less than the diameter of a proton. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. detectable	D. obvious	G. masked
B. usable	E. subtle	H. disastrous
C. explicable	F. violent	I. minuscule

5. Readers have long considered Lawd Today! , Richard Wright's first written and last published novel, _____; the novel simply seems inconsistent with the image of what a Wright text should do or be.

- A. an artifact
- B. a prototype
- C. an anomaly
- D. a mainstay
- E. an aberration
- F. a model

6. It is hardly _____ for today's film to try to blur the boundaries between the moral and the immoral. Hollywood has been doing that since at least the 1960s.

- A. entertaining
- B. original
- C. novel
- D. pertinent
- E. relevant
- F. insightful

7. Reversing a decade-long trend on global _____, earth's surface has become brighter since 1990, scientists are reporting.

- A. warming
- B. cooling

- C. diffusing
- D. dimming
- E. darkening
- F. heating

test 9 section 1 (easy)

1. The identity of hominid remains found in a cave in the Altai Mountains was _____ until Paabo and his colleagues ended the speculation by showing that DNA sequences indicated the bones belonged to Neanderthals.

- A. extraneous
- B. conjectural
- C. improbable
- D. demonstrable
- E. consistent

2. Despite the abundance and importance of maize, its biological origin has been a long-running mystery. The bright yellow, mouth-watering treat does not grow in the wild anywhere on the planet, so its (i) _____ is not at all (ii) _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. utility	D. helpful
B. popularity	E. important
C. ancestry	F. obvious

3. Although Thaler employs an innovative mode of analysis, his study offers yet another examination of quite (i) _____ ground—namely, the culture ideology of Norwegian-American preservationist writers in the early twentieth century. The history, literature, and changing internal dynamics of the Norwegian subculture in America constitute a particularly well-studied area. Anyone familiar with the authoritative work of scholars in the field will (ii) _____ little in Thaler's study that is (iii) _____.

A. unfamiliar	D. find	G. accurate
B. well-worked	E. understand	H. new
C. fruitful	F. reveal	I. recognizable

4. All Shaker furniture implies _____ humanism in design: the Shakers made objects that look like objects, following a nonhuman law of design and rejecting the unconscious self-flattery inherent in making anthropomorphic objects.

- A. a rejection of
- B. a liberation from
- C. a belief in
- D. an affinity for
- E. an attraction to
- F. a misunderstanding of

5. The controversial social analysis that Moynihan offered in the 1960s is now generally recognized as having been prescient; in fact, it has been the _____ upon which much of our discussion of social pathology must base.

- A. concession
- B. bedrock
- C. imperative

- D. compromise
- E. foundations
- F. vision

6. The life of a secret agent is dangerous enough, but the life of a double agent is infinitely more ____: a single slip can send an agent crashing to destruction.

- A. arduous
- B. precarious
- C. clandestine
- D. perilous
- E. covert
- F. exhilarating

7. The jazz style called bebop was born and nurtured in New York City, and despite a ____ initial reception, it resonated three thousand miles away on the West Coast.

- A. wary
- B. warm
- C. confused
- D. muddled
- E. convivial
- F. hostile

test 9 section 2 (medium)

1. In a production process that is complex and often unpredictable, roles that start out discretely defined may become quite _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. confused
- B. perfunctory
- C. independent
- D. overt
- E. exacting

2. The description of Green's scholarship as (i)_____ is grossly misleading: while her research on interstellar particles is not especially novel, the conclusions she draws from her data are (ii)_____.

A. esoteric	D. remarkably pioneering
B. tendentious	E. dubiously supported
C. derivative	F. strangely comforting

3. People frequently attempt to relieve their workplace frustrations via surreptitious comments around the water cooler but would be better able to resolve their resentment if they were less (i)_____ about their problem and imitated a more (ii)_____ dialogue.

A. vexatious	D. equitable
B. clandestine	E. sincere
C. opportunistic	F. open

4. Publisher, publicist, and broadcasters love anniversaries, those occasions when historical events become (i)_____ in (ii)_____ culture of celebration. On such occasions patriotic sentiment and national pride are wrapped in the panoply of history to manufacture a mythical past that is

serviceable for public (iii)_____.

A. elusive moments	D. an authentic	G. consumption
B. marketable artifacts	E. a commercial	H. scrutiny
C. raging controversies	F. an elitist	I. censure

5. Despite the _____ of medical information available through e-mail, the Internet, and mobile devices, not many patients are taking advantage of the potential of electronic communications for health-related needs.

- A. wealth
- B. complexity
- C. intricacy
- D. profusion
- E. resurgence
- F. overload

6. The political upheaval caught most people by surprise: despite the _____ warnings of some commentators, it had never seemed that imminent. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. stern
- B. prescient
- C. prophetic
- D. indifferent
- E. repeated
- F. apathetic

7. Wilson is wont to emphasize the _____ of ants, how ants with full stomachs will regurgitate liquid food for those without, or how the old will fight so the young can survive.

- A. beneficence
- B. altruism
- C. unpredictability
- D. intelligence
- E. fecundity
- F. fertility

test 10 section 1 (medium)

1. Because people expect theater directors to be authoritarians, many were surprised that Clark was so _____.

- A. histrionic
- B. megalomaniacal
- C. egalitarian
- D. indolent
- E. charismatic

2. It would be (i)_____ not to (ii)_____ these tabloid journalists for thriving in hard times: they deserve credit for doing well in a profession in financial straits.

A. apropos	D. admire
B. churlish	E. envy
C. cagey	F. emulate

3. Laws protecting intellectual property are intended to stimulate creativity, yet some forms of creative work have never enjoyed legal protection—a situation that ought to be of great interest. If we see certain forms of creative endeavor (i)_____ as a result of uncontrolled copying, we might decide to (ii)_____ intellectual property law. Conversely, if unprotected creative work (iii)_____ in the absence of legal rules against copying, we would do well to know how such flourishing is sustained.

A. languishing	D. jettison	G. declines in originality
B. proliferating	E. extend	H. manages to thrive
C. diversifying	F. relax	I. openly invites imitation

4. Though it may seem as if more than a century of _____ has made the electrical grid an all-encompassing web connecting the whole of the continent, many vast and beautiful areas remain without power.

- A. refinement
- B. expansion
- C. ubiquity
- D. augmentation
- E. omnipresence
- F. isolation

5. Much of the literature of railroad seeks someone to _____, and it is thus replete with encomiums on entrepreneurs and managers.

- A. indict
- B. rehabilitate
- C. exalt
- D. valorize
- E. emulate
- F. excoriate

6. Not only was this writer content to leave the reading public in the dark, she seems to have _____ the role of trickster, seeding her works with apparent clues that led nowhere.

- A. rejected
- B. disdained
- C. relished
- D. participated in
- E. delighted in
- F. developed

7. The major _____ of much popular history is that it betrays no interest in making intellectual contributions to our understanding of an issue. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. characteristic
- B. shortcoming
- C. dilemma
- D. quandary
- E. ploy
- F. fault

test 10 section 2 (easy)

1. The students' _____ natures were in sharp contrast to the imperturbable dispositions of their teacher.

- A. volatile
- B. duplicitous
- C. apathetic
- D. cunning
- E. blithe

2. Despite the neighborhood's lingering reputation for _____, it has in fact become increasingly varied in its architecture and demographics.

- A. boisterousness
- B. unpretentiousness
- C. idiosyncrasy
- D. accessibility
- E. homogeneity

3. It would be imprecise to characterize her scholarship as (i) _____: though her etymological discussion is necessarily esoteric, there is nothing (ii) _____ about the conclusions she derives from it. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. derivative	D. obscure
B. arcane	E. controversial
C. careless	F. innovative

4. Common sense tells me some people are more (i) _____ than others. The claim that these differences are (ii) _____, or that deep down, everybody acts only to further their own interests, (iii) _____ our everyday observations and deep-seated human practices of moral evaluation.

A. altruistic	D. growing	G. mimics
B. adaptable	E. illusory	H. explains
C. disciplined	F. relevant	I. contradicts

5. After rising continuously over the summer, commodity prices fell, leaving analyst wondering whether the downward trend is a turning point or merely a _____ before demand picks up in the winter months.

- A. spike
- B. upsurge
- C. harbinger
- D. portent
- E. lull
- F. respite

6. Doris Kearns Goodwin's elegant, incisive study of Lincoln _____ those whose knowledge of Lincoln is an amalgam of high school history and popular mythology as well as those who are experts.

- A. gratify
- B. entice
- C. inspire
- D. confuse
- E. perplex
- F. please

7. Explorers could not build each other's knowledge if they could not trust records of previous explorers; thus exploration depended on the _____ of those who had gone before.

- A. collegiality
- B. endurance
- C. exactitude
- D. meticulousness
- E. eminence
- F. tenacity

test 11 section 1 (medium)

1. That Seiberg and Witten lack celebrity can be explained by the _____ nature of their pursuit: the mathematical exploration of four-dimensional space.

- A. pedestrian
- B. esoteric
- C. compelling
- D. global
- E. univocal

2. While acknowledging behaviors the Prime Minister took in order to remain in office were (i)_____, some politicians nevertheless believed this small amount of (ii)_____ was justified to keep reforming government in office. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. unethical	D. skullduggery
B. impractical	E. indolence
C. quixotic	F. incivility

3. China's rapidly growing population is the main threat facing large carnivores in the People's Republic. Increasingly, policies aimed at limiting population growth have been (i)_____; nevertheless, the country's vast size and the isolation of many of its regions mean that human populations in areas where large carnivores still occur (ii)_____. This human pressure has (iii)_____ the South China tiger.

A. modified	D. could start to decline	G. celebrated
B. deemphasized	E. can grow unchecked	H. doomed
C. implemented	F. have stabilized	I. bypassed

4. Well organized and researched and including all significant discoveries and medical scientists, this history of Western medicine has justly been called _____.

- A. encyclopedic
- B. long-winded
- C. exhaustive
- D. rambling
- E. overbearing
- F. indiscriminating

5. Science is arguably a very high-minded pursuit, but that is not to say that all of its practitioners are _____, as numerous articles alleging overly generous pharmaceutical industry payments to medical researchers have tried to show.

- A. conventional

- B. clever
- C. unimpeachable
- D. ingenious
- E. blameless
- F. predictable

6. In a field of egotists, Bloomfield is _____, often praising her competitors and punctuating her correspondence with self-deprecating remarks.

- A. unassuming
- B. complimentary
- C. acerbic
- D. ingenuous
- E. cutting
- F. modest

7. Because its previously _____ beliefs had become core tenets of mainstream politics, the activist group disbanded; with no more skeptics to persuade, its purpose had evaporated.

- A. arcane
- B. seditious
- C. quixotic
- D. idealistic
- E. popular
- F. conventional

test 11 section 2 (easy)

1. Paintings created in India during the Mughal dynasty were _____ in ambition but ornamental in presentation: in one direction they have a affinity with newspaper photographs, while in the other they have the intricacy of jewels. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. metaphorical
- B. documentary
- C. aesthetic
- D. sectarian
- E. baroque

2. Attending with equal (i) _____ to any question that presents itself, the sociologist's work has strengths and weaknesses that flow from this energetically (ii) _____ approach.

A. skepticism	D. hybrid
B. lethargy	E. indiscriminate
C. fervor	F. conciliatory

3. The national bank has been uncommonly powerful in comparison to its counterparts in other nations. It retains this potency partly because its control of the nation's banking system is (i) _____ governmental interference, and thus its actions remain largely (ii) _____.

A. unencumbered by	D. compulsory
B. replete with	E. discretionary
C. hindered by	F. bureaucratic

4. The usual (i)_____ spending public monies on scientific projects is that such projects have the potential to make our lives healthier, safer, and more productive. However, the fact that science – even “pure” science – can strengthen democracy and promote public participation in the political process is hardly ever (ii)_____. It should be Scientific literacy (iii)_____ democracy, and this is an important ancillary benefit of the promotion of science.

A. argument against	D. denied	G. stifles
B. rationale for	E. mentioned	H. energizes
C. precedent for	F. gainsaid	I. disregards

5. Although scientific progress leads to constant revision of ideas, one observation that has remained _____ over the years is that there are a lot of insects in the world: some 950,000 species have been identified.

- A. robust
- B. significant
- C. strong
- D. perplexing
- E. confounding
- F. obscure

6. Anne Carson’s book Nox is, very deliberately, _____ literary object—the opposite of an e-reader, which is designed to vanish in your palm as you read on a train. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. an evanescent
- B. a cumbersome
- C. an immutable
- D. an unwieldy
- E. an ephemeral
- F. a flexible

7. One of the peculiarities of humans is that we irrationally gravitate to the predictable and avoid risk, whatever the reasons for this _____, it is hardly a sound basis for dealing with complex, long-term problems.

- A. eccentricity
- B. predilection
- C. vacillation
- D. proclivity
- E. wavering
- F. cowardice

test 12 section 1 (medium)

1. Blake’s reputation for weakness is _____: almost all who have worked with him say he is a disciplined, intellectually formidable, and very tough politician.

- A. specious
- B. pervasive
- C. irreversible
- D. trivial
- E. ambivalent

2. Mr. Billington, at times, can be a (i)_____. For instance, he deplores the Royal Shakespeare Company’s eight-and-a-half hour version of Nicholas Nickleby, which many found (ii)_____.

A. naysayer	D. perplexing
B. pushover	E. unpredictable
C. braggart	F. absorbing

3. Early practitioners of the natural sciences developed methods to remove distortions caused by either the research environment or the researcher. Such methods, especially with respect to the researcher, were considered to (i) _____ those (ii) _____ subjectivity whose unbridled expression was thought to (iii) _____ research.

A. restrain	D. incursions of	G. corrupt
B. reveal	E. restrictions on	H. justify
C. disguise	F. acknowledgements of	I. expedite

4. Williamson had a fierce commitment to achieving an accord, spending enormous amount of time trying to forge a consensus out of an often _____ assembly.

- A. apathetic
- B. fractious
- C. restive
- D. cynical
- E. compliant
- F. tractable

5. One _____ is that so far, Web services have turned out to be much harder to deliver than their champions had hoped. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. hope
- B. snag
- C. prospect
- D. hitch
- E. upshot
- F. reason

6. Asserting a need to preserve the _____ that became the hallmark of her predecessor's tenure, the new director of federal monetary policy refused to subscribe to rigid or mechanistic rules in policy making.

- A. firmness
- B. adaptability
- C. unpredictability
- D. autonomy
- E. strictness
- F. flexibility

7. At first, most of the famous fairy tales seem so implausible and so irrelevant to contemporary life that their _____ is hard to understand.

- A. universality
- B. persistence
- C. appeal
- D. ephemerality
- E. survival
- F. transience

test 12 section 2 (easy)

1. In protoscientific (for example, in ancient Greece), claims about the physical world were often accepted as true if they were reasonable; experimental verification, if thought necessary at all, was _____.

- A. utilitarian
- B. perfunctory
- C. egregious
- D. empirical
- E. inductive

2. At Cerro Portezuelo, the task of separating grinding tools from the larger collection of excavated stone objects was (i) _____ the ancient practice of recycling grinding tool fragments for building materials, hammer stones, and other purposes that (ii) _____ their original use.

A. complicated by	D. complemented
B. important to	E. obscured
C. independent from	F. underscored

3. Behavioral economists have come to believe that a (i) _____ of choices can be paralyzing as Schwartz pointed out in the recent book *The Paradox of Choice*. Studies of retirement plans show that the more investment choices a plan offers, the less likely people are to participate in it. It may follow, then, that a lack of flexibility in certain plans may actually be a (ii) _____. People reasonably (iii) _____ some advantages in exchange for peace of mind.

A. surfeit	D. virtue	G. foresee
B. reduction	E. conundrum	H. forestall
C. stabilization	F. revelation	I. forgo

4. The (i) _____ quality of much contemporary drawing may be attributable to the use of photography as a drawing shortcut. Photography (ii) _____ modern arts, but when it is used as a tracing tool in order to (iii) _____ the difficulties of achieving correct proportion, the resulting art often feels static and lifeless.

A. inert	D. frequently enervated	G. augment
B. jubilant	E. wonderfully enriched	H. foreground
C. sensuous	F. inevitably circumscribed	I. circumvent

5. Far from _____ innovations, as the patent system was designed to do, the patenting of concepts such as gene sequences gives individuals and corporations a legal choke to hold over ideas that should be useful to all. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. spurring
- B. recognizing
- C. codifying
- D. acknowledging
- E. fostering
- F. cataloging

6. Advocates for workers' rights have adopted a new strategy, one that will require considerable ingenuity but that, if successful, could _____ a movement aimed at making labor rights an unassailable feature of American democracy.

- A. frustrate
- B. galvanize
- C. presume
- D. affect
- E. animate
- F. thwart

7. In Inuit culture, elaborate carving has often been used to enhance _____ object such as harpoon heads and other tools.

- A. utilitarian
- B. functional
- C. domestic
- D. decorative
- E. manufactured
- F. ornamental

test 13 section 1 (medium)

1. While early biographies of Florence Nightingale tended to be quite _____, Lytton Strachey's irreverent 1918 essay about her ushered in a new era, making it acceptable, even fashionable, to criticize her.

- A. unsympathetic
- B. sycophantic
- C. unsentimental
- D. censorious
- E. pedantic

2. Tagore had a sharply defined sense of the (i) _____ of scientific inquiry. The fact that science dealt in statistics and numbers, that its logic was probabilistic, meant that the domain of moral questions (ii) _____ it: moral questions, for Tagore, required certainties, not probabilities.

A. irrationality	D. guarded over
B. limits	E. lay outside
C. futility	F. was subject to

3. Although political events in different countries were not (i) _____ in the nineteenth century, their interrelationship was (ii) _____ compared with the present, when interdependence has become far greater: (iii) _____ has ceased to be an option. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. unconnected	D. conditional	G. isolationism
B. trivial	E. superficial	H. resilience
C. simultaneous	F. transparent	I. idealism

4. Benjamin Franklin's reputation is so much one of appearing scientific investigation with commonsense empiricism that it is somewhat startling to realize how _____ the great experiment's mentoring truly was.

- A. reasonable

- B. speculative
- C. pragmatic
- D. conjectural
- E. careless
- F. judicious

5. Scientist reported last month on a sign of relative solar ____: the solar wind, a rush of charged particles continually spewed from the Sun at a million miles an hour, had diminished to its lowest level in 50 years.

- A. quiescence
- B. turbulence
- C. isolation
- D. calm
- E. remoteness
- F. instability

6. Publicity surrounding celebrities' donations to charity is often greeted with cynicism, but a study of celebrity donation shows that they do ____ other donations.

- A. preclude
- B. elicit
- C. allow
- D. draw
- E. bar
- F. replace

7. Aerial viewings of the gigantic stone horse attributed to the Native American Quechuan people fail to ____ the considerable artistry required to create the piece: the horse appears crudely constructed unless carefully examined from the ground. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. reveal
- B. justify
- C. manifest
- D. mitigate
- E. diminish
- F. undercut

test 13 section 2 (easy)

1. The modest but functional new wing finally gives the museum the ____ to serve its visitors properly, including multiple entrances to eliminate the lines that used to snake around the building.

- A. visibility
- B. wherewithal
- C. reputation
- D. solemnity
- E. panache

2. Apparently, advanced tortoises evolved multiple times: the high-domed shells and columnar, elephantine feet of current forms are specializations for terrestrial life that evolved ____ on each continent.

- A. independently
- B. interchangeably
- C. paradoxically
- D. simultaneously
- E. symmetrically

3. The author suggests that cinema archives should become more like museums, justifying their existence by selecting, grouping and commenting on important films. By thus (i) _____ films, archives would not only serve as repositories but would provide (ii) _____ as well.

A. improving	D. conservation
B. restoring	E. education
C. interpreting	F. income

4. To read Joanna Scott is to admire the work of a (i) _____. From sentence to story, she narrates with great skill and (ii) _____, so that the reader soon relaxes in the assurance that a hint or a brushstroke delivered in chapter 1 will be (iii) _____ before the novel comes to an end.

A. proselytizer	D. deliberation	G. given import
B. sage	E. enthusiasm	H. largely forgotten
C. master	F. flamboyance	I. overwhelmed with details

5. Culture, like speech, is primarily a human faculty, although both functions may exist in a more _____ form in lesser primates.

- A. indispensable
- B. crucial
- C. primitive
- D. intelligible
- E. recognizable
- F. rudimentary

6. Jackie Wullschlager's biography of Hans Christian Andersen _____ the insipid sweetness with which Andersen coated his life and reveals a vulnerable gingerbread man with a bitter almond where his heart should be. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. conjures up
- B. imagines
- C. strips away
- D. overlooks
- E. removes
- F. ignores

7. While it is always clear that the author's message is heartfelt, it is mostly buried by shortcomings of style, organization, and production, although the book does become more _____ toward the end.

- A. sincere
- B. intelligible
- C. orthodox
- D. readable
- E. frank
- F. voluble

test 14 section 1 (medium)

1. Politicians who invoke the founders of the United States in support of their views seem to imply that the founders consistently concurred in their own views when in reality they were a highly _____ group of thinkers.

- A. erudite
- B. innovative
- C. predictable
- D. contentious
- E. methodical

2. Although Professor Pearson's colleagues often complained that he was (i)_____, his friends were quick to defend him from this charge of (ii)_____.

A. importunate	D. inconstancy
B. garrulous	E. dishonest
C. mercurial	F. partiality

3. The experimental theater company's members know that their performances (i)_____ an audience, that they were dense and unpredictable and not always easy to digest. But none of the techniques used would be (ii)_____ anyone with an interest in music or films. Indeed, they would seem strange only to people who expected to see traditionally crafted plays. The actors therefore felt that theater critics' derisive commentary showed only that the critics (iii)_____ the company's work.

A. made demands on	D. contemplated by	G. lambasted
B. had to command	E. alien to	H. exploited
C. were sure to please	F. intuitive for	I. misunderstood

4. A clever form of diplomacy involves subtly inducing the other party to propose your preference so that your _____ their requests appears as the granting of concession.

- A. accession to
- B. inattention to
- C. subversion of
- D. abnegation of
- E. repudiation of
- F. acquiescence to

5. Films that critics have slumbered through rarely generate industry excitement, even though the critics' _____ reception may be less the fault of the movie than of its unfortunate time slot near a fatiguing film festival's conclusion.

- A. somnolent
- B. impartial
- C. lethargic
- D. laconic
- E. befuddled
- F. evenhanded

6. Even the cleverest use of time management techniques is powerless to _____ the sum of minutes in a person's life (over 52 million, optimistically assuming a life expectancy of 100 years), so people squeeze as much as they could into each one of them. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. justify
- B. quantify
- C. augment

- D. enrich
- E. measure
- F. extend

7. In the absence of a surface gradient, the new laws of refraction and reflection are _____ the conventional law, so they represent more of an extension than a complete revolution.

- A. inferable from
- B. entailed by
- C. antithetical to
- D. coincident with
- E. antecedent to
- F. oppositional to

test 14 section 2 (easy)

1. What once seemed a quixotic vision—the “Subway to the Sea,” connecting Union Station in downtown Los Angeles to the Pacific Ocean in Santa Monica—no longer seems quite so _____.

- A. impracticable
- B. prescient
- C. banal
- D. viable
- E. beneficial

2. In a federally governed country, a regional government can function as a (i) _____ for the entire nation—a setting in which new ideas under consideration for national implementation are (ii) _____ without having to involve the country as a whole. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. laboratory	D. dispersed
B. catalyst	E. undermined
C. standard	F. tried

3. Conventional deposits of oil and gas are actually the final resting place of far-traveled hydrocarbons that were (i) _____ deeper source beds of organic-rich rock. By contrast, shale gas (ii) _____ its birthplace, remaining in the source bed whose organic matter produced the gas.

A. trapped in	D. never leaves
B. generated in	E. swiftly escapes from
C. bound for	F. rarely stays in

4. Unlike most other serious journals, which drain money from their owners, the Review has long been (i) _____. But the formula is not without its imperfections, which have grown more pronounced in recent years. The publication has always been erudite and (ii) _____ but not always lively and readable. (iii) _____, accompanied by a certain aversion to risk taking, has pervaded its pages for a long time.

A. lucrative	D. authoritative	G. an originality
B. realistic	E. animated	H. an impulsiveness
C. unesteemed	F. trendy	I. a staleness

5. Flawed as it may be because it is conducted by subjective scientists, science itself has methods that help us _____ our biases and talk about objective reality with some validity.

- A. bypass
- B. reduce
- C. exacerbate
- D. magnify
- E. acknowledge
- F. circumvent

6. In Japanese aesthetics, especially but not only in Noh, beauty contains the idea of _____. beauty must have an air of evanescence, the intimation of its own demise.

- A. transience
- B. symmetry
- C. decay
- D. simplicity
- E. balance
- F. deterioration

7. The uniquely human ability to rethink and revise our social arrangements is a weird blessing, allowing us to create systems that are as likely to _____ us as to liberate us.

- A. cheer
- B. shackle
- C. admonish
- D. educate
- E. stifle
- F. enliven

test 15 section 1 (medium)

1. There is _____ in the director's most recent film that keeps the melodramatic possibilities latent in its script safely at bay. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. a mawkishness
- B. a predictability
- C. an austerity
- D. an ostentatiousness
- E. an emotiveness

2. Despite dispute between the sisters lasted all summer, Megan remained (i)_____ and Laruen was equally (ii)_____.

A. intransigent	D. indolent
B. feckless	E. uncompromising
C. munificent	F. taciturn

3. Cultures can shape attitudes and beliefs in ways that (i)_____ conscious awareness or control; in other words, cultural orientations may develop from processes that do not entail (ii)_____ participation, and cultures may pervade subtle psychological dynamics in ways that individuals may not be able to (iii)_____. Thus, theories and tools developed to study implicit cognition may increase our understanding of the complex interplay between culture and individuals.

A. operate outside of	D. active	G. report
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B. tend to facilitate	E. random	H. maintain
C. may not alter	F. rote	I. condone

4. The Chavez Pass archaeological site was initially interpreted as indicative of _____ society, since it was thought to have been at the center of a cluster of smaller, contemporary settlements that it presumably controlled.

- A. an expansionist
- B. a hierarchical
- C. an urban
- D. a heterogeneous
- E. a diverse
- F. a stratified

5. Although the insistence on balancing spending against tax revenues has contributed to the economy's stagnation, unfortunately, the government does not seem likely to _____ this rigid policy.

- A. initiate
- B. persist in
- C. publicize
- D. repudiate
- E. continue
- F. recant

6. Although its director _____ that the movie uses a documentary approach in portraying the famous sit-down strike, in practice its characters are heavily fictionalized and fall into familiar Hollywood types.

- A. asserts
- B. concedes
- C. guarantees
- D. disputes
- E. grants
- F. maintains

7. For all the _____ the new CEO has received from the press recently, her staff have a decidedly less rosy view of her.

- A. encomiums
- B. tributes
- C. evaluations
- D. critiques
- E. attention
- F. publicity

test 15 section 2 (medium)

1. Unlike some mammals—cows and sheep, for instance—that are notably _____, lions have a wide range of facial expressions. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. tractable
- B. impassive
- C. solitary
- D. social
- E. sluggish

2. World demand for oil had been intensified, but it slackened because China's surge in oil consumption had (i)_____. Moreover, high oil price had themselves started to act as a short-term (ii)_____ the global economy, thus further dampening demand.

A. spread	D. spur to
B. commenced	E. drag on
C. slowed	F. panacea for

3. The slow pace of job creation was without precedent for the period of recovery from a recession, but the conditions that conspired to cause the recession were also (i)_____. The stock market declined sharply, and rampant business investment slumped. Then an ensuing spate of scandals (ii)_____ public trust in the way companies were run. And yet, despite these powerful (iii)_____ to growth, the recession proved surprisingly mild.

A. heartening	D. weakened	G. counterforces
B. atypical	E. illuminated	H. stimulants
C. ambiguous	F. consolidated	I. concomitants

4. Given children's active fantasy lives, one might think of truthfulness as (i)_____ virtue in young children, but it turns out that lying is the more (ii)_____ skill. A child who is going to lie must recognize the truth, intellectually conceive of an alternate reality, and be able to convincingly sell that new reality to someone else. Therefore, lying (iii)_____ cognitive development and social skills in a way that honesty simply does not. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. an instinctive	D. advanced	G. undermines
B. an acquired	E. practical	H. forgoes
C. a conscious	F. mundane	I. demands

5. A cure for the common cold has been so elusive that it has become a modern symbol of _____.

- A. danger
- B. futility
- C. unease
- D. pointlessness
- E. sloth
- F. apathy

6. The dictator's gleaming military uniform and imperial paraphernalia sharply contrast with the _____ fashion favored by most other contemporary political leaders.

- A. unostentatious
- B. modest
- C. august
- D. majestic
- E. formal
- F. casual

7. If giant X-ray flares churn circumstellar disks enough to keep newborn planets, such as Earth once was, from spiraling into their suns, it would be an ironic twist on our conception of X-ray flares as _____.

- A. dangerous
- B. predictable

- C. ancient
- D. ephemeral
- E. perilous
- F. foreseeable

test 16 section 1 (easy)

1. Though humanitarian emergencies are frequent features of television news, such exposure seldom _____ the public, which rather seems resigned to a sense of impotency.

- A. paralyzes
- B. demoralizes
- C. assuages
- D. galvanizes
- E. exasperates

2. Despite the fact that the book promises a complete rethinking of the factors contributing to the conflict, the picture that the book paints is (i)_____: in identifying cause, it is more orthodox than (ii)_____.

A. obscure	D. restrictive
B. detailed	E. revisionist
C. familiar	F. enigmatic

3. Traditional Vietnamese culture has long promoted the idea of gender equality. Founding myths (i)_____ the equal division of labor in child care for mothers and fathers. As is often the case, however, theoretical commitments are (ii)_____ actual processes. In reality, gender-based (iii)_____ persists. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. obscure	D. incommensurate with	G. parity
B. celebrate	E. surpassed by	H. inclusiveness
C. countermand	F. inspired by	I. stratification

4. Not only was this writer content to leave the reading public in the dark, she seems to have _____ the role of trickster, seeding her works with apparent clues that led nowhere.

- A. rejected
- B. disdained
- C. relished
- D. participated in
- E. delighted in
- F. developed

5. Although the biography never explicitly assesses what role the dynamic between Mr. Merrill's parents might have played in the development of his personality, the author offers plenty of _____.

- A. mystification
- B. elucidation
- C. speculation
- D. reflection
- E. obfuscation
- F. conjecture

6. There are great _____ in countries' greenhouse gas emissions, especially in per capita terms: while the United States and China are similar in aggregate emissions, United States per capita emissions are a huge multiple of China's.

- A. distortions
- B. disparities
- C. fluctuations
- D. advances
- E. variances
- F. vacillations

7. There is frequently a protracted time interval between the introduction of an innovative musical composition and its public acceptance; the concert-going public often spurns the _____ in favor of the familiar for a prolonged period.

- A. comprehensive
- B. intricate
- C. novel
- D. original
- E. intelligible
- F. complex

test 16 section 2 (medium)

1. The theory that the 1908 Tunguska event was the explosion of a cosmic body in the sky over Siberia is _____: no one has yet found fragments of the object or any impact craters in the affected region. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. long-standing
- B. indisputable
- C. plausible
- D. uncontested
- E. unproven

2. Motivation is the hardest of all managerial tasks, and it is _____ to expect a single memo, no matter how well crafted, to have much effect on the staff's attitude.

- A. ingenious
- B. reasonable
- C. fanciful
- D. scrupulous
- E. radical

3. Collecting such fragment of contemporary popular culture as postcards, newspaper clippings, and wallpaper patterns, Susan Hiller transforms these seemingly (i) _____ artifacts into objective (ii) _____ by making them the centerpieces in her compositions.

A. extravagant	D. importance
B. trivial	E. uniformity
C. archaic	F. banality

4. In adolescence, (i) _____ interactions are crucial in forging a self-identity. To be sure, this process often plays out in (ii) _____ as a means of defining and shoring up the sense of self. Kids will seek out like-minded companions, and spurn others who seem different. But when kept within reasonable bounds, this in-group (iii) _____ generally evolves into a more mature friendship pattern.

A. adult	D. cliquish social behavior	G. alienation
B. wide-ranging	E. dramatic changes in personality	H. clustering
C. peer	F. heightened sociability	I. competition

5. The concept of the Hellenistic period in ancient history has proved useful but also _____, with scholars disagreeing on the dates when the period began and ended.

- A. slippery
- B. elusive
- C. fruitless
- D. deceptive
- E. futile
- F. compelling

6. Few ideas are more _____ than the notion that cultures evolve in Darwin fashion; many academics have begun writing about cultural evolution, but few treat the underlying Darwinian logic with the care it deserves.

- A. abused
- B. archaic
- C. misused
- D. outdated
- E. divisive
- F. derivative

7. After many years of feeling _____ by his seniors managers, Clark was becoming hopeful of advancement. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. vilified
- B. stymied
- C. hindered
- D. aggrieved
- E. circumvented
- F. overlooked

test 17 section 1 (easy)

1. Many readers today consider the moral sentiments expressed in the ancient writers' work to be quite vapid, and in the seventeenth century they were similarly regarded as _____.

- A. jejune
- B. didactic
- C. dogmatic
- D. tendentious
- E. arcane

2. Although movie critic Pauline Kael had a distaste for sycophancy, she also had a need for (i)_____; as a consequence of these competing feelings, she sent very (ii)_____ signals to friends and colleagues.

A. solitude	D. direct
B. obeisance	E. subtle
C. clarity	F. mixed

3. One sometimes hears that Marco Polo introduced pasta to the Western world, having encountered it in China. This durable myth, which (i) _____ that nothing should have been known of pasta in Italy until 1295, when Marco Polo returned from the Far East, can easily be (ii) _____ by pointing out that there are Italian references to pasta that (iii) _____.

A. requires	D. augmented	G. praise its virtues
B. demonstrates	E. debunked	H. can be authenticated
C. symbolizes	F. traced	I. predate that event

4. Williamson had a fierce commitment to achieving an accord, spending enormous amount of time trying to forge a consensus out of an often _____ assembly.

- A. apathetic
- B. fractious
- C. restive
- D. cynical
- E. compliant
- F. tractable

5. Readers looking for another condemnation of private equity firms should look elsewhere, this book is not _____ such firms.

- A. a rant against
- B. a diatribe on
- C. an exculpation
- D. a disquisition on
- E. a vindication of
- F. an argument about

6. His premiership, seemingly cast-iron year ago, is now so vulnerable that even a good day at the office does no more than buy him a few weeks of _____ from rebels within his own party.

- A. controversy
- B. reproach
- C. respite
- D. relief
- E. blame
- F. deference

7. Even before she went to art school, Veronica found the standard design categories _____: she didn't understand why designing buildings and designing tables should require different sensibilities. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. provocative
- B. limiting
- C. stimulating
- D. confusing
- E. confining
- F. exhilarating

test 17 section 2 (medium)

1. Though the volume of radioactive waste produced by nuclear power plants is _____, the problem of how to dispose of that waste is not: rather, it is of major importance.

- A. unmanageable

- B. troubling
- C. significant
- D. small
- E. deceptive

2. Since fibromyalgia's symptoms can be (i)_____ and can (ii)_____ other disorder, and its diagnosis depends largely on patients' descriptions rather than blood tests or biopsies, fibromyalgia's cause and treatment have been the subject of much debate.

A. wide-ranging	D. mimic
B. distinctive	E. illuminate
C. debilitating	F. preclude

3. Architecture scholar Sandy McCreery recently argued that traffic congestion, far from being a sign of urban (i)_____, is a mark of urban (ii)_____; congestion promotes contemplation of our surroundings and provides us with a shared experience, thereby fulfilling the essential task of the city.

A. plentitude	D. ambition
B. decline	E. privation
C. excitement	F. health

4. For almost two centuries, the German island of Sylt has offered various therapies for every conceivable (i)_____ from broken bones to liver complaints. The local mud, saltwater, thermal pools, and spas have been deemed (ii)_____ by the German medical system, which (iii)_____ some of these treatments. Consequently, the treatments are widely used.

A. malady	D. healthful	G. doubts
B. indiscretion	E. suspect	H. denies
C. prognosis	F. innocuous	I. funds

5. The author engages this issue from diverse perspectives, supports his arguments with many examples, and manages to avoid antagonizing others in dealing with a very _____ subject.

- A. contentious
- B. pedestrian
- C. controversial
- D. perplexing
- E. mundane
- F. intriguing

6. Space is often referred to as the final frontier, as the only realm of which humankind has still to gain substantial understanding, yet the ocean is also another vast area about which our knowledge is _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. erroneous
- B. confusing
- C. frustrating
- D. rudimentary
- E. delusive
- F. sketchy

7. Culture, like speech, is primarily a human faculty, although both functions may exist in a more _____ form in lesser primates.

- A. indispensable
- B. crucial
- C. primitive
- D. intelligible
- E. recognizable
- F. rudimentary

test 18 section 1 (medium)

1. For the urban researcher, the long lives of ancient cities can provide ample chronological data, making up for the paucity stemming from relative _____ of most present-day cities.

- A. complexity
- B. formlessness
- C. transparency
- D. diversity
- E. youthfulness

2. Though many professional book reviewers would agree that criticism should be (i) _____ enterprise, a tendency to write (ii) _____ reviews has risen, partly out of the mistaken belief that sharing personal details will help reviewers stand out of the pack. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. an anonymous	D. scathing
B. an evenhanded	E. confessional
C. a spirited	F. superficial

3. Biologists have little (i) _____ drawing the link between the success of humanity and human (ii) _____. Indeed, many biologists claim that this attribute, the ability to (iii) _____, or, to put it more sharply, to make individuals subordinate their self-interest to the needs of the group, lies at the root of human achievement.

A. consensus regarding	D. resilience	G. reflect
B. compunction about	E. sociability	H. communicate
C. justification for	F. uniqueness	I. cooperate

4. Tompkinson's prior donations to the university, while very generous, failed to _____ the magnitude of her latest gift.

- A. compensate for
- B. portend
- C. clarify
- D. predict
- E. offset
- F. undermine

5. The first images of Jupiter's moon Callisto show bright regions of material, as if older and darker ice had slid downhill and exposed the _____ ice underneath.

- A. ancient
- B. murky
- C. compact

- D. pristine
- E. grimy
- F. unblemished

6. Mortoris is dour and _____, seemingly incapable of smiling, let alone laughing.

- A. mirthful
- B. jovial
- C. intelligent
- D. tepid
- E. lugubrious
- F. gloomy

7. Circulatory systems on organisms originated in widely separated epochs, according to the fossil record, and under a broad range of circumstances, the myriad forms they take attest to that _____ of origin.

- A. mysteriousness
- B. randomness
- C. ambiguity
- D. heterogeneity
- E. indeterminacy
- F. diversity

test 18 section 2 (medium)

1. Few studies have been published on ground-squirrel dispersal, and most of them have involved very small sample sizes, thus most statement regarding ground-squirrel dispersal must be considered _____.

- A. invaluable
- B. unexceptional
- C. inveterate
- D. routine
- E. conjectural

2. Many of the unusual behaviors attributed to crows—such as drinking coffee or presenting gifts to people who feed them—are based on (i)_____ and therefore fall into the category of (ii)_____ rather than science.

A. long-term observation	D. anecdote
B. controlled experiments	E. speculation
C. secondhand testimony	F. hypothesis

3. Despite the scathing precision with which she satirizes the lives of social aspirants and moneyed folk, the writer appears to (i)_____ being part of the world she presents as so (ii)_____.

A. abhor	D. unattainable
B. relish	E. insufferable
C. evoke	F. enchanting

4. Inuit print making is less (i)_____ than carving in that it does not have substantial historical precedents, although there are (ii)_____ incised carvings on bone or antler, facial tattoo marks or inlay skin work on clothing, mitts and footwear. Carving materials such as stone, bone, antler,

wood, and ivory were (iii)_____, but paper and drawing tools were unknown until introduced by early explorers and missionaries. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. traditional	D. affinities with	G. available locally
B. prestigious	E. objections to	H. rarely used
C. anomalous	F. regulations about	I. virtually interchangeable

5. Compared to their predecessors, who were more nationalist than feminist in political orientation, Roman women activists of the younger generation are more inclined to _____ women's rights, often creating organizations focused primarily on women's issues.

- A. expand
- B. de-emphasize
- C. champion
- D. idealize
- E. downplay
- F. defend

6. Individuals, governments, and companies show ample ability to _____ themselves by setting goals based on current conditions and then blindly following them even when those conditions change drastically.

- A. hamstring
- B. reinvent
- C. promote
- D. revitalize
- E. impair
- F. invigorate

7. The performer can be _____ in his comedy, but he is fundamentally a bighearted person who displays a core sweetness even at his most manic.

- A. inflammatory
- B. pedestrian
- C. gloomy
- D. uninspired
- E. puerile
- F. provocative

test 19 section 1 (medium)

1. To criticize a disaster film for being _____ is a bit silly, since people do not go to disaster movies to see an honest portrayed of reality. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. expensive
- B. harrowing
- C. derivative
- D. convoluted
- E. implausible

2. The benefits offered by information technology do not (i)_____ the need for individual reasoning; for example, Internet user should not allow the reasoning process to be (ii)_____ the mere accumulation raw data.

A. disguise	D. preceded by
-------------	----------------

B. signal	E. supplemented with
C. diminish	F. supplanted by

3. For many years, Americans have had a love affair with ferryboats. Ferries are said to relieve our frayed nerves after we've stewed in bumper-to-bumper traffic, and conventional wisdom also says ferries (i)_____ congestion and air pollution by getting us out of cars. Unfortunately, this (ii)_____ notion recently has (iii)_____ several West Coast mayors, who have in consequence eagerly pursued the implementation of ferry service in their cities.

A. contribute to	D. provocative	G. captivated
B. reduce	E. misguided	H. confused
C. cover up	F. cynical	I. outraged

4. In ways large and small, millions of people are taking active steps to _____ the medical mainstream, whether by taking herbal remedies for disease or by placing their hopes for a cure in alternative treatment.

- A. augment
- B. sidestep
- C. support
- D. vilify
- E. circumvent
- F. endorse

5. Although its gray text blocks and black-and-white illustrations give it a sober mien, this one-stop resource can take the place of a dozen less _____ texts.

- A. exhaustive
- B. interesting
- C. appealing
- D. original
- E. educational
- F. comprehensive

6. The media have constantly disparaged the governor's competence and have found a public only too eager to applaud their _____.

- A. assiduousness
- B. stupefaction
- C. mockery
- D. incredulity
- E. certitude
- F. derision

7. The _____ of ophthalmology as a field in the United States from 1820 to 1850 is evident in the opening of at least five eye hospitals during this period, offering new venues for ophthalmic treatment and experimentation. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. sophistication
- B. retrenchment
- C. burgeoning
- D. resurgence
- E. curtailment
- F. expansion

test 19 section 2 (medium)

1. In contrast to such sparsely populated terrestrial habitats as desert and tundra, the oceans _____ with a seemingly endless array of creatures.

- A. teem
- B. flow
- C. evolve
- D. roil
- E. ebb

2. Barring the discovery of new letters, hidden diaries, or the like, fresh information about eminent people is hard to find because their lives have been so intensely _____.

- A. ridiculed
- B. scrutinized
- C. admired
- D. embellished
- E. underrated

3. Because the book is largely concerned with an examination of various (i) _____ often encountered in contemporary thinking, such as an exaggerated appreciation for meaningless coincidence and a credulous accept of pseudoscience, much of the writing has a (ii) _____ quality to it. Nevertheless, it avoids the overly earned scolding tone common to many such endeavors.

A. inadequacies	D. debunking
B. abstractions	E. speculative
C. complexities	F. generalizing

4. Analysis of 47.5-million-year-old fossils from Pakistan has yielded fresh insights into the early ancestors of modern whales. For example, *Maiacetus inuus* was a land animal (i) _____ life in the sea. One *Maiacetus inuus* fossil encased a fetus positioned for a head-first delivery, which is typical of a land mammal and suggests the species gave birth onshore. But it probably spent much of its time (ii) _____: its big teeth were suited for catching fish, while its flipper-like feet must have been (iii) _____ walking. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. resistant	D. in the water	G. incompatible with
B. removed from	E. fleeing from predators	H. clumsy for
C. adapted to	F. protecting its young	I. strengthened by

5. Aerial viewings of the gigantic stone horse attributed to the Native American Quechuan people fail to _____ the considerable artistry required to create the piece: the horse appears crudely constructed unless carefully examined from the ground.

- A. reveal
- B. justify
- C. manifest
- D. mitigate
- E. diminish
- F. undercut

6. The book aims to illuminate how science has changed the meaning of nothingness from _____ philosophical concept to something we can almost put under a microscope.

- A. a tangible

- B. a palpable
- C. a nebulous
- D. a nettlesome
- E. an incontrovertible
- F. a vague

7. Few ideas are more _____ than the notion that cultures evolve in Darwin fashion; many academics have begun writing about cultural evolution, but few treat the underlying Darwinian logic with the care it deserves.

- A. abused
- B. archaic
- C. misused
- D. outdated
- E. divisive
- F. derivative

test 20 section 1 (medium)

1. Scientists have argued not only that the chains of atoms called ladder compounds have _____ theoretical interest but also that studies of such systems can lead to important practical applications.

- A. limited
- B. dubious
- C. superfluous
- D. unidimensional
- E. intrinsic

2. The building affairs minister rightly recognizes that the current planning system—under which the government controls every aspect of construction—creates disastrous developments, but she is wrong to propose the opposite: the wholesale (i) _____ of the building market. Such a complete (ii) _____ of responsibility on the part of the state can hardly be in the public's interest.

A. liberalization	D. abnegation
B. preservation	E. recapitulation
C. regulation	F. accretion

3. Those who took Clark's old-mannered compliance for obsequiousness (i) _____ him: his apparent (ii) _____ veiled a fervent (iii) _____ of the authority that others exercised over him, one that he occasionally expressed by discreetly sabotaging their most important projects.

A. misconstrued	D. cynicism	G. veneration
B. condemned	E. acquiescence	H. justification
C. respected	F. intractability	I. detestation

4. The initial, widely shared pessimism turned out to be _____, because it ignored the many things that could be done with resources left behind. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. unintelligible
- B. unfathomable
- C. unfounded
- D. unimaginative

- E. unjustified
- F. unimportant

5. Historically, the depletion of soil's nitrogen has been one of the most _____ problems faced by farmers: an essential nutrient, nitrogen is quickly leached from soil, and farmers have struggled to find ways to replenish it.

- A. capricious
- B. ubiquitous
- C. worrisome
- D. stubborn
- E. intractable
- F. unpredictable

6. Scientists should hope the faults in their theories will be _____ their peers since the refutation of one hypothesis can free its originator to develop a better one.

- A. discerned by
- B. disregarded by
- C. discovered by
- D. ignored by
- E. opaque to
- F. inspiring to

7. Although men still dominate the ranks of full professors in the field of astronomy, the increasing numbers of younger women in the field could _____ a change in its gender mix.

- A. require
- B. alleviate
- C. block
- D. presage
- E. portend
- F. hinder

test 20 section 2 (medium)

1. Some novelists immodestly idealized and exaggerated the significance of their work, but others, _____ to exalt the role of the writer, question a transcendent view of the art.

- A. averring
- B. declining
- C. seeking
- D. feigning
- E. avowing

2. Though many avant-garde writers _____ traditional distinctions among literary categories, combining elements of biography and fiction, prose and poetry, this fusion of forms has been slow to catch on with publishers. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. flout
- B. presuppose
- C. exploit
- D. imitate
- E. illuminate

3. Scholarly works on detective stories often begin with (i)_____, suggesting that there is something vaguely wrong with adults who spend their time reading such fiction and certainly something (ii)_____ those who devote energy to its analysis.

A. chronologies	D. awry in
B. apologies	E. astute about
C. synopses	F. courageous about

4. There are two opposing theories about mountain formation and climate over the past 40 million years: either the surge of mountain building (i)_____ the global cooling or vice versa. The first of these two theories asserts that widespread mountain building cooled the earth as a result of the (ii)_____ mountains and climate. For example, mountain glaciers tend to be (iii)_____: once established, they increase the reflectivity of the surface, thus lowering temperatures and allowing more ice to form.

A. superseded	D. disparity between	G. unpredictable
B. halted	E. feedback between	H. static
C. caused	F. complexity of	I. self-perpetuating

5. An apparent paradox led the scientists to pursue their present line of research. They were struck by the fact that a single mathematics formula can be used to describe physical phenomena that appear to be so _____.

- A. rudimentary
- B. interdependent
- C. interrelated
- D. complex
- E. heterogeneous
- F. dissimilar

6. In the northeastern United States, beaver populations had been critically reduced or even _____ in large areas at the end of nineteenth century; as a result, several states instituted prohibitions on beaver trapping.

- A. diminished
- B. extirpated
- C. eliminated
- D. devalued
- E. weakened
- F. underrated

7. The preliminary analysis being on the whole, reassuring its confirmation would _____ concerns about the dangers of project.

- A. explain
- B. deflate
- C. rationalize
- D. soothe
- E. reflect
- F. hide

test 21 section 1 (medium)

1. By pointing out the self-serving nature of the governor's motives for supporting the new health care policy, the columnist implied that the governor's idealistic-sounding explanation of her position on the issue was almost certainly _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. impractical
- B. derivative
- C. simplistic
- D. disingenuous
- E. ineffectual

2. Due to the extraordinary circumstances, British business owners found themselves in a (i) _____ position during the Second World War, forced to accept regular interference from government and to acquiesce to (ii) _____ role for labor unions in negotiating the terms and conditions of employment.

A. defensive	D. a traditional
B. dominant	E. an enhanced
C. customary	F. a diminished

3. With the emergence of scientific history-writing in the late nineteenth century, several authors sought to ignore the glowing myths surrounding George Washington and uncover the human being within, but their biographies were still (i) _____ enough that Washington remained a marbled and remote figure. Indeed, by the 1920s Washington has become such (ii) _____ personage that inevitably someone had to go to the other extreme and try to (iii) _____ the legend.

A. ponderous	D. a deified	G. debunk
B. empirical	E. an ignored	H. aggrandize
C. laudatory	F. a misunderstood	I. reproduce

4. Some kinds of deadly bacteria, including those that cause tetanus, tuberculosis, and botulism, remain _____ until something triggers their insidious activity.

- A. harmless
- B. innocuous
- C. anomalous
- D. aberrant
- E. efficacious
- F. undetectable

5. Titan, Saturn's largest moon, looks surprisingly _____, even though it is a cold, dimly lit world made from unknown materials. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. habitable
- B. familiar
- C. forbidding
- D. placid
- E. daunting
- F. recognizable

6. The initial, widely shared pessimism turned out to be _____, because it ignored the many things that could be done with resources left behind.

- A. unintelligible
- B. unfathomable
- C. unfounded
- D. unimaginative
- E. unjustified
- F. unimportant

7. Despite a tendency to be overtly _____, her poetry does not consist solely of pious sentiments: it often sparks the imagination and provides lively entertainment.

- A. preachy
- B. querulous
- C. insincere
- D. sanctimonious
- E. plaintive
- F. disingenuous

test 21 section 2 (medium)

1. In the solar system, collisions involving cosmic object are among the most _____ processes shaping surfaces: images of many solar objects show a proliferation of impact craters formed throughout the past 4.5 billion years.

- A. cataclysmic
- B. pervasive
- C. misleading
- D. uncontrollable
- E. random

2. As Ellen Donkin explains, in eighteenth-century England, writing plays (i)_____ women. Even when the (ii)_____ meant that playwriting did not bring personal fame, the work nevertheless enabled them to present their own views to the public and offered the possibility of acquiring capital.

A. empowered	D. use of a pseudonym
B. overextended	E. lack of a producer
C. impressed	F. poor remuneration

3. Pioneering medical research scientists' (i)_____ claims regarding the (ii)_____ new researches make the public wonder their own doctors are not dispensing miracles. There are forces, both external and internal, on scientists that most require them to (iii)_____. Without money, there is no science. Researchers must constantly convince administrators who control tax dollars, investors, and individual donors that the work they are doing will make a difference.

A. modest	D. serious constraints on	G. improvise
B. inflated	E. overblown interpretations of	H. oversell
C. fastidious	F. potential benefits of	I. generalize

4. Despite the occasional (i)_____ of their venues, the culture of corporate conferences is a deeply (ii)_____ conference, each day consisted of nearly nine hours of continuous lectures and panels enlivened by pleasantries or anything that could be construed as a joke. The only (iii)_____ sensory deprivation of the sessions came from the handsome color slides favored by the corporate presenters.

A. seclusion	D. sycophantic	G. allusion to
B. opulence	E. ascetic	H. ramification of
C. enormity	F. mercenary	I. respite from

5. Willian Perkins, his _____ speaking style notwithstanding, has long been seen as the moderate face of his political party. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. fiery
- B. genteel
- C. bumbling
- D. unremarkable
- E. affable
- F. impassioned

6. Although in his new book he tends to repeat himself like a _____ uncle, McHughen makes a persuasive case for the safety of tinkering with genes to create new foods.

- A. taciturn
- B. reserved
- C. prototypical
- D. cantankerous
- E. loquacious
- F. garrulous

7. Joshua Gisemba Bagaka found that the pedagogical results of group projects and other engaged learning activities in Kenyan mathematics classroom were _____; such activities, then, may not be the best way of improving mathematics education.

- A. overstated
- B. counterintuitive
- C. mixed
- D. discouraging
- E. inconsistent
- F. inexplicable

test 22 section 1 (medium)

1. If the study proves that bears are still endemic to the area, the proposal to introduce additional bears of the same species will probably face less opposition, since the plan would then involve _____ a historic population, not trying to build population from scratch.

- A. reclassifying
- B. augmenting
- C. forestalling
- D. publicizing
- E. winnowing

2. Computers have become adept in rarefied domains once thought to be uniquely human. However, they simultaneously have (i) _____ certain tasks basic to the human experience, including spatial orientation and object recognition, and in so doing, have shown us how (ii) _____ such fundamental skills truly are. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. failed to master	D. outmoded
B. helped to improve	E. common
C. managed to mimic	F. impressive

3. Anna Gavalda's fiction is appealing largely because of her writing styles, which is certainly (i) _____. It is heavy on dialogue (and light on embellishment) features very short sections (of often only a few sentence) in rapid succession, and in general favors an unadorned directness. Not surprisingly, this style works better in short-story form than in novels, and the story collection I Wish
微信公众号：张巍GRE

someone Were Waiting for Me Somewhere (ii)_____ her attempt to (iii)_____ it in novel, as in, for example, Someone I loved.

A. annoying	D. is thought to precede	G. undermine
B. distinctive	E. fails in comparison with	H. sustain
C. convoluted	F. impresses considerably more than	I. reject

4. Architects may be more extroverted and therefore the more _____ members of a bridge design team, but they are not always the most essential.

- A. indispensable
- B. conscientious
- C. reliable
- D. visible
- E. valuable
- F. salient

5. Excessive focus on what might have been can cause in us feelings of restlessness and regret, but some scientists are beginning to think that fancying an alternative reality might have _____ effects as well.

- A. subtle
- B. adverse
- C. restorative
- D. pleasurable
- E. unfavorable
- F. tonic

6. Apparent flaws in the sculptor's work have not _____ its respectful reception by most modern critics.

- A. determined
- B. controlled
- C. undermined
- D. prevented
- E. overshadowed
- F. precluded

7. It's hardly _____ the committee calls for: rudimentary competence would be an improvement on the current chaos. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. accountability
- B. disarray
- C. unruliness
- D. faultlessness
- E. loyalty
- F. perfection

test 22 section 2 (medium)

1. A new television documentary focuses on of the prime minister's defining contradiction, portraying her as a woman who cultivated an image of _____, but who liked to live grandly.

- A. irascibility
- B. abstemiousness
- C. contentiousness
- D. insouciance

E. surreptitiousness

2. The stories in Yiyun Li's recent collection are distinctive particularly for the strong contrast between their emotional intensity and their consistently _____ tone.

- A. affable
- B. ebullient
- C. measured
- D. irascible
- E. overwrought

3. Until the advent of film, commercial entertainment in England occurred only where concentrated urban populations provided audiences large enough to make it remunerative: theaters and music halls were (i) _____ in rural villages. But village cinemas quickly become (ii) _____, even though they were ramshackle affairs in comparison to the urban picture palaces.

A. spartan	D. commonplace
B. unconceivable	E. sophisticated
C. profitable	F. unfashionable

4. For Plato the art of music was so (i) _____ moral and political reality that any alteration to music system would necessarily require a corresponding political shift. But two and a half millennia later, when classical music is generally seen merely as a lifestyle accessory, Plato's conception seems (ii) _____. To be sure, there are still people who consider classical music to be of (iii) _____ cultural importance, but few of them are able to articulate this convincingly.

A. rarely identified with	D. apt	G. marginal
B. tenuously connected to	E. absurd	H. profound
C. firmly anchored in	F. disingenuous	I. uncertain

5. One of the vocalists who auditioned for a leading part in the local production of Sweeney Todd seemed to prefer _____ to any attempt at producing a melody; a more unpleasant voice was hard to imagine. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. warbling
- B. imitating
- C. improvising
- D. shrieking
- E. crooning
- F. caterwauling

6. Even if the story now seems a surprisingly innocuous overture to the author's later, more fully developed narrations, it _____ some of the key traits of those bleaker tales.

- A. avoids
- B. belies
- C. undercuts
- D. anticipates
- E. possesses
- F. prefigures

7. While recognizing that recent reports of cyber warfare, phone-hacking scandals, and identity thefts have tended to accent the destructive connotation of the word, Sue Halpern maintains that "hacking" is such _____ term that its meaning nearly always derives from its context.

- A. a generic

- B. an inclusive
- C. a positive
- D. a subjective
- E. an affirmative
- F. a technical

test 23 section 1 (medium)

1. The paleontologist examined the problem afresh, believing that the accepted classification _____ the essential continuity of the specimens by making specious distinctions among them.

- A. disproved
- B. belied
- C. conflated
- D. divulged
- E. relaxed

2. Among wide-ranging animal species, populations at the edge of the species' range are frequently exposed to less (i) _____ and more variable conditions than those in other parts on the range. As a result, the animal's abundance is often (ii) _____.

A. erratic	D. lower at the periphery
B. favorable	E. unaffected by habitat
C. demanding	F. underestimated by researchers

3. When a new scientific model emerges, research studies (i) _____ that paradigm tend to dominate in the scientific literature: the process of selecting articles for publication is tilted towards positive results. But once the paradigm (ii) _____, the academic incentives shift in the opposite direction: research results are more considered worthy publication when they (iii) _____ what has become the established view.

A. tweaking	D. is initially articulated	G. bolster
B. affirming	E. has become entrenched	H. circumvent
C. controverting	F. is about to be attacked	I. undermine

4. When studying the ancient Greek astronomers, Copernicus realized that despite the intrinsic beauty of many of their arguments, the ancients often made claims that _____ logic.

- A. refuted
- B. questioned
- C. influenced
- D. swayed
- E. defied
- F. disregarded

5. Although Wynne claims to recognize that _____ evidence is available to make definitive statement, she offers them nonetheless, arriving at some sweeping generalizations.

- A. concrete
- B. finite
- C. insufficient
- D. indirect
- E. conclusive
- F. meager

6. In order to cultivate new repertoire, the music industry is providing a hearing for previously _____ composers. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. idle
- B. thwarted
- C. celebrated
- D. renowned
- E. anonymous
- F. obscure

7. Although many skeptics of the scientific theory _____ critiques that have long since been disproved, some of the doubters arguably bring up valid points.

- A. overlook
- B. revise
- C. recycle
- D. utilize
- E. neglect
- F. rehash

test 23 section 2 (medium)

1. The era's examples of _____ that are cited by the author can be balanced in part by certain examples of dissent during the same period.

- A. diversity
- B. authoritarianism
- C. forbearance
- D. volatility
- E. lucidity

2. Historian Barbara Alpern Engel's task in writing a book about women in Russia must have been a (i) _____ one, because the (ii) _____ the Russian empire's peoples meant that Russian women could never be treated as a homogeneous group. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. motivating	D. unity among
B. boring	E. disinterest in
C. daunting	F. diversity of

3. The material covered in this article has been (i) _____ in previous publications, and since currently neglected areas remained unexplored, the article contains no (ii) _____.

A. skirted	D. revelations
B. scrutinized	E. distortions
C. countered	F. conclusions

4. The historian of ancient science Otto Neugebauer concluded that Babylonian astronomical texts are (i) _____ because everything has been eliminated from the astronomy except observations and the mathematical consequences of an initial hypothesis about the fundamental character of the astronomical movements. This judgment cohered with the high level of mathematical theory, which (ii) _____ mathematical computation together with empirical observations as (iii) _____ of science

and denied any role to speculative hypotheses of a strongly theoretical nature.

A. questionable	D. repudiated	G. end result
B. scientific	E. admitted	H. necessary characteristics
C. limited	F. confounded	I. discredited path

5. In a number of instances, investors hoping to tap into the region's meteoric growth have instead faced problems ranging from unpredictable management practices to outright ____.

- A. malfeasance
- B. incompetence
- C. fraudulence
- D. capriciousness
- E. hysteria
- F. impulsiveness

6. To call Kermode the finest English critic of his generation would be a _____ compliment, since not many of its population are professionally engaged in literary criticism.

- A. sincere
- B. backhanded
- C. paltry
- D. heartfelt
- E. meager
- F. plausible

7. Even though the original settlement may not hold up, it at least proves that the deadlock can be broken and that a hitherto _____ party is ready to bargain.

- A. implacable
- B. unyielding
- C. impeccable
- D. flawless
- E. unqualified
- F. capricious

test 24 section 1 (medium)

1. It seems foolish to refuse the offer of an expedient that is both so _____ success and so difficult to create them absent. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. reminiscent of
- B. lacking in
- C. distinct from
- D. indispensable to
- E. inimical to

2. Although the political science professor's paper is quite (i) _____ about the government's problem, suggesting that they are part of (ii) _____ a process, the prognosis for the government is, on the contrary, actually quite auspicious.

A. straightforward	D. degenerative
B. circuitous	E. comprehensive
C. pessimistic	F. spontaneous

3. The notion of film producers as the ogres of the movie business has proved an (i) _____ one, but according to *The Producers* by Tim Adler, it is not always grounded in reality. Attacking what he calls the “auteur myth”—the idea of the director as the single purveyor of art in an industry otherwise peopled with (ii) _____—he places at the heart of his book an image of the producer, not the director, as the primary (iii) _____ force in the development and production of a movie.

A. accurate	D. visionaries	G. financial
B. hypocritic	E. profitmongers	H. inertial
C. enduring	F. innocents	I. creative

4. In sharp contrast to the novel’s scenic realism and precisely characterized figure is its persistent philosophical _____.

- A. naturalism
- B. abstraction
- C. generality
- D. impartiality
- E. sincerity
- F. objectivity

5. Her attempts to wrest fiction free from traditional constraints like plot and character were never entirely popular with readers; nonetheless, her fiction has had _____ influence on critical theory, novel, cinema, and even psychology.

- A. a studied
- B. a negligible
- C. a decisive
- D. an unmistakable
- E. an insignificant
- F. a restorative

6. The physics graveyard is strewn with the skeletons of failed theories, unexplained effects, and anomalous particles that briefly _____ the research spotlight, then rapidly fade from view.

- A. douse
- B. intensify
- C. perpetuate
- D. capture
- E. extinguish
- F. secure

7. The media have constantly disparaged the governor’s competence and have found a public only too eager to applaud their _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. assiduousness
- B. stupefaction
- C. mockery
- D. incredulity
- E. certitude
- F. derision

test 24 section 2 (medium)

1. With the numerous opponents of the controversial new taxation measure in such a fury, anyone who publicly advocated the measure did not fail to meet with _____ usage.

- A. politic
- B. severe
- C. sober
- D. respectful
- E. dejected

2. Although the vast weight of evidence supports the contention that the products of agricultural biotechnology are environmentally (i)_____, many people still find them (ii)_____ unsettling.

A. destructive	D. retroactively
B. sound	E. innocuously
C. intriguing	F. intrinsically

3. The (i)_____ nature of the candidate's comments is calculated. As a long-standing target of critics who regard him as radical, he understands that he needs to be as (ii)_____ as possible if he is to overcome those critiques and appear as a (iii)_____ leader.

A. opprobrious	D. innocuous	G. polarizing
B. platitudinous	E. truculent	H. cautious
C. pugnacious	F. supercilious	I. conciliatory

4. The new art museum's (i)_____ building augurs well for that ambitious institution because it speaks of (ii)_____ contemporary architecture on the part of the board of directors that may (iii)_____ equal astuteness about contemporary art.

A. nondescript	D. a discernment about	G. conceal
B. outstanding	E. a hostility toward	H. supplant
C. outdated	F. an intoxication by	I. promise

5. Science is arguably a very high-minded pursuit, but that is not to say that all of its practitioners are _____, as numerous articles alleging overly generous pharmaceutical industry payments to medical researchers have tried to show. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. conventional
- B. clever
- C. unimpeachable
- D. ingenious
- E. blameless
- F. predictable

6. The town's air was consistently _____: depending on the breeze, one might be greeted with the sour effluvia of twenty breweries, choking fumes from the coal factory, or brackish smells from the nearby river.

- A. malodorous
- B. toxic
- C. redolent
- D. benign
- E. noisome
- F. anodyne

7. One of the vocalists who auditioned for a leading part in the local production of Sweeney Todd seemed to prefer _____ to any attempt at producing a melody; a more unpleasant voice was hard to imagine.

- A. warbling
- B. imitating
- C. improvising
- D. shrieking
- E. crooning
- F. caterwauling

test 25 section 1 (medium)

1. She constantly _____ herself for not living up to her own ideas—for not working hard enough or not having motives that were pure enough.

- A. exalted
- B. coddled
- C. excoriated
- D. mollified
- E. deluded

2. The author argued that the field of sociology has been overly (i)_____, partly because, for many scholars, the edges of social universe are defined by national borders. In this era of increasing globalization, however, sociology is presented with a historically distinct opportunity to transcend its former (ii)_____.

A. narrow in scope	D. utilitarianism
B. susceptible to fads	E. parochialism
C. averse to empiricism	F. historicism

3. The modern iron suspension bridge dates from the early nineteenth century, but it did not have (i)_____ debut; many early suspension bridges were damaged, if not outright destroyed, by the wind. There were few (ii)_____, however, so the form (iii)_____.

A. a propitious	D. obvious parallels	G. declined
B. a conspicuous	E. practical alternatives	H. inspired
C. an equivocal	F. unnoticed instances	I. persisted

4. Some experts estimate that the recreational salmon fishery in British Columbia contributes more to the province's economy than the commercial salmon fishery does—a surprising statistic given the political commercial _____ of the fishery in the province.

- A. naïveté
- B. prominence
- C. supremacy
- D. ingenuousness
- E. salience
- F. resurgence

5. In 1884, Sewall and Dow agreed to join Roosevelt in the Dakota territory for reasons that appear to have been _____. Sewall later recalled that Roosevelt guaranteed them a share of anything made in his cattle business. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. pecuniary
- B. straightforward
- C. economic
- D. selfless
- E. quixotic
- F. altruistic

6. Because movie studios, under pressure to generate international sales, have favored big-budget pictures with fantasy plots, the representation of everyday domestic life has largely been _____ other media, such as television and literature.

- A. left to
- B. ceded to
- C. ascribed to
- D. attributed to
- E. substituted for
- F. replaced with

7. In order to cultivate new repertoire, the music industry is providing a hearing for previously _____ composers.

- A. idle
- B. thwarted
- C. celebrated
- D. renowned
- E. anonymous
- F. obscure

test 25 section 2 (medium)

1. In his youth, the naturalist and artist John James Audubon was given to _____ glamorous tales about himself: he falsely claimed to have studied under a renowned French painter and hinted that he was the heir apparent to the French throne.

- A. disavowing
- B. understanding
- C. constraining
- D. obfuscating
- E. concocting

2. Holston characterized a colonial situation as an aggregation of activities and a conjunction of outcomes that, though _____ and at times coordinated, were usually diffuse, disorganized, and even contradictory.

- A. dubious
- B. chaotic
- C. harmonious
- D. linked
- E. imputed

3. The author of this travel guide (i)_____ to show his readers Cairo as it really is, but his information is not reliable: for example, his geography is (ii)_____, with one walking tour covering areas of the city that are twenty miles apart. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. designs	D. erratic
B. forbears	E. erudite

C. purports	F. extensive
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4. The characters in this comic strip fret about the (i)_____ of their “little counterculture lives”, especially when terrible things are happening in the world, but the cartoonist makes their lives (ii)_____ in ways that do not seem (iii)_____ at all. Real things happen here—births, deaths, adoptions, affairs, breakups, commitments, ceremonies, civil union—and they matter.

A. unpredictability	D. stagnate	G. outlandish
B. arduousness	E. resonate	H. inconsequential
C. triviality	F. compete	I. intangible

5. It's hardly _____ the committee calls for: rudimentary competence would be an improvement on the current chaos.

- A. accountability
- B. disarray
- C. unruliness
- D. faultlessness
- E. loyalty
- F. perfection

6. Contrary to certain recent analyses that paint a dire portrait of soil loss from farmland, a new study of surveying data reaching back to the 1930s shows that erosion rates have been steadily _____.

- A. intensifying
- B. waning
- C. accelerating
- D. worsening
- E. declining
- F. deteriorating

7. Communicating articulately is typically regarded as an aggressive, persuasive talent, but it can also be protective: it allows a certain _____ closeness, conveying proximity while actually maintaining distance.

- A. feigned
- B. secretive
- C. dubious
- D. subtle
- E. false
- F. furtive

test 26 section 1 (medium)

1. The space travels described in science fiction stories always used to be epic adventures, in comparison to which current journals in space seem quite _____.

- A. mundane
- B. exciting
- C. dramatic
- D. risky
- E. heroic

2. The school system's modest plan for curriculum improvements has (i)_____ local educators: some call it (ii)_____ effort, while others say it is a pragmatic approach given the complexity of the task.

A. surprised	D. genuine
B. impressed	E. halfhearted
C. divided	F. practical

3. A certain amount of theoretical frenzy about comics today is (i)_____. After all, similar frenzies have been in other art forms in periods of their rapid development, for instance, the debates about painting that roiled Renaissance Italy. But such intellectual (ii)_____ rarely precedes creative glory. On the contrary, it commonly indicates that an artistic (iii)_____, having been made and recognized, is over, and that a process of increasing strained emulation and diminishing returns has set in. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. understandable	D. torpor	G. pitfall
B. unprecedented	E. conservatism	H. tradition
C. perplexing	F. arousal	I. breakthrough

4. The Chavez Pass archaeological site was initially interpreted as indicative of _____ society, since it was thought to have been at the center of a cluster of smaller, contemporary settlements that it presumably controlled.

- A. an expansionist
- B. a hierarchical
- C. an urban
- D. a heterogeneous
- E. a diverse
- F. a stratified

5. Although the essayist's arguments did not _____ her most perceptive readers, the extreme subtlety of the points she made explains why she was misinterpreted by most critics of her day.

- A. convince
- B. confound
- C. entertain
- D. persuade
- E. perplex
- F. enlighten

6. Architects may be more extroverted and therefore the more _____ members of a bridge design team, but they are not always the most essential. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. indispensable
- B. conscientious
- C. reliable
- D. visible
- E. valuable
- F. salient

7. Citing the corruption and intrigue that pervaded politics in the city, my colleague _____ the newspaper's trove of journalism prizes, declaring that finding great stories in the city must be effortless.

- A. slighted
- B. ignored

- C. lauded
- D. disparaged
- E. confounded
- F. commended

test 26 section 2 (hard)

1. Medieval cathedrals still stand as marvels of architecture, but as far as modern science is concerned, medieval physics and chemistry are simply irrelevant, at best a dead end, at worst the very _____ of what science is supposed to be.

- A. exemplar
- B. glorification
- C. reflection
- D. dilution
- E. antithesis

2. The author of this political history text shows considerable bias against the political party when assigning credit or blame for its actions: he deems (i) _____ what he favors and avoids what he (ii) _____.

A. pertinent	D. condemns
B. inevitable	E. condones
C. divided	F. ignores

3. It would be naïve to treat remarks made in diaries or personal letters as giving especially candid access to historical truth or even as being expressions of the writer's true state of mind, since the (i) _____ for exaggeration and deception in those forms is virtually nonexistent. Diaries and letters are rarely sites for (ii) _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. motivation	D. premeditated manipulation
B. penalty	E. childish theatrics
C. tendency	F. balanced reflection

4. Applications of the Endangered Species Act (ESA) have fared best in contexts in which habitat condition is closely linked to species condition and the cause of habitat degradation is easily identified. The achievements of the ESA in those contexts, however, have (i) _____ that other uses of the act can (ii) _____ that record even where such favorable conditions do not (iii) _____.

A. quelled the conviction	D. mitigate	G. vary
B. presaged the uncertainty	E. duplicate	H. pertain
C. fostered the misconception	F. elucidate	I. diminish

5. When studying the ancient Greek astronomers, Copernicus realized that despite the intrinsic beauty of many of their arguments, the ancients often made claims that _____ logic.

- A. refuted
- B. questioned
- C. influenced
- D. swayed
- E. defied

F. disregarded

6. Films that critics have slumbered through rarely generate industry excitement, even though the critics' _____ reception may be less the fault of the movie than of its unfortunate time slot near a fatiguing film festival's conclusion.

- A. somnolent
- B. impartial
- C. lethargic
- D. laconic
- E. befuddled
- F. evenhanded

7. Even though his opponent is currently trying to portray him as a wild-eyed radical, voters will likely reject this charge because it does not _____ his moderate political record.

- A. defer to
- B. conform to
- C. accede to
- D. argue with
- E. meddle with
- F. square with

test 27 section 1 (medium)

1. Investors are grateful that the attorney general has stepped in to pursue inquiries into misfeasance in the financial markets, given that the regulators officially charged with policing the industry have been _____.

- A. diffident
- B. meticulous
- C. straightforward
- D. implacable
- E. tenacious

2. The author paints a rather dark picture of book publishing as a hidebound industry, one that is facing a profound change in its mode of production but is so (i) _____ its past as to be (ii) _____ opportunity offered by technological changes.

A. alienated from	D. eager to exploit
B. emboldened by	E. unable to seize
C. encumbered by	F. forced to reconsider

3. Scientific papers often (i) _____ what actually happened in the course of the investigations they describe. Misunderstandings, blind alleys, and mistakes of various sorts will fail to appear in the final written accounts because (ii) _____ is a desirable attribute when transmitting results in a scientific report and would be poorly served by (iii) _____.

A. amplify	D. transparency	G. a comprehensive historical account
B. misrepresent	E. efficiency	H. a purely quantitative analysis
C. particularize	F. exhaustiveness	I. an overly superficial discussion

4. In noting that critical and popular opinions about Li's art coincided, Chuang _____ the existence of an exception to her general theory of art criticism, which posits that critics' views do not intersect with those of the general public.

- A. asserted
- B. conceded
- C. acknowledged
- D. doubted
- E. pondered
- F. questioned

5. Excessive focus on what might have been can cause in us feelings of restlessness and regret, but some scientists are beginning to think that fancying an alternative reality might have _____ effects as well. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. subtle
- B. adverse
- C. restorative
- D. pleasurable
- E. unfavorable
- F. tonic

6. As a historical genre, biography is best when _____, a careful reconstruction of the past in all its unfamiliar particularity.

- A. introspective
- B. reflective
- C. concrete
- D. concise
- E. meticulous
- F. thorough

7. Explorers could not build each other's knowledge if they could not trust records of previous explorers; thus exploration depended on the _____ of those who had gone before.

- A. collegiality
- B. endurance
- C. exactitude
- D. meticulousness
- E. eminence
- F. tenacity

test 27 section 2 (hard)

1. Consolidating memory is not instantaneous or even _____: every memory must be encoded and moved from short-term to long-term storage, and some of these memories are, for whatever reason, more vividly imprinted than others.

- A. salutary
- B. deliberate
- C. sequential
- D. momentary
- E. inevitable

2. Recent scholarship has questioned the (i) _____ of tropical forests around the world. Archaeologists have shown, for example, that the largest contiguous tract of what was thought to be virgin rain forest in the southern Amazon had been transformed into a cultural parkland before

European contact, and many of the forest islands in West Africa's savanna forest transition zone are (ii)_____ as well. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. diversity	D. isolated
B. naturalness	E. endangered
C. sustainability	F. anthropogenic

3. Even the reader acquainted with the outlines of Pushkin's biography will be (i)_____ the (ii)_____ so vividly conveyed in Binyon's biography. Not only was Pushkin's personal correspondence intercepted and his movements (iii)_____, but Tsar Nicholas I's decision to oversee Pushkin's career obliged Pushkin to submit all his manuscripts for inspection.

A. attracted by	D. suffocating lack of creative freedom	G. ignored
B. confused by	E. concern for contemporary society	H. monitored
C. struck by	F. underlying sense of historical change	I. commended

4. Viewing people as "social atoms" that obey rather simple rule (which are not unlike the laws of physics), one may discover certain (i)_____. Take, for example, the way channels emerge when people move in crowds. In the midst of initially (ii)_____ movements, one person begins to follow another—in an effort to avoid collisions—and streams of movement emerge. As more people join in, there is greater pull on others to join the flow, and the particular channels become (iii)_____.

A. apparent contradictions	D. inflexible	G. self-defeating
B. unproductive tendencies	E. straightforward	H. self-aggrandizing
C. lawlike regulations	F. chaotic	I. self-perpetuating

5. The _____ nature of the approval process for new drugs suggests that incentives to promote more expeditious decision making may be necessary.

- A. pecuniary
- B. commercial
- C. arbitrary
- D. sluggish
- E. capricious
- F. dilatory

6. The critic claims that, contrary to its reputation for _____, the novelist's prose is full of opaque language games. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. scrupulousness
- B. simplicity
- C. mendacity
- D. artlessness
- E. polish
- F. meticulousness

7. Not only is the advent of bookless or largely bookless libraries too large and powerful a change to be _____, it also offers too many real advantages for it to be considered a tragedy.

- A. understood
- B. averted
- C. foreseen
- D. forestalled
- E. endured

F. anticipated

test 28 section 1 (hard)

1. Instead of demonstrating the _____ of archaeological applications of electronic remote sensing, the pioneering study became, to some skeptics, an illustration of the imprudence of interpreting sites based on virtual archaeology.

- A. ubiquity
- B. limitation
- C. promise
- D. redundancy
- E. complexity

2. A (i)_____ to disseminate the vast scientific knowledge of our time to nonscientists shows real (ii)_____ the magnificent achievement humanity is capable of, like allowing a great work of art to mold in a warehouse.

A. triumph	D. indifference to
B. failure	E. enthusiasm for
C. diffusion	F. glory of

3. Fifty pages of footnotes, some of them presenting quite lengthy bibliographies, suggest that very few pertinent sources on the Black Arts movement in literature have (i)_____ Thompson's search; (ii)_____, the text makes it clear that the author's examination of these sources has been similarly (iii)_____.

A. eluded	D. moreover	G. valuable
B. characterized	E. however	H. timely
C. motivated	F. consequently	I. exhaustive

4. Her attempts to wrest fiction free from traditional constraints like plot and character were never entirely popular with readers; nonetheless, her fiction has had _____ influence on critical theory, novel, cinema, and even psychology. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. a studied
- B. a negligible
- C. a decisive
- D. an unmistakable
- E. an insignificant
- F. a restorative

5. Shifting Fortunes take a conventional approach to American union history by simply explaining the reasons behind union growth and decline in the nineteenth and twentieth centuries: it is a chronologically and thematically _____ study and nothing more.

- A. complicated
- B. confined
- C. multifarious
- D. onerous
- E. circumscribed
- F. taxing

6. A clever form of diplomacy involves subtly inducing the other party to propose your preference so that your _____ their requests appears as the granting of concession.

- A. accession to
- B. inattention to
- C. subversion of
- D. abnegation of
- E. repudiation of
- F. acquiescence to

7. Scientist reported last month on a sign of relative solar _____; the solar wind, a rush of charged particles continually spewed from the Sun at a million miles an hour, had diminished to its lowest level in 50 years.

- A. quiescence
- B. turbulence
- C. isolation
- D. calm
- E. remoteness
- F. instability

test 28 section 2 (hard)

1. While the writer was best known for her much-ballyhooed _____, her impact reached far beyond memorable quips.

- A. pensiveness
- B. drollness
- C. stoicism
- D. fastidiousness
- E. congeniality

2. The governor might conceivably find a genuine resolution to the budgetary dilemma, but she may be tempted to engage in a deception: a _____ exercise in fiscal prudence.

- A. rigorous
- B. sparking
- C. specious
- D. blatant
- E. convincing

3. In her works, she (i) _____ confidence. She gets excessively (ii) _____ to authorities, even when rejecting their views. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. inspires	D. pugnacious
B. exudes	E. deferential
C. lacks	F. condescending

4. Unquestionably, the particular forms that folly and cruelty take in Jane Austen's novels are (i) _____ the character's social milieu, which was also Austen's own; but to realize that one's society motivates people in unfortunate ways is not necessarily to (ii) _____ it, for the alternatives, though different, might be no more (iii) _____.

A. shaped by	D. expose	G. salutary
B. removed from	E. condemn	H. corrosive

C. unrecognizable in	F. rationalize	I. realistic
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5. The author takes issue with the ideological blinders that have distorted much migration research, especially _____ modernization theorists and others for their untested assumptions of an immobile preindustrial past.

- A. undermining
- B. citing
- C. castigating
- D. chastising
- E. endorsing
- F. commending

6. While normal floods resulting from usual monsoon rainfall are _____ the growth of crops, recently there has been an increase in the frequency of high-intensity floods that do not have such welcome effects.

- A. conducive to
- B. hindered by
- C. devastating for
- D. deleterious for
- E. essential for
- F. indispensable to

7. The difficulty of reforming electoral politics is not lack of the right tools but the need to put them into the hands of impartial agents: the goal should be to build capacity while _____ partisanship.

- A. expediting
- B. constraining
- C. facilitating
- D. deterring
- E. exacerbating
- F. lamenting

test 29 section 1 (hard)

1. Without seeming unworldly, William James appeared wholly removed from the _____ of society, the conventionality of academy. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. ethos
- B. idealism
- C. romance
- D. paradoxes
- E. commonplaces

2. The trade in scientific literature in nineteenth-century Germany was so robust that publisher constantly worried about (i) _____ of new titles, an anxiety that gave even relatively undistinguished authors, who made their living writing technical treatises, (ii) _____.

A. prices	D. limited public relevance
B. supplies	E. enviable scholarly credentials
C. embargoes	F. strong bargaining positions

3. While some commentators suggest that abstraction and complexity in scientific research are signs that a given direction is misguided, Lisa Randall, a professor of physics at Harvard, counters

that these qualities instead reflect the success of human ingenuity in (i) _____ the increasingly (ii) _____ challenges that nature presents. They can, however, make it more (iii) _____ to communicate scientific developments, even to colleague.

A. creating	D. difficult	G. challenging
B. meeting	E. conspicuous	H. unproductive
C. eschewing	F. pragmatic	I. advantageous

4. That guild of experts has always appraised the economic stimulation plan as bootless, while the advocates of the policy do not take their _____ evaluation for granted.

- A. tendentious
- B. meticulous
- C. detracting
- D. indifferent
- E. ubiquitous
- F. deprecatory

5. In noting that critical and popular opinions about Li's art coincided, Chuang _____ the existence of an exception to her general theory of art criticism, which posits that critics' views do not intersect with those of the general public.

- A. asserted
- B. conceded
- C. acknowledged
- D. doubted
- E. pondered
- F. questioned

6. The ambassador's critical remarks seemed to be less a product of _____ and more the careless utterances of a fatigued or undisciplined individual.

- A. intensity
- B. optimism
- C. purposefulness
- D. design
- E. confidence
- F. caution

7. In sharp contrast to the novel's scenic realism and precisely characterized figure is its persistent philosophical _____.

- A. naturalism
- B. abstraction
- C. generality
- D. impartiality
- E. sincerity
- F. objectivity

test 29 section 2 (medium)

1. The idea of a "language instinct" may seem _____ to those who think of language as the zenith of the human intellect and of instincts as brute impulses.

- A. jarring
- B. plausible
- C. gratifying

- D. inevitable
- E. conciliatory

2. The artist is known for making photographs that deal with politically charged subject matter, yet because her art is so evocative and open-ended, it would be wrong to characterize it as _____.

- A. polemical
- B. edifying
- C. unobservant
- D. innovative
- E. ambiguous

3. The documentation of Earth's biodiversity is complicated by the (i) _____ taxonomists. Those experts in classifying species tend to be (ii) _____ North American and Europe, whereas most of the undocumented biodiversity is likely in the tropics. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. uneven distribution of	D. clustered in
B. theoretical commitments of	E. oblivious to
C. professional rivalries among	F. exported from

4. A transformative scientific idea that emerged in the eighteenth century was the realization that slow, inexorable geological processes follow the basic laws of physics and chemistry. This seems (i) _____ conclusion in hindsight, but its implication—that geological processes in the distant past must have (ii) _____ these very same laws—was (iii) _____ geologists in the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries.

A. an obvious	D. followed	G. evident to
B. a significant	E. preceded	H. overlooked by
C. a controversial	F. entailed	I. revolutionary for

5. Individuals, governments, and companies show ample ability to _____ themselves by setting goals based on current conditions and then blindly following them even when those conditions change drastically.

- A. hamstring
- B. reinvent
- C. promote
- D. revitalize
- E. impair
- F. invigorate

6. The cat known to researchers as M-120—beefy, audacious, and apparently smart enough to spot a free lunch—is perhaps the world's least _____ lynx: the scientists catch him several times a year.

- A. intelligent
- B. evasive
- C. fearless
- D. furtive
- E. elusive
- F. intrepid

7. Origin, distribution, and habitat are included in the book for some but not all of the plants; offering this information for each species would have given readers a clearer appreciation of the differences between _____ and introduced species. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. endemic
- B. native
- C. seasonal
- D. rare
- E. unusual
- F. dominant

test 30 section 1 (hard)

1. The medical professor's thesis—hardly new, but rarely _____ by a faculty members of his distinction—is that patients are more than the sum of their symptoms and systems.

- A. discounted
- B. ignored
- C. subverted
- D. underestimated
- E. espoused

2. Invention was (i)_____ the work of the ancient Greek historians, whose writings were filled with long and often purely fictitious speeches by great historical figures. The animating force in historical writing was rhetoric rather than (ii)_____. Even well into the eighteenth century, not a few historians continued to understand themselves as artists, given a license to invent.

A. discouraged in	D. eloquence
B. a hallmark of	E. evidence
C. exceptional in	F. imagination

3. It is possible for human to go 40 or more hours without sleep and still be able to (i)_____ information acquired at the beginning of the sleepless period. Thus, when we are considering a role for sleep in human memory consolidation, we are referring to a possible role in the (ii)_____ encoding of information and optimizing of recall, not a (iii)_____ of sleep for recalling events of the prior day.

A. legitimize	D. longer-term	G. requirement
B. augment	E. acute	H. surplus
C. disgorge	F. qualitative	I. facet

4. Some have argued that naming scientific discoveries after the people who make them can _____ scientific progress, because the nomenclature lacks useful clarity, having no relationship to the underlying principles that govern nature. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. hamper
- B. abet
- C. instigate
- D. obscure
- E. nullify
- F. impede

5. Each of the country's 26 sates and most of its more than 2,000 municipalities have their own police forces, _____ communication and making it difficult to establish a coordinated law-enforcement strategy.

- A. establishing

- B. impeding
- C. hampering
- D. launching
- E. obscuring
- F. preventing

6. Although there is an incredible diversity of microbes across the body of each individual, the fact that specific body sites tend to host a few specific bacteria indicates that the body's microflora are not _____ distributed.

- A. haphazardly
- B. uniformly
- C. effectively
- D. heterogeneously
- E. functionally
- F. randomly

7. Changes made to ecosystems in order to achieve a goal, such as food production or flood control, often _____ significant unforeseen trade-offs between other important products and services the ecosystems provide.

- A. predict
- B. delay
- C. foretell
- D. obscure
- E. yield
- F. engender

test 30 section 2 (hard)

1. Even if he wants to serve again—and given his obvious love for the job, the assumption among insiders is that he is more likely to stay than go—there is at least _____ his serving another term.

- A. impediment to
- B. incentive for
- C. precedent for
- D. benefit in
- E. rationale for

2. Folmer's book on Edith Wharton seems far removed from recent trends in literary criticism; this need not to be a fault, except that, in its title and introduction, the book (i)_____ to be conversant with contemporary discourse in the field, but in its actual analysis of Wharton's work, it is marked by a very (ii)_____ approach. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. designs	D. old-fashioned
B. fails	E. timely
C. purports	F. arcane

3. The book is not comprehensive but is, instead, (i)_____ in the most positive sense:(ii)_____ rather than settles.

A. definitive	D. stipulates
B. provocative	E. suggests

C. timely	F. disseminates
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4. Several studies (i)_____ the assumption that paper cups, because they were made of natural products, were more environmentally (ii)_____ than cups made of plastic (polystyrene). Indeed, these studies indicated that the environmental (iii)_____ of producing and recycling paper cups were similar to, if not more than, those related to the production, disposal, and recycling of polystyrene cups.

A. corroborated	D. friendly	G. benefits
B. exploited	E. hazardous	H. costs
C. dispelled	F. predictable	I. opportunities

5. One big challenge with placebo responses is that they are _____: people given the same inert pill or potion may show wildly different reactions, and the effects can vary widely according to each person's illness.

- A. capricious
- B. illusory
- C. unpredictable
- D. chimerical
- E. marginal
- F. ephemeral

6. The Chicago journal known as Poetry has been the launching pad for many poets since its _____ in 1913; among them, T. S. Eliot, Gwendolyn Brooks, and John Ashbery.

- A. extraction
- B. foundation
- C. partnership
- D. employment
- E. revival
- F. inception

7. Although most land snails are _____, the giant African snail is a notable exception; it can be 15 inches long and weigh 2 pounds.

- A. gargantuan
- B. juvenile
- C. functional
- D. diminutive
- E. responsive
- F. minuscule

test 31 section 1 (hard)

1. Many creative photographers were delighted to find in instant photography a mode that encouraged them to stop viewing photography as _____ and start viewing it as something they could handle with spontaneity, even derision.

- A. sacrosanct
- B. ephemeral
- C. malleable
- D. egalitarian
- E. autonomous

2. The author clearly supports the causes he writes about, but he is more a narrator than (i)_____. Some say he should have included more (ii)_____, but he is wise to let the fact speak for themselves. They are complex enough to prompt many kinds of interpretation, and he would bog down the complicated tale if he tried to adjudicate all of their competing claims.

A. a reporter	D. statistical data
B. an advocate	E. analysis of events
C. an adversary	F. detailed description

3. Schechter is atypically (i)_____ the film version of Stephen King's horror novel *The shining* because the qualities for which the majority of other critics have approved it (its artful camera work and so on) get in the way of narrative and render the story less, rather than more, (ii)_____ than other films of the same genre. This is not (iii)_____ view, and we must be grateful to Schechter for putting it forward. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. unimpressed with	D. heartbreaking	G. a commonplace
B. confused by	E. comical	H. a superior
C. enamored of	F. terrifying	I. an unfamiliar

4. As the biography makes plain, the scientist led _____ sort of life, rarely remaining in one place for long.

- A. an enigmatic
- B. an idiosyncratic
- C. an itinerant
- D. a cautious
- E. a peripatetic
- F. a circumspect

5. There is a revelation on almost every page of this book, and the author's prose is _____ in the best possible way: blunt, sweet, off-kilter, and often quite funny.

- A. eloquent
- B. austere
- C. somber
- D. awkward
- E. solemn
- F. ungainly

6. The potential reduction in water lost from the proposed reservoir from evaporation is _____ inconsequential: even the minimum projected reduction would save enough water to furnish the needs of a Denver-sized municipality.

- A. nearly
- B. comparatively
- C. scarcely
- D. rarely
- E. hardly
- F. relatively

7. _____ the notion that attention is a limited resource, scientists have found lots of evidence that drivers with cell phones drives slower and are more apt to miss important details than drivers who drive solely on the road.

- A. controverting
- B. buttressing

- C. questioning
- D. bolstering
- E. perpetuating
- F. refuting

test 31 section 2 (hard)

1. Some ethicists worry that a deeper understanding of the brain may be tantamount to ____; if we discover that free will is an illusion of neural circuitry, how will we hold people responsible for their actions? 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. vindication
- B. proscription
- C. ministration
- D. valediction
- E. exculpation

2. Of all her works, this play is the most dependent on the dramatic conventions of the author's day: it was both the least ____ of her plays and the most commercially successful.

- A. experimental
- B. popular
- C. formulaic
- D. lucrative
- E. contemporary

3. The controversy about Alexander the Great's personality derives from the fact that our sources are (i)____, all eyewitness accounts having perished. What remains is, at best, (ii)____ (one history, for instance is based largely on the now-lost memoirs of Alexander's alleged half-brother, Ptolemy) and at worst, highly unreliable.

A. outdated	D. secondhand
B. inadequate	E. repetitious
C. abstruse	F. deceptive

4. Firebaugh and Beck contend that economic development improves the overall well-being of people within developing countries. However, other scholars emphasize the (i)____ of this view, empirically demonstrating that while economic development does in fact contribute to the well-being of the population of developing countries, the magnitude of development's positive effects on well-being has (ii)____. In other words, these scholars suggest that (iii)____ economic development and human well-being is taking place in developing countries.

A. falsity	D. been greatly underestimated	G. a decoupling of
B. arbitrariness	E. not yet been measured	H. an inversion of
C. limitation	F. decreased over time	I. a decline in

5. Although a dedicated reader of the book can ____ a brief of chronology of Chappell's life, the book is nevertheless not a real biography of Chapelle. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. mass
- B. obtain
- C. overlook
- D. excuse

- E. forgo
- F. glean

6. In their quest for kinder cutting, physicians increasingly rely on endoscopic surgery, replacing large scalpels and clamps with cameras and _____ tools that snake into the body through tiny holes.

- A. flexibility
- B. rigidity
- C. magnitude
- D. suppleness
- E. enormity
- F. precision

7. The university's once _____ department of economic history has lost prestige and transmogrified into a department of management and marketing.

- A. respected
- B. slighted
- C. pretentious
- D. gigantic
- E. venerable
- F. snubbed

test 32 section 1 (hard)

1. Carmen's affection for her sister, though not _____, was plainly too great to permit a painless departure.

- A. unsteady
- B. ambivalent
- C. careless
- D. unbounded
- E. noticeable

2. Making loans and fighting poverty are normally two of the least glamorous pursuits around, but remarkably enough put the two together, and you have an economic innovation that has become not just (i) _____ but downright (ii) _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. popular	D. chic
B. pointless	E. unfathomable
C. dangerous	F. sensible

3. The research on otters' environmental requirements is surprisingly (i) _____. One reason for this has to do with the estimation of how much they use different areas. Doing so may be (ii) _____ in some kinds of terrain, such as Shetland where the Eurasian otters are active in daytime and have clear individual markings. There it is possible to identify the individuals over stretches of coast of a few kilometers and to see what kinds of coast they use. However, the field conditions are (iii) _____.

A. straightforward	D. quite problematic	G. routine
B. controversial	E. relatively simple	H. deceptive
C. difficult	F. largely unnecessary	I. exceptional

4. Travel writers have a special burden of forming _____ story—that is, one with a beginning, middle, and end—out of the unformed moments that make up the act of traveling.

- A. a compelling
- B. a coherent
- C. an original
- D. a serious
- E. an orderly
- F. an innovative

5. There are many ways in which rat brains and human brains are _____. Indeed, rat brains are often used as generalized models for all mammalian brains, including our own.

- A. identical
- B. analogous
- C. mysterious
- D. comparable
- E. adaptable
- F. inexplicable

6. Space is often referred to as the final frontier, as the only realm of which humankind has still to gain substantial understanding, yet the ocean realm is another vast area about which our knowledge is _____.

- A. erroneous
- B. confusing
- C. frustrating
- D. rudimentary
- E. delusive
- F. sketchy

7. The occasional minor errors, while annoying, do not _____ the basic scholarship or the valuable contribution of this book.

- A. support
- B. uphold
- C. expose
- D. explain
- E. vitiate
- F. impair

test 32 section 2 (hard)

1. The science of astronomy was begun by amateurs and today remains dependent on their contributions, which are incisive by virtue of being _____ by the a priori assumptions that often vitiate the work of professional research scientists. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. characterized
- B. unencumbered
- C. supported
- D. contradicted
- E. inspired

2. The genius of the scientific method is that it (i) _____ the dictum of Aristotle that the goal of science is knowledge of the ultimate cause of things. True science, we now know, advances human knowledge by (ii) _____ ultimate causes and focusing instead on the testing of empirical hypotheses.

A. qualifies	D. ignoring
B. jettisons	E. predicting
C. affirms	F. confirming

3. The meandering journey across the soundscape of the Internet can be (i)_____. Listening to music in this medium often generates anxiety fulfillment: no sooner has one experience begun than the thought of what else is out there intrudes. Putting an old-fashioned disk and letting it play to the end restores a measure of (ii)_____.

A. liberating	D. choice
B. taxing	E. boredom
C. educational	F. sanity

4. In this single volume, Kenny aims to survey for the general reader all of ancient philosophy; understandably, space in such a book is (i)_____, and he is not to be faulted for minor omissions. However, Kenny would have added significantly to his book's value had he more effectively (ii)_____ the influence of ancient philosophy on the subsequent tradition. As it is, newcomers to the subject will have little (iii)_____ the afterlife enjoyed by ancient philosophy in the period 1600-1750.

A. at a premium	D. overlooked	G. sense of
B. hard to fill	E. signaled	H. devotion to
C. taken for granted	F. prevented	I. aversion to

5. In American art the line between the good and the goods is not a hard-and-fast boundary, for in a commercial society the membrane that separates spirit and store is always _____.

- A. porous
- B. clogged
- C. permeable
- D. unwavering
- E. steady
- F. imaginary

6. Although the four microclimates, observed over the three years, show very similar overall trends, suggesting spatial _____ in the rock surface temperature regime, relative humidity and surface wetness data show clear differences. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. invariability
- B. superiority
- C. perception
- D. homogeneity
- E. resemblance
- F. immutability

7. Because chemistry's position as one of the natural sciences has long seemed _____, historians have generally treated the foundation of chemical professorship as an inevitable component of the progression of universities.

- A. manifest
- B. impregnable
- C. relevant
- D. predictable
- E. germane

F. self-evident

test 33 section 1 (hard)

1. The maps in this volume are meant not as guides but as ____: they are designed to make the reader think anew about the city.

- A. adornments
- B. references
- C. truisms
- D. provocations
- E. valedictions

2. Proponents of international regulation of environmental issues have always struggled against scientific uncertainty and economic hostility, two obstacles which, from a political standpoint, often have been closely related, as economic hostility toward environmental regulation for economic reasons have (i)_____ the considerable uncertainty underlying most environmental challenges to (ii)_____ of environmental regulation.

A. resolved	D. exaggerate the efficacy
B. gainsaid	E. downplay the legitimacy
C. exploited	F. question the fallibility

3. Many popular musicians have (i)_____ new digital technologies that allow them unprecedented control over their music. These musicians use computers to (ii)_____ and modify their songs, resulting in a level of musical precision often unattainable naturally. Of course, though, as is often the case with new technologies, some traditionalists (iii)_____ these developments.

A. incorporated	D. energize	G. balk at
B. synthesized	E. delineate	H. revel in
C. alleviated	F. recast	I. retaliate

4. Her apparent _____ her background and ancestry seems unconceivable in an age when people tend to think of themselves to exhaustion.

- A. rejection of
- B. deference to
- C. unfamiliarity with
- D. dishonesty with
- E. ignorance of
- F. fixation on

5. For parents, the pleasure of letting children choose which book to read aloud together is not always _____. I well remembered my inner groans when my child would constantly pick my least favorite book from the shelf. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. intangible
- B. enduring
- C. impalpable
- D. unalloyed
- E. ephemeral
- F. unqualified

6. In Schaller's contradictory introduction to the book, she alternately applauds and _____ humankind's role in animal conservation.

- A. authorizes
- B. endorses
- C. denounces
- D. discloses
- E. relates
- F. lambasts

7. The company is so old-fashioned and opposed to innovation that it can seem downright _____.

- A. antediluvian
- B. flighty
- C. archaic
- D. chauvinistic
- E. capricious
- F. patronizing

test 33 section 2 (medium)

1. Neuroscientists are excited by technological progress that facilitates brain mapping, the most _____ of them comparing their growing abilities to tremendous advances that led to unimaginable success of the Human Genome Project.

- A. rigorous
- B. sanguine
- C. punctilious
- D. unorthodox
- E. sophisticated

2. Many scholars have argued that the United States Supreme Court usually (i) _____ public opinion in its decisions because it fears that it will (ii) _____ if does not; when it does depart from public opinion, it whips up political maelstroms.

A. comments on	D. lose public support
B. hews to	E. mitigate public anger
C. overrides	F. create public indifference

3. Campus-wide discussion on academic integrity can be (i) _____ by the fact that faculty and students tend to define cheating in (ii) _____ ways. Even when they concur on what cheating means, faculty and students often assign different levels of severity to specific violations. These differences can serve as a major (iii) _____ the creation of a commonly accepted set of standards of integrity that are consistently applied to all academic work within the campus community.

A. expedited	D. disparate	G. indictment of
B. obscured	E. conventional	H. impediment to
C. hampered	F. rigid	I. metaphor for

4. Compared to Earth over most of its 4 to 6-billion-year history, the world we live in today is quite (i) _____. Of course, it is human nature to regard the world that we are used to as (ii) _____. The oceans, prairies, and mountain chains—even the air we breathe—seem the norm and therefore (iii) _____.

A. bountiful	D. invaluable	G. eternal
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B. atypical	E. permanent	H. precious
C. stable	F. corrupted	I. endangered

5. The central idea of the worldview known as “consilience” is that all tangible phenomena are based on material process that are ultimately reducible, however long and _____ the sequences, to the laws of physics. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. facile
- B. ethereal
- C. tortuous
- D. superficial
- E. convoluted
- F. protracted

6. Although evolutionary psychologists do not seem quite as imperialist in their intellectual ambitions as their sociobiologist forebears of the 1970s, they tend, in some critics’ view, to be no less _____ in their claims.

- A. abashed
- B. arrogant
- C. impetuous
- D. hubristic
- E. narcissistic
- F. diffident

7. Although the company still loses the occasional lawsuit, the litigation threat that once seemed so _____ has become quite manageable.

- A. burdensome
- B. pedestrian
- C. sporadic
- D. mundane
- E. promising
- F. onerous

test 34 section 1 (hard)

1. The science community’s perennial lament over inadequate budgets has come to seem increasing _____, because government support for science and engineering has never been greater.

- A. vital
- B. hopeless
- C. poignant
- D. condescending
- E. disingenuous

2. In aquatic environments, the herbicide atrazine is more likely to (i) _____ developing amphibians when it is highly diluted than when it is much more concentrated, a new study suggests. Although counterintuitive, the finding is (ii) _____ some past research on atrazine and studies showing that other hormonally active compounds are most damaging at trace concentrations.

A. supplant	D. unanticipated given
B. kill	E. consistent with

C. circumvent	F. undiminished by
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3. Leo Tolstoy wrote many works of nonfiction and professed (i)_____ these explorations of ethics and religion compared with his novels and short stories. The fiction writer in him, however, was hard to (ii)_____. Handi Murdd is a short novel with the breadth and power of an epic, with vivid characterization and intense storytelling that sweep the reader away. While the reader senses the moral concerns of the tale's creator, the novel is a far cry from the (iii)_____ of Tolstoy's nonfiction.

A. a preference for	D. suppress	G. didacticism
B. an aversion to	E. identify	H. fluidity
C. an indifference toward	F. incite	I. creativity

4. The concept of increasing complexity of organisms has _____ history among evolutionary biologists, and yet many laypeople would unhesitatingly say that the pattern applies to the history of life on Earth. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. an illustrious
- B. a sordid
- C. a curious
- D. a contentious
- E. a distinguished
- F. a fraught

5. The story lines of silent dramas may often have been _____, yet within those basic narrative outlines, the true artists among silent-film actors could express emotional shadings that have no analogue in spoken language.

- A. implausible
- B. incredible
- C. conventional
- D. elemental
- E. rudimentary
- F. confusing

6. The candidate seeks to depict his opponent as being _____, as one who is simply unable to make a decision and stand his ground.

- A. inconstant
- B. cowardly
- C. opportunistic
- D. petty
- E. capricious
- F. spiteful

7. Given the _____ of solid case studies of environment degradation, this new study adds very little to our knowledge of the field. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. erroneousness
- B. plethora
- C. surfeit
- D. inaccuracy
- E. rigor
- F. outcome

test 34 section 2 (medium)

1. In modern times, friendship has become a _____ relationship: a form of connection in terms of which all are understood and against which all are measured.

- A. conciliatory
- B. mercenary
- C. paradigmatic
- D. contentious
- E. supplementary

2. Even those observers who are the most _____ about genetic privacy issues would have to concede that genetic discrimination is rare: there have only been two cases of any notoriety.

- A. sanguine
- B. zealous
- C. candid
- D. objective
- E. apathetic

3. If newspaper consumers are concerned about more than (i) _____ and prefer to read news that is consistent with their beliefs, then (ii) _____ is not a journalistic flaw, but, rather, a cultivated feature. In a competitive news market, producers can use slant to differentiate their products and stave off price competition.

A. politics	D. bias
B. accuracy	E. sensationalism
C. expense	F. inconsistency

4. Twenty years ago, when the book was first published, most reviewers dismissed the author's predictions as (i) _____. Sometimes people (ii) _____ their errors: those same reviewers today, comparing the predictions with actual events, acknowledge how (iii) _____ the author was.

A. insightful	D. persevere in	G. mistaken
B. judicious	E. recognize	H. prescient
C. alarmist	F. complicate	I. pessimistic

5. Although his original mission was a failure, Russian botanist Michael Friedrich Adams achieved an unexpected _____ when he found, by chance, the carcass of a woolly mammoth.

- A. conclusion
- B. upheaval
- C. triumph
- D. bombshell
- E. success
- F. venture

6. The medical researchers replied to the charge that their proposed new treatment was _____ by demonstrating that it in fact observed standard medical practices. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. deleterious
- B. untested
- C. unorthodox
- D. expensive
- E. intricate

F. unconventional

7. Because experience had convinced her that Hector was both self-seeking and avaricious, she rejected the possibility that the motivation behind his donation had been wholly _____.

- A. redundant
- B. frivolous
- C. egotistical
- D. ephemeral
- E. altruistic
- F. benevolent

test 35 section 1 (medium)

1. In one theory, as people learn things throughout the day, connections between neurons get strengthened, but during sleep then all synapses are weakened, tenuous connections are _____ and only the strongest bonds could remain.

- A. reinforced
- B. reproduced
- C. replaced
- D. stimulated
- E. severed

2. The irony of digital networking is that it can produce more (i) _____ than did the geographical confinement it supposedly transcended. As human interactions become (ii) _____ physical location, people are less likely to have regular dealings with others who do not share the same values and outlooks.

A. provincialism	D. more determined by
B. diversity	E. less contingent on
C. materialism	F. less insensitive to

3. Keith Haring's cartoonish art became even more (i) _____ than Andy Warhol's much-reproduced soup cans when, in 1986, he opened his own store, the Pop Shop, to sell licensed Haring merchandise. The public loved the souvenirs; the critics (ii) _____ what they saw as his betrayal of artistic integrity. Haring claimed that these critics misunderstood his (iii) _____ to take art beyond galleries and museums, and thus to give a wider audience the opportunity to experience art.

A. commercial	D. fostered	G. failed plan
B. traditional	E. decried	H. financial need
C. expert	F. anticipated	I. sincere effort

4. Far from _____ innovations, as the patent system was designed to do, the patenting of concepts such as gene sequences gives individuals and corporations a legal choke to hold over ideas that should be useful to all.

- A. spurring
- B. recognizing
- C. codifying
- D. acknowledging
- E. fostering
- F. cataloging

5. The 1840s were _____ time for young women beginning to study science, particularly astronomy, in 1847 Maria Mitchell discovered the Nantucket comet, the first of several important astronomical discoveries of the era.

- A. a favorable
- B. an awkward
- C. a perilous
- D. a hazardous
- E. an improbable
- F. an auspicious

6. To keep the museum's admission lines moving, security inspections are considerably _____.

- A. thorough
- B. annoying
- C. cursory
- D. casual
- E. irritating
- F. methodical

7. The evil of class and race hatred must be eliminated while it is still _____ state; otherwise, it may grow to dangerous proportions. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. an amorphous
- B. an overt
- C. a rudimentary
- D. a threatening
- E. an independent
- F. an embryonic

test 35 section 2 (medium)

1. One baffling aspect of the novel is its capacity to generate emotional power from a plot that lacks the most elementary _____: readers must accept not an occasional coincidence, but a continuous stream of them.

- A. synergy
- B. continuity
- C. naivety
- D. premise
- E. credibility

2. The mood of the times is no longer one of (i) _____ over our scientific achievements. Doubts and worries beset technical and scientific specialist, as well as the public at large. I do not consider such worries (ii) _____, though they are often based on intuitive feeling rather than on strictly logical arguments.

A. widening skepticism	D. unfounded
B. uncritical joy	E. sacrosanct
C. false humility	F. foreordained

3. Britain's deteriorating economy after 1945 was (i) _____ by politicians who favored the manufacturing sector over the service sector: rather than attempting to (ii) _____ the decline of manufacturing, they should have promoted service industries.

A. mishandled	D. augment
B. bolstered	E. arrest
C. forestalled	F. escalate

4. Even though intelligence may be quite (i)_____, and even though scientists may have made frustratingly (ii)_____ progress in understanding it, many experts on intelligence still think that the potential (iii)_____ of the quest to understand intelligence make it worth continuing. For instance, a brain-based understanding of intelligence may help teachers design strategies for educating children more effectively. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. useful	D. little	G. intellectual impediments
B. neglected	E. rapid	H. practical values
C. complex	F. extensive	I. financial rewards

5. Many people remember a time when cutting-edge architects, who are these days treated like celebrities, had _____ relationship with the public: for much of the 1960s, big new buildings in cities were often cause for hostility, not celebration.

- A. an antagonistic
- B. an inimical
- C. an autocratic
- D. a symbiotic
- E. an indifferent
- F. an apathetic

6. It is surprising to see such a child that is at his sixteenth manifest a great measure of _____, for he delivers too cogent, brilliant a speech among adults.

- A. maturity
- B. precociousness
- C. convulsion
- D. nefariousness
- E. naïveté
- F. ingenuousness

7. People from one community always take each other as _____ since they automatically classify the others as their family line.

- A. acquaintance
- B. consort
- C. neighborhood
- D. kinfolk
- E. relative
- F. patron

test 36 section 1 (medium)

1. Since many African farmers face a soil fertility problem, providing funding for fertilizer seems _____; closer examination of the data raises some troubling questions, however.

- A. imprudent
- B. expensive
- C. unimpeachable

- D. modern
- E. worrisome

2. The politician's record while in office, though (i)_____, hardly accounts for her high standard three decades later—a standing all the more (ii)_____ because of continuing assaults on her reputation during those years. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. bewildering	D. unusual
B. admirable	E. regrettable
C. unappreciated	F. persistent

3. While the Prime Minister's long-standing reputation for (i)_____ practical power may (ii)_____ his recently stated willingness to devolve real power to regional assemblies and local governments, it certainly does not (iii)_____ his doing it.

A. centralizing	D. render inevitable	G. require
B. overseeing	E. be based on	H. allow
C. exploring	F. raise doubts about	I. preclude

4. The juxtaposition of fertile alluvial soils originating in the Andes with the infertile inland soils of central Amazon Basin is one example of _____ of the soil conditions that can be found in the tropics.

- A. intractability
- B. heterogeneity
- C. incompatibility
- D. disparateness
- E. instability
- F. fragility

5. Although most scientists hold that quantum theory and the theory of general relativity ought to be intimately connected, the theories have remained stubbornly _____.

- A. consistent
- B. unlinked
- C. self-contradictory
- D. estranged
- E. arbitrary
- F. congruent

6. One big challenge with placebo responses is that they are _____: people given the same inert pill or potion may show wildly different reactions, and the effects vary widely according to each person's illness.

- A. capricious
- B. illusory
- C. unpredictable
- D. chimerical
- E. marginal
- F. ephemeral

7. The _____ of biographies of antebellum capitalists is particularly striking in contrast with the abundance of life stories of industrialists in later eras. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. brevity
- B. banality

- C. utility
- D. paucity
- E. triteness
- F. dearth

test 36 section 2 (medium)

1. Having regarded Marcus relationship to their boss as entirely _____, Jo was flabbergasted when Marcus publicly made clear his objections to some changes the boss was introducing.

- A. professional
- B. sycophantic
- C. prosaic
- D. dissident
- E. collegial

2. Although it is not uncommon for journalists to portray political inexperience on the part of public officials as an (i)_____, it was nevertheless surprising when members of the press treated the new senator's obvious (ii)_____ as an extraordinary virtue.

A. advantage	D. nonchalance
B. impediment	E. acumen
C. exception	F. naiveté

3. Wolosky claims that Ella Wheeler Wilcox joined other women poets such as Julia Ward Howe, Frances Harper, and Charlotte Perkins Gilman in critiquing materialism and possessive individualism. Wolosky's description (i)_____ the poetry of Gilman, Howe, and Harper, but it is not entirely (ii)_____ in the case of Wilcox, who hardly (iii)_____ the materialism of her time. Rather, Wilcox seems to have embraced the amassing of private property.

A. fits	D. apt	G. reflected
B. conflates	E. puzzling	H. countenanced
C. misinterprets	F. uncommon	I. impugned

4. What she disliked in the fictions of some of her peers was the excessive (i)_____. In her novel, by contrast, she was marked by a (ii)_____ : she always (iii)_____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. explicitness	D. ebullience	G. keeps some details undisclosed
B. deviousness	E. reticence	H. ends the book with a bleak note
C. divergence	F. introspection	I. draws on unusual sources

5. He was one of the most powerful chess players over and one of the most _____; at the height of his fame he all but dropped out of chess, entering into a self-imposed exile.

- A. perplexing
- B. creative
- C. troubled
- D. infuriating
- E. enigmatic

F. imaginative

6. A small degree of _____ is always desirable in a published diary. A sense of authenticity is seldom worth the diarist's questionable grammar or careless phrasing.

- A. characterization
- B. emendation
- C. documentation
- D. revision
- E. substantiation
- F. individualization

7. In his heyday, Sonny Bono's role in public was _____: he was an accomplished lyricist, a mayoral success story, delegate from Palm Springs, and the husband of an internationally acclaimed vocalist.

- A. protean
- B. versatile
- C. pedestrian
- D. prominent
- E. circumscribed
- F. illustrious

test 37 section 1 (easy)

1. Some ambitious lawyers are willing to work on Supreme Court cases without charge in an effort to gain _____; they believe that this increased cachet will help them succeed in the future.

- A. wisdom
- B. certitude
- C. prestige
- D. integrity
- E. humility

2. Contrary to those who fear the impact of invasive species on native plants, the biologists contend that the threat posed to biodiversity by nonnative species is often (i) _____. For instance, a study of garlic mustard, a nonnative plant now thriving in Minnesota's oak forests, found that garlic mustard abundance in forest plots was not (ii) _____ the number of other plant species there.

A. subtle	D. consistent with
B. uniform	E. related to
C. exaggerated	F. sustained by

3. To pay for the extra spending under this international poverty plan, each American would have to contribute less than the cost of buying a premium cup of coffee once a week. But financial aid is not (i) _____, and even if the funding recommended here were to (ii) _____, the grandest objectives may well remain unfulfilled. Nonetheless, carefully targeted aid can reward responsible governments, (iii) _____ individual initiative, and alleviate suffering. Many will think that's worth of a cup of coffee.

A. an impediment	D. be insufficient	G. obviate
B. a panacea	E. recede	H. temper
C. a malady	F. materialize	I. encourage

4. Criticized for decades of overproduction in their signature line of derivative goods, Rectangle Record has satiated the market with a _____ of repackaged old CDs, which interferes with its ability to innovate and produce new albums. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. dearth
- B. glut
- C. deficiency
- D. surfeit
- E. abundance
- F. profusion

5. His political view, harking back to the turmoil in the 1934, is a _____ with no bearing on the present.

- A. prototype
- B. pretense
- C. paradigm
- D. relic
- E. contradiction
- F. vestige

6. As a critic, Nelson is noteworthy for her _____: rather than presenting fully formed pronouncements, she is willing to let us watch as she works out her ideas.

- A. generosity
- B. humility
- C. integrity
- D. modesty
- E. eloquence
- F. rhetoric

7. Although in the mid-1970s nuclear power seemed poised for a still greater role in energy supply, in fact the _____ of its prestige had already begun.

- A. evaluation
- B. waning
- C. defense
- D. undermining
- E. ebbing
- F. vindication

test 37 section 2 (medium)

1. The author's unfortunate predilection for mannered turns of phrase and complicated metaphors had a tendency to _____ her work's straightforward themes.

- A. propitiate
- B. accentuate
- C. augment
- D. occlude
- E. presage

2. The company's steering committee, reluctant to be held any specific commitments, released a strategic plan that was deliberately _____.

- A. unpopular
- B. repetitive

- C. stringent
- D. inflexible
- E. nebulous

3. So, perhaps the lesson is that rather than wanting their monarchy to (i)_____ its modernized Scandinavian counterparts, the British public cherishes it most when it is most (ii)_____.

A. commend	D. egalitarian
B. discount	E. anachronistic
C. emulate	F. regal

4. Parker's model of human affairs reflects (i)_____ outlook, in stark contrast to the generally (ii)_____ premises that her colleagues in the economics department adopt in their work. Accordingly, her conclusions (iii)_____ theirs. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. a sanguine	D. pessimistic	G. are somewhat more accessible than
B. an introspective	E. theoretical	H. are not so sunny as
C. a technical	F. distinctive	I. diverge markedly

5. The women's rights movement has been mostly _____ in the Middle East, but it is likely that activists will be newly galvanized by the political upheavals currently sweeping the region.

- A. subverted
- B. quiescent
- C. interminable
- D. bootless
- E. abeyant
- F. feckless

6. Beatified by the Catholic Church in 1765, Italian cleric Ludovico Sabbatini is _____ each year on the day of his death, June 1.

- A. pledged
- B. evoked
- C. deified
- D. venerated
- E. honored
- F. christened

7. What they see in Jimenez is the one candidate capable of decisive leadership, in stark contrast to Diaz, whose team in office has been marred by _____.

- A. defensiveness
- B. corruption
- C. irresolution
- D. vacillation
- E. belligerence
- F. pugnacity

test 38 section 1 (medium)

1. Gladys took a _____ approach to problem solving, so when the committee needed ideas on how to create more low-cost public transportation, she suggested they study what worked well in other cities with similar needs.

- A. benign
- B. pragmatic
- C. compliant
- D. rarefied
- E. dogmatic

2. Convinced of the gravity of her poetry, Voigt must have found the reviews of her most recent collection (i)_____ reading: one amused reviewer thought that it was unrecognizable as poetry but decidedly (ii)_____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. tempting	D. inspiring
B. depressing	E. irritating
C. thrilling	F. diverting

3. To many newspapers readers now, this book published in 1953 is (i)_____. It is filled with references to some people whose ideas seemed (ii)_____ at that time, but are rarely viewed as (iii)_____ persons now.

A. refreshingly inspired	D. unfashionable	G. ignoble
B. somewhat dated	E. dutiable	H. prolific
C. excessively angry	F. important	I. seminal

4. The research informing Gregory's book on vegetarianism in Victorian England appears to be _____, with a great deal of revealing detail on display and more than a third of the text taken up with footnotes.

- A. uneven
- B. excessive
- C. exhaustive
- D. mixed
- E. inconsistent
- F. comprehensive

5. He was a man of few words, _____ around all but his closest friends.

- A. laconic
- B. garrulous
- C. ascetic
- D. taciturn
- E. tempestuous
- F. ambiguous

6. There are many insights in the essay collected in Observations on modernity, but they are embedded in a dense English translation of a dense German original that may make many of them _____ to most readers.

- A. vapid
- B. inaccessible
- C. sagacious
- D. banal
- E. distressing
- F. opaque

7. It is not unusual for American education leaders to hold up another nation as a model for school reform: in the mid-nineteenth century, such figures _____ the professionalism and structure of the Prussian school system. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. envied
- B. imitated
- C. hailed
- D. augmented
- E. acclaimed
- F. enhanced

test 38 section 2 (hard)

1. In the final scene of the movie, the character exhibits an almost unbelievable _____, remaining imperturbable in the face of intense and immediate physical danger.

- A. cunning
- B. endurance
- C. arrogance
- D. sangfroid
- E. percipience

2. The author's best-selling book on Virginia Woolf is not (i) _____ treatment of her subject; on the contrary, it presents (ii) _____ portrait of the novelist, faults and all.

A. an idealized	D. an unflinching
B. a comprehensive	E. a slapdash
C. a compelling	F. an erudite

3. Nordhaus predicts that in the future we will increasingly be (i) _____ ecological problems like global warming rather than (ii) _____ them. We may, for example, make some headway in limiting emissions that contribute to warming, but much of our work will be in adapting to ecological problems and alleviating their effects.

A. managing	D. solving
B. analyzing	E. addressing
C. transcending	F. mitigating

4. Compared with, say, the precision of a skein of geese winging its way across the autumn sky in a V formation, the seasonal marches of grazers across the Serengeti seem (i) _____, and at times even (ii) _____. But, in fact, years of careful observation by scientists have shown that there is (iii) _____ those migrations of zebras, wildebeests, and Thomson's gazelles.

A. disorganized	D. illusionary	G. feats a tendency toward aggression in
B. purposeful	E. overwhelming	H. an undeniable grandeur to
C. massive	F. chaotic	I. a definite order to

5. In her career as an editor, she pruned and shaped many a writer's _____ prose into crisp lucidity.

- A. wayward

- B. transparent
- C. errant
- D. urbane
- E. elegant
- F. incisive

6. Philby secretly loathed the host of the party that he was attending, but it seemed _____ to say so publicly. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. recondite
- B. tactless
- C. clever
- D. malign
- E. deft
- F. impolitic

7. In American Indian art, the supposed distinction between modern and traditional was fabricated by critics, and when artists have control over interpretation of their own work, the distinction appear, happily, to have been _____.

- A. eliminated
- B. reinforced
- C. put to rest
- D. intensified
- E. recognized
- F. established

test 39 section 1 (hard)

1. As the release of the annual report drew near, it was clear that more than a few employees suspected the company was on the verge of bankruptcy; the belief was _____ throughout the organization.

- A. omniscient
- B. abject
- C. pervasive
- D. estimable
- E. specious

2. The contemporary trend whereby fashion designers flout mainstream tradition is unique only in its (i)_____; earlier fashion designers experience the same (ii)_____ impulse, albeit in a less extreme form.

A. subversiveness	D. indiscriminate
B. intensity	E. iconoclastic
C. culpability	F. temperate

3. A bird's feathers would seem to be a (i)_____ design for protecting a bird from attack by microscopic organisms. They create a warm, moist space next to the skin that could be an ideal incubator for spores. Wild birds rarely (ii)_____ skin diseases, however. The chemicals in the sebum include an array of antibacterial and antifungal agents that allow the bird's skin to (iii)_____.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. perfect	D. contract	G. stay healthy
------------	-------------	-----------------

B. typical	E. overcome	H. become irritated
C. poor	F. notice	I. recover quickly

4. Despite the general _____ of Roman archaeological studies toward the major cities and their monuments, archaeology has contributed much to a better understanding of rural developments in Roman territory.

- A. openness
- B. indifference
- C. hostility
- D. animus
- E. bias
- F. orientation

5. Our mass media are much more fascinated by bad ideas or the failure of good ones than by successes: we drown in bad news—tales of how things went wrong—but we have only the most _____ discussion on how they might go right.

- A. incisive
- B. tantalizing
- C. trenchant
- D. cursory
- E. illusory
- F. perfunctory

6. A few decades ago the idea of animal morality would have been met with _____; however, recent research suggests that animals not only act altruistically but also have the capacity for empathy, forgiveness, trust, and reciprocity.

- A. derision
- B. resentment
- C. dismissal
- D. conviction
- E. ridicule
- F. certainty

7. At first, most of the famous fairy tales seem so implausible and so irrelevant to contemporary life that their _____ is hard to understand.

- A. universality
- B. persistence
- C. appeal
- D. ephemerality
- E. survival
- F. transience

test 39 section 2 (medium)

1. The automation of many of the functions performed at the factory, although initially inspiring _____ in many of the company's employees, has had none of the deleterious effects forecast either within and beyond the organization.

- A. indifference
- B. optimism
- C. ambition
- D. arrogance
- E. trepidation

2. Memory-prompt technology such as online birthday reminders does more than enhance our recall abilities; it induces us to (i)_____ ever more behaviors to automated processes. Witness the (ii)_____ a program that allows us to create computer greeting cards for the entire year in one sitting.

A. delegate	D. controversy over
B. ascribe	E. popularity of
C. liken	F. sophistication of

3. While people complain about their hectic lives and demanding schedules, one might be justified in suspecting that they are being somewhat (i)_____: compulsive busyness seems to be, for many, a source of (ii)_____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. disingenuous	D. pride
B. guarded	E. despair
C. dilatory	F. irritation

4. Evidence has been accumulating since the 1930s that reducing an animals energy intake below its energy expenditure extends the life span and delays the (i)_____ of age-related diseases in rats, dogs, fish, and monkeys. Such results have inspired thousands of people to (ii)_____ in the hope of living longer, healthier lives. They have also led to a search for drugs that (iii)_____ the effects of calorie restriction without the pain of actually going on a diet.

A. diagnosis	D. eat healthier foods	G. undermine
B. onset	E. put up with constant hunger	H. mimic
C. treatment	F. take vitamin supplements	I. delay

5. Because archaeology explores the most profound changes in human history by means of a grossly incomplete record; it has invited the sort of bold, imaginative interpretation in which speculation too easily becomes _____ evidence.

- A. replaced by
- B. constrained by
- C. untethered from
- D. divorced from
- E. substituted for
- F. constricted by

6. During the eighteenth century, improvements in their material circumstances did not necessarily mean expanded independence for women elite families and, arguably, the social conventions of gentility _____ more of their time and energy.

- A. provided
- B. justified
- C. demanded
- D. granted
- E. exacted
- F. rationalized

7. For certain economists, "pure" economic theory, that is, economic theory _____ a specific social structure, is impossible, much like a concept of anatomy that investigates no specific species.

- A. attuned to

- B. abstracted from
- C. derived from
- D. divorced from
- E. sensitive to
- F. analyzed in

test 40 section 1 (hard)

1. Like all general models, island biogeography theory is _____ reality, capturing just a few important elements of a system while ignoring many others. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. an adjunct to
- B. an improvement on
- C. a mirror of
- D. a corollary to
- E. a simplification of

2. The reclusive clergyman may have lived and died in melancholy, but this doesn't seem to have (i) _____ his genius in any way. On the contrary, we find ourselves wondering whether his genius wasn't (ii) _____ in some mysterious way by his mood.

A. influenced	D. served
B. hampered	E. controlled
C. triggered	F. identified

3. Although Uruk in southern Mesopotamia has been (i) _____ as being both the first city and the model for later ones, at least two sites in northern Mesopotamia have yielded clear evidence of urbanization long before the existing evidence from Uruk, and other discoveries indicate that some of the (ii) _____ early urbanism were invented not in southern Mesopotamia but in the north. These findings have led some archaeologists to (iii) _____ a serious reconsideration about when and where the first cities arose.

A. established	D. defining features of	G. evaluate
B. contested	E. derivative aspects of	H. ignore
C. presented	F. traditional theories about	I. propose

4. The professor's habitual air of _____ was misleading front, concealing amazing reserves of patience and a deep commitment to his students' learning.

- A. cordiality
- B. irascibility
- C. disorganization
- D. conviviality
- E. diffidence
- F. exasperation

5. Rebecca West's book *Black Lamb and Grey Falcon* is a singularity _____ achievement, 1,100 pages that meld the genres of travel narratives, autobiography, historical analysis, and philosophical meditation.

- A. evanescent
- B. petty
- C. polymathic

- D. incongruous
- E. encyclopedic
- F. fleeting

6. She expected her book to be _____, but in fact few of her readers disagreed with its premise that street art, long considered a mere sideshow entertainment, deserved to be regarded as high art.

- A. controversial
- B. dramatic
- C. impressive
- D. acclaimed
- E. provocative
- F. popular

7. Researchers have recorded around 60 separate behaviors for worker honeybees, a number that seems to _____ the achievements of many mammals: even the versatile bottlenose dolphin only performs about twice the number a worker honeybee manages. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. approximate
- B. eclipse
- C. reflect
- D. compound
- E. outdo
- F. echo

test 40 section 2 (hard)

1. The restaurant often experience a decline in business after holiday seasons, for potential customers attempt to be more _____ to balance out their former celebratory indulgences.

- A. abstemious
- B. loyal
- C. unsophisticated
- D. blithe
- E. indolent

2. The museum's compelling new architectural exhibition looks at eleven projects around the world that have had major (i)_____ impacts despite modest budgets. It is part of (ii)_____ in the museum's architecture and design department, which in the past has championed architecture's artistic value over its real-world consequences.

A. social	D. an emphasis on theory
B. aesthetic	E. a shift in philosophy
C. critical	F. a rejection of pragmatism

3. Partly because of Lee's skill at synthesizing (i)_____ trends drawn from many fields of study, her theories appeared to present, with uncanny aptness, ideas already (ii)_____ in the minds of her contemporaries. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. superseded	D. discredited
B. irrelevant	E. well established
C. emergent	F. half-formulated

4. The motives of many major investors in Pop Art have arguably been to a large extent, (i) _____. These collectors demonstrate and enhance their power over the art market by establishing seemingly arbitrary works of art as priceless. This phenomenon reveals that (ii) _____ is not (iii) _____ of truth or beauty, but simply a trick of investment capital.

A. visionary	D. value	G. a product
B. ambiguous	E. virtuosity	H. an inversion
C. self-aggrandizing	F. originality	I. a limitation

5. Despite its best efforts to stimulate sales, the bookselling business remains far from _____, for it has high fixed costs in wages and rent, and falling prices make these ever harder to spur.

- A. effective
- B. healthy
- C. innovative
- D. robust
- E. stingy
- F. parsimonious

6. Every illness is a story, and when Annie's began it was characterized by the kinds of _____ details that mean nothing until seen in hindsight.

- A. salient
- B. unexceptional
- C. conspicuous
- D. suggestive
- E. abundant
- F. nondescript

7. People's decisions about childbearing depend on innumerable personal consideration and societal factors, yet even knowing this, demographers are often _____: their projections of birth rates frequently turn out to be embarrassingly at odds with reality.

- A. sanguine
- B. flummoxed
- C. inconsistent
- D. overconfident
- E. heartened
- F. confounded

test 41 section1 (medium)

1. Needing an advocate who would be both precise and succinct, they rejected McLintock, whose inveterate _____ would automatically preclude meeting those requirements.

- A. punctiliousness
- B. concision
- C. cautiousness
- D. imperturbability
- E. prolixity

2. It can be (i) _____ to read Margaret Fuller's travel writing, as she produced accounts of her travel that (ii) _____ conventions of bourgeois travel narrative, often capitulating to the most well-worn clichés of the genre at precisely the moments when she sought most energetically to cast them off in favor of some new, more passionate mode of discernment. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. frustrating	D. challenged
B. enlightening	E. conformed to
C. exciting	F. established

3. Human-caused disturbances, such as habitat destruction and the introduction of nonnative species, are among the leading causes of plant and animal population declines. Most populations are affected by a combination of adverse human pressures, each of which is in itself insufficient to (i)_____ a population crash. Therefore, studies of population declines that (ii)_____ individual factors and thus (iii)_____ potential interactions may lead to improper management of declining species.

A. delay	D. integrate	G. exaggerate
B. trigger	E. focus on	H. overlook
C. offset	F. ignore	I. anticipate

4. The brain has become, for many people, _____ the biological machinations of the self, and the self-knowledge promised by neuroscience has ignited a hunger to understand how new findings weigh in on age-old questions.

- A. tantamount to
- B. synonymous with
- C. implicated in
- D. divorced from
- E. detached from
- F. subservient to

5. Although scientific progress leads to constant revision of ideas, one observation that has remained _____ over the years is that there are a lot of insects in the world: some 950,000 species have been identified.

- A. robust
- B. significant
- C. strong
- D. perplexing
- E. confounding
- F. obscure

6. We do not always use words in accordance with their dictionary definitions, for meaning often fluctuates with context: that does not mean, however, that we are completely _____ in how we use language.

- A. rote
- B. unconstrained
- C. irrational
- D. unpredictable
- E. free
- F. methodical

7. Today the chair of task force in charge of revising the psychiatric diagnostic manual is _____ post—people work for years to position themselves as candidates—but in the early 1970s, descriptive psychiatry was a backwater.

- A. a coveted
- B. an arduous
- C. a taxing
- D. a lucrative

- E. an enviable
- F. an influential

test 41 section 2 (medium)

1. Baker set a new standard for explaining difficult art in language the public could understand; consequently, her books remain exemplars of _____ in art-historical analysis.

- A. fashion
- B. rigor
- C. lucidity
- D. erudition
- E. grandiosity

2. The (i)_____ to disseminate the vast scientific knowledge of our time to nonscientists shows real (ii)_____ the extent of achievements humanity is capable of, like allowing a great work of art to molder in a warehouse. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. failure	D. pretentious regarding
B. plan	E. sympathy toward
C. willingness	F. indifference to

3. Unlike the elected branches of the United States government, where making personal connection with citizens is (i)_____ and almost (ii)_____ political efficacy, the United States Supreme Court continues to maintain that its members should communicate with the public almost exclusively through formal opinions—and even then through ceremonial rituals that date back to the nineteenth century.

A. frowned upon	D. a requirement for
B. rampant	E. a detriment to
C. disregarded	F. an irrelevance to

4. Movement from bottom to top, from poor to rich, was rare, even movement from poor to middle class was (i)_____. Statistical analysis of trends in occupation, income, and property ownership, Thernstrom wrote, “yielded rather (ii)_____ conclusions about social mobility in nineteenth-century America.” So we might expect Thernstrom to be suspicious now of claims that differences in class could be (iii)_____ if only the public schools did a better job.

A. an anomaly	D. multifaceted	G. distinguished
B. a cinch	E. pessimistic	H. misapprehended
C. a conjecture	F. unsophisticated	I. obliterated

5. The astronomer admits that his interpretation of so-called Population III stars is _____ at present since no one has yet done any real calculations to see if it holds up under closer scrutiny.

- A. spurious
- B. speculative
- C. predictive

- D. conjectural
- E. fabricated
- F. implausible

6. Excessive focus on what might have been can cause in us feelings of restlessness and regret, but some scientists are beginning to think that fancying an alternative reality might have _____ effects as well. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. subtle
- B. adverse
- C. restorative
- D. pleasurable
- E. unfavorable
- F. tonic

7. The territory's tradition of simple and low taxes, combined with a comparatively easygoing government, has earned it the _____ of its citizens and is widely seen as a main reason for its stunning rise to prosperity.

- A. opprobrium
- B. vituperation
- C. attention
- D. dismissal
- E. approbation
- F. adulation

test 42 section 1 (hard)

1. The macromolecule RNA is common to all living beings, and DNA, which is found in all organisms except some bacteria, is almost as _____.

- A. mercurial
- B. amorphous
- C. ubiquitous
- D. manifest
- E. exiguous

2. Argument may be an overly (i)_____ word to apply to the gossamer contrivance that is A Summer of Humming birds. In what seems a self-conscious (ii)_____ of its mascot the book flits from one subject or moment in history to another, following the various whims of its author.

A. archaic	D. repudiation
B. imprecise	E. emulation
C. robust	F. misrepresentation

3. So (i)_____ is the reputation of the country's police for corruption and other forms of (ii)_____ that it has become a kind of tradition that every newly appointed police chief pledges to (iii)_____ the force.

A. persisted	D. indolence	G. contradict
B. paralyzing	E. incompetence	H. reform
C. unfounded	F. criminality	I. reward

4. Although the parents do not think highly of the educational system "as a whole", they fail to treat teachers with _____ equally.
- A. consideration
B. veneration
C. lucubration
D. opprobrium
E. reverence
F. disdain
5. Economic growth has been identified as a _____ for poor countries to eradicate poverty, but this prescription also triggers great environmental concerns.
- A. panacea
B. refuge
C. remedy
D. heaven
E. culprit
F. recipe
6. In mathematics, judgments about the validity of proofs are mediated by peer-reviewed journals; to ensure _____, reviewers are carefully chosen by journal editors, and the identity of scholars whose papers are under consideration are kept secret. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】
- A. timelessness
B. originality
C. fairness
D. comprehensiveness
E. objectivity
F. novelty
7. The sociologist argued that criminal behavior is an impermanent condition because it is the result of cyclical forces operating through _____ factors, not the manifestation of deeply rooted personal characteristics.
- A. contingent
B. alarming
C. circumstantial
D. proliferating
E. unsustainable
F. intensifying

test 42 section 2 (hard)

1. Notwithstanding that the _____ of local branch banks has been so much predicted, in most countries the number of branch banks has increased over the past decade.
- A. resurgence
B. proliferation
C. demise
D. profitability
E. reorganization

2. As he has matured as a scholar, Felmar has come to see the merit of qualification. His conclusions, which early in his career he (i) _____, are now often (ii) _____.

A. stated as absolutes	D. hedged
B. refused to reveal	E. simplified

C. backed up extensively	F. reiterated
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3. Unlike the elected branches of the United States government, where making personal connection with citizens is (i) _____ and almost (ii) _____ political efficacy, the United States Supreme Court continues to maintain that its members should communicate with the public almost exclusively through formal opinions—and even then through ceremonial rituals that date back to the nineteenth century.

A. frowned upon	D. a requirement for
B. rampant	E. a detriment to
C. disregarded	F. an irrelevance to

4. The wealthy donor was known for his annual acts of (i) _____ throughout the community, but even more (ii) _____ was the fact that he was willing to get his hands dirty and serve the needy through hard physical labor as well as through (iii) _____ and gifts. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. quality	D. laudable	G. effort
B. legacy	E. inexpressible	H. endowments
C. largesse	F. disquieting	I. handiwork

5. British critics covering African American musicians performing in London in the 1910s had little idea how to distinguish what was authentic African American music from what was _____, but they knew such a distinction existed.

- A. eclectic
- B. genuine
- C. derivative
- D. spurious
- E. legitimate
- F. specious

6. Any antimatter in our part of the universe is necessarily _____ because of the overwhelming preponderance of ordinary matter, by which antimatter is quickly annihilated.

- A. short-lived
- B. nebulous
- C. scarce
- D. concrete
- E. substantial
- F. ephemeral

7. There are great _____ in countries' greenhouse gas emissions, especially in per capita terms: while the United States and China are similar in aggregate emissions, United States per capita emissions are a huge multiple of China's.

- A. distortions
- B. disparities
- C. fluctuations
- D. advances
- E. variances
- F. vacillations

test 43 section 1 (medium)

1. By the early nineteenth century, education in the United States had become _____ affair: almost every town provided free schools for young children, and many were in the process of building high schools. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. an analytical
- B. a civic
- C. a contested
- D. a trivial
- E. an exclusive

2. The description of humans as having an internal clock is not a (i) _____. Or rather, it is—you do not have a tiny watch in your cerebellum—but it also refers to (ii) _____, a specialized bundle of cells that regulates cyclical processes.

A. euphemism	D. an elusive psychological phenomenon
B. cliché	E. a standard literary trope
C. metaphor	F. a real biological feature

3. (i) _____ have often shrilled that Australia's Great Barrier Reef is dying, a result of agricultural runoff from the (ii) _____ Queensland coast. In truth, the preservation of the reef (iii) _____, a combination of active government intervention and the beneficial effects of responsible tourism.

A. Apologists	D. long-abandoned	G. is based on an impracticality
B. Optimists	E. over-farmed	H. remains a matter of controversy
C. Scaremongers	F. well-preserved	I. is something of a success story

4. Although people often describe the correct trajectory for a thrown or moving object, their efforts to explain that trajectory in terms of physics can reveal _____ understanding of the forces acting on the object.

- A. a naïve
- B. a subtle
- C. a fallacious
- D. an unsophisticated
- E. a nuanced
- F. a fresh

5. Appearing in the midst of so many equivocal comments, this unambiguous statement, whatever its intrinsic merit, plainly stands out as _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. anomalous
- B. arcane
- C. irrelevant
- D. superfluous
- E. unusual
- F. esoteric

6. For decades, Pluto seemed to be the mysteriously _____ planet: it was first thought to be about as large as Earth, but, subsequently, measurements had it smaller and smaller.

- A. morphing
- B. appearing
- C. dwindling

- D. orbiting
- E. contracting
- F. emerging

7. Science is arguably a very high-minded pursuit, but that is not to say that all of its practitioners are _____, as numerous articles alleging overly generous pharmaceutical industry payments to medical researchers have tried to show.

- A. conventional
- B. clever
- C. unimpeachable
- D. ingenious
- E. blameless
- F. predictable

test 43 section 2 (hard)

1. His _____ character enables him to work with people who often hold sometimes even conflict views.

- A. choleric
- B. intransigent
- C. officious
- D. irenic
- E. prudent

2. The author of this biography gives an accurate and (i)_____ account of the subject's life story, but all the carefully assembled detail fails to compensate for the general lack of (ii)_____ in her writing.

A. exhaustive	D. specificity
B. glib	E. veracity
C. selective	F. vivacity

3. Although she admitted that her airport expansion plan had recently collapsed, the governor (i)_____ the significance of the failure, pointing out that competing economic development proposals are now more (ii)_____.

A. minimized	D. tenuous
B. touted	E. complicated
C. acknowledged	F. important

4. Industry-sponsored scientific research on chemical safety often (i)_____. Media reports regularly imply that industry support of scientific work is alone sufficient to (ii)_____ that research. Even though the source of funding has been determined to be a less significant cause of bias than other factors, industry support suffices, in the minds of many people, to (iii)_____ the credibility of scientific work.

A. uncovers risks	D. fund	G. adopt
B. elicits skepticism	E. vindicate	H. vitiate
C. promotes innovation	F. invalidate	I. bolster

5. Experiments show that it is shockingly easy to elicit a sense of _____ among a group of strangers: just tell them they'll be working as a team, and they immediately start working as a team. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. dominance
- B. hierarchy
- C. obedience
- D. solidarity
- E. camaraderie
- F. optimism

6. Typefaces, in one sense, are just like styles of shoes: they _____ because different people have different tastes and identities and because both creators and users value novelty for its own sake.

- A. bemuse
- B. converge
- C. proliferate
- D. abound
- E. evolve
- F. coincide

7. It's a sign of John Dramani Mahama's maturity as a writer that he is willing to consider his country's future so _____: his memoir is appealingly honest, given to clear-eyed assessments rather than exaggerated accounts of achievements.

- A. cheerfully
- B. dispassionately
- C. insightfully
- D. evocatively
- E. analytically
- F. blithely

test 44 section 1 (medium)

1. The jury's verdict was such a surprise that the populace rioted in the streets; nothing less than a reversal of the verdict could _____ them. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. mollify
- B. emulsify
- C. denigrate
- D. petrify
- E. disabuse

2. Research into butterfly wings could have (i) _____ implications, since knowledge of their optical and thermal properties may be (ii) _____ controlling the behavior of computer chips, which likewise consist of finely structured thin film.

A. ecological	D. tantamount to
B. aesthetic	E. germane to
C. technological	F. advance by

3. Communal feeding is a remarkable behavioral aspect of this generally solitary animal. It is also a misunderstood behavior and one of the reasons is that Tasmanian devils have a bad reputation. Far from being a (i)____, communal devil feeding is (ii)____ and purposeful, and is described as (iii)____ behavior. The screaming and apparent fighting is an elaborate combination and variety of vocalizations and postures by which order is maintained.

A. free-for-all	D. structured	G. innate
B. rarity	E. vicious	H. acquired
C. necessity	F. infrequent	I. ritualized

4. The action in Zadie Smith's novel *On Beauty* is mediated by an unabashedly _____ narrator who does not hesitate to inform us, as once upon a time the narrators of novels were wont to do, how we behave in general and how society usually works.

- A. knowing
- B. obtrusive
- C. conspicuous
- D. antiquated
- E. mysterious
- F. secretive

5. Since the data we have analyzed are so _____, it would be hazardous to draw a definite conclusion.

- A. copious
- B. overwhelming
- C. abundant
- D. meager
- E. paltry
- F. uncertain

6. The phrase "bread and circuses" refers to early Roman politicians' plans to _____ the votes of the poor by handing out cheap food and entertainment.

- A. belie
- B. surmount
- C. secure
- D. control
- E. cherish
- F. earn

7. They applaud the musicals of the 1930s and 1940s, whose plethora of stars, jokes, dances witty dialogue, and general gaiety make today's offering seem _____ by comparison.

- A. cheerless
- B. vacuous
- C. mirthful
- D. insincere
- E. gloomy
- F. jovial

test 44 section 2 (hard)

1. The inconspicuous location and lack of striking vistas that characterize the villa reflect the _____ aspect of its creator's personality.

- A. volatile

- B. grandiose
- C. gregarious
- D. self-effacing
- E. imperious

2. There are far too many (i)_____ in the report, such as incorrect date (albeit on (ii)_____ points), inconsistency between the text and related tables, and discrepancies between the citations and the references.

A. unsupported generalizations	D. numerous
B. stylistic infelicities	E. minor
C. little errors	F. perplexing

3. The physical (i)_____ seen in the remains of soldiers who fought in the fifteenth-century battle of Towton is unsurprising, given the (ii)_____ origins of the men who took the battlefield that day.

A. decay	D. disparate
B. strength	E. unknown
C. diversity	F. controversial

4. Until now, old snapshots and home movies faded and crumbled and were eventually (i)_____. Only a few precious mementos were preserved and passed along. But as photography moves into the digital realm, family albums and home videos see capable of (ii)_____ : our capacity to store them is, for all practical purposes, approaching the infinite. Is such a transformation a good thing? The natural world teaches us that (iii)_____ are vital to ecological health. Does a similar principle apply to communal memory? 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. archived	D. transmission	G. death and decay
B. discarded	E. immortality	H. predator and prey
C. reproduced	F. revolution	I. reproduction and renewal

5. It may not seem like a big deal for produce distributors to mix together soybeans from different farms, but a growing number of buyers are willing to pay a premium for soybeans the _____ of which is know: they like to know exactly where their food came from.

- A. purity
- B. output
- C. heterogeneity
- D. origin
- E. yield
- F. provenance

6. The book reaffirms the idea that Africans on the continent have not stopped _____ or responding to their own creations; in fact, African creative agents have ushered in their own modern forms rooted in traditional ideas.

- A. exposing
- B. detecting
- C. absorbing
- D. noticing
- E. generating
- F. originating

7. Flash floods are common in desert regions and were widespread before the evolution of trees and woodland soils; in contrast, flash floods are _____ in woodlands, where floodwaters, impeded by trees, form ponds.

- A. overshadowed
- B. redirected
- C. obscured
- D. precluded
- E. mitigated
- F. abated

test 45 section 1 (medium)

1. Since many prehistoric tools were made of materials, such as wood, bone, and antler, that tend to decay quickly, these archaeological specimens are _____ their stone counterparts.

- A. cruder than
- B. derived from
- C. found with
- D. rarer than
- E. similar to

2. The councilman was a highly respected, even (i) _____ member of society, so when he was accused of fraud, people were (ii) _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. venerated	D. stunned
B. obscure	E. elated
C. unassuming	F. gullible

3. Not all paleontologists agree that connections between the continents were (i) _____ just after the extinction of the dinosaurs. Some hold the view that North America, Asia, and South America had (ii) _____ immediately following the dinosaur extinction, pointing to (iii) _____ between ancient kinds of mammals that existed on all three continents at this time in support of their argument.

A. significant	D. lasting differences	G. similarities
B. permanent	E. extensive contacts	H. intermediaries
C. limited	F. trivial likeness	I. hostilities

4. A formal floods resulting from usual monsoon rainfall are _____ the growth of plants, recently there has been an increase in the frequency of highly intensified floods that do not have such welcome effects.

- A. conducive to
- B. hindered by
- C. devastating for
- D. deleterious to
- E. essential for
- F. indispensable to

5. Those who read Empson's correspondence for the first time may be disappointed that so much of it is professional rather than personal, but the distinction in this case is _____: every letter bears the full stamp of Empson's personality.

- A. unambiguous

- B. artificial
- C. significant
- D. spurious
- E. clear-cut
- F. unique

6. Analysis for the structural feather that were thought to _____ kinship between the two species prompted an investigation that dispelled that presumption and revealed that the two share a family history. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. signify
- B. underrate
- C. point to
- D. preclude
- E. rule out
- F. exaggerate

7. The book captures the _____ of several politicians who spoke publicly of old-time virtues in order to mask private vices.

- A. probity
- B. dissemblance
- C. opportunism
- D. rectitude
- E. ingenuousness
- F. duplicity

test 45 section 2 (medium)

1. There are no _____ criteria of excellence in art: works that once were ignored or even reviled now fetch millions of dollars at auction, while those that were most highly praised in their day now languish in storage.

- A. subjective
- B. dubious
- C. transitory
- D. immutable
- E. uncontroversial

2. The pupil had a reputation for obduracy, but the teacher found her to be, on the contrary, quite _____.

- A. zealous
- B. astute
- C. tractable
- D. efficient
- E. amusing

3. (i) _____ may sound like the (ii) _____ novelty seeking, but in fact the latter can coexist with and balance that stick-to-it virtue strong-willed Victorians so promoted.

A. Ambition	D. antithesis of
B. Creativity	E. foundation for
C. Persistence	F. precursor to

4. Company historians tend to focus on either the company itself or company leaders, the latter being (i)_____ by writers who think (ii)_____ is important, the former favored by writers who think company heads are actually (iii)_____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. rehashed	D. leadership	G. influential
B. misrepresented	E. organization	H. interchangeable
C. preferred	F. function	I. uncontrolled

5. Baker was struck by the amount of _____ she saw at the renowned medical facility; for all their experience, the physicians could not seem to agree on the correct diagnosis for any given patient.

- A. discordance
- B. contention
- C. quackery
- D. nepotism
- E. indecision
- F. cronyism

6. There are great _____ in countries' greenhouse gas emissions, especially in per capita terms: while the United States and China are similar in aggregate emissions, United States per capita emissions are a huge multiple of China's.

- A. distortions
- B. disparities
- C. fluctuations
- D. advances
- E. variances
- F. vacillations

7. Church, Nussbaum, Waldman, and Wills have written very different books—Nassbaum and Wills range both farther and deeper—but each one of the four strives for _____, wanting to save us from the errors of partisans and zealots.

- A. concision
- B. evenhandedness
- C. frankness
- D. trustworthiness
- E. succinctness
- F. impartiality

test 46 section 1 (medium)

1. Because the critic thought that the mark of great literature was grandiosity and elegance not to be found in common speech, writers seeking his approbation _____ the vernacular.

- A. exploited
- B. embraced
- C. misapplied
- D. considered
- E. eschewed

2. Knowing how (i)_____ she was at work, her colleagues were surprised at her (ii)_____ throughout the dinner.

A. dependable	D. timidity
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B. diffident	E. assertiveness
C. diligent	F. punctiliousness

3. Cynics will dismiss the race between Richard and Gorman as two equally dull candidates. However, the notion that the two leaders are (i) _____ does not meet them, for they are as different as can be. Richard is (ii) _____ and is fastidious of her appearance. So one could hardly accuse her of being either taciturn or (iii) _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. interchangeable	D. condescending	G. unkempt
B. uncritical	E. loquacious	H. reticent
C. competent	F. blunted	I. adherent

4. Given that the department director was such a feeble contributor, sitting silently at important policy meetings and usually deferring to low-level aides, it was surprising that he had such a reputation for _____.

- A. magnanimity
- B. perspicacity
- C. impartiality
- D. detachment
- E. benevolence
- F. discernment

5. Between the late 1800s and early 1900s, various institutional structures emerged that set researchers in scientific fields apart as a professional class and moderated disputes by _____ some kinds of knowledge as real science.

- A. differing
- B. sanctioning
- C. mischaracterizing
- D. censuring
- E. reprehending
- F. endorsing

6. In Ramachandran's opinion, it is perfectly acceptable to propose bold speculations about the brain, even if these speculations seem _____; as Ramachandran frequently remarks, science thrives on risky conjecture.

- A. unfounded
- B. premature
- C. controversial
- D. verifiable
- E. testable
- F. baseless

7. Price knew about how to do people favors, sometimes just from kindness, but often out of _____.

- A. self-interest
- B. benevolence
- C. magnanimity
- D. opportunism
- E. disinterest
- F. mercy

test 46 section 2 (easy)

1. Due to the many _____ in his committee presentation, Mark's advisor suggested that he revise his work and practice in front of a mirror before presenting it to the entire department.

- A. facilities
- B. jeremiads
- C. gaffes
- D. obloquies
- E. exploits

2. Fears that the recent sharp rise in oil prices is an indication that oil is running out appear to be (i) _____. The Middle East still contains vast oil supplies. Furthermore, even if new oil finds elsewhere have been (ii) _____ than in the past, substantial quantities of oil can be profitably stripped from tar and shale. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. contagious	D. less frequent
B. unfounded	E. more accessible
C. sagacious	F. less publicized

3. The claim that large budget deficits significantly depress private investment and thereby hurt future wages and living standards is (i) _____; in reality, the (ii) _____ effects of budget deficits are tiny.

A. fallacious	D. adverse
B. incomprehensible	E. unforeseen
C. incontrovertible	F. ameliorate

4. People love to talk about their commutes to and from work: those with an easy commute tend to (i) _____, while those who hate their commute think and speak of it as a core affliction, like a chronic illness. Once you raise the subject, the testimonies pour out, and, if your ears are tuned to it, you begin overhearing commute talk everywhere. People who are normally (ii) _____ may, when describing their commutes, be unexpectedly (iii) _____ divulging the intimate details of their lives.

A. grumble	D. inattentive	G. candid in
B. commiserate	E. garrulous	H. economical in
C. gloat	F. circumspect	I. flustered about

5. Caricature can be revealing as well as amusing, and Ager's novel is both: Ager's delineation of class, ethnic, and generational struggle is exaggerated for comical effect, but it _____ nonetheless.

- A. resonates
- B. entertains
- C. diverts
- D. confuses
- E. rings true
- F. falls short

6. Although the claim that no one knows what dark matter is remains _____, some scientists dispute the parallel assertion that dark matter has not been detected.

- A. contentious
- B. sound

- C. questionable
- D. unassailable
- E. unverifiable
- F. prominent

7. Benjamin Franklin's reputation is so much one of appearing scientific investigation with commonsense empiricism that it is somewhat startling to realize how _____ the great experiment's mentoring truly was.

- A. reasonable
- B. speculative
- C. pragmatic
- D. conjectural
- E. careless
- F. judicious

test 47 section 1 (hard)

1. Anthropologist Jane Goodall was _____ in her determination to anthropomorphize the animals she observed with such empathy, and so resisted her editors' attempt to recast her descriptions in more dispassionate language. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. fickle
- B. stalwart
- C. solicitous
- D. pretentious
- E. whimsical

2. The small errors of fact in the work are not sufficient to allow one to (i) _____ Johnson's main thesis, but their cumulative effect is to make the reader (ii) _____ of the quality of his research.

A. dismiss	D. skeptical
B. endorse	E. credulous
C. decipher	F. appreciative

3. A minor criticism of the book, which is (i) _____ an understanding of the difficulty of doing direct research in Hong Kong's, is that So relied on secondary sources to tell the story of Hong Kong's political development, with previous histories of the period (ii) _____ his research. Given So's (iii) _____ many of the players in Hong Kong politics, it is surprising that he did not use interviews and other forms of direct research to delve further into the motivations, strategies, and tactics of participants.

A. attributable to	D. largely debunked by	G. deference to
B. exacerbated by	E. obviating the need for	H. estrangement from
C. tempered by	F. playing a large role in	I. proximity to

4. In its few decades of existence, the field of technology assessment has undergone large changes: its original high ambitions to predict consequences of technology have been _____ if not discarded.

- A. deferred
- B. subverted
- C. abandoned

- D. relinquished
- E. tempered
- F. modulated

5. Individuals interested in longevity have sought to fine-tune their bodies with all kinds of _____ diets: only raw foods; only plant; only the flesh, fruit, and nuts that prehistoric humans would have hunted and foraged. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. eccentric
- B. meager
- C. salutary
- D. proscriptive
- E. trendy
- F. exacting

6. The baseball players performance during last nights game was impressive, although not _____; others have performed similar feats.

- A. decisive
- B. unexampled
- C. significant
- D. novel
- E. outstanding
- F. spectacular

7. The laboratory maze has grown ever less _____ since it was first invented instead of hoping to lose a rodent in a labyrinth; today's scientists design mazes to elicit a few simple, easily measured behaviors.

- A. intricate
- B. extensive
- C. effective
- D. convoluted
- E. useful
- F. prevalent

test 47 section 2 (hard)

1. Although New York exhilarated him, even at first Leger's reaction to it was not _____: he was initially bothered by its stunning verticality.

- A. unspontaneous
- B. unintentional
- C. unqualified
- D. unhopeful
- E. uninterested

2. Just as different human groups have different kinds of musical traditions, different groups of whales have different dialects evident in their songs, and it is possible for one group to influence the (i) _____ of another. It has been documented more than once that a group of whales will (ii) _____ its own tunes and adopt the new songs of an unfamiliar group.

A. tastes	D. create
B. diversity	E. abandon
C. organization	F. perpetuate

3. Any number of mysteries to which individual scholars of Athenian history have devoted whole careers are addressed by Ober, and mostly successfully. This will cause some (i) _____ among scholars who have worked for years on a particular problem only to see another scholar suddenly (ii) _____ it. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. chagrin	D. prolong
B. complacency	E. exacerbate
C. hubris	F. resolve

4. Recent proposals for fixing the climate have taken the form of large-scale geoengineering projects such as launching mirrors into space to reflect solar radiation away from Earth, undertakings that are vastly more (i) _____ than anything a nineteenth-century rainmaker could have cooked up. What is unclear, as one looks back at the history of weather modification research, is whether this resourceful ambition will be (ii) _____, or if, by contrast, it serves to make the scientific community's (iii) _____ that much more devastating.

A. effective	D. anticipated	G. avidity
B. enterprising	E. challenged	H. impotence
C. accessible	F. productive	I. resignation

5. While the group's street protests assumed an assertory uncompromising tenor, once admitted to the halls of power to begin formal lobbying, the group's leadership wisely chose to _____ the stridency of their rhetoric.

- A. metamorphose
- B. gild
- C. wane
- D. palliate
- E. succor
- F. damp

6. His own writing style was _____: colorful and tart in its choice of language, willing to run risks in its allusions, metaphors, and verbal juxtapositions, prone to irreverent conclusions designed to surprise or startle.

- A. effusive
- B. audacious
- C. lyrical
- D. striking
- E. ornate
- F. emotional

7. Debate rages on between proponents of corporal punishment and the death penalty and their detractors, though even the most rabid supporter agrees that punishments must be _____ and the justice system evenhanded and thorough.

- A. meet
- B. clement
- C. delimited
- D. condign
- E. tantamount
- F. merciful

test 48 section 1 (medium)

1. Discussions of impending water shortages are often couched in apocalyptic rhetoric, yet if the language is somewhat _____, the basic message is sound: water is indeed scarce and growing scarcer. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. abstract
- B. complacent
- C. ambiguous
- D. unfamiliar
- E. overblown

2. He was a leader about whom the country's people felt (i) _____: both (ii) _____ and reviling him.

A. ambivalent	D. ignoring
B. complacent	E. understanding
C. indifferent	F. adulating

3. Women in the mining towns of the American West were strictly stereotyped into neat categories of public and private, good and bad, but the 100 intrepid female prospectors in Zanjani's book managed to (i) _____ those categories. In addition to providing documentation that demolishes the all-male version of prospecting, Zanjani uses the examples of her female loners to (ii) _____ some of the (iii) _____ generalizations about Euro-American women as uniformly nurturant and sociable pioneers.

A. inhabit	D. puncture	G. accurate
B. reveal	E. invent	H. facile
C. confound	F. perpetuate	I. unknown

4. Miller reminded his clients that labor relationship are inherently _____; the interests of business owners are diametrically opposed to those of employees. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. adversarial
- B. exploitative
- C. mercenary
- D. antagonistic
- E. variable
- F. changeable

5. Even the man was reserved in his speech, he thoroughly understood his mother, which made him far from _____ as people usually thought.

- A. comprehensive
- B. ingenuous
- C. sophisticated
- D. foolish
- E. simple
- F. sententious

6. Mark Messina's book *The Simple Soybean and Your Health* exudes recognition much less unrestrained in the description of the soy's medical efficiency than its versatility, but the author cautions against soy to be a _____.

- A. cure-all
- B. solitude

- C. efficacy
- D. effectuality
- E. panacea
- F. placebo

7. Three of the nation's largest airlines could be operating under bankruptcy protection in coming weeks, analysts say, the latest sign of the industry's ____ as it lurches through a historic transformation. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. upheaval
- B. exorbitance
- C. affluence
- D. peril
- E. convulsion
- F. opulence

test 48 section 2 (hard)

1. The physical layout of the laboratory, although well adapted to the research being pursued when it was built, was not ____, making a thorough redesign necessary before a proposed new experimental program could be undertaken.

- A. compromised
- B. imprecise
- C. convoluted
- D. ubiquitous
- E. plastic

2. Fables often endure due to their (i) ____, often telling one simple narrative, based around one character. This is both by design, because direct statements are more easily remembered than florid ones, and by accident, as fables are passed from teller to teller, (ii) ____ details fall away, leaving only the essential story.

A. bombast	D. superfluous
B. objectivity	E. requisite
C. simplicity	F. apocryphal

3. There are something like 1,400 seed banks around the world, which guard samples of crop plants ranging from alfalfa to yams. But this agricultural archive is (i) ____ as a result of war, storms, scant money, and bad management, particularly in the world's most (ii) ____ places.

A. eroding	D. secure
B. expanding	E. turbulent
C. stabilizing	F. cosmopolitan

4. The limitations of human attention cause us to miss much of what goes on around us. The real problem here is that we are often (i) ____ these limitations: we think that we see the world as it really is, but our ostensibly reliable visual experience (ii) ____ striking mental (iii) ____.

A. impatient with	D. belies	G. feats
B. unaware of	E. unifies	H. images

C. distracted by	F. dispels	I. lapses
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5. Agencies responsible for protecting natural resources too often issue permits allowing exploitation of those resources, a process that remains _____ given that agencies have become experts at masking their decisions in the scientific terms.

- A. controversial
- B. exacting
- C. obscure
- D. onerous
- E. opaque
- F. misleading

6. The recent exhibition on Dadaism is nothing if not _____, for the visual arts are currently awash in Dadaist gestures and gambits of one variety or another. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. sensational
- B. timely
- C. daunting
- D. ill-advised
- E. opportune
- F. misguided

7. Ascorbate readily oxidizes in aerated aqueous solutions, and the PH of such solutions, in part, _____ the rate of oxidation, since the higher the PH, the greater the rate of oxidation.

- A. determines
- B. accelerates
- C. consolidates
- D. governs
- E. compounds
- F. stabilizes

test 49 section 1 (hard)

1. Within the field of emotional intelligence research, disagreements remain about whether emotional intelligence can be learned and strengthened or is _____ characteristic.

- A. an expressed
- B. an inborn
- C. an invented
- D. a cultivated
- E. a perceptible

2. Recent years have seen a disheartening string of revelations in which everyday items once considered (i) _____ are found to contain (ii) _____ chemicals.

A. ubiquitous	D. benign
B. innocuous	E. complex
C. insalubrious	F. baneful

3. Most advocates of space exploration by the United States would not explicitly associate spaceflight with (i) _____, yet that belief, Launius and McCurdy write, is among the roots of arguments (ii) _____ human spaceflight. Throughout United States history there has been (iii) _____

—seek utopia—on the frontier, and many space advocates have used that notion to make their case for exploring and settling space. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. entertainment	D. questioning	G. a hostile region fit only for the most self-reliant
B. irrationality	E. analyzing	H. the ideal location for one to better oneself
C. utopia	F. prompting	I. a paradise corrupted by European civilization

4. Consuming 25 to 35 percent of their body weight each day, sea otters are not only _____ but highly specialized eaters, organizing themselves into groups that zero in on specific kinds of prey.

- A. prodigious
- B. indiscriminating
- C. fastidious
- D. picky
- E. voracious
- F. omnivorous

5. The concept of the Hellenistic period in ancient history has proved useful but also _____, with scholars disagreeing on the dates when the period began and ended.

- A. slippery
- B. elusive
- C. fruitless
- D. deceptive
- E. futile
- F. compelling

6. The current _____ of repackaged music under Miles Davis' name might prompt any reasonable person to conclude that the recording vault has been plundered bare.

- A. glut
- B. revival
- C. hodgepodge
- D. surfeit
- E. modicum
- F. dearth

7. People enjoy listening to the governor's inspiring speeches, and his eloquence lulls his adversaries into underestimating his _____, the tempered steel beneath the sleek suits.

- A. tenacity
- B. resolve
- C. resourcefulness
- D. kindness
- E. compassion
- F. frankness

test 49 section 2 (hard)

1. The cognitive flexibility of successful fictional detectives is often _____ by their cultural ambivalence: detectives' intellectual acumen, it seems, exists in direct proportion to their uneasy place in society.

- A. amplified
- B. highlighted

- C. spurred
- D. matched
- E. negated

2. The scientist's motivation for (i) _____ a ban on the food addictive cannot be called (ii) _____. He himself had a patent for the substitution for the addictive food. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. advocating	D. altruistic
B. opposing	E. solemn
C. conceding	F. effective

3. Since the field of quantum mechanics is often considered to be (i) _____, it was surprising to find it attracts so much (ii) _____ interest.

A. abstruse	D. cursory
B. unconventional	E. technical
C. interdisciplinary	F. general

4. To get funding and tenured positions, medical researchers have to get their work published in well-regarded journals, where rejection can climb above 90 percent. Not surprisingly, the studies that tend to make the grade are those that make (i) _____ claims. But while coming up with such (ii) _____ claims is relatively easy, getting the data to bear them out is another matter. When studied rigorously, the great majority of these claims (iii) _____.

A. well-supported	D. practical	G. yield contradictory evidence
B. eye-catching	E. orthodox	H. require extensive analysis
C. small-scale	F. striking	I. support conventional beliefs

5. Ancient cave painters explored every surface, and although they bypassed certain walls that to us seem just as suitable for decoration as ones they chose, the placement of the art apparently wasn't _____.

- A. inconsequential
- B. capricious
- C. strenuous
- D. undisclosed
- E. arduous
- F. impulsive

6. Although many skeptics of the scientific theory _____ critiques that have long since been disproved, some of the doubters arguably bring up valid points.

- A. overlook
- B. revise
- C. recycle
- D. utilize
- E. neglect
- F. rehash

7. Although the employees' union and company management, entering into contract negotiations, both issued statements encouraging _____, acrimony between the two sides continued unabated.

- A. pertinacity
- B. compromise

- C. patience
- D. civility
- E. comity
- F. steadfastness

test 50 section 1 (hard)

1. Barry was a skilled _____.: though his arguments were completely flawed, they were clever-sounding enough to deceive everyone who heard them. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. sophist
- B. scholar
- C. quibbler
- D. doctrinaire
- E. pedant

2. There has been great enthusiasm in the United States for reducing fossil fuel dependence by increasing production of biofuels from crops such as corn and switchgrass, but this (i)_____ about biofuel's potential should be (ii)_____ by a realistic appraisal of the costs and challenges of biofuel production.

A. forbearance	D. tempered
B. exuberance	E. delineated
C. obduracy	F. exacerbated

3. As the study of the foundation of western Shanghai reveals, there was a sense of elegance in the refined, simple lines that characterized the entire row, bereft of the exuberant, emphatic, assertive, ornament that constituted the latest British architectural fashion, which expressed its detestation of Plalladianism and neoclassicism—London's Regent Street then being regarded as abhorrent—calling it the product of a (i)_____ "shopocracy". The (ii)_____ of Western architectural taste—oscillating between simplicity and ornamental (iii)_____—must have bemused Chinese observers who had long accepted that both approaches were valid and could co-exist. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. superficial	D. impermanence	G. profundity
B. quintessential	E. eternality	H. modesty
C. disdained	F. subtlety	I. exuberance

4. As a way of _____ the negative impacts of overdependence on a single export product—crude oil, the Nigerian government passed legislation in 1999 intended to revitalize the moribund solid minerals sector. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. assuming
- B. checking
- C. disguising
- D. stemming
- E. downplaying
- F. shouldering

5. After many years of feeling _____ by his seniors managers, Clark was becoming hopeful of advancement.

- A. vilified

- B. stymied
- C. hindered
- D. aggrieved
- E. circumvented
- F. overlooked

6. Even before she went to art school, Veronica found the standard design categories ____: she didn't understand why designing buildings and designing tables should require different sensibilities.

- A. provocative
- B. limiting
- C. stimulating
- D. confusing
- E. confining
- F. exhilarating

7. Upon realizing that the indicators of a stressful situation can be extremely ____, the psychologist reconsidered her claim that a reliable way of reducing stress is to recognize stressful situations and then avoid them.

- A. acute
- B. exiguous
- C. persistent
- D. overstated
- E. tenuous
- F. unrelenting

test 50 section 2 (hard)

1. Reading chunks of Shapiro's verse in one sitting, it must be said, exposes the ____ nature of his writing: scads of poems are too glancing to strike a nerve, scarcely worth a second reading.

- A. jejune
- B. esoteric
- C. corrosive
- D. finicky
- E. indiscreet

2. According to Dr. Edith Widder, measuring the level of pollutants in sediment provides a more accurate and robust indication of an estuary's health than does measuring the level of chemicals in the water, since pollution in water is (i)____, but pollution in sediment is (ii)_____.

A. declining	D. significant
B. manageable	E. persistent
C. transient	F. detectable

3. As the pace of the trial (i)____, the wait at the beginning of the day became less interminable, and the attorneys' requests to suspend proceeding for private conferences with the judge, almost invariably granted early on, were routinely (ii)____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. slowed	D. rebuffed
B. materialized	E. repeated
C. accelerated	F. recounted

4. During the Harlem Renaissance, Alain Locke (i)_____ the first flourishing of a self-consciously racial art movement in America and was widely credited with providing the philosophical basis for its emergence. His importance as a critic of African America art and as an art theorist is (ii)_____ if controversial, yet he has received (iii)_____ attention for his unique insight into the broad forces that shaped American modernism and cultural nationalism in the visual arts.

A. forestalled	D. undisputed	G. undeserved
B. presided over	E. misleading	H. meticulous
C. seethed over	F. questionable	I. insufficient

5. To call Kermode the finest English critic of his generation would be a _____ compliment, since not many of its population are professionally engaged in literary criticism.

- A. sincere
- B. backhanded
- C. paltry
- D. heartfelt
- E. meager
- F. plausible

6. In sharp contrast to the novel's scenic realism and precisely characterized figure is its persistent philosophical _____.

- A. naturalism
- B. abstraction
- C. generality
- D. impartiality
- E. sincerity
- F. objectivity

7. Estimating demographic parameters in marine mammals is challenging, often requiring many years of data to achieve sufficient precision to _____ biologically meaningful change.

- A. effect
- B. tolerate
- C. discern
- D. envisage
- E. withstand
- F. detect

test 51 section 1 (medium)

1. The painter's problem, like that of an author whose early literary masterpiece exhausts the themes it embodies, is how to _____ his first highly acclaimed efforts with works of comparable significance and presence.

- A. combine
- B. illuminate
- C. realize
- D. amend
- E. follow

2. Managers who categorically squelch insights from low-tiered employees run the obvious hazard of (i)_____ creativity; conversely, these very same managers are more likely to (ii)_____ any ideas that flow down from the top brass. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. fomenting	D. unquestioningly embrace
B. smothering	E. arbitrarily denounce
C. sparking	F. conditionally approve

3. Vaccine denial has all the hallmarks of a belief system that is not (i) _____. The notion that childhood vaccines are driving autism rates has been (ii) _____ by multiple epidemiological studies. Yet the true believers are (iii) _____, critiquing each new study that challenges their views, and rallying to the defense of disgraced researchers whose work was retracted.

A. amenable to refutation	D. resuscitated	G. indignant
B. susceptible to fashion	E. documented	H. persistent
C. open to criticism	F. upended	I. phlegmatic

4. Governments are often willing to pay the direct costs of preparing for emergencies that may never happen: they make room in their budgets to prepare for _____ but unlikely events.

- A. plausible
- B. anticipated
- C. dangerous
- D. conceivable
- E. foreseen
- F. unimaginable

5. Sports stars are often _____ figures, regarded as representative of the city or country for which they compete.

- A. totemic
- B. iconoclastic
- C. protean
- D. idealized
- E. irreverent
- F. emblematic

6. The life of a secret agent is dangerous enough, but the life of a double agent is infinitely more _____: a single slip can send an agent crashing to destruction.

- A. arduous
- B. precarious
- C. clandestine
- D. perilous
- E. covert
- F. exhilarating

7. The writer's assignment of the critic includes personal _____ such as jibes about his physical girth and style of delivery, and is not the better for it. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. aspersions
- B. commendations
- C. falsehoods
- D. fantasies
- E. whims
- F. slurs

test 51 section 2 (medium)

1. The presidents' cordial greeting may seem to be a small gesture of friendliness, but it is not without _____ in the heretofore stifled atmosphere of the society's meetings.

- A. significance
- B. impertinence
- C. nostalgia
- D. precedent
- E. triviality

2. Because reading on the Web entails quickly scanning and sorting through a deluge of information, many wonder if our level of engagement with the text (i) _____ or if the ability to read closely and carefully is one that can be (ii) _____ if we simply spend more time immersed in a book.

A. irreparably compromised	D. fully reactivated
B. tentatively disrupted	E. further degraded
C. permanently restored	F. summarily disregarded

3. From time to time, all scientific disciplines encounter observations that do not fit the theories of the day. At first such observations tend to be treated as (i) _____, but those scientists (ii) _____ them sometimes discover that they have to abandon established principles in order to account for the new findings.

A. anomalies	D. averse to scrutinizing
B. discoveries	E. willing to investigate
C. harbinger	F. unable to acknowledge

4. The perennial problem for critics of nineteenth-century novelist Charlotte Yonge is the relationship of her realism to her (i) _____. While admiring her complex psychological portraits and detailed descriptions of quotidian family life, readers since her own time have tended to fault her improbable manipulation of plot to teach a moral lesson. Indeed, many critics (ii) _____ her because of her willingness to (iii) _____.

A. pessimism	D. dismiss	G. squander suspense
B. didacticism	E. applaud	H. sacrifice credibility
C. eclecticism	F. underestimate	I. deflate pretension

5. A priori mathematics, according to Galileo, does not _____ the need for observation, but mathematics does allow us to deduce unobservable properties and thus to penetrate further into the structure of nature than observation does. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. address
- B. acknowledge
- C. obviate
- D. diminish
- E. displace
- F. appreciate

6. One of the peculiarities of humans is that we irrationally gravitate to the predictable and avoid risk, whatever the reasons for this _____, it is hardly a sound basis for dealing with complex, long-term problems.

- A. eccentricity
- B. predilection
- C. vacillation
- D. proclivity
- E. wavering
- F. cowardice

7. An abundance of nutrient-rich pollution in estuaries causes algae to _____, much as houseplants grow better when their soil contains added fertilizer.

- A. abound
- B. proliferate
- C. stagnate
- D. coalesce
- E. collect
- F. diversify

test 52 section 1 (medium)

1. The purpose of accounts of the Amazons for their male Greek recorders was _____, to teach both male and female Greeks that all-female groups, formed by withdrawal from traditional society, are destructive and dangerous.

- A. deceptive
- B. didactic
- C. pre-cautious
- D. vengeful
- E. reflective

2. While in their consideration of the unique way athletics and academics are combined in United States universities, Markovits and Rensmann do not (i)_____ Gumbrecht's idealizing vision of the compatibility of college athletics with the intellectual missions of institutions of higher learning, neither do they regard college athletics as (ii)_____: they believe that big-time sports have a rightful place in university life.

A. fully endorse	D. indispensable
B. intentionally recapitulate	E. venal
C. entirely misconstrue	F. profitable

3. The order applies to all Federal agency whose actions may affect the status of invasive species and requires agencies to identify such actions and to the extent practicable and permitted by law, and since invasive species severely reduce the number of native species and even (i)_____ their existence, the agency has determined and made public its determination that the benefits of such actions clearly outweigh the potential harm caused by invasive species; and that all feasible and (ii)_____ measures to (iii)_____ risk of harm of the introduction of invasive species will be taken in conjunction with the actions.

A. escalate	D. prudent	G. remedy
B. preclude	E. mawkish	H. counterbalance
C. diminish	F. braggart	I. minimize

4. The stories of silent drama may often have been ____; yet, within those broad outlines, the true artists among silent-film actors could express shadings that had no immediate analogue in language. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. implausible
- B. incredible
- C. conventional
- D. elemental
- E. rudimentary
- F. confusing

5. In the wild, no other mammal ____ individuals from another species: badgers do not tend hares, deer do not nurture baby squirrels, lions do not care for giraffes.

- A. protects
- B. fosters
- C. aids
- D. cajoles
- E. adopts
- F. coaxes

6. Recent research runs counter to the long-cherished notion that a small drop in body temperature during and after surgery is either ____ or actually protects the patient by slowing metabolism and reducing the body's demand for blood and oxygen.

- A. beneficial
- B. immaterial
- C. inconsequential
- D. preventive
- E. prophylactic
- F. redundant

7. In the northeastern United States, beaver populations had been critically reduced or even ____ in large areas at the end of nineteenth century; as a result, several states instituted prohibitions on beaver trapping.

- A. diminished
- B. extirpated
- C. eliminated
- D. devalued
- E. weakened
- F. underrated

test 52 section 2 (hard)

1. The often-cited parallels between human communities and insect colonies are ____: the cooperation found among social insects is essentially due to the insects genetic ties, while humans often collaborate with non-relatives. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. superficial
- B. obvious
- C. hackneyed
- D. contradictory
- E. uncanny

2. In the years prior to the Civil War, Philadelphia's African American press encourage readers to be vaccinated against smallpox. This journalistic campaign was initially (i)____, appealing to

readers sense of communal duty, and became even more (ii)_____ once the war started, as smallpox outbreaks began to occur on Philadelphia's outskirts.

A. hortatory	D. controversial
B. ineffective	E. urgent
C. widespread	F. inopportune

3. A hallmark of certain nineteenth-century mystery novels was the reform agenda of their authors, who ostensibly sought to expose economic injustice while depicting the seamy underside of urban life. In reality, however, these claims to a radical political agenda were often (i)_____ meant to give lurid thrillers the appearance of (ii)_____.

A. authentic	D. escapist appeal
B. complicated	E. high-minded purpose
C. disingenuous	F. gripping suspense

4. Conventionally, the ultimate measure of a scientific work's validity is how broadly and confidently its conclusions become accepted in the relevant field, which in turn (i)_____ the extent to which its findings are replicated and extended. However, establishing such validity, especially for a novel experimental finding, can take years, and what (ii)_____ replication or extension may be (iii)_____ for some time.

A. derives from	D. justifies	G. evident
B. works against	E. impugns	H. disputed
C. leads to	F. constitutes	I. touted

5. Laughter, like speech, is primarily a human faculty, although both functions may also exist in a more _____ form in lesser primates.

- A. indispensable
- B. crucial
- C. primitive
- D. intelligible
- E. recognizable
- F. rudimentary

6. It is normal for artists who achieve great acclaim during their lifetimes to be considered _____ shortly after their deaths, only to have their reputations restored by subsequent generations.

- A. sacrosanct
- B. outmoded
- C. overrated
- D. canonical
- E. unfashionable
- F. emblematic

7. Human perception is not a direct consequence of reality but rather requires imagination, because the data that people encounter in their lives are never complete and always _____.

- A. equivocal
- B. ambiguous
- C. apparent
- D. clear
- E. transient

F. contradictory

test 53 section 1 (medium)

1. In the nineteenth century, geology became so respected among middle-class Britons that the science came to be seen as _____, a yardstick by which other disciplines measured their scientific rigor and imaginative power. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. accessible
- B. derivative
- C. pragmatic
- D. empirical
- E. paradigmatic

2. Though McDonough discusses (i) _____ the filmmaker's aesthetic principles, it is the description of the (ii) _____, the very vulgarity of the director's films, rather than McDonough's learned discourses on the aesthetics of the film, that makes the book so entertaining.

A. inaccurately	D. subtle ingenuity
B. superficially	E. absolute discretion
C. adroitly	F. flagrant crassness

3. Saul's particular combination of intellectuality and vitality was not paradoxical; it was category-shattering. (i) _____ was, in a way, his very theme. Was ever a bookish soul so cracklingly unmediated, so (ii) _____ raw life? He was as vivid physically as he was mentally, almost perversely alert, completely at home in the world of matter, repulsed by (iii) _____.

A. energy	D. put off by	G. seriousness
B. nostalgia	E. flush with	H. sensuality
C. solitude	F. uninterested in	I. tedium

4. Susanne Prediger argues that although rational decimals and fractions are mathematically equivalent, students generally deal with them in _____ ways, hence they are not cognitively equivalent.

- A. variable
- B. divergent
- C. unique
- D. cursory
- E. dissimilar
- F. superficial

5. Although Lemettais was _____ computer engineering, he lacked the spirit or enthusiasm to pursue it as a lifelong occupation.

- A. fanatical about
- B. adept at
- C. indifferent to
- D. diligent regarding
- E. proficient in
- F. apathetic about

6. In science, replicability comes with the idea that the pursuit of scientific truth should not be _____. researchers who make claims must allow others to test them empirically.

- A. incomplete
- B. settled
- C. private
- D. unfinished
- E. insular
- F. unerring

7. Even the most hard-nosed critics could hardly deny that the novelist's best books are _____. they are filled with energy, imagination, and something close to a white-hot inspiration.

- A. inventive
- B. engaging
- C. spirited
- D. compassionate
- E. vigorous
- F. warmhearted

test 53 section 2 (medium)

1. One might expect someone of such _____ views to have a comparably dour personality, but people who have worked with her talk about how she uses her considerable charm to convince people that she is right. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. forbearing
- B. convoluted
- C. felicitous
- D. astringent
- E. hyperbolic

2. In our daily lives, we often (i) _____ our separate identities: you can have one identity at work and another online, for example. Such (ii) _____ disappear in certain circumstances, however, resulting in a cross-pollination of our different selves.

A. renounce	D. uncertainties
B. merge	E. correlations
C. compartmentalize	F. boundaries

3. If the candidate wins the election now that rivals within his own party have (i) _____ him in a campaign that was (ii) _____ without their help, he will be mightily indebted to these self-styled saviors.

A. rallied	D. foundering
B. separated from	E. effective
C. undermined	F. improving

4. The difficulty for nineteenth-century advocates of the claim that forests helped regulate climate was that their argument (i) _____ historical anecdote and observations. Proving the forest-climate link through verifiable and experimental scientific means rather than observation was (ii) _____ for these individuals, a situation that eventually led to the link (iii) _____ justifications for forest conservation.

A. lacked	D. problematic	G. being revived in
B. discounted	E. unnecessary	H. dropping out of
C. employed	F. straightforward	I. losing out to

5. Liam Clancy described the young Bob Dylan as a sponge, eagerly absorbing the possibilities life and culture might provide, and Dylan presents himself so in his memoir _____ in his intellectual and musical curiosity. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. insatiable
- B. devious
- C. unique
- D. pretentious
- E. voracious
- F. cunning

6. The Red Sea town of Aydhab presents scholars with _____: medieval records describe it as a major port for ships engaged in trade, yet today there is no trace of a viable harbor at the site.

- A. an illusion
- B. a contradiction
- C. a chimera
- D. a puzzle
- E. an anachronism
- F. a conundrum

7. As clucks of disapproval about Americans' political _____ have grown louder in recent years, many historians have looked for contrast to the decades before the Civil War as a time when Americans were enthusiastically engaged in politics.

- A. zealotry
- B. apathy
- C. hypocrisy
- D. partisanship
- E. insincerity
- F. passivity

test 54 section 1 (easy)

1. Some species camouflage patterns may be _____, granting those species a higher chance of survival in a heterogeneous environment.

- A. plastic
- B. subtle
- C. singular
- D. consistent
- E. imitable

2. In the popular conception, (i) _____ is inextricably tied up with (ii) _____: doing something truly creative, we are inclined to think, requires the freshness and energy of youth. Orson Welles made his masterpiece, Citizen Kane, at twenty-five, and Mozart wrote his breakthrough Piano concerto no.9 at twenty-one.

A. progress	D. serendipity
B. genius	E. precocity
C. destiny	F. dedication

3. Methods were developed to remove distortions caused by either the research environment or the researcher. Such methods, especially with respect to the researcher, were considered to (i) _____ those (ii) _____ subjectivity whose unbridled expression was thought to otherwise (iii) _____ research.

A. restrain	D. incursions of	G. corrupt
B. reveal	E. efficacy of	H. obviate
C. supersede	F. restrictions on	I. facilitate

4. The latest publications predicting disastrous coastal erosion are unlikely to _____ knowledgeable readers because variations on the same claims have been effectively refuted in the past few years.

- A. intrigue
- B. reassure
- C. baffle
- D. alarm
- E. unsettle
- F. calm

5. Some social insects, such as bees and ants, are celebrated for their industriousness and engineering feat, but popular culture has not generally _____ termites for theirs—even though they can build mounds twenty feet high. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. considered
- B. reprehended
- C. applauded
- D. deprecated
- E. exonerated
- F. extolled

6. Because the organization often trumpeted itself as a forum for _____ discussion, visitors were startled by the frequently heated tone of its recent debates.

- A. elevated
- B. vigorous
- C. temperate
- D. strenuous
- E. dispassionate
- F. strident

7. Many scholars studying leadership _____ cult of the celebrity that has been fostered both by the media and by politicians' public relations staffs, arguing that it trivialized politics.

- A. abet
- B. decry
- C. question
- D. analyze
- E. countenance
- F. condemn

test 54 section 2 (medium)

1. The monitoring is not _____.: on the contrary, the defendant and his or her attorney are required to be given notice of the government's listening activities. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. obtrusive
- B. circumspect
- C. surreptitious
- D. adroit
- E. meticulous

2. Even if the merits of the proposal are (i)_____, faculty members may be reluctant to (ii)_____, given their fear of offending the group that champions it.

A. unparalleled	D. demur
B. dubious	E. approve
C. obvious	F. acquiesce

3. Whatever the acknowledged (i)_____ of the market and the merits of considering ways to (ii)_____ them, implementing public policies toward this end entails the inevitable risk that those policies will simply create new deficiencies even as they address old ones.

A. attractions	D. remedy
B. shortcomings	E. enhance
C. complexities	F. restore

4. People accustomed to thinking that the human lifespan (i)_____ the outer bounds of animal longevity tend to dismiss tales of musket balls being found in the shells of living turtles. Samantha Romney, however, argues that while such stories may be (ii)_____, some turtles do indeed exhibit a phenomenon known as "negligible (iii)_____" showing no signs of aging even as they pass the two-century mark.

A. belies	D. apocryphal	G. rejuvenation
B. demarcates	E. authentic	H. superannuation
C. antedates	F. heresy	I. senescence

5. Experimentation in the arts often generates befuddlement, and even _____ of innovative art generally have voiced perplexity regarding this new, experimental artwork.

- A. proponents
- B. vilifiers
- C. defenders
- D. belittlers
- E. vendors
- F. luminaries

6. The sailors realized too late that winds had shifted the ice in such a way as to obstruct the ship's path; this process had been so _____ that it was completed by the time they discovered the effect.

- A. gradual
- B. negligible
- C. unpredictable
- D. time-consuming
- E. inconsequential
- F. imperceptible

7. What makes the precisely oriented flight of a honeybee swarm to its new home so _____ is that only a small percentage of its members know the swarm travel route and final destination.
- A. exact
 - B. unpredictable
 - C. amazing
 - D. erratic
 - E. reliable
 - F. wondrous

test 55 section 1 (medium)

1. When studying human history, one must be aware that the _____ between historical periods are arbitrary; certainly none of the people alive at the time were aware of a shift from one era to another.
- A. judgements
 - B. ideologies
 - C. innovations
 - D. demarcations
 - E. episodes

2. Research note that wolves' otherwise strongly hierarchical society is marked by occasional displays of populist (i) _____: if a pack leader proves a too-snappish tyrant, subordinate wolves will (ii) _____ the top cur. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. umbrage	D. collectively overthrow
B. expiation	E. eventually placate
C. torpor	F. quickly appraise

3. For a time in the early Middle Ages, Latin culture came close to (i) _____: the witness to that is the (ii) _____ of manuscript copies of texts datable to the period. The process of copying manuscripts, the only way in which the fragile products of centuries of accumulating knowledge could be preserved, (iii) _____, a situation that did not change for two and a half centuries, until the time of Charlemagne. In the intervening period, much of Classical literature was lost to use forever.

A. reversing	D. paucity	G. was pursued methodically
B. exploding	E. provenance	H. expressed the spirit of the time
C. vanishing	F. proliferation	I. virtually came to a standstill

4. The proposition that foraging Native Americans studied the skies is _____: anthropological evidence demonstrates, for example, that the Chumash Indians counted the lunar cycles and established the times of the solstices.

- A. unquestionable
- B. unremarkable
- C. undeniable
- D. unprecedented
- E. unexceptional
- F. unparalleled

5. In the nineteenth century, the circus, for all its glitz and even its glamour, was entertainment with an old soul, _____ the fast-forward pace of change in modern life.

- A. a forerunner of
- B. an antidote to
- C. a respite from
- D. a break from
- E. a precursor to
- F. a rebuke to

6. Sokari Douglas Camp was _____ in the early 1990s by many of London's commercially driven art dealers and galleries, some of whom apparently found her themes difficult to market.

- A. criticized
- B. lionized
- C. misrepresented
- D. neglected
- E. forsaken
- F. eulogized

7. It is troubling that blogs, which may be among the least reliable sources of information in human history, occupy such _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. enviable
- B. conspicuous
- C. suspect
- D. dubious
- E. controversial
- F. prominent

test 55 section 2 (hard)

1. Although his friends insisted that his black garb was simply depressing, Peter felt just the opposite—that it gave him an air of upbeat, _____ maturity.

- A. melancholic
- B. wearisome
- C. salacious
- D. aghast
- E. urbane

2. Throughout much of the twentieth century, common scientific sense seemed to dictate that animals could not make a choice based on rational or aesthetic criteria. Such choices were (i) _____ the mental capacity of humans. Scientists who (ii) _____ this animal-human cognitive division were often accused of anthropomorphism.

A. reserved for	D. accepted
B. inconsistent with	E. transgressed
C. similar to	F. exacerbated

3. For many adults, the adolescent years occupy (i) _____ place in the memory, which to some degree is even quantifiable: give a grown adult a series of random prompts and cues, odds are he or she will recall (ii) _____ number of memories from adolescence.

A. a peripheral	D. a disproportionate
B. a privileged	E. a modest

C. an arbitrary	F. an uncertain
-----------------	-----------------

4. Barker's account of how mores have evolved over time is illuminating. It reveals as (i)_____ and (ii)_____ some values that have often been regarded as (iii)_____, while uncovering other values that do indeed seem to be universal.

A. transient	D. transcendent	G. liberating
B. instinctive	E. relative	H. nonnegotiable
C. resilient	F. enduring	I. antiquated

5. Considering that space travel was science fiction only decades ago, we should be extremely reluctant to proclaim an idea forever technologically infeasible unless that idea _____ some hard physical constraint. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. violates
- B. contravenes
- C. overcomes
- D. transcends
- E. utilizes
- F. introduces

6. The actor's part in the film turned out to be _____: he had only one line, and by the time the film appeared in theaters, even that line had been removed.

- A. misunderstood
- B. mandatory
- C. intriguing
- D. fascinating
- E. trivial
- F. inessential

7. Although _____ to please his audiences, Mozart was, at the same time, fully aware of his musical genius and had no intention of compromising his music.

- A. disposed
- B. loath
- C. disinclined
- D. eager
- E. keen
- F. compelled

test 56 section 1 (medium)

1. The actor's performance was so absurdly _____ that Gwen felt a little ashamed to have to resort to tissues in the final scene. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. proficient
- B. unfeasible
- C. seditious
- D. maudlin
- E. accommodating

2. In the discussions on international patent law, many (i)_____ issues will probably be pushed far into the future. This cautious approach makes diplomatic sense, since attempts over the past 15 years to reach international agreements on patents have (ii)_____ just such sensitive issues.

A. contentious	D. approached
B. stimulating	E. articulated
C. subjective	F. foundered on

3. Much of the newspapers readership found it hard to (i) _____ the allegations of venality laid against the superintendent, since these readers were still (ii) _____ the superintendents reputation for (iii) _____. The superintendents subsequent vindication will have come as no surprise to them.

A. ignore	D. swayed by	G. grouchiness
B. credit	E. unaware of	H. probity
C. dismiss	F. learning about	I. creativity

4. It is true that science, and more particularly scientists, _____ cherished paradigms with great reluctance and that when they do, scientific revolutions may result.

- A. unify
- B. share
- C. cede
- D. embrace
- E. dismantle
- F. relinquish

5. Patterson thought the waste leaking into the river was _____ situation: by contrast, judging from their silence on the matter, the owners of the factory felt the problem did not require immediate action.

- A. a lingering
- B. a convoluted
- C. a pressing
- D. an enervating
- E. an exigent
- F. an intricate

6. Some historians represent the East India Company as _____ participant in political and military conflict in India, only taking an interest in territorial power and revenue as a last-ditch effort to protect its trading activities.

- A. a shrewd
- B. an ineffectual
- C. an irregular
- D. a canny
- E. a reluctant
- F. an unwilling

7. Very few companies take the trouble to discover where the wood in their products originates, consumers do not demand this information, and consequently _____ regarding illicit timber has become the norm. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. greed
- B. indifference
- C. outrage
- D. timidity
- E. apprehension
- F. apathy

test 56 section 2 (medium)

1. During the Renaissance, history was thought to be _____: it supplied instances of good and bad behavior in the past, thus informing the ethical precepts of the present.

- A. amoral
- B. subjective
- C. superfluous
- D. exemplary
- E. progressive

2. The report is admittedly (i) _____: it is intended to suggest new lines of research rather than to deal with the subject in a (ii) _____ manner.

A. sketchy	D. cavalier
B. exculpatory	E. deceptive
C. flippant	F. thorough

3. Memoirs are inherently (i) _____, but Larry McMurtry's volume of reminiscences about his life with books—not as a novelist but as a reader and bookstore owner—is especially (ii) _____: nearly every page sounds a note of farewell to an age of books that he sees as passing.

A. unreliable	D. whimsical
B. wistful	E. ungracious
C. self-serving	F. valedictory

4. Persian prose writers from the second half of the twelfth century onward were characteristically (i) _____ the literary form of their works, a fact that some scholars have perceived as a derogation of those works' content. It may be better interpreted as (ii) _____ the development of an awareness of authorship, for the awareness of authorship (iii) _____ the awareness of form.

A. ambivalent about	D. a retreat from	G. evolves through
B. indifferent to	E. an indication of	H. extends beyond
C. preoccupied with	F. a justification for	I. holds back

5. Scientists are investigating odors so faint that people cannot _____ them in order to see whether such odors can nevertheless change the way people interact.

- A. tolerate
- B. endure
- C. avoid
- D. dispel
- E. detect
- F. discern

6. The tribes' _____ a settled mode of living was derived from their long-standing traditions, which, though differing from one tribal group to another, always included a resistance to nomadic lifestyles.

- A. curiosity about
- B. proclivity toward
- C. predilection for

- D. unfamiliarity with
- E. rejection of
- F. disdain for

7. In politics, tactical calculations about which groups a candidate should appeal to are never pleasant, but they are not always _____, and sometimes they are necessary.

- A. injudicious
- B. sleazy
- C. effective
- D. sordid
- E. useful
- F. exceptional

test 57 section 1 (medium)

1. Many legislators who helped Roosevelt shape the New Deal _____ the fact that emerging social problems affected every segment of the population; nonetheless, they often acted with a view to aiding only their own constituents.

- A. disregarded
- B. bemoaned
- C. ignored
- D. disputed
- E. downplayed

2. Federal efforts to regulate standards on educational achievements have been met by (i) _____ from the states; local governments feel that government imposition represents an undue infringement on their (ii) _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. receptivity	D. autonomy
B. intransigence	E. legislation
C. compromise	F. comportment

3. Many researchers assume that politicians consider the preferences of the entire public, and not merely those of likely voters, when making decisions. Yet, since the desire to be reelected is central, it is plausible that politicians (i) _____ the opinions of likely voters in formulating their positions on issues. It is possible that researchers' suppositions about policy makers' (ii) _____ aggregate public opinion may serve to (iii) _____ the fact that only the preferences of likely voters actually matter.

A. rely insufficiently on	D. responsiveness to	G. mask
B. depart sporadically from	E. neglect of	H. reflect
C. attend disproportionately to	F. misrepresentation of	I. obviate

4. The spacecraft's considerable heft forces an unusually _____ route that meanders through the solar system and depends on the gravitational pull of three heavenly bodies.

- A. predetermined
- B. circuitous
- C. indirect
- D. truncated
- E. shortened

F. sequential

5. According to some political analysts, the candidate's occasionally rambling responses to questions suggest that she has been out of circulation for a while and her debating skills need to be _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. honed
- B. discredited
- C. enhanced
- D. reevaluated
- E. remedied
- F. de-emphasized

6. Until 1992, microprocessor types were identified by number, and for a long time they were considered so _____ that manufacturers would share design specifications for them.

- A. fungible
- B. interchangeable
- C. perishable
- D. integral
- E. inimitable
- F. essential

7. The apparent simplicity of savanna or a prairie landscape is illusory, but the illusion takes real effort to _____ because much of what actually occurs in these places takes place underground.

- A. dispel
- B. acknowledge
- C. confirm
- D. disavow
- E. dismiss
- F. perceive

test 57 section 2 (easy)

1. One thing both authors have in common is a striking amount of _____: they claim to know how massive institutions, some of them richly endowed, all of them central to American society and culture, should be reshaped.

- A. hubris
- B. propriety
- C. bias
- D. prescience
- E. indolence

2. The company president's reputation for unflappability could easily be understood upon observing her (i) _____ performance during a particularly (ii) _____ board meeting.

A. supercilious	D. productive
B. histrionic	E. contentious
C. composed	F. lifeless

3. In the 1980s, many historians sounded urgent calls for (i) _____ in American historical writing, as longer and longer monographs on smaller subjects were being written—dazzling studies, but pieces of a puzzle no one was putting together. This scholarship was not illuminating the central themes of history but (ii) _____.

A. indulgence	D. obscuring
B. detail	E. criticizing
C. synthesis	F. celebrating

4. Observers of modern presidential campaigns who (i) _____ the highly (ii) _____ productions that pass for campaigns these days do sometimes find reason for hope in the occasional mix-ups that (iii) _____ candidates on the trail despite the presence of political strategist's plotting every event with the tactical precision of military commanders. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. relish	D. ambitious	G. rattle
B. misinterpret	E. chaotic	H. bolster
C. despair over	F. choreographed	I. legitimate

5. Lustig's critics argue that what makes him a compelling public speaker is his practice of citing evidence that is merely suggestive in support of a claim and insisting that this evidence is _____.

- A. invaluable
- B. irrelevant
- C. indubitable
- D. immaterial
- E. insignificant
- F. incontrovertible

6. The series of documentaries certainly does not promote the country's recent diplomatic initiatives; in fact, some of the films appear to be _____ those initiatives.

- A. commendations of
- B. reparations of
- C. tributes to
- D. rationalizations of
- E. denunciations of
- F. indictments of

7. If Wilson's article style changed overtime, it was in the wrong retrograde direction, _____ experimentation and inclining toward works that seemed hobbled by a fear of risk.

- A. belaboring
- B. shunning
- C. eschewing
- D. overemphasizing
- E. misconstruing
- F. mocking

test 58 section 1 (medium)

1. Since the deficit predicament is fundamentally a long-term problem, the legislature's _____ short-term approaches has actually compounded the difficulty in each succeeding year, eroding the state credit rating in the process.

- A. vexation regarding
- B. skepticism about
- C. addiction to
- D. wariness of

E. demonization of

2. There has been (i) _____ elephant's fabled mental capacities until recently, when these behavioral observations have begun to be (ii) _____ by brain science. MRI scans of an elephant's brain suggest that even relative to its overall size it has a large hippocampus, the component in the mammalian brain linked to memory and an important part of its limbic system, which is involved in precessing emotions.

A. surprising credence given to	D. buttressed
B. a widespread dismissal of	E. anticipated
C. only anecdotal evidence for	F. overwhelmed

3. However luminous an insight might seem initially, brilliance is not a reliable predictor of (i) _____, and sure enough the history of physical chemistry is replete with theories that were as (ii) _____ as any but that (iii) _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. popularity	D. opaque	G. slowly developed
B. originality	E. ingenious	H. eventually collapsed
C. validity	F. useful	I. ultimately prevailed

4. Considering how difficult it is to prove or disprove the existence of life on Mars, which is practically our neighbor, it is quite _____ challenge to do the same for any Earthlike planets that might exist outside our solar system.

- A. a formidable
- B. an impossible
- C. a hopeless
- D. a daunting
- E. an urgent
- F. an immediate

5. While it's hard to know for sure, I suspect that the well-known authority's silence on this contentious topic reflects the cautious _____ of a sensible scientist confronted with mixed data and mountains of speculation.

- A. neutrality
- B. impartiality
- C. optimism
- D. diffidence
- E. commitment
- F. buoyancy

6. Very few companies take the trouble to discover where the wood in their products originate; consumers do not demand this information, and consequently _____ regarding illicit timber has become the norm.

- A. greed
- B. indifference
- C. outrage
- D. timidity
- E. apprehension
- F. apathy

7. Humanity's struggle with bedbugs is _____: archaeologists have recovered remains of the parasites dating back 3,500 years to the time of the Egyptian pharaohs.

- A. disconcerting
- B. unexceptional
- C. perennial
- D. preordained
- E. inevitable
- F. long-standing

test 58 section 2 (medium)

1. His _____ speaking style notwithstanding, William Perkins has long been seen as the moderate face of his political party. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. genteel
- B. mundane
- C. affable
- D. captivating
- E. vehement

2. The novel's heroine shows a remarkable (i) _____ to worship at the altar of youth; in her world, youth is (ii) _____, while age, by contrast, confers competence and wisdom.

A. disinclination	D. incredulous
B. desire	E. sagacious
C. tendency	F. callow

3. Recently released statistics on the prevalence of heart disease in the United States, while (i) _____, nevertheless reflect a decline from heights reached in the 1960s, before health officials began publicly (ii) _____ people to guard against heart disease.

A. definitive	D. entreating
B. sobering	E. defying
C. implausible	F. absolving

4. Many historians of the ancient world are wary of sounding (i) _____. Write so much as a sentence and the temptation is immediately to (ii) _____ it. Even in cases when the sources for a given event are (iii) _____, uncertainties and discrepancies crop up everywhere.

A. fusty	D. recapitulate	G. consistent
B. anachronistic	E. forswear	H. plentiful
C. dogmatic	F. qualify	I. biased

5. The composer's string quartets exhibit a structural _____ that seems to challenge the conventions of the string quartet genre, which have long been celebrated for their rigor and coherence.

- A. austerity
- B. restraint
- C. uncertainty
- D. ostentation
- E. vitality
- F. instability

6. It is _____ and rather, surprising, for someone with a considerable background in philosophy, that Taylor fails to distinguish adequately between forms of communication and forms of knowledge.

- A. reprehensible
- B. inexplicable
- C. deplorable
- D. dangerous
- E. typical
- F. characteristic

7. As a proponent of women's traditional roles, Sarah Hale was adamant against women's suffrage as thrusting women into an improper sphere; yet she _____ female textile strikers when they publicly protested their mistreatment at miles. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. opposed
- B. supported
- C. criticized
- D. championed
- E. challenged
- F. welcomed

test 59 section 1 (easy)

1. Like her literary heroine, George Eliot, Barbara Kingsolvers is an old-fashioned _____, deeply curious about all branches of human learning.

- A. prodigy
- B. polymath
- C. tyro
- D. ante
- E. philistine

2. I knew well, from experience with hundreds of hired crew members on her boats, how (i)_____ attitudes can be: how one negative influence can impel an otherwise (ii)_____ member of a crew to quit.

A. insipid	D. untested
B. infectious	E. captious
C. innocuous	F. contented

3. His new role gives the normally clownish actor a chance to impress audiences with his (i)_____. He is among the most uninhibited comic performers around, but here he buttons his lip and stares straight ahead. Perhaps without quite knowing it, the audience waits for a wink, a hint that some of the (ii)_____ spirit that animated his previous movies might be lurking inside the (iii)_____ manner he presents in this film. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. raillery	D. madcap	G. facetious
B. effusiveness	E. lugubrious	H. reserved
C. forbearance	F. edifying	I. beguiling

4. Since Venus and Earth are so similar in their mass and density, Mueller suggested that the two planets have similar compositions and, therefore there must be surface features on Venus that have terrestrial ____.

- A. causes
- B. consequences
- C. counterparts
- D. parallels
- E. properties
- F. outcomes

5. It turns out that the seeming spontaneity of his letter actually involved a good deal of ____: the writer carefully revises them before mailing them, and he worked hard to establish the right tone.

- A. deliberation
- B. whimsicality
- C. inventiveness
- D. effort
- E. capriciousness
- F. consideration

6. There is ____ quality to Beryl Bainbridge's best novels, what Hilary Martel calls "an air of mystery, as if something has been inked in and then sponged away, leaving a faint trace for the reader to pick up".

- A. an elegiac
- B. a cryptic
- C. a deceptive
- D. a plaintive
- E. an elusive
- F. a mesmerizing

7. Another challenge to biologists and land-use planners alike is that while human-induced changes to the landscape are somethings ____, they can nevertheless drastically alter the habitat for some plants and animals.

- A. indisputable
- B. inappropriate
- C. unacceptable
- D. unfathomable
- E. imperceptible
- F. indiscernible

test 59 section 2 (medium)

1. Physicists' opinions diverge on whether the unexpected phenomena that can occur in systems more complex than individual particles represent new physical principles, or whether the principles involved are ____, in that they rely, albeit in an extremely complicated way, on known physical principles.

- A. extraneous
- B. inexpressible
- C. derivative
- D. heterogeneous
- E. uncorrelated

2. The question whether children like sweetener or not is (i)_____. Of course children like sweetener, which is (ii)_____ to sellers, since children's taste will not change once they are used to a certain brand.

A. debated	D. a pragmatic solution
B. decided	E. a commercial advantage
C. overlooked	F. an idealistic conception

3. The new drug was useful, but unfortunately its effect was largely (i)_____ rather than (ii)_____.

A. placatory	D. immediate
B. palliative	E. curative
C. addictive	F. mollifying

4. Some climatologists dismiss as (i)_____ the debate among geophysicists over the role of carbon dioxide in global climate change across many millions of years. These climatologists say the evidence of a tie between carbon dioxide and planetary warming over the last few centuries is so (ii)_____ that any longer-term evidence against such a link must somehow be (iii)_____.

A. unavoidable	D. unlikely	G. tainted
B. irrelevant	E. controversial	H. accommodated
C. undecidable	F. compelling	I. reinforced

5. While merchants and bankers in thirteen-century Europe quickly embraced the Hindu-Arabic numeral system, the governing authorities were less _____ it. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. persuaded by
- B. guarded about
- C. captivated by
- D. open-minded about
- E. inhibited about
- F. enamored of

6. It's true that occasional _____ entries might have been edited without damaging the diary's overall impact, but the very completeness of Clara's eloquent reflections conveys a strong sense of the density of a young woman's experiences.

- A. verbose
- B. redundant
- C. long-winded
- D. curt
- E. mundane
- F. laconic

7. Berwick, middle-aged, soft-spoken, and _____, with a keen sense of how to use this apparent ordinariness to his advantage, began with a gripping story about how a firefighter saved himself during a forest fire by using a completely improbable tactic.

- A. imperturbable
- B. implacable
- C. unimaginative
- D. unprepossessing
- E. unremarkable
- F. unruffled

test 60 section 1 (medium)

1. In an ironic twist, the recent _____ of the reductive observational methods that have enabled science to progress for four centuries may turn out to be science's biggest step forward.

- A. introduction
- B. validation
- C. acceptance
- D. standardization
- E. questioning

2. In reviewing cases decided by lower courts, Supreme Court justices search for precedents to justify their arguments. Reliance on precedent (i) _____ judicial restraint: the precedent (ii) _____ a judge's ability to determine the outcome of a case in a way that he or she might choose if there were no precedent. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. promotes	D. establishes
B. compromises	E. constrains
C. promulgates	F. prioritizes

3. Part of what currently makes it so (i) _____ to arrive at a scientific understanding of the living world is that while technological advances have produced a cascade of data—from detailed genome sequence to the sophisticated satellite imagery that documents the planet's ecosystems—our ability to (ii) _____ these data still lags far behind their (iii) _____.

A. frustrating	D. gather	G. acquisition
B. intriguing	E. apprehend	H. interpretation
C. challenging	F. dispute	I. implementation

4. Because the literary club often trumpeted itself as a sanctuary for temperate discussion, visitors were startled by the frequently _____ tone of its recent debates.

- A. blunt
- B. ingratiating
- C. acerbic
- D. unctuous
- E. vitriolic
- F. bombastic

5. Contrary to popular myth, cockroaches are not especially tough or radiation resistant; indeed, they are pretty _____ as insects go.

- A. harmless
- B. average
- C. strong
- D. undistinguished
- E. weak
- F. hardy

6. Scientific discovery calls for a difficult balance: intrepid advocacy of new ideas must often be _____ by the results of self-imposed trials.

- A. tempered

- B. moderated
- C. unhampered
- D. preempted
- E. superseded
- F. prefaced

7. Reuters are not against _____ noteworthy architecture but suggests a cap on the amount to be protected at any one time: if you want to protect another ancient building, one should come off the list.

- A. preserving
- B. rehabilitating
- C. promoting
- D. restoring
- E. emulating
- F. safeguarding

test 60 section 2 (medium)

1. Even though the municipal government was not totally _____ the positive review of the charter, the mayor nevertheless decided to veto the laws. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. garrulous about
- B. enthusiastic about
- C. sanguine about
- D. approbatory to
- E. unsympathetic with

2. To abolish the existence of nation-states is neither feasible nor desirable; but insofar as there are collective interests that transcend national boundaries, the (i) _____ of nation-states must be (ii) _____ to international institutions.

A. sovereignty	D. subordinated
B. traditions	E. attributable
C. genealogy	F. analogous

3. The virtual absence of cougars from late prehistoric faunas in the North American Great Basin (i) _____ a general scarcity of carnivores from these sites: bobcats, coyotes, and badgers are routinely found, and even such historically (ii) _____ carnivores as bears and wolves are found as well.

A. largely parallels	D. widespread
B. does not reflect	E. rare
C. is a consequence of	F. representative

4. Since the 1920s, historical fiction writers in China have emancipated the genre from the traditional notion that (i) _____ was the ultimate goal of history writing. Yet the traditional commitment to (ii) _____ was not simply (iii) _____: this new genre was expected to capture the essence of historical truth even as it allowed space for the writer's imagination.

A. comprehensiveness	D. veracity	G. jettisoned
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B. factuality	E. thoroughness	H. rationalized
C. entertainment	F. pleasure	I. acknowledged

5. Jaime Javier Rodriguez notes that popular art forms often conceal a daunting complexity: frequently what appears _____ becomes intricate and challenging when closely examined.

- A. tedious
- B. canned
- C. convoluted
- D. vacuous
- E. tortuous
- F. formulaic

6. Many theorists believe that measures to prevent industrial pollution necessarily increase production costs, but several recent reports document innovations that _____ environmental harm while also delivering economic benefits. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. offset
- B. preclude
- C. disclose
- D. mitigate
- E. curtail
- F. divulge

7. A closer examination of the author's footnotes explains the datedness of his argument: he has ignored most of the recent work in the field, drawing instead mainly on research that is now decidedly _____.

- A. familiar
- B. germane
- C. obsolete
- D. relevant
- E. discredited
- F. outmoded

test 61 section 1 (medium)

1. By deliberately dripping paint on their canvases, expressionists affirmed that paint is not _____ entity, something merely to be moved where the artist please, but rather a material possessing a fluid energy that the painter attempts to control.

- A. an immutable
- B. an expressive
- C. a vital
- D. a passive
- E. a kinetic

2. Interest in creating handheld computers is fueled by the desire to shrink the size of the electronic circuitry and to create exceptionally small mechanical systems. At this scale, however, physical (i)_____ poses unique challenges. Machining, positioning, and assembling parts by hand are easy at macroscopic scales but at minute scales they are far from (ii)_____.

A. deterioration	D. subtle
B. manipulation	E. inflexible

C. durability	F. routine
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3. The journey to (i)_____, when it starts from a vantage as (ii)_____ as Dunsany's, is often as (iii)_____ as the path to glory. How did a writer of such talent and renown wind up nearly forgotten?

A. obscurity	D. eminent	G. unfathomable
B. normalcy	E. reactionary	H. cyclical
C. genius	F. egalitarian	I. mundane

4. The environmental threat posed by the New Zealand mud snail, an invasive species, is _____ by the snail's small size, which facilitates its spread across watersheds through human activity.

- A. initiated
- B. ameliorated
- C. exacerbated
- D. extenuated
- E. mitigated
- F. aggravated

5. Although the Kuiper Belt—the icy region of the solar system where Pluto orbits—was once much more crowded, today it has such a low density of objects that collisions between them are _____.

- A. inconsequential
- B. ongoing
- C. unthinkable
- D. improbable
- E. continuous
- F. unlikely

6. Williams finds the appearance of Whitman's Leaves of Grass in 1855 nearly _____ given the immense disparity between Whitman's earlier published works, which Williams finds dismal, and the consummate mastery of Leaves. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. oracular
- B. prophetic
- C. inevitable
- D. inexplicable
- E. inauspicious
- F. incomprehensible

7. Carr insists that the so-called information society might be more accurately described as the interruption society: it _____ attention, the scarcest of all resources, and stuffs the mind trivia.

- A. guards
- B. protects
- C. diverts
- D. destroys
- E. annihilates
- F. transcends

test 61 section 2 (hard)

1. It is often argued that psychoanalysis, which was _____ at that stage of the eighteenth century, provided the main filter by which death could be looked at, but it has now been largely replaced by

medicine, which provides both a mindset and practical measures by which death may be cheated, and in terminal illness, approached, formulating a process called medicalization.

- A. predominant
- B. pompous
- C. precarious
- D. elegant
- E. mundane

2. The introductions to each section, written by the editors of the anthology, provide useful background material, but they do not provide analysis of the articles. Because the articles are in many senses the editors' personal favorites, it is probably (i) _____ to expect more such criticism would be as (ii) _____ as the articles themselves.

A. juvenile	D. biased
B. paradoxical	E. complex
C. unrealistic	F. informative

3. Reviews written by music critic and composer Stephenson were hardly (i) _____ : musicians who performed his music could count on sympathetic coverage, while those who ignored him were held to (ii) _____ standards. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. disinterested	D. exacting
B. lucid	E. minimal
C. conventional	F. accepted

4. At least one otter species, the sea otter, has a large, often dominating, effect on the structure of its own habitat. There is no evidence that other species have ever exercised such (i) _____ effects. That lack of evidence could merely be because the other species have been studied less thoroughly. However, the size and density of the historic sea otter populations in many Pacific coastal regions (ii) _____ those of other otter species elsewhere, so perhaps the sea otter is indeed (iii) _____ in its effects on habitat.

A. ephemeral	D. vastly exceed	G. unique
B. unpredictable	E. have little effect on	H. destructive
C. significant	F. roughly parallel	I. transitory

5. Of all the singer's works, this album is the most dependent on the musical conventions of her day; it was both the least _____ of her albums and the most commercially successful.

- A. personal
- B. well-known
- C. experimental
- D. innovative
- E. acclaimed
- F. recognizable

6. The environmental advocacy group pushed for a single, overarching wetlands management plan that would _____ the existing efforts of various entities, resulting in a focused blueprint for saving the area's wetlands.

- A. combine
- B. meld
- C. undermine

- D. spearhead
- E. support
- F. subvert

7. Nature-loving pilgrims from the eastern United States altered the country's attitude toward California's sequoia groves, transforming those stands of great trees from scientific curiosities to places of _____.

- A. recreation
- B. mystery
- C. veneration
- D. solitude
- E. reverence
- F. acclamation

test 62 section 1 (medium)

1. She demonstrates a great extent of _____, as she has traveled to many more countries and places around the world than any of her kindred.

- A. perfidiousness
- B. peregrination
- C. jubilation
- D. sagaciousness
- E. conspicuousness

2. The laser has been widely utilized in many industries such as the packaging industry, CD player manufacturing, and all sorts of commonplace articles; however, the (i)_____ of the laser doesn't mean the laser can only be used in (ii)_____ ways. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. rare extermination	D. assorted
B. sporadic usage	E. pedestrian
C. everyday presence	F. pointless

3. For many years Cole experienced (i)_____ his professional circle. He was a (ii)_____ figure in the Middle East Studies Association of North America, editing for five years its flagship publication, and in 2004 he was even elected the association's incoming president. But because his research focused on highly (iii)_____ aspects of the eighteenth-and-nineteenth century Middle East, he was unlikely to achieve any sort of public acclaim.

A. obscurity within	D. leading	G. relevant
B. estrangement from	E. provocative	H. esoteric
C. anonymity outside	F. traditional	I. disputed

4. Established scientists recognize that peer review of manuscripts submitted to scientific journals is critical to science, but this recognition _____ a certain ambivalence in them, since reviewing takes time away from their research.

- A. obviates
- B. mitigates
- C. engenders
- D. tempers

- E. induces
- F. exacerbates

5. Despite _____ leaving their old jobs behind, workers were eager to move because there were to be no layoffs under the union contract at the new location.

- A. jubilation over
- B. indifference to
- C. misgivings about
- D. outrage over
- E. trepidation over
- F. enthusiasm for

6. After the Turkish Republic was established, traditional hamams (bathhouses) seemed to many Turks to be outmoded, but thanks to tourism, hamams have experienced a _____, becoming important cultural sites for foreign and Turkish visitors alike. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. proliferation
- B. retrenchment
- C. transformation
- D. revival
- E. slump
- F. renaissance

7. In spite of her fascination with chance, coincidence, and contingency, Stanning's novels are _____ constructed, written from the head rather than the heart.

- A. hastily
- B. extravagantly
- C. painstakingly
- D. meticulously
- E. evocatively
- F. impulsively

test 62 section 2 (medium)

1. People who are reluctant to oppose a court nominee straightforwardly on ideological grounds often search for any sort of peccadillo to serve as a _____ their opposition.

- A. mitigation of
- B. violation of
- C. predictor of
- D. reparation for
- E. pretext for

2. The strategists who created the European Unions practiced piecemeal social engineering. Recognizing that perfection is (i)_____, they set limited objectives and then mobilize the political will for a small step forward knowing full well that when they achieved it, its (ii)_____ would become apparent and necessitate further measures.

A. unattainable	D. potential
B. salubrious	E. inadequacy
C. bromidic	F. mutability

3. Britain's Queen Victoria, however (i)_____ she had been at the beginning of her reign, was politically much more (ii)_____ by the end of her time on the throne, as she resigned herself to the

emergence of an increasing powerful electorate that prevented her from stubbornly insisting on getting her own way in matters of state. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. naïve	D. powerful
B. personable	E. arbitrary
C. obdurate	F. malleable

4. At a recent conference on ancient DNA, one presentation opened with the claim that the field was now mature and could move ahead with confidence. This (i)_____ is (ii)_____, as demonstrated at the conference by the many presentations that notably lacked an adequate methodology for ensuring that DNA was uncontaminated by material that is more recent. In fact, ancient DNA research presents extreme technical difficulties, in part precisely because of the (iii)_____ of surviving DNA.

A. concern	D. infectious	G. corrupted nature
B. optimism	E. unfounded	H. straight forward
C. diffidence	F. unusual	I. copious amounts

5. Although traditionally artists have rightly been seen as the most _____ audience for the work of their colleagues, today taste is also created by critics and curators and occasionally by collectors.

- A. arbitrary
- B. volatile
- C. perceptive
- D. impulsive
- E. subjective
- F. discerning

6. Every serious attempt at a historical portrait of the past will subtly absorb the milieu and temperament of its living author, however _____ he or she sets out to be.

- A. entertaining
- B. comprehensive
- C. objective
- D. engaging
- E. rigorous
- F. impartial

7. Although we no longer have to rely on salt to keep food from spoiling, our appetite for it is _____: most people eat much more salt than they need.

- A. involuntary
- B. inconstant
- C. unabated
- D. unpredictable
- E. undiminished
- F. insatiable

test 63 section 1 (medium)

1. Although Emily Bronte is impassioned about gender equality, she is anything but ____ to endorse more privileges endowed to women. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. zealous

- B. apathetic
- C. abhorrent
- D. stubborn
- E. lethargic

2. Earlier discussions with neighboring countries (i)_____ due to the government's failure to alter policies that those countries find objectionable. Moreover, there is every reason to (ii)_____ the success of further talks, since the government if anything different, more intransigent.

A. commenced	D. doubt
B. advanced	E. undermine
C. foundered	F. anticipate

3. Anthony Kenny states that although his A New History of Western Philosophy is intended for undergraduates, he aimed to write it in a lighthearted manner that will give (i)_____ to those who read the history "not for curricular purposes but for their own enjoyment". His book is certainly enlightening, and although the bibliography includes technical works liable to (ii)_____ the newcomer, the work is written at a level that generally (iii)_____ between elementary and advanced.

A. solace	D. baffle	G. strikes a good balance
B. pleasure	E. initiate	H. makes fine distinctions
C. offense	F. suit	I. rejects the difference

4. Precipitation is not _____ in the Atacama Desert west of Andes mountains, and water scarcity is compounded by problems with water appropriation, the existence of agro pastoralists is in jeopardy.

- A. regular
- B. negligible
- C. evident
- D. consistent
- E. insignificant
- F. abundant

5. What differentiates this book from more traditional works on grammar is that it reserves its _____ not for students of writing, bur for teachers who harbor unduly restrictive views.

- A. mockery
- B. skepticism
- C. scolding
- D. approbation
- E. admonishment
- F. commendation

6. Like ants' propensity to congregate on one food pile and neglect another, the human tendency to make choices that _____ the observed behavior of others is a self-reinforcing process.

- A. imitate
- B. confirm
- C. avoid
- D. emulate
- E. inhibit
- F. constrain

7. The difficulty of reforming electoral politics is not lack of right tools but the need to put them into the hands of impartial agents: the goal should be to build capacity while _____ partisanship.
- A. expediting
B. constraining
C. facilitating
D. deterring
E. exacerbating
F. lamenting

test 63 section 2 (hard)

1. The chairman, faced with the need to forge a consensus on a number of proposals, acknowledged that it would be difficult to reconcile the push for a radical overhaul with the stance of those who want _____ change. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. deliberate
B. indiscriminate
C. genuine
D. immediate
E. wholesale

2. As cheaper imports drove most California potteries out of business during the 1950s, one company (i)_____. The substantial size and weight of the specialized products produced by Architectural Pottery helped (ii)_____ the company, because it was uneconomical for foreign companies to ship similarly large objects to California.

A. stagnated	D. transform
B. diversified	E. insulate
C. flourished	F. finance

3. Each new generation of students grow up (i)_____ the world of classical physics, with its mostly intuitive, billiard-ball causality; that is the everyday vantage from which we approach the alien world of quantum physics, which has for this reason never lost its air of (ii)_____.

A. immersed in	D. verisimilitude
B. disdainful of	E. objectivity
C. unmoved by	F. radicalism

4. Substantial atmosphere around planetary bodies acts as (i)_____ incoming objects. Smaller objects, particularly those that are lower in density and more fragile, (ii)_____ in the upper reaches of the atmosphere, whereas more intact, larger bodies may survive to impact the surface. Thus, relative to large craters, small craters are much less (iii)_____ on bodies with dense atmosphere, such as Earth, Venus, and Titan, than they are on Mercury and Moon.

A. effective obscurers of	D. vaporize	G. unusual
B. significant filters to	E. proliferate	H. persistent
C. impenetrable barriers against	F. agglomerate	I. common

5. When it comes to arriving at brilliant ideas, filtering out distractions might well be ____: if a person's mind is wandering, that person tends to outperform peers in a range of tasks in which flashes of insight are important.

- A. indispensable
- B. irrelevant
- C. overrated
- D. imperative
- E. deleterious
- F. counterproductive

6. Matsui is an extremely ____ political tactician, as she generally will withhold her support for a political faction or a policy until she is confident it will prevail.

- A. successful
- B. dogmatic
- C. shrewd
- D. flexible
- E. canny
- F. rigid

7. There is ample evidence that men and women think, express themselves, and even experience emotions differently, but in the area of sensory perception, psychologists are hard-pressed to identify major ____.

- A. difficulties
- B. innovations
- C. discrepancies
- D. challenges
- E. incongruities
- F. trends

test 64 section 1 (medium)

1. The stars' attitudes toward their glowing press are diametrically opposed: some think it ____ and others take the adulation seriously. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. flummery
- B. consequential
- C. fanatical
- D. coincidental
- E. sincere

2. Up to the 1970s, histories of science tended to be (i) ____ not least in their focus on discoveries and theories that could be read as anticipating later scientific orthodoxies, rather than on those deemed (ii) ____ in their own periods. Historians of science are now routinely far more sensitive on such scores.

A. anachronistic	D. major
B. convoluted	E. fallacious
C. undogmatic	F. inessential

3. An invasive creeping weed native to the Mediterranean region, *Cirsium arvense* has been present in Yellowstone National Park at least since the nineteenth century. Because of its extensive root system, the plant defies attempts to (i) ____ it by normal methods, and consequently, park

officials have (ii)_____ efforts to do so. Warming temperature have also (iii)_____ of the thistle's fortune.

A. control	D. largely abandoned	G. helped
B. study	E. recently reinitiated	H. undermined
C. nourish	F. increasingly promoted	I. illuminated

4. Robbins' accomplishment is not _____ one: her book makes the topic accessible to a general audience while still providing the sort of analysis that scholars demand.

- A. a trivial
- B. a fascinating
- C. a questionable
- D. an insignificant
- E. an intriguing
- F. an amusing

5. We should be more _____ than we often are when making claims about antiquity—for example, the common statement, "The ancient Athenians invented democracy," is simply not true when put like that. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. skeptical
- B. credulous
- C. precise
- D. trusting
- E. equivocal
- F. circumspect

6. The author advocates a diminished role for philosophy, aiming to show that many of the questions traditionally debated among philosophers can be _____ the realm of scientific inquiry.

- A. ceded to
- B. inferred from
- C. relevant to
- D. initiated by
- E. germane to
- F. left to

7. With regard to verity, neutrality, and transparency, nothing about the Internet makes it any different than Gutenberg's printing press, which could serve _____ just as well as truth.

- A. fantasy
- B. bureaucracy
- C. protocol
- D. disinformation
- E. mendacity
- F. panic

test 64 section 2 (hard)

1. Studies of hermaphroditic plants may exhibit sampling bias against self-fertilizing and cross-fertilizing species, thus inflating the frequency of species using a mixed mating system (both self-fertilizing and cross-fertilizing); nevertheless the number of mixed-system species is not _____. A. self-evident

- B. static
- C. trivial

- D. relevant
- E. calculable

2. A curiosity of the film *Vertigo* is its capacity to generate emotional power from a plot that lacks the most of elementary _____.: viewers are required to accept not an isolated implausibility, but a continuous stream of them. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. believability
- B. impact
- C. narrative
- D. tension
- E. premise

3. The students seeking undergraduate representation on the board of trustees viewed the impasse in their negotiations with the administration as (i)_____, since it promised to (ii)_____ the administration's belief that students should take no part in running the university.

A. unfortunate	D. undermine
B. inevitable	E. fuel
C. unprecedented	F. distort

4. Marie Tharp's mapping of the ocean floor, which was based on a mass of previously unanalyzed measurements of ocean depth, did not depend on (i)_____ but on (ii)_____: she (iii)_____ the sea floor's contours by marrying the voluminous but incomplete data with her knowledge of geology.

A. rote work	D. serendipity	G. inferred
B. analytical prowess	E. extrapolation	H. detected
C. empirical knowledge	F. collaboration	I. reconstituted

5. As astronomers do not yet have a good understanding of the fundamental nature of dark matter, it should not be a surprise that astronomy students' ideas about dark matter are, at best, _____.

- A. superficial
- B. sketchy
- C. inconsistent
- D. mistaken
- E. outdated
- F. far-fetched

6. Given that the department director was such a feeble contributor, sitting silently at important policy meetings and usually deferring to low-level aides, it was surprising that he had such a reputation for _____.

- A. magnanimity
- B. perspicacity
- C. impartiality
- D. detachment
- E. benevolence
- F. discernment

7. The book captures the _____ of several politicians who spoke publicly of old-time virtues in order to mask private vices.

- A. probity

- B. dissemblance
- C. opportunism
- D. rectitude
- E. ingenuousness
- F. duplicity

test 65 section 1 (hard)

1. The threat of litigation makes the art authentication industry _____ realm: connoisseurs refuse to communicate in writing and confidential agreements bind authenticators to silence.

- A. an opportunistic
- B. a clandestine
- C. a moralizing
- D. a xenophobic
- E. an anarchistic

2. It was fine to be (i) _____ in the old days when papers were still not losing readers and ad revenue was not tough to come by, but many editors today are uneasy about bludgeoning their readers with the inherently (ii) _____ work of cartoonists. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. comprehensive	D. unbalanced
B. opinionated	E. flawed
C. profligate	F. vacuous

3. The Golden Gates Bridge has been quite (i) _____ by most aesthetic and functional criteria. However, as a structure it has had some limitations. Shortly after it opened, its roadway proved to be (ii) _____ under certain wind conditions, so it was stiffened. The additional steel that provided that stiffening naturally added weight to the structure, and this made it (iii) _____ later to add a proposed rail system beneath the roadway.

A. inadequate	D. quite noisy	G. unnecessary
B. unusual	E. overly flexible	H. impossible
C. successful	F. dangerously windswept	I. feasible

4. Upon realizing that the indicators of a stressful situation can be extremely _____, the psychologist reconsidered her claim that a reliable way of reducing stress is to recognize stressful situations and then avoid them.

- A. acute
- B. exiguous
- C. persistent
- D. overstated
- E. tenuous
- F. unrelenting

5. For wily political press officers, the art of spin is not quite supplanting truth with lies, but instead it aspires to replace awkward complexity with catchy _____; successful spin creates the impression of unavoidable common sense.

- A. novelties
- B. slogans
- C. falsehoods

- D. duplicity
- E. simplicity
- F. intelligibility

6. British composer Benjamin Britten would seem to have _____ place in the cultural pantheon, yet, at the same time that place is still contested by some.

- A. an illustrious
- B. an assured
- C. a precarious
- D. a modest
- E. a settled
- F. a tenuous

7. Once the scientists began to research the matter, it didn't take them long to find out that life far beneath the ocean floor was not only possible, but _____.

- A. vulnerable
- B. prevalent
- C. conspicuous
- D. fragile
- E. extensive
- F. essential

test 65 section 2 (medium)

1. Some of the areas of research covered in the collection have already attracted substantial scholarly interest, while others are more _____, hence requiring pioneering effort to map the territory and suggest productive avenues of inquiry.

- A. intricate
- B. pristine
- C. parochial
- D. heterogeneous
- E. onerous

2. Some academic criticism of popular novels has been (i)_____ in character, being based on the assumption that the wider the appeal, the more (ii)_____ the novel. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. rigorous	D. undesirable
B. exculpatory	E. accomplished
C. elitist	F. comprehensible

3. Since he had demonstrated (i)_____ talent as an amateur, several of his acquaintances (ii)_____ a career on the stage, but he followed his parents' wishes, becoming an engineer.

A. an innocuous	D. aided him in pursuing
B. an unremarkable	E. badgered him to pursue
C. the requisite	F. swayed him into pursuing

4. The prime minister underestimates the fatigue that her continual (i)_____ induces, even among those who are largely (ii)_____ her aims. Constantly referring to the bold challenges and tremendous opportunities that she and the country face, the prime minister insists that she is

(iii)_____ the country, when most people would be grateful if she succeeded just in improving it a bit.

A. complaining	D. sympathetic to	G. deliberately analyzing
B. diffidence	E. confused by	H. radically transforming
C. overclaiming	F. troubled by	I. slowly fine-tuning

5. Compared with their parties, politicians are _____: they are considerably less enduring than the organizations in which they function. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. essential
- B. redundant
- C. crucial
- D. unreliable
- E. transitory
- F. temporary

6. The notion's _____ notwithstanding—it was first proposed by a Nobel Prize-winning physicist—it was neglected for many years until some unexpected observations led to its revival.

- A. pedigree
- B. antecedents
- C. precursors
- D. origin
- E. brilliance
- F. novelty

7. Psychologists have discovered that some of the most _____ advice on study habits is flat wrong, leading them to revise the guidelines they offer to students.

- A. popular
- B. hallowed
- C. respected
- D. unassailable
- E. effective
- F. beneficial

test 66 section 1 (easy)

1. The painter has emphasized the figure's erect posture by making it contrast so starkly with the _____ exhibited by trees of the windswept orchard in the background.

- A. strength
- B. list
- C. rigidity
- D. fruitfulness
- E. uprightness

2. In the past, the discussion of artificial light had been (i)_____. When electrification spread, the talk of artificial light became (ii)_____, perhaps because the material was more familiar. Distance lends enchantment.

A. engaging	D. nugatory
B. momentous	E. repetitious

C. dormant	F. dull
------------	---------

3. It is only recently that emotion has attracted any substantial scholar attention, with historians lagging behind anthropologists, sociologists, and philosophers in their willingness to (i) _____ emotion as subject worthy of scholarly attention. In the past, scholars viewed emotion as a natural and essential force that (ii) _____ analysis—a strictly private matter—and therefore (iii) _____ social life and the stuff of research.

A. recognize	D. enlivened	G. requisite for
B. overlook	E. defied	H. extraneous to
C. repudiate	F. sustained	I. synonymous with

4. Scenes of bustling streets full of well-dressed citizens going about their business _____ the growing hardship faced by all but the richest local residents.

- A. betoken
- B. signify
- C. contradict
- D. gainsay
- E. quell
- F. forestall

5. Though only nine years old, the dancer possesses _____ flexibility that suggests she may become a balletic superstar. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. an inchoate
- B. an unexceptional
- C. an ungainly
- D. a preternatural
- E. a prodigious
- F. an awkward

6. Upstream dam construction can be _____ aquatic fauna: the natural seasonal flow patterns to which the fauna had become adapted are altered and populations therefore fragmented.

- A. redundant for
- B. disorienting for
- C. inimical to
- D. derogatory to
- E. deleterious to
- F. superfluous for

7. Whereas there has been extensive sociological research into how globalization affects finance, religion, and population, comparable studies of globalization's impact on lawmaking and the practice of law have been _____.

- A. tedious
- B. scarce
- C. compromised
- D. tiresome
- E. nonexistent
- F. inadequate

test 66 section 2 (medium)

1. "RESIGNATION", an English word the French novelist Christian Oster would no doubt appreciate, presents an elegant paradox: in one sense, it indicated a bold step, a cleaving of oneself from an attachment grown onerous; in another, it's the height of _____, an acquiescence to fate.

- A. sham
- B. fissure
- C. desperation
- D. passivity
- E. maturity

2. The guilty-pleasure of the play lies in its invitation for us to identify with its characters—attractive, articulate young women and young men (i)_____ behavior that, from the outside, may look more than a little (ii)_____: though the actions are initially repugnant, we cannot help but share the point of the view of the characters committing them.

A. lament	D. trivial
B. execrate	E. altruistic
C. rationalize	F. monstrous

3. The research found that in assessing others, many people hold an unconscious view that competence and warmth are (i)_____: when they perceive a person to be highly capable, they infer that he or she must have a tendency to be (ii)_____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. equally important	D. ambitious
B. mutually reinforcing	E. unfeeling
C. inversely related	F. disingenuous

4. The art of letter writing is like the art of acting in that it is the impression of (i)_____ which usually makes a performance convincing. Great letter writers, like great actors, have a gift for (ii)_____, for the here and now, the depth of expression depending on its closeness to actual processes of thought. By these criteria Ellen Terry was a remarkable letter writer indeed: her letters invariably have an air of (iii)_____.

A. spontaneity	D. compassion	G. confidence
B. mastery	E. exaggeration	H. improvisation
C. sympathy	F. immediacy	I. sensitivity

5. The fact that most hypotheses turn out to be wrong does not mean that hypothesizing is _____. In fact, most hypotheses include useful ideas that survive to become part of the next model or scenario.

- A. futile
- B. reckless
- C. fruitless
- D. frustrating
- E. exasperating
- F. unnecessary

6. New Zealand's breakaway landmass proved _____ sanctuary for the tuatara, for the island lacked any terrestrial mammals that would dig up the tuatara's slowly maturing eggs or pick off adolescents before they had a chance to breed.

- A. a temporary

- B. an excellent
- C. an agreeable
- D. an endangered
- E. a complicated
- F. a difficult

7. Though he said nothing, James _____ his father's meaning; the boy was far from being so obtuse as everyone thought him to be. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. comprehended
- B. distorted
- C. respected
- D. fathomed
- E. underestimated
- F. misjudged

test 67 section 1 (easy)

1. He accused some people who _____ him of being by contrast supportive of another candidate, who shared a similar stance on most political issues.

- A. offended
- B. lauded
- C. excoriated
- D. promoted
- E. noticed

2. Just as large manufacturing companies with dominant positions in large domestic markets were once able to resist (i) _____ despite ample signs that foreign competition was rapidly overtaking them, strong and wealthy states can (ii) _____ and still manage to limp along for many years.

A. innovation	D. exploit vulnerable markets
B. temptation	E. dominate international affairs
C. inertia	F. maintain misguided policies

3. Despite the (i) _____ in negotiations apparently signaled by the recent agreement between the two neighboring countries, the countries remain (ii) _____ even about the import of that agreement. One wants to prolong agreed—to resumption of limited cross-border traffic, believing it can become entrenched as a new status quo. The other, by contrast, insists that the resumption is (iii) _____ and has been undertaken voluntarily and provisionally in order to show goodwill.

A. progress	D. unreconciled	G. requisite
B. stalemate	E. vague	H. temporary
C. setbacks	F. flexible	I. advantageous

4. The _____ of highly social species like rhesus monkeys—and like humans—is that their complex sociality is the reason for their success, but it's also the source of their greatest troubles.

- A. virtue
- B. irony
- C. delight
- D. paradox
- E. myth

F. joy

5. Since new movie stars seem to be cut from only a few bolts of the same bland cloth these days, it is _____ just to be in the presence, once again, of a true original.

- A. unremarkable
- B. reassuring
- C. routine
- D. invigorating
- E. overwhelming
- F. refreshing

6. Once the judge had been found guilty of corruption, it was not long before he found himself _____ his position. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. revolted by
- B. divested of
- C. stripped of
- D. recognized by
- E. enamored of
- F. absorbed by

7. Eschewing today's hovered-over kids as less plausible characters for an adventure story, Rebeca Stead set her new children's novel in nineteen-seventies New York to show children with a great deal of _____.

- A. autonomy
- B. independence
- C. resilience
- D. self-assurance
- E. sympathy
- F. sensitivity

test 67 section 2 (easy)

1. Common and easily accessible resources (prey for predators or hosts for parasites) should be, all other things being equal, used frequently, yet in some environments apparently accessible and suitable resources remain _____.

- A. vulnerable
- B. unobtainable
- C. sustainable
- D. depleted
- E. unexploited

2. Regardless of the putative decline of (i) _____ in contemporary culture, such (ii) _____ remains essential to civil discourse. It allows people to avoid embarrassing or maligning an adversary, and it serves as a form of irony that draws attention to a problem that can scarcely be exaggerated.

A. understatement	D. inventiveness
B. originality	E. objectivity
C. partisanship	F. restraint

3. In science education, it is important to differentiate between inaccurate ideas that are conceptually (i) _____ and understandings that are inaccurate, and yet can (ii) _____ learning of

more sophisticated understanding. The former are simply wrong, the latter can be seen as incomplete, overly simplistic, or tied to only a few limited contexts.

A. unproductive	D. foster
B. unproblematic	E. delay
C. distinct	F. resemble

4. One of the fundamental problems with learning mathematics is that while the number sense may be (i)_____, exact calculation requires cultural tools—symbols and algorithms—that are relatively new and must therefore be absorbed by areas of the brain designed for other purposes, which is easier when what we are learning (ii)_____ our built-in circuitry. With an understanding of it we can at least (iii)_____ our teaching methods by reflecting on the constraints it imposes.

A. innate	D. harmonizes with	G. preserve
B. modern	E. intrudes on	H. discard
C. complex	F. goes beyond	I. adapt

5. It is commonly said that each person's aesthetic taste is _____, yet that notion overlooks a large body of shared aesthetic preferences. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. unchangeable
- B. acquired
- C. distinct
- D. learned
- E. idiosyncratic
- F. inexplicable

6. Unlike the theatrical adaptation of Nicholas Nickleby, which attempted to _____ its source precisely, the adaption of Les Misérables chooses sweeping and hurtling motion over the savoring of minute details.

- A. gut
- B. digest
- C. render
- D. reproduce
- E. eviscerate
- F. relish

7. Our eating habits are rooted in our physiology, but they are also _____ the culture in which we grow up.

- A. symbolic of
- B. mediated by
- C. influenced by
- D. ascribed to
- E. inferable from
- F. universal in

test 68 section 1 (easy)

1. Even though the authors repeatedly _____ their own shrewdness, they show a remarkable credulousness toward far-fetched ideas such as carbon-eating trees and cloud-making machinery.

- A. soft-pedal

- B. extol
- C. deprecate
- D. broaden
- E. compromise

2. Shirky argues that the Internet (i) _____ the needs for hierarchical structures and the sluggish organizations that (ii) _____ them: the Internet makes it possible to do things cheaply and efficiently on one's own.

A. delineates	D. circumvent
B. obviates	E. perpetuate
C. redoubles	F. undervalue

3. Logically, one might assume that the nostalgia in which Guzman engages at times in his documentary about Chilean history would be (i) _____ critical reflection and thus leave the film intellectually flaccid. This conclusion would be (ii) _____, however, insofar as not all nostalgia necessarily results in a (iii) _____ of critical thought. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. a motive for	D. hasty	G. reappropriation
B. a marker of	E. dilatory	H. distillation
C. an impediment to	F. warranted	I. stagnation

4. Though Fine leavens her work with humor and playfulness, she can be _____ writer, mincing no words in her judgements of other scientists' work.

- A. an acerbic
- B. a provocative
- C. an ingratiating
- D. a demanding
- E. an obsequious
- F. a harsh

5. It is an ironic reversal that just those politicians who most vociferously _____ the distorting complexities of the country's tax system are now the ones embracing an agreement that worsens the mess.

- A. espoused
- B. disregarded
- C. lambasted
- D. eschewed
- E. derided
- F. ignored

6. There is very little _____ in culture: an art form or a practice (or a language or an institution) can become extinct in a generation if it does not evolve.

- A. inertia
- B. homogeneity
- C. symbiosis
- D. stasis
- E. cooperation
- F. waste

7. In spite of being one of the world's biggest _____ of fossil fuels, the firm has made some environmentally responsible investments.

- A. buyers
- B. purveyors
- C. disparagers
- D. exploiters
- E. suppliers
- F. maligners

test 68 section 2 (easy)

1. The piecrust was not punctured, so steam built up and the crust _____, bursting like a balloon, creating an over-cleaning project where hopes of dinner were expected.

- A. split
- B. warped
- C. distended
- D. shrunk
- E. caved in

2. Given the many thematic strands that the book seeks to draw together into a continuous cord of narrative, it is perforce work of _____, which is not to say that the author's research fails to provide sufficient detail about each of his chosen themes. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. synthesis
- B. conjecture
- C. analysis
- D. reconstruction
- E. accretion

3. Not only is the field of behavioral genetics strewn with (i)_____ findings, but even among those findings that managed to survive, many have turned out to be (ii)_____ a very restricted class of cases.

A. convergent	D. refuted by
B. disparate	E. germane to
C. repudiated	F. subordinate to

4. Sometimes the criteria that are used to categorize nation-states are purely factual: for example, the denotation of a state as a coastal state or an inland state. But most state labels have a predominantly (i)_____ character. Labels such as failed state or democratic state tend to be accepted only by those who (ii)_____ the assumptions that (iii)_____ such a marker.

A. pejorative	D. share	G. are necessarily distorted by
B. functional	E. flout	H. constitute the basis of
C. evaluative	F. transcend	I. rarely make reference to

5. The use of retail coupons is commonly touted as a consumer benefit, discounting the price on an item; however, if the coupon relates to an item that the consumer neither needs nor wants, the discount is _____.

- A. immaterial
- B. reduced
- C. diminished
- D. offset

- E. irrelevant
- F. unnecessary

6. During the fifteenth century, three aspects of the mathematical sciences were usually singled out as ____: their preparatory value for the study of philosophy, their practical advantage for the community, and their antiquity. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. estimated
- B. superlative
- C. inflated
- D. praiseworthy
- E. unique
- F. adventitious

7. Most of the drugs used to treat celiac disease that are now in development would not eliminate the need for a gluten-free diet but would help ____ symptoms when some gluten is unintentionally ingested.

- A. diagnose
- B. extirpate
- C. allay
- D. palliate
- E. ascertain
- F. undermine

test 69 section 1 (easy)

1. For many in the room, the idea of coming to the assistance of a rival was more than unpleasant: it was ____.

- A. unpropitious
- B. anomalous
- C. anathematic
- D. redundant
- E. meretricious

2. The prime minister's spokesman faces a difficult task in defending his boss from what he sees as the (i)_____ of a decidedly prejudiced press. To make his defense effectively he will certainly have to give specific examples of the media coverage he finds so (ii)_____.

A. overwrought panegyrics	D. objectionable
B. lowly calumnies	E. confusing
C. justified fulminations	F. unexciting

3. Appreciating that mathematical notation presents a major roadblock to many students, some well-meaning educators (i)_____ them by (ii)_____ the use of notation; but this is an unfortunate detour, since practice with notation (iii)_____ the important skill of reasoning.

A. enrich	D. mandating	G. compromises
B. discourage	E. accelerating	H. promotes
C. accommodate	F. minimizing	I. circumvents

4. It is true that science, and more particularly scientists, _____ cherished paradigms with great reluctance and that when they do, scientific revolutions may result. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. unify
- B. share
- C. cede
- D. embrace
- E. dismantle
- F. relinquish

5. Because the political situation seriously impeded international communication, French scientific research was at that time uncharacteristically _____.

- A. biased
- B. insular
- C. competitive
- D. misleading
- E. deceptive
- F. parochial

6. Other monarchs have been accused by posterity of murder and treason without having come to be regarded with such _____, perhaps because the cases against them have never been satisfactorily proved.

- A. equivocation
- B. opprobrium
- C. trepidation
- D. infamy
- E. levity
- F. ambivalence

7. Many macroscopic or higher-level properties on the basis of which we sort chemicals into types are not _____ the chemical structure itself but instead only manifest themselves under certain conditions or in particular contexts.

- A. inherent in
- B. intrinsic to
- C. equivalent to
- D. influenced by
- E. affected by
- F. separable from

test 69 section 2 (medium)

1. That Seiberg and Witten lack celebrity can be explained by the _____ nature of their pursuit: the mathematical exploration of four-dimensional space.

- A. pedestrian
- B. esoteric
- C. compelling
- D. global
- E. unequivocal

2. It remains a mystery how *Theobroma cacao*, which scholars believe originated in lowland Amazonia, was introduced to tropical Mesoamerica. It must have been a (i) _____ process: cacao trees do not easily sprout from seed, need years to mature, and grow only in humid lowland forest. Moreover, in a tropical climate, cacao pods spoil quickly, rendering their transport from lowland Amazonia to tropical Mesoamerica in a single journey by foot or canoe (ii) _____.

A. clandestine	D. unlikely
B. protracted	E. redundant
C. spontaneous	F. expeditious

3. To the avid reader of E.O. Wilson, much of his most recent book *Consilience: The Unity of Knowledge* will be (i)_____, as the book represents the culmination of a life spent thinking about everything from the social lives of ants to the social lives of people. Nonetheless, new thoughts have been mixed in with the old to produce a book remarkable for its (ii)_____ and ambition.

A. predictable	D. purview
B. discounted	E. overreaching
C. startling	F. contingency

4. Having an intense and long-standing culture of (i)_____, the company understandably has a reputation as the supreme corporate (ii)_____. But even by these standard, the degree of secrecy surrounding the company's most recent research is (iii)_____.

A. impropriety	D. anachronism	G. remarkable
B. progress	E. abomination	H. predictable
C. privacy	F. enigma	I. counterproductive

5. It is rare for a prominent member of the company to leave without some _____. Smith, who resigned with civility, is an exception. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. acrimony
- B. bitterness
- C. trepidation
- D. apprehension
- E. regret
- F. embarrassment

6. For literary critics and book reviewers, the notion of critical authority has become _____ in an age of quick, teeming Internet response, where all the old critical standards and parameters are in the process of being reinvented.

- A. fluid
- B. transparent
- C. obvious
- D. unstable
- E. justifiable
- F. defensible

7. Although initially it may be difficult to discern the essay's message of peace and conciliation, a close reading reveals its essentially _____ nature.

- A. pacific
- B. indolent
- C. banal
- D. lethargic
- E. austere
- F. dovish

test 70 section 1 (easy)

1. Many Latin American writers and critics have come to bristle at the very mention of the type of fiction termed "magic realism," but to the common reader the appeal of such fiction is _____.

- A. elusive
- B. undiminished
- C. unfathomable
- D. unexpected
- E. derivative

2. The professor frequently reiterated a basic assumption behind the experimental method---namely, that the outcome of the experiment is always (i)_____. The hypothesis can never assume the experiment's results, in other words, but instead must (ii)_____ their appearance.

A. undetermined	D. await
B. incontrovertible	E. signal
C. inconsequential	F. negate

3. When pulsars were first discovered, some of the astrophysicists involved briefly (i)_____ these types of stars might be (ii)_____ extraterrestrial intelligence. Specifically, the pulsar's periodic radiation pattern was initially interpreted as (iii)_____ rather than—as it turned out to be—the natural product of the spinning of a neutron star. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. ignored whether	D. suggestive of	G. a deliberate hoax
B. thought that	E. unrelated to	H. an episodic phenomenon
C. disavowed that	F. evidence against	I. a constructed code

4. While the band's music is loud and aggressive, it is never _____.

- A. simpleminded
- B. unsophisticated
- C. subdued
- D. restrained
- E. melodious
- F. disingenuous

5. There is a risk in _____ vagueness in speech: all kinds of distortions and lies can go unrecognized in the general haziness and so come off as facts.

- A. detecting
- B. sanctioning
- C. castigating
- D. countenancing
- E. discerning
- F. perpetuating

6. French's tone was reasonable, _____ almost, but the gaze she fixed on Backhouse over her reading spectacles had something of defiance in it.

- A. distracted
- B. preoccupied
- C. deferential
- D. apprehensive
- E. respectful

F. inquisitive

7. The book is impressively _____, drawing from multiple disciplines and perspectives, and resting on diverse and extensive archival sources, autobiographies, published collections of letter, and works of history.

- A. learned
- B. progressive
- C. comprehensive
- D. concise
- E. succinct
- F. erudite

test 70 section 2 (hard)

1. He defended the government's equivocations regarding the mysterious contrail as resulting not from _____ as critics say, but from a benightedness about its own doings that is almost inevitable, given the multitudinousness of its agencies. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. obtuseness
- B. mendacity
- C. abnegation
- D. guilelessness
- E. trenchancy

2. Hyana Kusiemko and her colleagues speculate that the (i)_____ support among low-income works for increases in the minimum wage is a form of last-place aversion: people who are in a marginally better position than the worst off seek to (ii)_____ to distinguish themselves from those in last place.

A. unwavering	D. disavow their willingness
B. vociferous	E. retain their ability
C. tepid	F. dissemble their need

3. Unlike the elected branches of the United States government, where making personal connection with citizens is (i)_____ and almost (ii)_____ political efficacy, the United States Supreme Court continues to maintain that its members should communicate with the public almost exclusively through formal opinions—and even then through ceremonial rituals that date back to the nineteenth century.

A. frowned upon	D. a requirement for
B. rampant	E. a detriment to
C. disregarded	F. an irrelevance to

4. Scientists suspect that the impact with which a bat lands is a function of (i)_____. Bats that roost on hard cave ceiling must land (ii)_____ to avoid injury. By contrast, since foliage is (iii)_____, a hard landing won't hurt, and might even give the bat time to make sure it has a good grip.

A. wind speed	D. quickly	G. plentiful
B. roosting location	E. softly	H. pliable
C. a bat's size	F. securely	I. seasonal

5. The latest publications predicting disastrous coastal erosion are likely to seem _____ to knowledgeable readers because variations on the same claims have been effectively refuted in the past few years.

- A. intriguing
- B. dubious
- C. baffling
- D. alarming
- E. unsettling
- F. suspect

6. Ursula Le Guin claims that looking at schoolbooks from around 1900 can be _____, given that the level of literacy and general cultural knowledge expected of a mere ten-year-old was, she notes, "rather awesome". 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. reassuring
- B. stimulating
- C. dreary
- D. tedious
- E. scary
- F. intimidating

7. Conchita evinced _____ the arts: her favorite activities included visiting museums, attending plays or concerts, and reading poetry aloud.

- A. a proclivity for
- B. a preoccupation with
- C. an indifference toward
- D. an optimism about
- E. an affinity for
- F. a detachment from

test 71 section 1 (easy)

1. Contrary to its reputation for intellectual _____, the 1950s was a decade exceptionally rich in works of trenchant and far-reaching social criticism.

- A. keenness
- B. inclusiveness
- C. complacency
- D. integrity
- E. productivity

2. In light of Elizabeth's habitually (i) _____ nature, her friends were quite surprised by her (ii) _____ at the convention.

A. ingenuous	D. garrulity
B. laconic	E. ostentatiousness
C. intractable	F. tenacity

3. Overall, fish farming may provide a (i) _____ wild fish stocks, but for certain species, the farmers cause a net loss of wild fish. Some fish farmers use upwards of five kilograms of wild fish as feed to grow one kilogram of carnivorous species like sea bass. Such (ii) _____ feed plus other environmental side effects undermine the expected (iii) _____ fish farming.

A. supplement to	D. appetite for	G. benefits of
B. rediscovery of	E. uncertainty regarding	H. impediments to
C. disruption of	F. optimism about	I. subtleties of

4. Computerized facial-recognition systems can be _____ by any number of factors, from the dirt caked on a camera lens to a hat pulled low over a subject's face. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. neutralized
- B. calibrated
- C. augmented
- D. ameliorated
- E. stymied
- F. confounded

5. Some social scientists who begin their studies of small communities with the intention of remaining detached revise their initial approach on discovering that personal involvement with subjects can actually _____ the gathering of important data.

- A. influence
- B. expedite
- C. facilitate
- D. circumvent
- E. affect
- F. intensify

6. Since their first appearance in the nineteenth century, commuter suburbs have been widely _____ in print as both a social disaster and an aesthetic desert.

- A. condemned
- B. identified
- C. discussed
- D. diagnosed
- E. welcomed
- F. embraced

7. In denying him a promotion, management cited his _____ decision making, charging that his judgements were based on vagaries rather than careful forethought.

- A. capricious
- B. dogmatic
- C. atrocious
- D. cavalier
- E. authoritative
- F. cogent

test 71 section 2 (medium)

1. The philosopher was a strong advocate of _____: he taught that happiness comes from forgoing one's desires.

- A. magnanimity
- B. duty
- C. abstinence
- D. pragmatism
- E. tolerance

2. After Betty found a qualified assistant to help her, the tasks that once seemed so (i) _____ became quite (ii) _____.

A. onerous	D. manageable
B. pleasant	E. challenging
C. trivial	F. unwieldy

3. In the new biography, Gonzalez doesn't (i) _____ the aspects of her subject that have drawn criticism but instead creates them with considerable (ii) _____: hardly a fact or assertion goes by her without being sourced in the endnotes. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. explain	D. sympathy
B. acknowledge	E. thoroughness
C. evade	F. ingenuity

4. At estimated 80 million adults in the United States use form of alternative medicine, from herbs and megavitamins to yoga and acupuncture. But while (i) _____ claims are made for these treatments, the scientific evidence for them often (ii) _____ studies and clinical trials, when they exist at all, can be (iii) _____ in design and too small to yield reliable insights.

A. unfounded	D. shows no inconsistencies with	G. shoddy
B. modest	E. lags far behind	H. clever
C. sweeping	F. holds great promise on	I. conventional

5. Berwick, middle-aged, soft-spoken, and _____, with a keen sense of how to use this apparent ordinariness to his advantage, began with a gripping story about how a firefighter saved himself during a forest fire by using a completely improbable tactic.

- A. imperturbable
- B. implacable
- C. unimaginative
- D. unprepossessing
- E. unremarkable
- F. unruffled

6. Investigating physiological _____ is not how biologists typically study function and structure, but it is not entirely unreasonable—if abnormalities in the lungs hinder breathing, then the lungs are very likely the organ required for breathing.

- A. deficiencies
- B. properties
- C. theories
- D. irregularities
- E. conjectures
- F. anomalies

7. Many great ghost stories remain _____ about the existence of their phantoms, whereas others leave no doubt about their ghosts' reality.

- A. ambiguous
- B. mute
- C. arch
- D. ominous
- E. positive

F. confident

test 72 section 1 (medium)

1. The architecture of the Shanghai Bund was for decades presented as an archetypal symbol of abhorrent Western influence, which may be one of the reasons that these grand buildings were _____ for so many years.

- A. imitated
- B. extolled
- C. commemorated
- D. disdained
- E. unnoticed

2. The governor is known for her unwillingness to (i)_____ policy decisions in the face of opponents typically, if she announces a specific policy and is confronted with objections from interest groups, she (ii)_____ the policy. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. adhere to	D. resumes
B. compromise on	E. appraises
C. disavow	F. abandons

3. The essential difference between writing nonfiction and fiction is that the artist can (i)_____ a completed vision of the world, while the journalist never can, the real world being always (ii)_____. Art provides freedom from the bewildering complexities of constant change. Indeed, it is the very (iii)_____ of well-wrought fiction that can sometimes make it feel more real than reality.

A. shun	D. diverting	G. popularity
B. correct	E. tragic	H. rarity
C. realize	F. unfinished	I. clarity

4. Although the courts have _____ an extremely flexible test for determining the admissibility of expert testimony, that does not mean that all experts will be allowed to testify.

- A. underwritten
- B. administered
- C. waived
- D. renounced
- E. endorsed
- F. rescinded

5. For more than 100 years, anarchism has been an embarrassing estranged sibling in the family of international radicalism, and its bad behavior had made it easy to _____ the awkward but important questions anarchism poses.

- A. exacerbate
- B. answer
- C. dismiss
- D. ignore
- E. aggravate
- F. embrace

6. Rosen argues that in the early years of the United States, individual states played important roles in the governance of American Indians, thereby _____ the common assumption that Indian policy was exclusively the federal government's domain. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. reinforcing
- B. belying
- C. adducing
- D. contradicting
- E. increasing
- F. demonstrating

7. Katherine's disobedient behavior earned her a _____ from her parent.

- A. eulogy
- B. rebuke
- C. panegyric
- D. mockery
- E. commendation
- F. agreement

test 72 section 2 (medium)

1. The wonder of Amy Chapman was her _____, her tenacious devotion to certain causes.

- A. subtle allure
- B. refractory willfulness
- C. obstinate self-regard
- D. brazen hubris
- E. staunch fealty

2. Far from (i)_____ the actions taken by the newspaper's executives, William praised the executive's resistance to corruption—yet he doubted that their policies were practical enough to warrant (ii)_____ by other papers.

A. lionizing	D. criticism
B. impugning	E. admiration
C. surveying	F. emulation

3. If you follow your intuition, you will more often than not err by misclassifying a random event as (i)_____. We are far too willing to (ii)_____ the belief that much of what we see in life is random.

A. uncharacteristic	D. countenance
B. systematic	E. reject
C. arbitrary	F. champion

4. Excitement is often considered anathema in science writing because it interjects the scientist's emotion and values into the work. Indeed, one should not be too quick to (i)_____ of science. At the same time, however, this (ii)_____ stance can occasionally be (iii)_____, cloaking more than it reveals.

A. evaluate the principles	D. unpopular	G. misleading
B. embrace the rhetoric	E. dispassionate	H. unnecessary

C. abandon the objectivity	F. inflexible	I. haphazard
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5. One can only bemoan how the wonderfully rich collections of genuine fossil specimens seen of yore in museum displays are being replaced by the _____ talking plastic of so-called virtual reality.

- A. ubiquitous
- B. exasperating
- C. estimable
- D. showy
- E. meretricious
- F. worthwhile

6. Potential readers may well be put off by the rather opaque quality of the prose in this book, which at times seems deliberately _____ the uninitiated reader.

- A. aimed at
- B. inclined toward
- C. inconvenient for
- D. tailored for
- E. inaccessible to
- F. insurmountable for

7. If aging is merely an avoidable by-product of life rather than a necessary progression, it is possible that we might eventually forestall _____.

- A. senescence
- B. dynamism
- C. decrepitude
- D. privation
- E. ennui
- F. voidness

test 73 section 1 (medium)

1. The author affects _____ in the tone of his novels that is quite at odds with his predilection for invective in his nonfiction publications. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. a tenacity
- B. a neutrality
- C. a pugnacity
- D. an effusiveness
- E. an irascibility

2. Trying to fix problems that affect vast numbers of people has an intuitive appeal that politicians and policymakers find (i)_____, but several warehouses of research studies show that intuition is often a poor guide to fixing (ii)_____ problems.

A. logical	D. localized
B. irresistible	E. systemic
C. off-putting	F. theoretical

3. Give a computer (i)_____ task—winning at chess, say, or predicting the weather—and the machine bests humans nearly every time. Yet when problems are (ii)_____, or require combining varied sources, computers are (iii)_____ human intelligence.

A. a well-defined	D. nuanced	G. no match for
B. a random	E. inconsequential	H. unyielding to
C. an open-ended	F. solvable	I. able to dwarf

4. The idea that Jim was _____, that he loved fighting for the sake of fighting, was a mistake, in reality he was a kind and gentle person. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. truculent
- B. audacious
- C. brazen
- D. obtuse
- E. pugnacious
- F. sapiential

5. Meera Mukherjee observed that while the work of the artisan has its well-defined contours, the artist is without palpable _____: like an explorer, the artist continually faces new regions of experience.

- A. opportunities
- B. rewards
- C. bounds
- D. risks
- E. limits
- F. hazards

6. The panel's failure to acknowledge the microbiologist as important in her field cannot be _____ a lack of accomplishment on her part, since her status as an important contributor to biology has been indisputably established.

- A. attributed to
- B. tantamount to
- C. related to
- D. explained by
- E. obviated by
- F. averted by

7. In 1839, working-class revolutions have been a real possibility in the industrialized countries of western Europe, but because revolutionary groups were poorly organized and led, government and employers regarded the movements with understandable _____.

- A. distaste
- B. placidity
- C. concern
- D. complacency
- E. foreboding
- F. solicitude

test 73 section 2 (medium)

1. The combination of Isabella Beeton's short life and the _____ of evidence for some parts of her story means that at times her biography, Kathryn Hughes, is forced to fill out her narrative with background information.

- A. reliability
- B. plethora
- C. relevance
- D. paucity
- E. transparency

2. This book, a more (i)_____ version of a highly technical report, is designed for the layperson, yet it is nothing if not (ii)_____ : it grapples with very complex questions about the world economy.

A. accessible	D. ambitious
B. professional	E. popular
C. formidable	F. persuasive

3. Even though the idea that medical research should be rigorously objective is (i)_____ one in the medical community, the editors of medical journals often display a disquieting (ii)_____ when it comes to articles submitted by researchers who accept money from the makers of the products they evaluate in their research; editors rarely ask whether that research is truly disinterested.

A. a neglected	D. capriciousness
B. an uncontroversial	E. credulity
C. an unproductive	F. stringency

4. With the grand ambition of sending unbreakable coded messages, some physicists are using exotic tools—quantum mechanics and streams of individual photons—to shut out (i)_____. But a wire and a few resistors may (ii)_____ a message as securely, according to a physicist who claims to have devised a simple and uncrackable scheme. The idea shows that more (iii)_____ methods might compete with budding quantum cryptography. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. inaccurate transmissions	D. convey	G. mundane
B. pernicious influences	E. decode	H. complex
C. prying eyes	F. intercept	I. celebrated

5. Many innovative breakthroughs come about when people venture beyond their own areas of expertise, because often it takes an outsider to ask the naïve questions that may yield _____ solution.

- A. a constructive
- B. an unconventional
- C. an amicable
- D. an agreeable
- E. a practical
- F. an original

6. In a major _____ for bat populations in the United States, on average 90 percent of the hibernating bats in four important caves and mines in New York died in the space of one year.

- A. achievement
- B. reversal
- C. venture
- D. calamity
- E. undertaking
- F. disaster

7. Human and animal shyness are not ____: in humans, shyness refers to an individual's awkwardness and apprehension in social situations, a different meaning than that used for animals.

- A. prevalent
- B. comparable
- C. useful
- D. disadvantageous
- E. detrimental
- F. analogous

test 74 section 1 (medium)

1. For the ancient Egyptians, inequality in human society was not ____ nature; in other words, existing differences—between rich and poor, strong and weak—were not viewed as a necessary part of the natural order of things. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. superseded by
- B. detectable in
- C. ameliorated by
- D. inherent in
- E. excluded from

2. Making the shift to the 90-nanometer manufacturing process has been (i) ____ for semiconductor companies. This process effectively doubles the manufacturing capacity of the industry, but it (ii) ____ enormous technical challenges because some components of the new semiconductor chips are no more than five to seven molecule thick.

A. an unanticipated boon	D. circumvents
B. a routine accomplishment	E. entails
C. a significant struggle	F. resolves

3. It is plausible to regard a collection of letters spanning youth and old age as (i) ____ of autobiography: the precession of characters who inhabit a life and a chronology of incidents turn up reliably in either form. Yet autobiography, even when ostensibly steeped in candor, tends toward (ii) ____ through later perspectives, afterwords, and second thoughts, whereas letters have an undeniable (iii) ____, offering select glimpses of the fraught and living moment.

A. an approximation	D. concision	G. sensitivity
B. a precursor	E. reconsideration	H. immediacy
C. the antithesis	F. sensationalism	I. formality

4. Spiderwebs suspended on flexible supports ____ even in low airflow in patterns that are erratic, enhancing the probability of insect capture over a volume of space.

- A. stretch
- B. waver
- C. contract
- D. shrink
- E. oscillate
- F. attenuate

5. Enlightened thinkers in late-eighteenth-century Europe broadly endorsed the concept of progress, yet theories of progress were usually _____ a strong streak of pessimism, a sense of the challenges inherent in the human condition.

- A. rooted in
- B. requisite for
- C. essential for
- D. contradicted by
- E. tempered by
- F. moderated by

6. We hold our breath so naturally and casually that it may come as a surprise to learn that the full details of this ability still _____ scientists.

- A. impress
- B. mollify
- C. elude
- D. placate
- E. divide
- F. puzzle

7. The work is alive and heterodox, the kind of ambitious failure that is more _____ than many finely crafted critical successes.

- A. compelling
- B. interesting
- C. innovative
- D. lauded
- E. inspired
- F. celebrated

test 74 section 2 (medium)

1. It was quite _____ for Sir Isaac Newton to believe in alchemy—most of the experimental scientists of his era did. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. unethical
- B. brave
- C. pretentious
- D. reasonable
- E. controversial

2. Some minor misgivings about the book notwithstanding, the editor's claim that the work will be recognized as "the authoritative history of sports for this era" is thoroughly _____.

- A. absurd
- B. undemonstrated
- C. credible
- D. outlandish
- E. researched

3. In a sharp blow to his reputation as (i) _____ leader, the evidence that the mayor has recently been involved in malfeasance seems to be (ii) _____.

A. a partisan	D. fabricated
B. an unsuccessful	E. sound
C. an exemplary	F. dubious

4. The nature of our recollection is (i) _____. One memory can seem (ii) _____ whereas another must be coaxed out of our brain little by little. Although a moment that excites our emotions is more likely to be recorded than a (iii) _____ experience, the sensory qualities of an event also play a part in how vividly and accurately we remember it. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. inaccurate	D. vague and spotty	G. riveting
B. inconsistent	E. immediate and colorful	H. traumatic
C. insignificant	F. unreliable and elusive	I. routine

5. In the face of competition from the Internet, television's beleaguered leaders should take heart: disruptive technologies nearly always _____ new ways to profit, sometimes even for the incumbent players whose business model is being upended.

- A. obviate
- B. clarify
- C. preclude
- D. beget
- E. create
- F. imitate

6. Prior to fermentation, cacao seeds are not _____.: they begin as something like apple pits and need fermentation to develop the chocolate taste.

- A. marketable
- B. palatable
- C. recognizable
- D. appetizing
- E. nourishing
- F. nutritious

7. The arrival of the manual describing procedures for adding content to the Web site may mark a new, more _____ phase in the site's history, and some contributors will no doubt become nostalgic for the unpredictable do-it-yourself days.

- A. fickle
- B. reticent
- C. indecisive
- D. sober
- E. prescribed
- F. staid

test 75 section 1 (easy)

1. In the 1630s, directors of the Dutch West India Company received reports of minor problems from their agents with _____, as the company was wealthy enough not to be overly concerned about small frustrations.

- A. trepidation
- B. consternation
- C. gratitude
- D. equanimity
- E. exhilaration

2. As climate change alters ecosystems, the winners are going to be the (i)_____ foragers, likes grizzlies that eat everything from ants to moose, and the losers are going to be those species that are too (ii)_____ to adjust.

A. adaptive	D. specialized
B. persistent	E. hierarchical
C. anomalous	F. voracious

3. Dirac may have (i)_____ the company of other theoretical physicals, but he often (ii)_____, rarely (iii)_____ group discussions and almost never collaborating with others in his own work.

A. appreciated	D. kept them at a distance	G. cutting off
B. analyzed	E. welcomed their company	H. contributing to
C. spurned	F. pondered their insights	I. shrinking from

4. Madame Germaine de Stael, famous for her opinionated views, sometimes made enemies with her _____ comments. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. caustic
- B. acerbic
- C. eccentric
- D. laudatory
- E. placatory
- F. conciliatory

5. Many people perceive an unearned grandiosity at work in the news business and given that perception, it should be no surprise that they have such a strong _____ for the business.

- A. preference
- B. passion
- C. esteem
- D. disdain
- E. fervor
- F. contempt

6. The archives of the museum, containing a plethora of documents that shed light on Picasso's work, may, for a time, give us the illusion of total comprehension, but in the end it seems that Picasso is no more _____ than he ever was.

- A. orthodox
- B. abstract
- C. prolific
- D. understandable
- E. transparent
- F. conceptual

7. Although streams of solar particles cause beautiful auroras —the northern and southern lights— sometimes their consequences are less _____: their electromagnetic effects, for instance, can overload power grids and damage orbiting satellites.

- A. spectacular
- B. significant
- C. benign
- D. consequential
- E. innocuous
- F. palpable

test 75 section 2 (medium)

1. While the current coffee craze was sparked by the emergence of flavorful, high-quality gourmet varieties, a slew of studies suggesting that concerns about coffee's health effects may be _____ has nurtured the trend. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. underemphasized
- B. exacerbated
- C. unfounded
- D. documented
- E. recapitulated

2. While the philosopher was known for valuing (i) _____ in the classroom, she was also, by contrast, a scrupulous and patient reviser, who (ii) _____ her lectures for print.

A. predictability	D. superficially proofread
B. spontaneity	E. haphazardly adapted
C. correctness	F. laboriously reworked

3. Catherine the Great comes across in her memoirs as (i) _____ ruler with a razor-sharp intellect, letting nothing stand in the way of her ambitions. In short, the impression the memoirs give is entirely in accord with her reputation for being (ii) _____.

A. an oblivious	D. ambivalent
B. an uncompromising	E. benevolent
C. a moralistic	F. formidable

4. The cowbird can seem a rather comical creature with a slow, awkward walk and often upraised tail. Less (i) _____ is the cowbirds' habit of laying their eggs in the nests of other birds. The (ii) _____ nesters will usually accept the cowbird egg and raise the baby cowbird as their own. Unfortunately, cowbird eggs hatch sooner than the eggs of other species and the young cowbirds (iii) _____, using their size to their advantage in getting more food from the parents.

A. amusing	D. feckless	G. grow quickly
B. painful	E. resistant	H. leave the nest
C. galling	F. unwitting	I. share their food

5. The economist noted that the occupations she analyzed in her study, which included waitresses, flight attendants, clerical workers, and domestic workers, _____ categorization: none can be captured by a single distinguishing characteristic.

- A. mask
- B. obviate
- C. invite
- D. confound
- E. resist
- F. encourage

6. On stage, jazz artist James Carter often veers dangerously close to the ____ : he becomes a man possessed, his tenor saxophone wailing and whimpering with a musicality so muscular it threatens to consume him.

- A. lugubrious
- B. doleful
- C. intemperate
- D. excessive
- E. idiosyncratic
- F. sublime

7. Wheelan proceeds from the assumption that statistics are ____ and, consequently, can be taught with minimal intimidation through examples.

- A. intuitive
- B. essential
- C. habitual
- D. instinctive
- E. indispensable
- F. straightforward

test 76 section 1 (easy)

1. Even months after massive storm, there remained a heavy, suspended sediment load in the surface water overlying the coral reef, the ____ water a testament to the storm's effects.

- A. turbid
- B. stagnant
- C. fathomless
- D. turbulent
- E. brackish

2. The prosecutor belied his hard-boiled reputation by submitting (i) ____ queries to the witness and accepting in turn (ii) ____ responses.

A. innocuous	D. evasive
B. quizzical	E. elaborate
C. impertinent	F. informative

3. The scientist (i) ____ that the now familiar term "global warming" is (ii) ____, arguing that the atmospheric buildup of long-lived greenhouse gases is setting in motion centuries of shifts in climate patterns, coastlines, water resources, and ecosystems—hardly (iii) ____ one would describe with a gentle word like "warming". 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. denied	D. an exaggeration	G. a transformation
B. complained	E. a cliché	H. an enigma
C. doubted	F. a misnomer	I. a signal

4. Nicolaus Copernicus was much less ____ than commonly thought: he wanted to improve the cosmological theory of his day by introducing one important change while preserving as many of its conceptual foundations as possible.

- A. visionary
- B. philosophical

- C. revolutionary
- D. iconoclastic
- E. diplomatic
- F. circumspect

5. Conditions at the training camp for runners were ____; few of the runners had proper shoes or a training kit. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. unpleasant
- B. tedious
- C. spartan
- D. austere
- E. rigorous
- F. monotonous

6. The differences between theater and film are never more ____ than with Shakespeare's plays, since Shakespeare wrote for an audience that liked to listen and films are made for people who primarily like to watch.

- A. pervasive
- B. patent
- C. evident
- D. suspect
- E. trivial
- F. inconsequential

7. One of the greatest hoaxes in the history of science was perpetrated by the Indian paleontologist Dr. Chandra Gupta, who fabricated entirely ____ for fossils throughout his career.

- A. counterfeit
- B. feckless
- C. refractory
- D. plausible
- E. circumstantial
- F. spurious

test 76 section 2 (medium)

1. Later in the book, the author takes pains to ____ the claims she had made earlier, as though she recognizes their implausibility and wants to quell skepticism by narrowing their scope.

- A. qualify
- B. apply
- C. reiterate
- D. verify
- E. jettison

2. Proffering one increasingly improbable scene character after another, (i) ____ by the constraint of realism, the novel revels in this (ii) ____ by ever more brazenly defying its readers' presumed expectations.

A. untrammelled	D. exiguity
B. liberated	E. ponderousness
C. confined	F. implausibility

3. Far from (i) _____ corporate influence on the academy, Taylor would like to see more of it; he is particularly (ii) _____ the idea of universities partnering with for-profit companies to sell online courses.

A. decrying	D. enamored of
B. presuming	E. judicious about
C. investigating	F. unnerved by

4. The longer the migratory route, the more fat migrating birds must accumulate as fuel for their flight. The gain in body mass would make birds obese by human standards, and should render them unable to fly, but this gain is (i) _____ premigratory (ii) _____ of digestive organs, inactive during migration, and by the (iii) _____ of the muscles that power the flight.

A. partially offset by	D. shrinking	G. strengthening
B. strongly suggestive of	E. specialization	H. attenuation
C. seemingly unrelated to	F. capacity	I. responsiveness

5. A _____ wit, Noel Coward could elicit laughs in a variety of ways—through his musical compositions, theater plays, and numerous acting roles.

- A. somber
- B. besotted
- C. secular
- D. versatile
- E. uniform
- F. protean

6. Some of the characters and themes depicted on the painted glass vessels found at Begram point toward an Egyptian provenance, but Egypt was not the _____ and perhaps not even the principal, place of manufacture. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. main
- B. leading
- C. sole
- D. likeliest
- E. original
- F. exclusive

7. A strong basic science program can be _____: the rate of return on capital invested in basic science is about three times that of capital invested in applied research and development.

- A. idealistic
- B. remunerative
- C. lucrative
- D. transcendent
- E. feasible
- F. radical

test 77 section 1 (medium)

1. By cosmic standards, Earth and its fellow terrestrial planets are chemical _____: they consist of primarily four elements (iron, magnesium, silicon, and oxygen) that are rare elsewhere in the universe.

- A. prototypes
- B. mavericks
- C. malefactors
- D. paragons
- E. old-timers

2. The shift from extraction to cultivation in forestry involves transforming the production of trees into a source of industrial productivity, leading to a greater degree of (i)_____ between biophysical nature on the one hand and industry on the other. In the process, nature is increasingly (ii)_____ industry and science. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. separation	D. excluded from
B. antagonism	E. appropriated by
C. entanglement	F. superfluous to

3. Since the 1920s, historical fiction writers in China have emancipated the genre from the traditional notion that (i)_____ was the ultimate goal of history writing. Yet the traditional commitment to (ii)_____ was not simply (iii)_____ : this new genre was expected to capture the essence of historical truth even as it allowed space for the writer's imagination.

A. comprehensiveness	D. veracity	G. jettisoned
B. factuality	E. thoroughness	H. rationalized
C. entertainment	F. pleasure	I. acknowledged

4. The developmental track for human beings-from rudimentary awareness to complex forms of rational agency-is quite _____ development proceeds with even minimally good physical and psychological health in any minimally favorable environment.

- A. sophisticated
- B. contingent
- C. robust
- D. situational
- E. elusive
- F. reliable

5. Despite the implications of their noble status, many aristocrats were virtually penniless and lived in a state of _____.

- A. indigence
- B. opulence
- C. eminence
- D. penury
- E. depravity
- F. complacency

6. The 1966 Mexican art exhibition "Confrontation 66" seemed to define the Mexican art world as one in which political alignment was _____, yet painter Joy Laville rose to prominence with paintings devoid of contentiousness.

- A. inconsequential
- B. ineluctable
- C. requisite
- D. perilous
- E. pointless
- F. obsolete

7. Although both salinization and alkalinization impact water quality, they have generally been treated as _____ phenomena; however, new research proves that the processes, which impact most of the drainage area of the United States, are in fact closely linked.

- A. unrelated
- B. insignificant
- C. unimportant
- D. reversible
- E. separate
- F. incremental

test 77 section 2 (medium)

1. Because of the newspaper's _____ joint bylines, lots of reporters were compelled to do anonymous work on stories credited to other people.

- A. toleration of
- B. aversion to
- C. instigation of
- D. endorsement of
- E. leniency toward

2. Though she had some exposure to great art and high culture, it must be said the ultra athletic Marion Carstairs remained throughout her life primarily (i) _____ mental and artistic pursuits. She was by nature (ii) _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. a product of	D. neither bookish nor cerebral
B. indifferent to	E. a model of delicacy and refinement
C. obsessed with	F. both didactic and argumentative

3. At the heart of present-day studies computational authorship attribution lies the hypothesis that each author has so personal a writing style that it can function as stylistic DNA. Any given author style, in other words, is regarded as (i) _____ and (ii) _____ every other authors writing style.

A. stable	D. distinguishable from
B. generative	E. related to
C. unintentional	F. influenced by

4. The amount of water flowing through United States streams has (i) _____ during this century, although without giving rise to more frequent floods, according to a new study by the United States Geological Survey. The country appears to be getting (ii) _____ even as its stream flow becomes less (iii) _____.

A. markedly declined	D. wetter	G. benign
B. steadily increased	E. hotter	H. predictable
C. slowly stabilized	F. drier	I. destructive

5. In owls with a facial disk, the ears are hidden behind it and are _____ placed: having one higher than the other allows the birds to locate prey both horizontally and vertically for more accurate detection.

- A. advantageously
- B. asymmetrically
- C. unevenly
- D. unobtrusively
- E. discreetly
- F. precisely

6. Family photos of the author suggest that she was _____ child: she seemed to wear a permanent frown.

- A. a sullen
- B. an amiable
- C. a surly
- D. a beautiful
- E. a prudent
- F. a stunning

7. Restoring the old practice of producing fish in rice fields does not just make environmental and economic sense; it has the added advantage that it _____ benefits the very poor.

- A. abnormally
- B. predominantly
- C. eminently
- D. moderately
- E. particularly
- F. unnaturally

test 78 section 1 (medium)

1. Although most of the lakes have merged, salinity levels are not _____ throughout the lake systems: an upward-trending salinity gradient extends southeast from Pelican Lake to East Stump Lake, a distance of nearly 80 kilometers. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. known
- B. equable
- C. rising
- D. problematic
- E. unprecedented

2. Here was one of the main (i) _____ of oceanography during the first two decades after the Second World War. Support for oceanographic research was based on its utility for making war on other nation. Yet at the same time, oceanography retained an identity that tied it closely to (ii) _____.

A. fallacies	D. international cooperation
B. paradoxes	E. military secrecy
C. assumptions	F. naval strategy

3. There is (i) _____ evidence that the giant African land snail *a. fulica* is a serious threat to the spread of human disease. Giant snails do carry rat lungworm—infection by which is a common cause of meningitis—but so do many other snail species. Moreover, if the threat posed by *a. fulica* were (ii) _____, one would expect to see an increase in disease rates (iii) _____ a rise in the spread of snails. However, in places like New Caledonia, explosions in giant snail populations have coincided with a fall in the number of meningitis cases.

A. abundant	D. contained	G. corresponding to
B. ambiguous	E. recognized	H. predating
C. little	F. major	I. giving way to

4. The decision to rely on mechanical biological treatment to process the two million tons of waste that the region produces annually was _____ to experts, who had long been aware that this approach had several shortcomings.

- A. alarming
- B. infuriating
- C. perplexing
- D. humiliating
- E. baffling
- F. surprising

5. Although some literary scholars may express disdain for words meant for popular audiences, only the most _____ proponent of so-called great literature could dismiss the works in a recent anthology of African science fiction as formulaic pulp. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. radical
- B. pedantic
- C. oblivious
- D. hidebound
- E. illiberal
- F. charitable

6. Biologists agree that snakes descended from lizards, but exactly where this first happened has been a matter of debate since the 1800s, when two _____ theories emerged.

- A. complex
- B. competing
- C. dubious
- D. conclusive
- E. contending
- F. irrefutable

7. The early stages of being trained to ride a motorcycle are all about developing muscle memory, repeating combinations of hand-foot movements until they are _____ and precise.

- A. aberrant
- B. innate
- C. reflexive
- D. inborn
- E. automatic
- F. calculated

test 78 section 2 (easy)

1. The novel presents him as a man who monitors his state of mind and emotions as though he were doing so _____, taking and thinking about himself as if he were someone else.

- A. guiltily
- B. instinctively
- C. furtively
- D. heedlessly
- E. externally

2. The professor's tendency to commandeer faculty meetings to promote her personal agenda quickly inspired resentment among other faculty, who objected to such _____.
 A. appropriation
 B. obfuscation
 C. caviling
 D. vacillation
 E. cronyism

3. Ancient cart ruts found on Malta were created in soft limestone that begins to dissolve when exposed to rainfall. Their forms thus necessarily become (i) _____ over time and their original features are (ii) _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. solidified	D. refined
B. degraded	E. replicated
C. conspicuous	F. obscured

4. There is no sense trying to rehabilitate the reputation of the mosquito; nobody loves such a creature. But it's (i) _____ to (ii) _____ all 2,600 described species of mosquito when it's just 80 or so—3 percent that drink human blood. Among those 2,520 relatively (iii) _____ kinds of mosquitoes, there's even one we'd like to see in greater numbers: Taxorhynchites, the mosquito that eats other mosquitoes.

A. rare	D. malign	G. blameless
B. necessary	E. represent	H. pernicious
C. unfair	F. commend	I. valuable

5. Although collisions between the largest planetesimals in a planetesimal belt are _____, they can release large amounts of debris when they occur.

- A. risky
- B. exceptional
- C. irregular
- D. violent
- E. rare
- F. powerful

6. Because it has usually been impossible to eradicate exotic species once they have become established, it is _____ to minimize introductions of species that have substantial probabilities of unwanted impacts.

- A. prudent
- B. customary
- C. provident
- D. superfluous
- E. essential
- F. pointless

7. In the Old Southwest, only writers who showed exceptional _____ were likely to become widely known, because the region's weak infrastructure inhibited the development of publishing beyond local newspapers that served small towns.

- A. prescience
- B. foresightedness
- C. optimism
- D. resolve

- E. patience
- F. determination

test 79 section 1 (medium)

1. The assumption that children learn about science primarily in the classroom is so _____ that few scientists, educators or policymakers question it, despite an ever-growing body of evidence demonstrating that most science is learnt outside of school.

- A. tenuous
- B. subtle
- C. irrefutable
- D. pervasive
- E. misconstrued

2. Psychologists note that in making purchase decisions, consumers often unconsciously use mental shortcuts, such as familiarity with a brand name to (i)_____ routine problems efficiently. Thus, part of what companies aim for developing a brand is very specifically to (ii)_____ consumers' conscious thought. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. identify	D. amplify
B. resolve	E. ascertain
C. postpone	F. circumvent

3. This book cannot be evaluated properly without examining the author's choice of format, which is the (i)_____ of the format of standard academic works; here the photographs take center stage, with the text playing only a supporting role. This layout poses many dangers for the serious historian, not the least of which being the (ii)_____ reception that academics—motivated partly by (iii)_____ but also by genuine concern over scholarly standards—generally reserve for books apparently aimed at the popular market.

A. duplicate	D. scornful	G. academic integrity
B. epitome	E. deferential	H. snobbish elitism
C. inverse	F. good-natured	I. collegial sympathy

4. The adipose tissue in which our bodies store fat from the food we eat has traditionally been thought of as _____, but in reality this tissue constitutes a dynamic organ, not a mere repository.

- A. capacious
- B. deleterious
- C. inert
- D. detrimental
- E. passive
- F. Inessential

5. The sound of disembodied human breathing in Miyazaki's films is at once a presence, close to the listener's ear, and a ghostly absence due to its lack of a visual _____.

- A. image
- B. counterpart
- C. urgency
- D. correlative
- E. cue

F. background

6. The problem a generation ago was not the new art itself but the heightened intensity of conviction surrounding it, which is thankfully absent in our wonderfully _____ times.

- A. fervid
- B. impassioned
- C. undogmatic
- D. receptive
- E. nostalgic
- F. optimistic

7. He found his new acquaintance to be _____: trying to understand her personality was like peering into an unknown dimension. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. vacuous
- B. unflappable
- C. unfathomable
- D. obdurate
- E. inscrutable
- F. imperturbable

test 79 section 2 (easy)

1. A significant element of the Gothic genre, the literary grotesque is sometimes inaccurately discussed as if it were a Gothic or, conversely, as if it were something entirely different from Gothic.

- A. synonym for
- B. characteristic of
- C. counterweight to
- D. ramification of
- E. deviation from

2. Journalist Michael Pollan is nothing if not (i)_____, committed to investigating our eating habits through (ii)_____ and unwilling to pass judgment on any food-related practice that he has not witnessed firsthand or even joined in.

A. an empiricist	D. brilliant theorizing
B. a traditionalist	E. voluminous reading
C. an enthusiast	F. careful observation

3. Scientists suspect that athletes may experience augmented bloodstream levels of the hormone oxytocin during competition. (i)_____ considerations, however, make it difficult to (ii)_____ oxytocin levels during sports events: few will willingly interrupt player in the middle of a game in order for scientists to test players' blood. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. Practical	D. predict fluctuations of
B. Theoretical	E. quantify changes in
C. Ethical	F. trigger elevation of

4. Based on the evidence available, it would be (i)_____ to insist on a wholly negative portrayal of King Prajadhipok. In his own writings and pronouncements as well as in firsthand accounts offered by others, Prajadhipok consistently emerges as (ii)_____ and even-tempered, though (iii)_____.

A. accurate	D. whimsical	G. unexceptional
B. convenient	E. thoughtful	H. vicious
C. facile	F. ingenious	I. innovative

5. The _____ of Craig's government had left the nation almost totally unprepared for war when it came.

- A. somnolence
- B. inexperience
- C. lethargy
- D. obstinacy
- E. perspicacity
- F. acuity

6. Japanese law draws a distinction between currency imitation and actual counterfeiting: only the latter involves an explicit intent to _____ the public.

- A. confuse
- B. malign
- C. defraud
- D. address
- E. swindle
- F. defame

7. It's easy to see why the aspiring singer was _____ the awareness of her lack of talent: her shaky voice notwithstanding, she was a kindly woman with a genuine appreciation for music.

- A. surprised by
- B. insulated from
- C. humbled by
- D. appreciative of
- E. guided to
- F. buffered against

test 80 section 1 (easy)

1. _____ is valuable in science, even when a scientific idea is true, it can be misused through grandiosity. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. humility
- B. experimentation
- C. patience
- D. cooperation
- E. exposure

2. She knew well, from experience with hundreds of hired crew members on her boats, how (i)_____ attitudes can be: one negative influence can impel an otherwise (ii)_____ member of a crew to quit.

A. insipid	D. untested
B. infectious	E. captious

C. innocuous	F. contented
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3. Thinking (i)_____ about one's choices can sometimes (ii)_____ decision making. For example, in one study in which college students selected their favorite poster from a set, those asked to explain their selection ended up less (iii)_____ their choices than those who were not asked. Researchers concluded that thinking of reasons interferes with people's ability to access gut-level reactions that are crucial to sound decision making.

A. uncritically	D. speed the process of	G. happy with
B. haphazardly	E. reduce satisfaction with	H. confused by
C. explicitly	F. enhance the quality of	I. concerned by

4. A decisive way to test planet formation hypotheses is to study planetesimals, but these objects are quite _____, neither numerous nor large enough to emit significant radiation that can be captured by telescopes.

- A. unpredictable
- B. inconspicuous
- C. clustered
- D. radioactive
- E. discreet
- F. erratic

5. The _____ of native South American textiles at the time of the Spanish conquest should not be surprising: it represented the apogee of one of the world's oldest and most sophisticated weaving and dyeing traditions. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. splendor
- B. eccentricity
- C. diversity
- D. brilliance
- E. practicality
- F. popularity

6. If it is wrong to justify human selfishness on the basis of the alleged selfishness of nature, then it is equally mistaken to espouse _____ merely because some animals happily assist each other.

- A. pragmatism
- B. moderation
- C. restraint
- D. altruism
- E. benevolence
- F. permissiveness

7. In many branches of science, our knowledge and technology have advanced so rapidly that new studies carried out with improved instruments and techniques may well _____ research done just twenty years earlier.

- A. confirm
- B. supplant
- C. elaborate
- D. supersede
- E. question
- F. validate

test 80 section 2 (medium)

1. A sunset, the poet asserted, is beautiful in part because it is ____: fleeting and never to be repeated.

- A. expeditious
- B. vibrant
- C. transitory
- D. evocative
- E. archetypal

2. Recently the novelist has (i)_____ the radically experimental forms with which he made his reputation in favor of more (ii)_____ narratives, fencing in and turning an imagination meant to run wild.

A. trumpeted	D. conventional
B. forsaken	E. pretentious
C. replicated	F. provocative

3. Evidence suggest that populations of migratory birds in both the New and Old Worlds have (i)_____, a (ii)_____ that carries the potential for significant ecological damage far beyond the shrinking numbers of the birds themselves. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. scattered	D. dispersal
B. stabilized	E. decline
C. plummeted	F. displacement

4. The patients given a placebo in the course of clinical trials receive much more than a pharmacologically inert substance. Like the patients receiving the experimental drug, they (i)_____ a thorough medical evaluation, a chance to discuss their condition with competent professionals, a diagnosis, and a treatment plan. Although viewed by many as (ii)_____ the healing process, these factors may actually provide an important clue as to why placebo often work: they are part of an experience that can itself be a (iii)_____ illness.

A. get	D. essential for	G. research laboratory for
B. avoid	E. incidental to	H. powerful antidote to
C. welcome	F. consequences of	I. breeding ground of

5. The campaign official argued that the large swings in the candidate's approval ratings were a result not of the _____ of the electorate but rather of the polls' margins of error and divergent methodologies.

- A. exactitude
- B. resurgence
- C. capriciousness
- D. volatility
- E. partisanship
- F. scrupulousness

6. Some consider the theorem Emmy Noether first published in 1918 to be as important as Einstein's theory of relativity, since much of today's vanguard research in physics is _____ Noether's theorem. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

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- A. contradicted by
- B. undergirded by
- C. incompatible with
- D. dependent on
- E. devoted to
- F. elucidated by

7. Beauford Delaney's dynamic depictions of Harlem and Greenwich Village, dating from 1929 to 1953, _____ the energy of the city, while the equally captivating abstract compositions from his Paris years of 1953 to 1979 demonstrate his sustained exploration of color.

- A. authenticate
- B. convey
- C. elicit
- D. impart
- E. stifle
- F. suppress

test 81 section 1 (medium)

1. The evidence depicts an _____ system of tree inspections and care, one in which the crucial job of spotting dangers is left to untrained workers, and essential repairs and pruning are delayed to save money.

- A. overeager
- B. ineffective
- C. uneconomical
- D. unflagging
- E. intuitive

2. Even though company's CEO professes to be (i) _____ and urges the deal forward, its investors are unlikely to be so (ii) _____ about its prospect. Many were uncomfortable at the way the corporation was forced to spend much of last year expansion, and this new venture is potentially even more risky. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. apprehensive	D. indifferent
B. apathetic	E. sanguine
C. confident	F. anxious

3. Transportation maps of Alaska are (i) _____ in large part by what they (ii) _____: lines identifying roads and railroads. With a single track bisecting the state and a handful of spokes to the east and south, Alaska is notable for its (iii) _____ of transportation options.

A. demarcated	D. lack	G. panoply
B. characterized	E. obscure	H. scope
C. elucidated	F. evince	I. dearth

4. Aboriginal people of Victoria Australia neither rejected Western material culture nor demonstrated an obsession with it in fact, Western artifacts such as pipes and handkerchiefs were appreciated for their symbolic rather than their _____ value.

- A. utilitarian

- B. intrinsic
- C. communicative
- D. aesthetic
- E. pragmatic
- F. theoretical

5. Despite dogs' talent for detecting those high-pitched whistles that are inaudible to us, dogs' ability to locate sounds is _____ compared with ours.

- A. imprecise
- B. innate
- C. impractical
- D. inherent
- E. inexact
- F. impaired

6. Because they were traditionally _____, Jam monks in sixteenth-century India particularly valued special dispensations from the royal court granting them freedom of movement.

- A. erudite
- B. ascetic
- C. apolitical
- D. peripatetic
- E. solitary
- F. itinerant

7. The coagulated latex of the gutta-percha tree, which grows wild in Sumatra Kalimantan and May, can be formed into a natural plastic that, although inelastic under ordinary conditions becomes _____ when placed in hot water. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. smooth
- B. pliable
- C. permeable
- D. malleable
- E. pervious
- F. buoyant

test 81 section 2 (medium)

1. The sand paintings that McCall created—a synthesis of painting, sculpture, and photography—were meant to be _____, preserved only in the memories of witnesses.

- A. archetypal
- B. incendiary
- C. ephemeral
- D. naturalistic
- E. dazzling

2. Among the most popular Currier&Ives lithographic prints in nineteenth-century America were bird's-eye views of great cities such as New York, Chicago, and San Francisco. These were edited into books, and the cities' (i) _____ meant that new views were (ii) _____ for successive editions.

A. tremendous productivity	D. hard to obtain
B. extraordinary growth	E. rendered superfluous
C. unparalleled activity	F. regularly required

3. The scientists who first proposed that Moon's craters had resulted from impacts (i)_____: almost all of these craters were circular, and yet most impactors in heliocentric orbit would have an oblique path and hence would be expected to form (ii)_____ craters.

A. devised a theory	D. massive
B. misinterpreted a finding	E. elongated
C. confronted difficulty	F. shallow

4. It is inevitable that ongoing research presupposes some accepted science as a principle. Usually no one even notices the implication that the accepted principle is being (i)_____ unless there emerges (ii)_____ that turns out to be sufficiently (iii)_____ that the assumptions underlying the research come to be considered. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. jeopardized	D. an anomaly	G. trivial
B. revised	E. a consensus	H. transparent
C. tested	F. a distinction	I. recalcitrant

5. Although dry weather in medieval England was not _____, documentary evidence suggests that the cluster of intense droughts between 1323 and 1333 was exceptional.

- A. anomalous
- B. severe
- C. uncommon
- D. seasonal
- E. frequent
- F. pervasive

6. Among some demographic groups, the Internet is _____: almost everybody who wants Internet access has it.

- A. necessary
- B. indispensable
- C. irresistible
- D. pervasive
- E. ubiquitous
- F. homogeneous

7. What Dr. Walther has shown is that many of the standard statistical techniques that are supposed to insure against _____ correlations are inadequate in this case.

- A. numerical
- B. specious
- C. elementary
- D. paltry
- E. quantifiable
- F. spurious

test 82 section 1 (medium)

1. From its nineteenth-century beginnings onward, photography was often tasked with providing _____ images of individuals, yet at the same time, photographs were prized for their perceived realism and truthfulness.

- A. recognizable
- B. candid
- C. idealized
- D. replicable
- E. detailed

2. When the United States government created the Post Office at the founding of the republic, it didn't invite rival postal firms to compete; in fact, it created a monopoly. That monopoly, however, was (i)_____ free expression because of policies Congress adopted, which (ii)_____ the circulation of newspapers irrespective of their viewpoint and spread postal service throughout the country.

A. conducive to	D. subsidized
B. threatened by	E. limited
C. dependent on	F. trivialized

3. Having displayed his art collection in a vast modernist white space in (i)_____ former warehouse, Mr. Saatchi has chosen for his new site its polar opposite, a riverside monument to civic pomposity that once housed the local government. There is nothing (ii)_____ about the new location: the building's design is bureaucratic baroque, (iii)_____ style that is as declamatory as a task-force report and as self-regarding as a campaign speech.

A. a decadent	D. atavistic	G. an ascetic
B. a claustrophobic	E. spare	H. a grandiose
C. an unprepossessing	F. pretentious	I. an understated

4. Motorcycle riders in London have discovered an ingenious, albeit _____ way of parking illegally without getting a ticket. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. inventive
- B. unscrupulous
- C. astute
- D. dishonest
- E. impractical
- F. shrewd

5. The writer's expression of _____ sentiments in fluid, vigorous prose is a strange blending of the high and the low-like an opera performed by sloppily dressed, unkempt musicians.

- A. patriotic
- B. vile
- C. noble
- D. base
- E. tender
- F. lofty

6. California's building codes are more _____ than those elsewhere in the United States to ensure that structures are capable of protecting people from frequent seismic events.

- A. circuitous
- B. exacting
- C. controversial
- D. stringent

- E. convoluted
- F. extensive

7. Jean Kimmel and Emily Hoffman argue for expanding the definition of child-care subsidies to include all programs that _____ or otherwise offset expenses for nonparental child care.

- A. tally
- B. tabulate
- C. alter
- D. defray
- E. pay
- F. simplify

test 82 section 2 (medium)

1. The tenor of Me, as indicated by the title, tends to be _____, sometimes insufferably so.

- A. self-effacing
- B. panegyric
- C. vainglorious
- D. discursive
- E. overmodest

2. The main thrust of her argument was that wage difference, far from being _____, do in fact reflect education, skills, experience, and other factors that make employees more productive.

- A. rational
- B. divergent
- C. arbitrary
- D. discernible
- E. attributable

3. Goodin notes that people have (i) _____ cognitive capacities and that they therefore must consider some factors as (ii) _____ so as to be able to make decisions about other things.

A. limited	D. essential
B. adaptable	E. variable
C. overlooked	F. given

4. (i) _____, we can safely infer causality by appealing to a set of general principles (Newtonian mechanics, for example) that are well understood and have been shown to apply in comparably straightforward circumstances. However, for the opposing class, which consists of (ii) _____ systems like the global economy, human physiology, or the human mind itself, explanations of singular events are usually (iii) _____, absent the requisite accounting for the intricate dynamics of such systems. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. In unknown settings	D. complex	G. consistent
B. For complicated events	E. homogeneous	H. unjustified
C. In simple situations	F. equivalent	I. unequivocal

5. While the coauthors of the new guide to the American artistic experience have received accolades for their wide-ranging work, they do not _____ that the publication is exhaustive in content.

- A. hope
- B. care
- C. assert
- D. insist
- E. doubt
- F. question

6. Journal editors note that the peer review process has difficulty detecting _____ : deliberate misinformation, if it is clever enough, might sail right through no matter how scrupulous the reviews.

- A. bias
- B. inconsistency
- C. fraud
- D. negligence
- E. duplicity
- F. carelessness

7. Coral reefs are often referred to as the rain forests of the sea, _____ comparison given that only tropical rain forests can compete with the sheer concentration of biodiversity found in coral reefs.

【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. a factitious
- B. an imaginative
- C. a fitting
- D. an artificial
- E. an apposite
- F. a creative

test 83 section 1 (medium)

1. Although not enough to _____ the conventional view of the manuscript's provenance, the new study was thought to have weakened the prevailing theory considerably.

- A. undermine
- B. affect
- C. resurrect
- D. disturb
- E. topple

2. Some people (i) _____ translations of great literary works—especially those insistent on a literal translation for whom no rendering is ever (ii) _____ enough.

A. dismiss	D. faithful
B. tolerate	E. creative
C. esteem	F. spontaneous

3. In its earliest days, the telegraph inspired (i) _____ without precedent in the annals of technology. A new sense of (ii) _____ across: a sense that the world was in (iii) _____, that life for one's children and grandchildren would be very different, all because of this wondrous force and its uses.

A. anxiety	D. resentment	G. a state of change
B. outrage	E. futurity	H. a downward spiral
C. exhilaration	F. nostalgia	I. an unyielding stasis

4. The rebellion was _____ one, driven less by ardor than by reason and calculation.

- A. a cerebral
- B. a dispassionate
- C. a rash
- D. an idealistic
- E. a cautious
- F. a reckless

5. Despite their current reputation, the original Luddites were neither opposed to innovation technology nor _____ using it: many were highly skilled machine operators in the textile industry.

- A. inept at
- B. enamored of
- C. resistant to
- D. unequal to
- E. enthralled by
- F. unfazed by

6. Once a pop musician's biggest source of income, recorded music now plays second fiddle to touring, endorsements, merchandise sales, and an array of other revenue streams previously considered _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. lucrative
- B. invaluable
- C. ancillary
- D. irrelevant
- E. supplementary
- F. remunerative

7. The colors of brocaded silks made by Merina weavers in Madagascar were not _____. magenta, blue, black, pink, yellow and brown characterize pieces before 1880, while thereafter green purple, and orange come to the fore.

- A. invariable
- B. generic
- C. conventional
- D. repetitious
- E. static
- F. traditional

test 83 section 2 (medium)

1. The economist argued that however much the government might trumpet the value of _____, it had been as bold as any other in its spending programs.

- A. thrift
- B. consumption
- C. dialogue
- D. cooperation
- E. transparency

2. It was not until 1995 that a planet beyond our solar system was first sighted, a discovery that greatly excited astronomers. Many had supposed that the processes that gave rise to our solar system were not (i)_____, and that there were other planets in the universe. Now, observations had (ii)_____.

A. manifest	D. caught up with belief
B. replicable	E. provided grounds for skepticism
C. unique	F. put assumptions to the test

3. Many of us remember a time when discovery and the thrill of learning were forces in our lives and were (i)_____. Frequently that time happened in a great classroom somewhere, in the hands of the one (ii)_____ teacher we can each remember.

A. elusive	D. consummate
B. inconsequential	E. truculent
C. exciting	F. superfluous

4. The enthusiasm that many English artists and writers felt regarding the Labour Party (i)_____ amid complaints that arts funding remained as (ii)_____. And even though the government recently announced a significant funding boost for the Arts Council, some art leaders still refuse to (iii)_____ Labour.

A. intensified	D. far-reaching	G. trust
B. resurfaced	E. parsimonious	H. condemn
C. waned	F. staggering	I. ignore

5. Meteorology is one of the few fields of applied science that demands prediction; since prediction involves considerable uncertainty and uncertainty is _____ scientists, meteorology will continue to exist in a fraught intellectual space. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. mysterious to
- B. anathema to
- C. discredited by
- D. pivotal for
- E. repellent to
- F. familiar to

6. One virtue of cornmeal as a component of the diets of laborers in early Puerto Rico was the mildness of its taste, a trait that enabled it to _____ the strong flavors of other foods.

- A. mimic
- B. temper
- C. camouflage
- D. neutralize
- E. complement
- F. augment

7. Asteroids of diameter less than 100km never melted but asteroids with larger diameters did so and became _____ with the heavier Fe-Ni material forming the core and the silicates forming the crust.

- A. stratified

- B. destabilized
- C. weakened
- D. liquefied
- E. differentiated
- F. distinguished

test 84 section 1 (medium)

1. Geologists suggest that as the most productive oil reservoirs begin to dry up, the expensive cost and high risk of drilling in the marginal area become less _____ and more acceptable.

- A. onerous
- B. efficacious
- C. auspicious
- D. benign
- E. natural

2. Because it is discussed by humanities scholars from diverse disciplinary backgrounds, "affect" has been (i) _____ defined; nonetheless there has been (ii) _____ the terms "emotion" and "affect" across academic writing in the humanities. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. clearly	D. a paucity of interest in
B. variously	E. a variety of interpretations of
C. narrowly	F. a consistent distinction between

3. Fifteen years ago, the author of this scholarly monograph would have (i) _____ found a university press willing to publish it. But today specialized books of this sort are (ii) _____ species. Their main purchasers—university libraries—have far less money to spend on these items than they once did. Computerized catalogues, subscription content, expensive scientific journals, exploding storage costs: all these demands are (iii) _____ library budgets.

A. voluntarily	D. a thriving	G. putting tremendous pressure on
B. never	E. an anomalous	H. leading to irregularities in
C. readily	F. an imperiled	I. causing increasing appropriations to

4. In science, _____ can sometimes inhibit understanding; indeed, the advantage of the technique for staining brain tissue developed in 1873 by Golgi was that it showed so little.

- A. biases
- B. projections
- C. prejudices
- D. minutiae
- E. approximations
- F. particulars

5. Faced with so much conflicting information on the internet, many people come to believe that all sources are so _____ that efforts to discriminate between the true and the false are inevitably futile.

- A. slanted

- B. imprecise
- C. splenetic
- D. tendentious
- E. surreptitious
- F. acrimonious

6. The auditors are relying on the failing bank to make changes that it has steadfastly resisted for years and even now does not seem _____ to carry out.

- A. able
- B. impatient
- C. destined
- D. disinclined
- E. loath
- F. keen

7. Though it once seemed so disastrous, with hindsight the disintegration of the artists' collective is revealed as generative, for each of the dispersed factions acted as a _____, reproducing the collective's founding inspiration in a new setting.

- A. strand
- B. seed
- C. shard
- D. fragment
- E. germ
- F. blueprint

test 84 section 2 (medium)

1. Williams finds the appearance of Whitman's Leaves of Grass in 1855 nearly _____ given the immense disparity between Whitman's earlier published works, which Williams finds dismal, and the consummate mastery of Leaves.

- A. oracular
- B. prophetic
- C. inevitable
- D. inexplicable
- E. inauspicious

2. In his study of Senegambian cleric Shaykh Mass Kah (1827-1936), Bala S. K. Saho notes that it is difficult to fully (i)_____ many of the oral accounts on which the study relies. Saho's work shows, however, that despite this absence of (ii)_____, oral history can provide useful sources from which historians can reconstruct the past. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. comprehend	D. partiality
B. reproduce	E. argumentation
C. validate	F. corroboration

3. For a genre that's supposed to be about the future, science fiction has certainly (i)_____ lately, (ii)_____ is what sells best, with readers spending their money on sequels to long-running series.

A. become quite pessimistic	D. suspense
B. been looking backward	E. fantasy

C. anticipated technological developments	F. nostalgia
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4. Those who blame the inadequacies of science education for students' lack of reasoning skills perpetuate their unproductive notion of science as (i)_____, unique in its capacity to inoculate us against superstition and ignorance. Certainly a good science education can (ii)_____ habits of mind, but the (iii)_____ effect of education in nonscientific, humanistic subjects such as literature and history should not be underrated.

A. vocational	D. counter uncritical	G. unforeseen
B. empirical	E. discourage rigorous	H. salutary
C. salvational	F. temper creative	I. pedestrian

5. Scientists are finding that the adult brain is far more _____ than they once thought: our behavior and environment can cause substantial rewiring of the brain or a reorganization of its functions and where they are located. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. reparable
- B. heterogeneous
- C. malleable
- D. variegated
- E. complex
- F. plastic

6. The folktale is perhaps the most _____ form of literature: a story that everyone is free to tell and embellish because it belongs to no one in particular.

- A. unpretentious
- B. archaic
- C. primitive
- D. democratic
- E. egalitarian
- F. changeable

7. According to Panamanian composer Danilo Perez, the gravity of jazz pianist Randy Weston's performances is _____: you can copy one of his chords, but it doesn't sound the same.

- A. elusive
- B. indelible
- C. unattainable
- D. estranging
- E. purposeful
- F. alienating

test 85 section 1 (medium)

1. Once so fluid, the political situation had, two years after the declaration of the Republic, _____ so much that further change seemed inconceivable.

- A. revitalized
- B. warmed
- C. intensified
- D. clotted
- E. destabilized

2. The (i)_____ current-generation solar cells are (ii)_____: although experimental cells have reached efficiencies greater than 40 percent, most commercially available cells in the early part of the twenty-first century still struggle to get past about 20 percent.

A. attractions of	D. clear
B. limitations of	E. unmatched
C. improvements in	F. misunderstood

3. Media stories about climate regularly use spokespeople from interest groups as sources, but what those individuals say is often (i)_____, citing results from scientific research in a highly (ii)_____ manner and (iii)_____ the caveats that are part of a full scientific assessment.

A. ingenuous	D. erudite	G. parsing
B. maladroitness	E. selective	H. omitting
C. tendentious	F. perspicuous	I. anticipating

4. While the _____ of reliable sources in later narratives make many details of the early history of China's Chou dynasty unverifiable, the Zhou rulers' successful rise to power is certain.

- A. dearth
- B. ambiguity
- C. paucity
- D. opacity
- E. authenticity
- F. credibility

5. Because the influence of French women writers in seventeenth-century England has been _____ by scholars, England's early women writers, such as Aphra Behn and Delarivier Manley, may appear to have sprung from a vacuum. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. documented
- B. discredited
- C. slighted
- D. misinterpreted
- E. discounted
- F. corroborated

6. Some historians have _____ the disjunction between the decades preceding and the ones following the political coup, ignoring the fact that the coup fell in the middle of a twenty-year period of considerable social and economic continuity.

- A. overstated
- B. exaggerated
- C. questioned
- D. misjudged
- E. misinterpreted
- F. overlooked

7. Although extreme and singular events occur in a black hole, its event horizon boundary is _____ space travelers; crossing it would be subject to the same physical laws that apply anywhere else.

- A. illusory
- B. obscure
- C. unremarkable
- D. immutable
- E. unchanging

F. commonplace

test 85 section 2 (medium)

1. Paul Robeson, Jr. wrote that his father was a flesh-and-blood artist whose accomplishments made him susceptible to hagiographic treatment by potential biographers. Robeson's achievements were real, and there was no need for _____.

- A. disclosure
- B. hyperbole
- C. retraction
- D. muckraking
- E. reticence

2. Boreal forest is at the southern boundary of the moss-dominated tundra, which remains characteristically treeless because its spongy surface retains water that cannot drain away through the underlying permafrost. But as temperatures rise the permafrost recedes, (i) _____ the (ii) _____ of forest.

A. impairing	D. renewal
B. facilitating	E. incursion
C. decelerating	F. decline

3. As late as the 1990s, Merry Wiesner Hanks argued that developments during the Reformation and the Enlightenment had (i) _____ effects on the participation of women in the field of medicine. She claimed that the (ii) _____ Reformation and Enlightenment women left female health's practitioners restricted to assisting in an unpaid and unrecognized capacity.

A. dire	D. unchanging opportunities for
B. positive	E. worsening positions of
C. ambiguous	F. reader respect for

4. For Ruskin, architecture serves the community only when approached in a spirit of piety and (i) _____. Architecture must set effective boundaries to public space, and it does so by (ii) _____ the desire to show off, to stand out, to record the artistic flair of some temporary ego. Architecture succeeds in its public task through (iii) _____ and devotion, of the kind that can be observed in the moulding, firing and laying of a properly proportioned brick, but which is violated at every point by Frank Gehry's bombastic Guggenheim Museum in Bilbao. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. altruism	D. retrieving	G. humility
B. sanctimony	E. fastening	H. demise
C. sacrifice	F. relinquishing	I. braggadocio

5. Although, in spirit at least, solar panels _____ nature and the way our biosphere harnesses the energy of our sun, the actual photosynthetic process by which plants convert sunlight into chemical energy is far more complex than solar power generation is.

- A. streamline
- B. enhance

- C. imitate
- D. exploit
- E. simplify
- F. mimic

6. The historical study of pregnancy and childbearing began fairly recently and has been hindered by the relative _____ of records concerning these particular experiences.

- A. pertinence
- B. dearth
- C. paucity
- D. ambiguity
- E. expediency
- F. applicability

7. In literature, thrillers thrive on heroes and villains, and usually the characterization is not very _____; writers don't want to confuse or slow the plot.

- A. nuanced
- B. trite
- C. realistic
- D. monotonous
- E. banal
- F. subtle

test 86 section 1 (medium)

1. Wood is an environmentally friendly building material because it _____ carbon dioxide, absorbing it during growth and retaining it even after it has been turned into lumber.

- A. disperses
- B. eradicates
- C. sequesters
- D. respires
- E. regulates

2. Early in the development of ice age theories, physicists identified the processing(slow gyration) and wobbling of Earth's spin axis as the likely drivers of the ice ages, but geologists (i)_____, and even the painstaking work done in the 1920s and 1930s by Mihution Mplankovitch failed to (ii)_____ of many of the day's geological experts.

A. demurred	D. anticipate the ascent
B. acquiesced	E. assuage the qualms
C. expatriate	F. acknowledge the consensus

3. The fall of the monarchical order produced a score of fragile successor states in Europe that (i)_____ ethnic discontent and revanchism. This (ii)_____, when fused with those states' inherent feebleness, make for power voids and political (iii)_____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. kept down	D. cosmopolitanism	G. cures
B. overshadowed	E. hierarchy	H. fluidities
C. simmered with	F. volatility	I. redundancies

4. Monarch butterflies sequester toxins in their skin to discourage predators, but black-backed orioles (*Icterus abeillei*) _____ the defense: they consume only the soft insides of the butterfly.

- A. anticipate
- B. disable
- C. ignore
- D. skirt
- E. circumvent
- F. disregard

5. Though it lacked _____ demeanor, Guatemala City was nonetheless a compelling place to be in 1954.

- A. an engaging
- B. a winning
- C. a sophisticated
- D. a detached
- E. a workaday
- F. a quotidian

6. By eating tiny organisms and incorporating their prey's nutrients into their own bodies, large insects become "nutrient packages" for larger insectivores for whom the pursuit of tiny organisms would be _____.

- A. unwieldy
- B. insalubrious
- C. unremunerative
- D. unnecessary
- E. inopportune
- F. unprofitable

7. Researchers comparing test subjects' abilities to interpret others' facial expressions found that while some expressions were easy to interpret, others were difficult because they were so _____ the person making the expression. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. habitual for
- B. customary for
- C. peculiar to
- D. idiosyncratic to
- E. opaque to
- F. inoffensive to

test 86 section 2 (medium)

1. Despite the fact that it is quite difficult to find, in everyday discourse, causal explanations taking the form Hume proposed, many philosophers have regarded Hume's model as _____ causal accounts.

- A. paradigmatic of
- B. unworkable for
- C. tendentious about
- D. superfluous to
- E. irreducible to

2. As a longtime fan of the fashion photography Web site, I wasn't sure if I wanted to see its images presented in a book, with all of the (i) _____ that implies. What I've always enjoyed about

the photos is their (ii)_____: they are disposable snapshots of what's going on in the world of style right now.

A. nonchalance	D. elegant
B. commercialism	E. ephemeral
C. permanency	F. mundane

3. Research indicates that many people hold (i)_____ views about government, believing that elected officials should be able to overcome differences and get things done while also regarding a willingness to compromise as a sign of (ii)_____.

A. cynical	D. fickleness
B. self-contradictory	E. pragmatism
C. shortsighted	F. intractability

4. In the early 1990s, the discovery of a new microbe in wastewater led microbiologists to (i)_____ ammonia's conversion to nitrogen compounds. Called anammox (for anaerobic ammonia oxidation), the microbe was converting into nitrogen gas in the absence of oxygen, a reaction previously assumed to be (ii)_____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. question existing dogma about	D. hazardous
B. abandon efforts to facilitate	E. irreversible
C. raise health concerns regarding	F. impossible

5. It is troubling that blogs, which may be among the least reliable sources of information in human history, occupy such _____ positions in Internet search engine results.

- A. enviable
- B. conspicuous
- C. suspect
- D. dubious
- E. controversial
- F. prominent

6. There is a vast disparity of computational power between mathematical _____ like many of us and a mathematical prodigy like Ramanujan.

- A. dullards
- B. enthusiasts
- C. virtuosos
- D. tyros
- E. geniuses
- F. novices

7. An academic with a questionable record in either teaching, administration, or research may still be well regarded at many schools, but simultaneous failure in all three areas normally results in _____ by superiors.

- A. exculpation
- B. dismissal
- C. impeachment
- D. disapprobation
- E. censure

F. acquittal

test 87 section 1 (medium)

1. Because of its _____, DNA can be invaluable as exculpatory evidence following a criminal conviction: it can be reliably tested years after a crime has occurred.

- A. versatility
- B. recognizability
- C. durability
- D. verifiability
- E. distinctiveness

2. Many civic institutions tend to (i) _____, when they do not actively discourage, the better natures of the citizenry. People are individually altruistic social animals who nonetheless teach themselves to be (ii) _____ in the public sphere.

A. expose	D. selfish
B. ignore	E. critical
C. presuppose	F. adamant

3. Computers' triumph in chess had been engineered not by creating machines that (i) _____ human thought, as most experts in artificial intelligence had expected, but by perfecting machines that played like machines. The analogy with flight is (ii) _____: as long as people tried to fly by imitating birds, attaching wings to their arms and flapping madly, they were (iii) _____ to fail. Once engineering escaped the paradigm of the familiar, however, people were soon flying much faster than birds.

A. aped	D. disingenuous	G. expected
B. shelved	E. instructive	H. likely
C. subverted	F. narrow	I. doomed

4. The scholar defended W.E.B. Du Bois from the charge of being _____ by pointing out that whenever Du Bois changed his views, he acknowledged it, explained his reasons for doing so, and moved on. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. inconsistent
- B. insensitive
- C. erratic
- D. unsympathetic
- E. pugnacious
- F. irresponsible

5. Sea turtle's grazing on sea grass is less _____ near Bermuda than elsewhere: Bermuda protects sea turtles as an endangered species but does not protect their predators, tiger sharks.

- A. consistent
- B. pervasive
- C. inhibited
- D. destructive
- E. damaging
- F. constrained

6. Comparing seawater to ice in asteroids to determine the origin of Earth's water is _____: the bulk of Earth's water, hidden deep underground, differs in composition from seawater.

- A. instructive
- B. inapposite
- C. unnecessary
- D. premature
- E. misguided
- F. challenging

7. Jane Austen belonged to the social class about which she mainly wrote, and although her novels offer abundant satire, one never has the sense that she viewed the basic elements of this social sphere as _____.

- A. laudable
- B. unfathomable
- C. ignoble
- D. reprehensible
- E. inviolable
- F. praiseworthy

test 87 section 2 (medium)

1. Throughout the High Middle Ages, the English government became increasingly _____: the document produced in the eleventh century could be placed on one large table, while the documents produced in the thirteenth fill whole rooms. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. despotic
- B. ceremonial
- C. aristocratic
- D. prolix
- E. insular

2. It is unfortunate that essays by literary critics so infrequently (i)_____ the opinions of novelists and poets, for creative writers are often quite (ii)_____ about their own philosophies and are frequently more familiar with alternative systems of thought than critics are.

A. influence	D. articulate
B. challenge	E. inconsistent
C. incorporate	F. prejudiced

3. At one time researchers viewed the placebo effect as (i)_____, a statistical (ii)_____ faced by those attempting an objective evaluation of the efficacy of potentially legitimate therapies. That view has changed: the placebo effect is today seen as an important part of the healing process.

A. a boon	D. increment
B. a touchstone	E. annoyance
C. an impediment	F. deviation

4. The lack of (i)_____ the poetry of the postwar decades has led not, as one might have expected, to (ii)_____ poetry, but to a curious closure in which all poets and forms of poetry are (iii)_____ and alone, not even respected establishment poets.

A. interest in	D. pluralistic debate on	G. marginalized
B. consensus about	E. popular acceptance of	H. revered
C. innovation in	F. any experimentation in	I. tolerated

5. Orbiting Jupiter just beyond Europa, the giant moon Ganymede—bigger than the planet Mercury—appears rather _____ on the outside, but it may be warm and active within.

- A. desiccated
- B. forbidding
- C. weathered
- D. inert
- E. adamant
- F. dormant

6. Although the use of cameras to study animal behavior was certainly not _____, cameras were nevertheless not used to study individual frogs in their natural habitat until 2009.

- A. ideal
- B. unprecedented
- C. laborious
- D. impractical
- E. novel
- F. perfect

7. In nineteenth-century Puerto Rico, the consumption of salted cod spread among the entire population; on the tables of humbler families it became _____ food, adding flavor to other products and supplying much-needed protein.

- A. an exotic
- B. an affordable
- C. an essential
- D. a supplemental
- E. a complementary
- F. a commonplace

test 88 section 1 (easy)

1. Characteristic of the diplomat's new book is the _____ relationship between the evidence adduced and the inferences drawn, the footnotes and citations teeming with ambiguity and complexity, while the summary statements are more dogmatic simplicities.

- A. healthy
- B. shifting
- C. tenuous
- D. compelling
- E. plausible

2. To function as (i)_____, literary critics must write well. A badly written book review is worse than a badly written political speech or greeting card; a badly written review is (ii)_____, like a barber with a terrible haircut. If critics cannot write well, how can they authoritatively recognize and promote good writing? 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. soothsayers	D. self-aggrandizing
B. evangelists	E. self-knowing

C. iconoclasts	F. self-defeating
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3. Genetic researchers have recently suggested that our political learnings may be determined by our DNA, a view that tends to undermine our reflective self-flattery. We (i)_____ the idea that personal politics are entirely (ii)_____. The genetic explanation for ideology (iii)_____ our belief that we are persuaded only by rational arguments.

A. recoil from	D. deliberative	G. defies
B. revel in	E. inexpensive	H. entails
C. puzzle over	F. self-serving	I. parallels

4. Jimi Hendrix was a pivotal figure in the visionary aesthetic movement known as Afrofuturism, which is steeped in African American musical tradition yet _____ technological innovation, from synthesizers to spaceships. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. circumspect about
- B. indebted to
- C. enthralled by
- D. wary of
- E. captivated by
- F. heedful of

5. Sánchez' novels have been praised for their remarkable _____, the way in which they so palpably represent a certain place and time.

- A. imaginativeness
- B. realism
- C. allusiveness
- D. verisimilitude
- E. compassion
- F. empathy

6. Because previous experience in office tends to reveal the limits of a political candidate's power, we are often _____ candidates with little experience, blank slates onto which we can project our fantasies for change.

- A. interested in
- B. uneasy about
- C. hoodwinked by
- D. drawn to
- E. captivated by
- F. troubled by

7. While Davy is regarded as a giant of early chemistry and was once known to every educated British school child, his mentor Beddoes is seen as a _____ figure, even by historians of medicine.

- A. risible
- B. peripheral
- C. charismatic
- D. subsidiary
- E. beguiling
- F. misleading

test 88 section 2 (easy)

1. Notwithstanding a lack of _____, nineteenth-century anthologies such as Evert and George Duyckinck's Cyclopaedia of American Literature represents serious attempts to collect the national writings up to that point as a way of establishing the viability of American letters.

- A. bias
- B. earnestness
- C. rigor
- D. ambition
- E. ambiguity

2. Despite the recent proliferation of gourmet and specialty salts, studies suggest that it would take an unusually (i) _____ palate to (ii) _____ foods prepared with different salts—most salts taste the same to most people.

A. broad	D. distinguish
B. indiscriminate	E. enjoy
C. sensitive	F. modify

3. In the search for truth, the knowledge gained by scientists consists of approximations with varying degrees of certainty. Such (i) _____ truth can be highly (ii) _____, as the rapid and relatively steady progress of medical knowledge well exemplifies.

A. unambiguous	D. useful
B. esoteric	E. equivocal
C. provisional	F. contentious

4. The mind has a tendency to (i) _____ abstractions, so that one might envision the ego existing somewhere physically in the brain, but Freud (ii) _____ such a physical structure: rather, he (iii) _____.

A. create	D. did not posit	G. believed that it is illusory
B. hypostatize	E. did not preclude	H. theorized that it is autonomous
C. incorporate	F. did not abjure	I. regard it as a process

5. Throughout the trial the plaintiff has been _____, refusing to comply with orders with which she disagreed. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. histrionic
- B. refractory
- C. meticulous
- D. recalcitrant
- E. idiosyncratic
- F. conscientious

6. Psychologists have discovered that some of the most _____ advice on study habits is flat wrong, leading them to revise the guidelines they offer to students.

- A. popular
- B. hallowed

- C. respected
- D. unassailable
- E. effective
- F. beneficial

7. Despite a reputation, once richly deserved, for _____ in adopting new technologies, most big carmakers are pouring resources both into battery power and other alternative forms of propulsion, and into automated driving.

- A. indolence
- B. stoicism
- C. sloth
- D. patience
- E. dispassion
- F. misjudgment

test 89 section 1 (medium)

1. Unable to escape their own literary tradition, literary critics either become the _____ of that tradition or, on the contrary, use their knowledge of it to reinterpret writers and trends from new perspectives. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. liberators
- B. guardians
- C. successors
- D. antithesis
- E. gadflies

2. The kilt has certainly had (i)_____ history, outlawed as it was by Britain in 1746 as an emblem of nationalist subversion, then more recently (ii)_____ from men's to women's apparel in a 2003 European Union survey, and ridiculed at various times for a wide variety of reasons.

A. an obscure	D. reclassified
B. an illustrious	E. feigned
C. a contentious	F. manufactured

3. Greenhouse gases emitted into atmosphere are virtually permanent, and because they (i)_____ in the atmosphere, their effects is (ii)_____. These facts necessitate that policies related to greenhouse gases differ from policies related to various pollutants whose effects are (iii)_____ and often temporary.

A. disperse evenly	D. subtle	G. local
B. accrue gradually	E. global	H. contrary
C. persist indefinitely	F. transit	I. hazardous

4. The photocopier, widely adopted in the 1960s, became not merely a vehicle for copying but one for publishing in _____ manner, so that ideas could be circulated without interference from potential censors.

- A. an incendiary
- B. a clandestine
- C. an expeditious

- D. a collaborative
- E. a cooperative
- F. a surreptitious

5. Because there has been such a _____ of information about Jorge Luis Borges' personal life, it is easy to understand the eager excitement generated by Borges, a selection from the diaries of his closest friend.

- A. stream
- B. glut
- C. paucity
- D. dearth
- E. surfeit
- F. tangle

6. "Over-appropriation"—i.e., excessive exploitation—of water is now the norm for many of the state's streams, resulting in extremely low seasonal flows and even, in some cases, in the drying up of formerly _____ streams.

- A. constant
- B. inundated
- C. healthy
- D. arid
- E. desiccated
- F. perennial

7. What Dr. Walther has shown is that many of the standard statistical techniques that are supposed to insure against _____ correlations are inadequate in this case.

- A. numerical
- B. specious
- C. elementary
- D. paltry
- E. quantifiable
- F. spurious

test 89 section 2 (easy)

1. Not only was Jarry _____ the pandemonium his play sparked, he actually worked to foment the conflict, organizing a posse to boo if the rest of the audience applauded and cheer if the other attendees booed.

- A. riled by
- B. surprised by
- C. unperturbed by
- D. critical of
- E. detached from

2. Some have challenged scientists who attribute the surge in amphibian deaths to habitat loss, since numerous populations have (i) _____ in protected parks and nature reserved—even in remote wilderness areas: places that are removed from humans' modern effluvium and that are presumably (ii) _____ such effects.

A. rebounded	D. preserved with
B. stabilized	E. insulated from
C. declined	F. enhanced by

3. Though nations no longer (i) _____ nuclear physicists—the men and women who once delivered the destructive power of the atom bomb—physics still has the same power to (ii) _____ but in another way, by revealing the basic truths that underpin reality. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. compete for	D. produce awe
B. worry about	E. incite debates
C. cower before	F. challenge orthodoxy

4. In the nineteenth century the (i) _____ advanced mechanical printing techniques made it possible for newspaper owners to print newspapers cheaply and in mass quantities, but unlike many other mechanized industries, where machines (ii) _____ workers, the new printing machines required trained compositors to run them, thereby (iii) _____ the demand for skilled printing labor.

A. wide application of	D. marginalized	G. ignoring
B. extensive resistance to	E. intrigued	H. anticipating
C. great expense of	F. isolated	I. increasing

5. The colors of brocaded silks made by Merina weavers in Madagascar were not _____: magenta, blue, black, pink, yellow, and brown characterize pieces before 1880, while thereafter green, purple, and orange come to the fore. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. invariable
- B. generic
- C. conventional
- D. repetitious
- E. static
- F. traditional

6. This novel resembles a piece of music in the way it _____ variations on separate themes that contrast, conflict, and combine to form ever-more-fascinating patterns.

- A. deploys
- B. alters
- C. rejects
- D. marshals
- E. reiterates
- F. repudiates

7. The ocean's heat capacity (the amount of heat needed to change its temperature) is far greater than that of dry land and thus _____ the ocean's seasonal temperature changes.

- A. reflects
- B. mutes
- C. alters
- D. determines
- E. attenuates
- F. parallels

test 90 section 1 (medium)

1. Behavior dubbed reprehensible by the residents of the region is considered conventional, even _____ by those of the neighboring region; fortunately, people traveling between the two are resigned to this disparity.

- A. eccentric
- B. compulsory
- C. innovative
- D. unconscionable
- E. transparent

2. Though the play crackles with humor, the dialogue is less (i) _____ when it comes to the drama's emotional core. There the players tend to spell out their emotions in (ii) _____ aphorisms, and repeat them as necessary.

A. adroit	D. shrewd
B. ambiguous	E. jejune
C. transparent	F. riotous

3. In some ways, fascism can be viewed as (i) _____ social contract: The individual (ii) _____ nearly all his or her political identity and (iii) _____ to the state.

A. an arbitrary	D. cedes	G. machinations
B. an altruistic	E. ascribes	H. autonomy
C. the ultimate	F. denies	I. ascendancy

4. Just two centuries after the _____ of Chinese algebra under the Song, even the finest mathematicians of Ming China could not fathom earlier texts.

- A. apogee
- B. rebirth
- C. pinnacle
- D. nadir
- E. expansion
- F. initiation

5. Eubank's efforts to facilitate _____ between the two sides came to nothing but could be seen as an early blueprint for the historic agreement between the sides over ten years later.

- A. an alliance
- B. a rapprochement
- C. a conversation
- D. a reconciliation
- E. an altercation
- F. a quarrel

6. The essayist was known to suffer fools impatiently, but admittedly her vast intellect made that _____ largely justified. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. hauteur
- B. diffidence
- C. irritability
- D. imperturbability
- E. superciliousness
- F. timorousness

7. Discussion of planetary orbits is _____ in the context of climate history today, thanks to the acceptance of the thesis that periodic fluctuations in the Earth's axial tilt and precession affect the timing and severity of glacial cycles.

- A. controversial
- B. gratuitous
- C. commonplace
- D. unnecessary
- E. fraught
- F. pervasive

test 90 section 2 (medium)

1. Though acquaintances are first overwhelmed by his _____, they soon appreciate that, contrary to appearances, he is not without self-interest.

- A. egotism
- B. magnanimity
- C. ambition
- D. profligacy
- E. brilliance

2. In 1831, a domestic insurrection that had stirred central Italy was squelched by the Austrian army, but while this invasion destroyed the immediate results of the movement, it could not _____ the insurrections causes, which continued to be felt.

- A. ignore
- B. extirpate
- C. fathom
- D. anticipate
- E. underscore

3. If all stars are fiery gas balls like our own sun, and if the principle that the situation of our own solar system is not (i) _____ is (ii) _____, then one might think that many other stars should be surrounded by a retinue of planets and moons. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. obvious	D. true
B. permanent	E. redundant
C. special	F. tested

4. In considering whether to (i) _____ mergers of large corporations, governments now must consider the impact of such mergers on a country's international competitiveness; for example, the United States has allowed the mergers of (ii) _____ such as Lockheed and Boeing in the aerospace industry in the belief European consortiums, backed by government funding, could pose a threat to American (iii) _____ in that industry.

A. encourage	D. behemoths	G. chauvinism
B. prevent	E. offshoots	H. preeminence
C. investigate	F. mavericks	I. sovereignty

5. While Elizabeth Barrett Browning often wrote in restrictively intricate verse forms such as the Petrarchan sonnet, she also sometimes _____ formal constraints in poetry.

- A. defended
- B. neglected
- C. dismissed
- D. appropriated
- E. vindicated
- F. repudiated

6. Journal editors note that the peer review process has difficulty detecting ____: deliberate misinformation, if it is clever enough, might sail right through no matter how scrupulous the reviews.

- A. bias
- B. inconsistency
- C. fraud
- D. negligence
- E. duplicity
- F. carelessness

7. The rapid melting of glaciers around the globe, while an ominous reminder of global warming, has been ____ for archaeologists, since glaciers are storehouses of frozen materials from prehistoric times.

- A. a conundrum
- B. a nuisance
- C. an inconvenience
- D. a boon
- E. a windfall
- F. a puzzle

test 91 section 1 (medium)

1. When he first hypothesized the neutrino, Wolfgang Pauli's elation was not ____: he feared that he had postulated a particle that could not be detected though his concern turned out to be overblown.

- A. unshared
- B. untoward
- C. unprecedented
- D. unqualified
- E. unjustified

2. Standard thermal evolution models of giant planets employ initial conditions that are, to some extent, arbitrarily chosen, selected more for computational expediency than for physical accuracy. Since eventually the initial conditions (i)____ the evolving planet, this approach is more (ii)____ for mature planets than it is for young planets. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. become irrelevant to	D. involved
B. are recreated by	E. unpredictable
C. enforce constraints on	F. valid

3. For feminist scholars, Kessler-Harris's concern that the term "labor history" (i)____ images of male workers exclusively may be (ii)____; her own immense contributions to the field offer evidence that feminism has (iii)____ the questions posed by labor historians, moving women's concerns from the periphery closer to the center of labor history writing.

A. spurns	D. overly bold	G. negated
B. subsumes	E. too pessimistic	H. altered
C. evokes	F. unwittingly condescending	I. underscored

4. Though initially presented in a blaze of hyperbole, the thesis is stated more _____ in the ensuing paragraphs.

- A. humbly
- B. levelheadedly
- C. pretentiously
- D. convincingly
- E. showily
- F. soberly

5. The geometry student struggled with the request to demonstrate the _____ proposition, feeling that, since opposite angles were self-evidently equal, there was no need for a proof.

- A. patent
- B. nebulous
- C. arcane
- D. manifest
- E. illogical
- F. plausible

6. The safety features of modern cars have actually had _____ effect on people's driving: drivers are lulled into a false sense of security by their cars' sophistication and therefore drive less attentively.

- A. an unintended
- B. an unaccountable
- C. an inconsequential
- D. a deleterious
- E. a negligible
- F. a pernicious

7. Evidence of the human brain's _____ abounds: violinists, for example, tend to have larger cortical areas devoted to processing signals from their fingering hands than do non-violinists.

- A. synchronicity
- B. flexibility
- C. complexity
- D. malleability
- E. vulnerability
- F. sensitivity

test 91 section 2 (medium)

1. In its literature and its political discourse, the nation has created various narratives about itself that tend to _____ intractable social divisions in the interest of perpetuating a dubious myth of unity. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. denounce
- B. obscure
- C. corroborate
- D. anatomize

E. explicate

2. The city's traffic-planning department has been working hard to (i)_____ drivers. Closely spaced stop lights have been added on roads into town, causing delays. Pedestrian underpasses designed to allow traffic to flow freely across major intersections have been (ii)_____.

A. assist	D. enhanced
B. calm	E. stabilized
C. discourage	F. removed

3. Gelles urges readers of Abigail Adams' letters to consider their (i)_____: in Adams' era women were denied a public persona separate from that of their husbands. That said, Gelles then (ii)_____ to promote Adams from a writer of private letters to a public figure, arguing that she was a significant force for change.

A. value	D. strains
B. context	E. neglects
C. style	F. fails

4. Locke's history of the emergence of the theory of chemical structure encapsulates over 30 years of research on nineteenth-century chemistry. This is (i)_____, since structure theory emerged gradually through the efforts of a network of chemists distributed across several countries. Locke focuses on just a few key figures, a strategy that necessarily involves some (ii)_____ of detail but that leads to (iii)_____ account of the subject.

A. something often undertaken	D. sacrifice	G. a digestible
B. a regrettable ploy	E. redundancy	H. an untrustworthy
C. no mean feat	F. appreciation	I. a digressive

5. The author first accused the official of espionage in a 1981 book, and—though the case was far from _____, full of suppositions rather than compelling evidence—the accusation has been repeated relentlessly ever since.

- A. unambitious
- B. unconvincing
- C. unassailable
- D. implausible
- E. coherent
- F. airtight

6. Planetary systems are _____, with the orbits of even the largest planets able to evolve and migrate, especially in the early period when interaction between forming planets and the protoplanetary disc is strong. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. stable
- B. dynamic
- C. predictable
- D. idiosyncratic
- E. mutable
- F. enigmatic

7. In hindsight, it is easy to say that the geological evidence for ice ages was _____ and to wonder why such periods in the Earth's past were not recognized earlier.

- A. accessible
- B. overwhelming
- C. emerging
- D. irresistible
- E. intriguing
- F. tenuous

test 92 section 1 (medium)

1. The notion that prehistoric farming of Micronesia's Mariana Islands degraded the soils upon which savannas now occur is _____ by soil scientists, who attribute nutrient-poor savanna soils instead to long geological periods of tropical weathering.

- A. bolstered
- B. proposed
- C. contradicted
- D. elucidated
- E. revived

2. The reason geological activity on Mars is so (i) _____ while on Earth it remains (ii) _____ is that Earth's diameter is about twice the size of Mars. Because Mars is smaller than Earth, it cooled faster, and therefore it lost the interrial heat that drives tectonic activity.

A. localized	D. vital
B. moribund	E. unnoticed
C. violent	F. predictable

3. The (i) _____ of community ecology and population ecology is (ii) _____ insofar as the two subdisciplines partly address issues at different hierarchical levels and different spatial and temporal scales. But it is harmful insofar as it (iii) _____ the fields' mutual enrichment.

A. expansion	D. anomalous	G. hampers
B. divergence	E. timely	H. protracts
C. maturation	F. understandable	I. overstates

4. Machiavelli's painful account of the Pazzi political conspiracy and the recriminations that followed seems to have been penned with _____ intent: to dampen naive enthusiasm for such adventures by warning of their dangers. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. an equivocal
- B. an ulterior
- C. a prophylactic
- D. a pragmatic
- E. an inhibitory
- F. a duplicitous

5. Just as the short strings of a violin cannot produce the deep, long-wavelength notes of a double bass, so photons—which are vibrations not of strings but of electromagnetic fields—are _____ by the physical characteristics of objects that conduct electricity.

- A. conveyed
- B. bound
- C. amplified
- D. thwarted
- E. transmitted
- F. circumscribed

6. Most farmers alternate corn and soybean crops in their fields rather than periodically leaving fields unplanted, as was once customary, but such _____ cropping can deplete the organic content of the soil.

- A. strenuous
- B. consistent
- C. continuous
- D. unremitting
- E. haphazard
- F. slipshod

7. Kelly Cherry's fiction speaks to various postmodern debates regarding history and perception, but does not become so abstract that the reader feels the narrative has been _____ an intellectual agenda.

- A. dependent on
- B. ceded to
- C. surrendered to
- D. facilitated by
- E. hampered by
- F. expedited by

test 92 section 2 (medium)

1. Demographic relationships that have been _____ may not be useful targets for prolonged study: that very characteristic suggests that they may continue to change rapidly.

- A. static
- B. enervated
- C. intransigent
- D. moribund
- E. mutable

2. The lobbyist argues that current environmental regulations must be (i) _____ to prevent a recession, thus reviving the notion that economic progress and environmental protection are inherently (ii) _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. introduced	D. inviolable
B. softened	E. incompatible
C. reviewed	F. unsustainable

3. The apparent promise of clean alternatives to environmentally harmful fossil fuels might actually (i) _____ fossil-fuel industries by framing energy problems not as a matter of excessive consumption but rather as a remediable lack of clean energy production, thus enticing citizens to (ii) _____ the current energy consumption patterns from which fossil-fuel industries profit.

A. benefit	D. call attention to
------------	----------------------

B. pressure	E. demand changes in
C. transform	F. remain complacent about

4. The danger often facing authors of satirical works is that if the audience is not (i) _____ the joke, the piece may end up (ii) _____ the behavior it was trying to (iii) _____.

A. already frustrated by	D. reinforcing	G. conceal
B. willing to laugh at	E. depicting	H. support
C. discerning enough to get	F. elucidating	I. ridicule

5. In the nineteenth century, the dish known as lobster Newburg was sometimes associated with the culinary accessory known as the chafing dish, but Welsh rarebit was considered the truly _____ chafing dish recipe.

- A. indigenous
- B. sumptuous
- C. ubiquitous
- D. paradigmatic
- E. newfangled
- F. archetypal

6. The airline might receive fewer complaints if it got passengers to their destinations on time: in the past few years, only one airline has been more _____.

- A. unprofitable
- B. aggressive
- C. remiss
- D. dilatory
- E. impeccable
- F. assiduous

7. Selling a product with no known or even _____ substitute and with ever-growing demand for it seems as if it would be quite lucrative, but in fact the three biggest private-sector water companies in the world are eager to get out of the business.

- A. recognized
- B. practicable
- C. profitable
- D. acknowledged
- E. imaginable
- F. conceivable

test 93 section 1 (medium)

1. The ability to reproduce in her paintings the supple and shapely lines of her great-grandfather's paintings seems to have _____ her the way a particular cast of mind might be perpetuated in another family.

- A. devolved upon
- B. become occluded in
- C. ebbed in
- D. strengthened
- E. confounded

2. Various factors complicate researchers' efforts to study time spent on housework. For example, housework may not stand out much in respondents' memories because it is so (i) _____ everyday life, and (ii) _____ problems among survey subjects may thus be more severe than for other activities.

A. integral to	D. logistical
B. disruptive of	E. recollection
C. essential to	F. fabrication

3. The quiet, careful member of a collaborative, creative pair may naturally be (i) _____ by posterity in comparison with the brash, dramatic one. Braque and Picasso created Cubism together, but the mercurial Picasso is regarded as the star of the movement while Braque, because he was so much more (ii) _____, has been relatively (iii) _____ by history. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. diminished	D. understated	G. neglected
B. scrutinized	E. gifted	H. manipulated
C. favored	F. pretentious	I. tolerated

4. Mechanization of agriculture made it easy for farmers to simply plow more land and _____ soil loss in existing fields: soil loss was slow enough that farmers saw the problem as someone else's concern.

- A. obscure
- B. ignore
- C. prevent
- D. avoid
- E. discount
- F. anticipate

5. The bird-watchers' _____ distinguishing personal interpretations from factual observations was a liability in their stated goal of obtaining objective information about the everyday behavior of ravens. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. zeal for
- B. exactness in
- C. ineptitude at
- D. maladroitness in
- E. indifference toward
- F. fervor for

6. Since it is an incredible challenge to detect dark matter directly, scientists have _____ existence from its gravitational effects on shaping galaxies and other large-scale structures.

- A. isolated
- B. confirmed
- C. inferred
- D. surmised
- E. documented
- F. hypothesized

7. Responsibility for the nation's decline rests squarely with a people who take for granted their claims to preeminence but do not _____ interest in or commitment to actually maintaining it.

- A. foresee
- B. rebuff

- C. evince
- D. reject
- E. predict
- F. betray

test 93 section 2 (hard)

1. The employees tasked with modeling scenarios for their company's bankruptcy assumed that their work was merely _____: none of them expected the firm to file for bankruptcy immediately.

- A. a penance .
- B. an inevitability
- C. a necessity
- D. a liability
- E. a contingency

2. There is a somewhat (i)_____ trend emerging in property law today: though property law historically has been used to legitimize the conquest of indigenous lands, indigenous groups worldwide are now (ii)_____ this same body of law to lay claim to their own cultural resources.

A. ironic	D. circumventing
B. untimely	E. employing
C. redundant	F. invalidating

3. Among geophysicists there was considerably less (i)_____ the proposed environment measure than the (ii)_____ media accounts of the conference would suggest: the debate was often animated but never uncivil. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. ambivalence toward	D. sanitized
B. satisfaction with	E. sensationalized
C. rancor over	F. poignant

4. Strains of *Prochlorococcus* plankton have such (i)_____ sequences at their small subunit RNA genes that they would be considered the same species by the normal criteria used by microbiologists. By contrast, the same strains exhibit such ecological (ii)_____ that they would be considered (iii)_____ species by normal ecological criteria.

A. similar	D. consistency	G. endemic
B. unusual	E. diversity	H. discrete
C. complex	F. vigor	I. ancestral

5. The essay, focusing on the intricacies of complex corporate accounting practices, was _____ almost to a fault, leaving the impression that these practices are rather straightforward.

- A. lucid
- B. punctilious
- C. reductive
- D. exhaustive
- E. intelligible
- F. comprehensive

6. Given that the detailed scientific description of four-legged animals' walking gaits is now over a century old, it is _____ that so many artists, taxidermists, and others responsible for depicting animals get leg positions wrong.

- A. exasperating
- B. unsurprising
- C. satisfying
- D. predictable
- E. remarkable
- F. frustrating

7. The Harlem Renaissance has been studied extensively as a literary and visual arts movement, but recent scholars have described the role of music as more than _____, in fact, as having made the Harlem Renaissance possible.

- A. necessary
- B. mundane
- C. essential
- D. emotional
- E. incidental
- F. peripheral

test 94 section 1 (medium)

1. The simultaneous ascension in the postwar United States of both the bulldozer and children's "bulldozer books" was far from _____; it reflected parallels between the landscapes of fact and feeling in a country undergoing massive physical upheaval.

- A. coincidental
- B. calculated
- C. discouraging
- D. significant
- E. disruptive

2. Far from being (i) _____ the corporate world because of cutbacks, serious scientific researchers are playing a growing role in innovation in certain firms. The explanation for this apparent paradox is that innovative companies are not looking for full-time scientists; they want moonlighting academics, professors (ii) _____ to work temporary projects.

A. banished from	D. disinclined
B. relegated to	E. unauthorized
C. reinstated in	F. disposed

3. With so many scientific papers chasing so few pages in the most prestigious journals, the winners could be the ones most likely to oversell themselves—to trumpet amazing or important results that later turn out to be false. This would produce a (i) _____ picture of scientific knowledge, with less (ii) _____ but more (iii) _____ results either relegated to obscure journals or left unpublished.

A. comprehensive	D. dramatic	G. controversial
B. bewildering	E. threatening	H. obvious
C. distorted	F. arbitrary	I. accurate

4. The teacher was known for being stern with _____ students, but kind to any member of the class who seemed the least bit tractable. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. complaisant
- B. supercilious
- C. recalcitrant
- D. pliable
- E. incorrigible
- F. mendacious

5. Piersma and Gill suggest that bar-tailed godwits—long-billed shorebirds of the Eurasian and Alaskan tundra—rank among the most _____ of the long-range fliers, traveling 11,000 kilometers nonstop across the Pacific.

- A. unpredictable
- B. versatile
- C. erratic
- D. unflagging
- E. renowned
- F. indefatigable

6. While prudence is recognized as a kind of virtue, there is nonetheless a tendency to view someone who is prudent as, in some sense, _____, too narrow and dull to partake of spontaneously arising opportunities.

- A. timid
- B. laudable
- C. wanting
- D. inculpable
- E. exemplary
- F. deficient

7. The society of the ancient Moche of northern Peru was _____ one : it was ruled by local lords who were overseen by an elite composed of administrative and religious authorities.

- A. an enduring
- B. an inflexible
- C. an abiding
- D. a stratified
- E. a cohesive
- F. a hierarchical

test 94 section 2 (medium)

1. The nineteenth-century legislator Robert Barnwell Rhett was known for using language so intemperate that even in an era of considerable political _____, it came almost to occupy a category of its own. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. malfeasance
- B. upheaval
- C. hypocrisy
- D. invective
- E. retrenchment

2. The enlightenment philosophers of the eighteenth century acknowledged that unrestricted freedom to publish could (i) _____ motivated by envy or hatred, but they hoped that any such (ii) _____ enabled by expanded liberties would suffer from being publicly exposed.

A. encourage blandishments	D. evasion
----------------------------	------------

B. facilitate calumny	E. defamation
C. constrain vituperation	F. prurience

3. The man was an avowed (i)_____: he made no secret of his disdain for (ii)_____ endeavor.

A. partisan	D. political
B. dilettante	E. aesthetic
C. philistine	F. amateur

4. It is a common complaint that female explorers have been unfairly (i)_____ in modern historical accounts. Amelia Earhart, Freya Stark, and Gertrude Bell may be (ii)_____, but only a special would recognize the names of Fanny Workman or Janet Wulsin. Whether that is a matter of (iii)_____ or a fair reflection of their achievements is debatable.

A. scrutinized	D. well enough known	G. analysis
B. ignored	E. largely overlooked	H. prejudice
C. attacked	F. subject to criticism	I. objectivity

5. In this instance, aesthetics _____ structure, and the unconventional design of the long, slender-decked bridge allowed its deck to move sideways excessively.

- A. prevailed over
- B. harmonized with
- C. bowed to
- D. dominated
- E. invigorated
- F. complemented

6. Her success is not _____, for she writes clearly about complicated subjects and provides lucid explanations and penetrating insights. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. undeniable
- B. undeserved
- C. unanticipated
- D. unparalleled
- E. unsurpassed
- F. unexpected

7. Although the shrewdness of Lynn Nottage's protagonist does seem _____, it is worth remembering that this character is trying to operate a business in a place where there is little room for heart.

- A. appealing
- B. anachronistic
- C. hypocritical
- D. attractive
- E. callous
- F. insensitive

test 95 section 1 (medium)

1. Throughout the High Middle Ages, the English government became increasingly ____: the documents produced in the eleventh century could be placed on one large table, while the documents produced in the thirteenth fill whole rooms.

- A. despotic
- B. ceremonial
- C. aristocratic
- D. prolix
- E. insular

2. Professor Redfield describes in his recent book publishing as dark as it is deep, even as one hidebound industry. Indeed, it is facing a profound change in its product model, but is so (i) ____ its past as to be (ii) ____ opportunities offered by technological change.

A. indebted in	D. unable to seize
B. encumbered by	E. capable of seeking
C. irrelevant with	F. definite to circumvent

3. By sucking people into towns and draining the countryside of communities and workers, the passenger train (i) ____ its reason for being: moving people between country districts and urban centers. The major (ii) ____ urbanization in the United States, the railway fell victim to it. Once the overwhelming majority of nonelective journeys were either very long or very short, it became (iii) ____ for people to undertake them in planes or cars.

A. vindicated	D. facilitator of	G. unusual
B. discovered	E. counterpoint to	H. sensible
C. destroyed	F. consequence of	I. inconsistent

4. Even though water quality in the main reservoir was ____, pollution was worsening in the tributaries because of high level of nitrates and phosphates that had already endangered drinking water in some areas.

- A. deteriorating
- B. declining
- C. stable
- D. steady
- E. improving
- F. acceptable

5. "Revolutionary" and "unique" are words that have become ____: every century in human history is described as unique, and every year, somewhere in the world, some event is characterized as revolutionary.

- A. overused
- B. interchangeable
- C. confused
- D. distorted
- E. trite
- F. contentious

6. As the global climate warms, some deserts, expanding to higher latitudes, are beginning to ____ fertile regions. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. augment
- B. endanger
- C. destroy

- D. displace
- E. supplant
- F. enrich

7. While Takaezu's ceramic pieces are highly distinctive, her body of work as a whole can feel _____ to critics who wish to track it since she has never dated or conscientiously documented her creations.

- A. edifying
- B. nebulous
- C. austere
- D. anachronistic
- E. instructive
- F. amorphous

test 95 section 2 (medium)

1. The notion that the director is the center of the team has been _____, but in fact it has not been accepted by academia.

- A. rejected
- B. proven
- C. abnegated
- D. enduring
- E. presented

2. The paradoxical characteristic of the reliable employee Donna is her _____, as we consider her usual feigning illness to escape from her labor. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. halcyon
- B. charlatan
- C. malingering
- D. retribution
- E. earnestness

3. Researchers in University of Maryland discover that many people subconsciously think that in assessment of others competence and warmth are (i)_____: when they feel someone is highly capable, they will assert that he or she must have a tendency to be (ii)_____.

A. clearly interconnected	D. passive
B. inversely related	E. ephemeral
C. physically paralyzed	F. unfeeling

4. Some chemists argue that although molecular motors are (i)_____, they are (ii)_____ by themselves; nevertheless, the chemical principles behind them might be (iii)_____: using the same light-activated mechanism that drives certain molecular motors, researchers have developed around 100 drug-like compound that can be switched on or off in response to light.

A. intricate	D. promising	G. well established
B. untested	E. straightforward	H. highly valuable
C. appealing	F. useless	I. imperfectly understood

5. In *The Balance Within*, Sternberg _____ hyperbole, opting for an admirable simplicity and clarity while introducing neuroimmunology as a potential foundation of psychosomatic medicine.

- A. evokes
- B. transcends
- C. elicits
- D. condemns
- E. eschews
- F. avoids

6. Williams argues that philosophy has become _____ occupation these days, and that it should rather be “part of a more general attempt to make the best sense of our life.”

- A. a recondite
- B. a challenging
- C. an esoteric
- D. an exacting
- E. a salacious
- F. an altruistic

7. As modern organizations amass more and more digital information, they need guidance on how to deal with the information surplus in a way that is more _____ than simply increasing their storage capacity.

- A. sustainable
- B. onerous
- C. judicious
- D. discriminating
- E. parsimonious
- F. prohibitive

test 96 section 1 (medium)

1. Except for the special circumstance in which historians record events they themselves have witnessed, scholars can only obtain historical facts through _____ sources.

- A. biased
- B. first-handed
- C. written
- D. unreliable
- E. intermediary

2. With the rate of technological (i) _____ accelerating—many people now consider a personal computer (ii) _____ after three years—the question of how to properly dispose of old equipment is no small matter. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. affordability	D. outdated
B. complexity	E. familiar
C. obsolescence	F. inestimable

3. The general statement that all objects are (i) _____ by gravity (ii) _____ is not (iii) _____. In reality, if a feather and a lump of iron were dropped at the same time from the same place, we should not expect them to hit the floor at the same time. In order to reconcile the general statement with real-world phenomena, we must take into consideration all of the forces that act upon objects.

A. molded	D. in proportion to their mass	G. self-contradictory
B. accelerated	E. at the same rate	H. novel
C. constrained	F. under special circumstances	I. self-evident

4. The indigenous uprising in Bolivia in 2008 was not _____: in 1781 indigenous people took over the area near present-day La Paz in what constituted the biggest challenge to the Spanish who then controlled Bolivia.

- A. unsuccessful
- B. unprecedented
- C. unpredictable
- D. disregarded
- E. unique
- F. random

5. In a time when so much new concert music failed to speak to listeners, the composer's symphonies expressed with _____ wit and scorching emotional power the tragic history he lived through. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. torpid
- B. insouciant
- C. patronizing
- D. caustic
- E. phlegmatic
- F. stinging

6. The team of physicists regarded the data as too _____ not to study with fresh eyes and first questions.

- A. anomalous
- B. singular
- C. implausible
- D. incidental
- E. confounding
- F. ancillary

7. Ruth Carter's campaigns for Congress were pretty _____: as a liberal in a deeply conservative district, she was virtually certain to lose.

- A. conventional
- B. underhanded
- C. contentious
- D. quixotic
- E. indecorous
- F. unrealistic

test 96 section 2 (hard)

1. As a result of lacking a strong opposing organization to _____, the chief focused their rancor on one another at the conference where the issues were put forward and intended to be resolved.

- A. immolate
- B. excoriate
- C. parley

- D. exterminate
E. collaborate

2. Gilbert saw himself as an investigator, a role whose mental state he (i)_____ with that of (ii)_____. Consequently he never accepted an academic position or wrote a comprehensive textbook, so that despite his years of intellectual leadership he never established a school of followers or articulated a distinctly Gilbertian creed.

A. contrasted	D. an administrator
B. combined	E. a teacher
C. equated	F. an engineer

3. There may be something (i)_____ about the very idea of jest, because it obeys no rules. The art of caricature, by contrast, is (ii)_____.

A. inappropriate	D. innately spontaneous
B. expansive	E. carelessly undisciplined
C. calculated	F. severely finite

4. Climate change is posited to be a frequent factor in mass extinctions by some scientist who speculate that minor climate shifts can trigger a catastrophic cascade of effects. Although this pattern is (i)_____ in that it confirms warnings about our own possibly dire future, it is also somehow (ii)_____ as it sets forth a context for today's turbulent weather as (iii)_____ in a natural, cyclical process.

A. alarming	D. contradictory	G. unanticipated
B. eccentric	E. reassuring	H. unpredictable
C. contentious	F. disquieting	I. unexceptional

5. Although the courts have _____ an extremely flexible test for determining the admissibility of expert testimony, that does not mean that all experts will be allowed to testify.

- A. underwritten
B. administered
C. waived
D. renounced
E. endorsed
F. rescinded

6. The _____ of native South American textiles at the time of the Spanish conquest should not be surprising: it represented the apogee of one of the world's oldest and most sophisticated weaving and dyeing traditions. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. splendor
B. eccentricity
C. diversity
D. brilliance
E. practicality
F. popularity

7. By 1600, France's sense of itself as nation bound by a shared destiny was _____, but over the course of the seventeenth century, French culture regained the strength it had had in the Middle Ages.

- A. absent
- B. innocuous
- C. benign
- D. unique
- E. precarious
- F. uncertain

test 97 section 1 (medium)

1. Because the organization she inherited was remarkably _____, her first priority was the establishment of a vigorous fund-raising campaign.

- A. controversial
- B. high-minded
- C. impecunious
- D. multifarious
- E. antiquated

2. The geographer held a (i) _____ view of the succession of theoretical trends(environmental determinism, spatial determinism, and various types of critical theory) in her field, maintaining that theory can (ii) _____ what is transpiring in a complex environment by focusing excessively on the favored schemes and variables of the moment. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. self-contradictory	D. exacerbate
B. sanguine	E. obfuscate
C. deprecatory	F. magnify

3. By the end of the 1970s, the postmodern novel had degenerated from a bold attempt to (i) _____ the conventions of traditional narrative into a literary style as (ii) _____ as any other. There are, it seems, (iii) _____ number of ways to avoid telling a straightforward story.

A. refine	D. predictable	G. a limited
B. perpetuate	E. inescapable	H. a variable
C. subvert	F. comprehensible	I. an inexhaustible

4. The workers' rights group was concerned that a new regulation allowing employees to request flexible working conditions was _____ because employers in turn were allowed to deny such requests at will.

- A. flawed
- B. nugatory
- C. incomprehensible
- D. opaque
- E. worthless
- F. disingenuous

5. _____ as ever at eighty-three, Williamson berated the journalists hovering outside his home with a constant stream of abuse.

- A. Fractious

- B. Irascible
- C. Malicious
- D. Reticent
- E. Taciturn
- F. Voluble

6. The difficulty of understanding subtle behavioral cues in dolphins is undisputed, but this does not obviate the need for the evidentiary foundation of any study of dolphin behavior to be _____.

- A. substantial
- B. outdated
- C. solid
- D. circumstantial
- E. hypothetical
- F. unconfirmed

7. Although Wanda Coleman's sonnets sometimes employ _____ word choices, they aptly bring to the fore a distinctly modern anxiety.

- A. ambiguous
- B. archaic
- C. puzzling
- D. surprising
- E. fusty
- F. disturbing

test 97 section 2 (medium)

1. Unlike some models of mathematical tasks that distinguish between lower and higher cognitive demands, Carolyn Kieran's model focuses only on the type of algebraic activity and thus is not _____ with regard to cognitive demand.

- A. consistent
- B. equitable
- C. indeterminate
- D. discriminatory
- E. extraneous

2. All the scholars at the conference agree on the character of the general philosophical concepts under discussion, but this does not imply _____ with regard to details.

- A. an element of controversy
- B. an excess of uncertainty
- C. a lack of conformity
- D. a mood of curiosity
- E. a community of opinion

3. The (i) _____ of the entrepreneur that the microfinance boom has helped foster is understandably appealing. But thinking that everyone is, and should be, an entrepreneur can encourage a tendency to (ii) _____ the virtues of larger businesses and the income that a steady job can provide.

A. demise	D. emphasize
B. evolution	E. advertise
C. cult	F. underrate

4. In the early twentieth century, rural women in the United States could feel caught between, on one hand, national myths upholding a "natural" lifestyle that by definition seemed to eschew science and technology, and, on the other hand, a desire to (i)_____ the new, modern standards of mechanized household practice that (ii)_____ their (iii)_____ by aligning them more and more with city women and modern life generally. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. disrupt	D. appeared to accentuate	G. distinctiveness
B. adopt	E. helped to explain	H. skepticism
C. improve	F. threatened to compromise	I. satisfaction

5. For those attempting the art, the record of past futurologists' prognostications can be _____: it includes many confident predictions of technological revolution that never happened, such as domed cities and nuclear-powered cars.

- A. incomplete
- B. intriguing
- C. mundane
- D. humbling
- E. prosaic
- F. chastening

6. Advertising's role in popular music culture has been redefined: instead of a last resort for the creation and distribution of popular music, advertising now functions as a _____ of music that might otherwise go unheard.

- A. promoter
- B. reflection
- C. component
- D. foe
- E. champion
- F. rival

7. Though the art of writing was well established in Egypt and Mesopotamia long before the Shang period, the Chinese writing that appeared then seems to have been an entirely _____ development. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. unique
- B. banal
- C. homegrown
- D. practical
- E. routine
- F. indigenous

test 98 section 1 (medium)

1. Suspicion is arguably a natural self-protective instinct essential to the survival of individuals and societies: a human being or community that is totally _____ is inviting trouble.

- A. exultant
- B. regressive
- C. reclusive
- D. ingenuous
- E. apprehensive

2. In general memoirs focus sharply on particular, and particularly memorable, events rather than on the entire life. This (i)_____ structure inevitably emphasizes drama at the expense of (ii)_____.

A. circular	D. excitement
B. episodic	E. completeness
C. panoramic	F. plausibility

3. Human brains are amazing organs but they are not perfect. Cognitive biases, as we know, sometimes produce errors. Yet the term "error" could be (i)_____ in that it suggests that there might be (ii)_____ way in which cognition should work. Such a binary opposition is (iii)_____.

A. corrective	D. a uniquely correct	G. incontrovertible
B. serviceable	E. a surprisingly novel	H. reductive
C. problematic	F. an infinitely fluid	I. warranted

4. Although the writer meant for the book to serve as a kind of tribute to motherhood, the approach here is hardly a _____ affair.

- A. memorable
- B. saccharine
- C. problematic
- D. divisible
- E. sentimental
- F. controversial

5. Although biologists know that thousands of species of microbes and invertebrates inhabit one square meter of temperate grassland soil, the identities of those creatures and their contributions to sustaining the biosphere remain _____.

- A. obscure
- B. self-evident
- C. immaterial
- D. murky
- E. contested
- F. obvious

6. Although a dedicated reader of the book can _____ a brief of chronology of Chappell's life, the book is nevertheless not a real biography of Chappelle.

- A. miss
- B. imagine
- C. overlook
- D. extract
- E. ferret out
- F. summarize

7. Physicians today increasingly rely on endoscopic surgery, _____ large scalpels and clamps in favor of endoscopy's cameras and flexible tools that can snake into the body through tiny holes.

- A. designing
- B. de-emphasizing
- C. rediscovering
- D. engineering
- E. downplaying
- F. rejecting

test 98 section 2 (hard)

1. With Robert Lowell's death, poetry appears to have shrunk from the ground he commandeered: his grand conception of the poet as public conscience has _____ in the present era of notably small and private poems. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. met little resistance
- B. experienced increased momentum
- C. garnered newfound credibility
- D. generated unqualified enthusiasm
- E. gained scant traction

2. Her lecture was entertaining though unoriginal: she hoped that by (i)_____ her audience, she could (ii)_____ the hackneyed observations on which her argument depended.

A. amusing	D. compensate for
B. goading	E. accentuate
C. boring	F. allude to

3. Around the early 1980s, technology companies began creating the first portable machines that resemble today's laptop computers. Still, for many years, large and bulky desktop computers (i)_____ the market, because you always had to (ii)_____ something for portability. Compared with laptops, desktops had more power, bigger screens, more comfortable keyboards, and more storage space.

A. found little room in	D. enhance
B. held sway in	E. sacrifice
C. lost share in	F. delay

4. Many people fail to (i)_____ memoirs and novels, a tendency arguably (ii)_____ by discussions of the "graphic novel": that term is applied to any narrative drawn in the manner of a comic book, even ones like Marjane Satrapi's *Persepolis*, which (iii)_____.

A. appreciate	D. anticipated	G. concerns historical events
B. distinguish	E. delineated	H. receives considerable acclaim
C. remember	F. exacerbated	I. invites complex interpretation

5. The mayor's hunger for power was _____: in her own heart, she was utterly convinced that all her energies were being poured out in the service of a cause greater than herself.

- A. despicable
- B. unacknowledged
- C. logical
- D. unquenchable
- E. subconscious
- F. understandable

6. Psychoanalysis has increasingly immured itself behind high walls of jargon by using terms like "introjective identification" and "countertransference" and this emphasis on _____ is in part an effort to preserve the field's waning mystique. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. conjecture
- B. abstruseness
- C. opacity
- D. consistency
- E. speculation
- F. terminology

7. Velazquez' painting can be somewhat _____: one cannot get on familiar terms with them, but only admire their colorful polish from afar.

- A. pedestrian
- B. slippery
- C. ominous
- D. prosaic
- E. flamboyant
- F. elusive

test 99 section 1 (hard)

1. The researchers theorized that people in power focus so keenly on their own prerogatives that they become oblivious to those around them and that their subordinates, not wanting to provoke the boss, _____ this process.

- A. subvert
- B. imitate
- C. abet
- D. expose
- E. underestimate

2. Intuitively, something is considered to the matter if, and only if, there is mass along with energy and/or momentum associated with it. In other words, possession of mass along with energy and/or momentum is regarded as (i) _____, rather than (ii) _____, property of matter.

A. an optimal	D. a unique
B. an essential	E. an irreducible
C. a contingent	F. an accidental

3. Although the (i) _____ and the not infrequent appearance of terms like synaptogenesis and N-methyl-D-aspartate glutamate receptor can be (ii) _____ in a book aimed at the general reader, Konner's overall style is (iii) _____ enough that you feel as though you are in the company of a helpful and hopeful teacher who is eager to share what he's found.

A. occasional glimpses of humor	D. placating	G. disputatious
B. deft deployment of examples	E. galvanizing	H. conversational
C. repeated use of jargon	F. daunting	I. baroque

4. While the environmental detection of nuclear explosions has become _____, the ability to detect nuclear weapons programs well before they result in a nuclear device would better serve security objectives. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. immediate
- B. unnecessary
- C. redundant
- D. straightforward
- E. surreptitious
- F. unproblematic

5. Eliot's satire stops short of cruelty; inveterately _____, even when it comes to her most flawed characters, her default authorial positions is one of pity.

- A. exacting
- B. magnanimous
- C. demanding
- D. considerate
- E. generous
- F. self-indulgent

6. Psychologist once _____ fiction as a way of understanding people because it is made up, but in the past 25 years cognitive psychologists have developed a new appreciation for the significance of fictional stories.

- A. overlooked
- B. countenanced
- C. underestimated
- D. scorned
- E. sanctioned
- F. disparaged

7. Geologists' customary distinction between planetary mantle and core material appears increasingly _____: liquid oxides can be considered either molten mantle constituents or electrically conducting core components.

- A. incontrovertible
- B. untenable
- C. dogmatic
- D. flawed
- E. contradictory
- F. confusing

test 99 section 2 (medium)

1. The fanciful notion that the legislative initiative would bring unlimited social benefits has soured into an equally _____ mood of skepticism and distrust. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. valid
- B. pessimistic
- C. unanticipated
- D. pragmatic
- E. baseless

2. The use of the term "greenhouse effect" is a complete _____, because it is not a veracious description of such a complicated transformation.

- A. anomaly
- B. spontaneity

- C. mishap
- D. misnomer
- E. appositeness

3. While several relationships fell by the wayside under the pressure of conflicting opinion, none was more affecting to the writer than her relationship with her brother. Her letters document a steady (i)_____ of feeling: intense pride in him giving way to more moderate respect, trust (ii)_____ as feeling of betrayal come to dominate.

A. emergence	D. materializing
B. cessation	E. intensifying
C. erosion	F. evaporating

4. For whom is Shipton's A New History of Jazz intended? It is written in (i)_____ language and contains no extended musical analysis, suggesting that it is meant for amateurs. But as it is twice as long as the next-longest history of the subject, my guess is that general readers will be put off by its (ii)_____. On the other hand, its great length is precisely what enables Shipton to avoid (iii)_____ the story of jazz's development.

A. accessible	D. paucity of exposition	G. belaboring
B. ornate	E. proliferation of detail	H. oversimplifying
C. graphic	F. preponderance of jargon	I. extolling

5. Most scholarship that is produced these days vanishes without apparent _____; 98 percent of all publications in the arts and humanities are never cited.

- A. credibility
- B. impact
- C. ignominy
- D. disgrace
- E. influence
- F. attribution

6. Booker T. Washington was always a welcome guest at the White House: although his aloofness _____ intimate conversation, the president felt entirely at ease in his company.

- A. compromised
- B. ruled out
- C. presupposed
- D. precluded
- E. called for
- F. necessitated

7. Researchers concluded that although the success of pearl millet crops in the region varied with seasonal climatic conditions, cultivation remains _____ because of pearl millet's predisposition to perform under stressful growing conditions, including drought. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. erratic
- B. advantageous
- C. inconsistent
- D. prevalent
- E. impractical
- F. expedient

test 100 section 1 (medium)

1. Some of writers whose interviews with the Paris Review are included in this volume were caught in the final years of their lives, and these interviews thus lend _____ mood to the collection.

- A. an autumnal
- B. a scintillating
- C. a liberal
- D. an apolitical
- E. a cosmopolitan

2. The widespread (i)_____ that has accompanied economic growth is not the result of the people's adopting the leader's own standards. Her personal (ii)_____ is recognized by all.

A. conformity	D. influence
B. corruption	E. integrity
C. frugality	F. traditionalism

3. The newly discovered fossil skeletons have the fins, scales, and other attributes of a giant fish, but also the telling anatomical traits of (i)_____ creature, such as the beginnings of digits, protowrists, and joints resembling elbows on the forward fins. The specimen is a fish with features that (ii)_____ the emergence of land animals and is thus a (iii)_____ of amphibians, reptiles, dinosaurs, and mammals.

A. a diurnal	D. anticipate	G. derivative
B. a marine	E. impede	H. predator
C. a transitional	F. supersede	I. predecessor

4. The Chancellor castigated one regime for its mistreatment of political opponents, whereas he inexplicably _____ another that had committed similar acts.

- A. adjured
- B. exculpated
- C. impugned
- D. neglected
- E. cosseted
- F. absolved

5. She had a feeling that was not yet fully articulated, _____ sense that something extraordinary and wonderful awaited her. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. an inchoate
- B. an onerous
- C. a burdensome
- D. an incipient
- E. a foreboding
- F. an enchanting

6. One commentator charged that the discipline of political science has not merely ignored pressing problems of contemporary society but has in fact been used to _____ erroneous public policies.

- A. identify
- B. overcome
- C. rationalize

- D. investigate
- E. explore
- F. justify

7. In some ways, the success of Aishwarya Rai _____ the growing international recognition of India's film industry: in 2003 she was the first Indian actor to be one the jury at the Cannes Film Festival.

- A. controverts
- B. personifies
- C. eclipses
- D. epitomizes
- E. explains
- F. belies

test 100 section 2 (medium)

1. Writing accessories such as letter openers, pen trays, and memorandum pads became tremendously popular during the Victorian era, and by far the most ubiquitous of such _____ was the letter box.

- A. epistles
- B. appurtenances
- C. vexations
- D. vestiges
- E. frugalities

2. It is possible to (i) _____ the benefits of diplomatic dialogue, because although it can certainly alleviate some of the problems that afflicts us, it is not a (ii) _____.

- A. overstate D. panacea
- B. compromise E. placebo
- C. extend F. liability

3. Seemingly to compensate for the (i) _____ nature of her subject, in her review the theater critic (ii) _____ a casual chatty style. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. undemanding	D. opted for
B. rarefied	E. misused
C. well-defined	F. invited

4. Because leadership in the computer hacker group is extremely (i) _____, when law enforcement agencies arrested several prominent members, taking them offline, the group (ii) _____. Instead, it continues to operate, sometimes under its own name, sometimes under other names. The names are (iii) _____, as are the members of the group: anyone, anywhere, is free to work behind its mask.

A. fluid	D. adopted new practices	G. idiosyncratic
B. efficient	E. replaced its leadership	H. fungible
C. hierarchical	F. did not collapse	I. misleading

5. It is readily apparent that structures and functions of immature forms in organism as diverse as butterflies and frogs are not necessarily mere _____ of adult traits but represent specific adaptations to life in the niches occupied by juveniles.

- A. miniatures
- B. vestiges
- C. embellishments
- D. precursors
- E. elaborations
- F. forerunners

6. _____ neuroscience's explanatory power, Patricia Churchland maintains that questions that have been discussed to no effect by philosophers over many centuries are solvable once rephrased as questions of neuroscience.

- A. A chronicler of
- B. A skeptic about
- C. An advocate of
- D. An apologist for
- E. A doubter of
- F. A dissenter from

7. The firm's startling admission of bookkeeping irregularities called into question the _____ of the oversight that government exercises over the financial health of private business.

- A. sufficiency
- B. efficacy
- C. authenticity
- D. legitimacy
- E. propriety
- F. constitutionality

test 101 section 1 (medium)

1. It ought to be surprising that the bank falsified the numbers on its accounts; it is truly shocking that such _____ was documented, in black and white, and that regulators found it and did nothing about it. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. chicanery
- B. raillery
- C. enmity
- D. sagacity
- E. probity

2. Because scientific breakthroughs tend to occur when a prevailing theory's predictions start to fail, scientists sometimes find it (i) _____ when a theory persists—as the standard model of particle physics has done—in making (ii) _____ predictions.

A. productive	D. bold
B. frustrating	E. abstract
C. surprising	F. correct

3. The chocolate company's scientists hoped that once they had (i)_____ the chemical makeup of cocoa beans, the knowledge would enable them to produce (ii)_____ the beans' taste, which could then be used to (iii)_____ future failures in the cocoa bean supply.

A. altered	D. subtle transformations in	G. prevent
B. unlocked	E. accurate descriptions of	H. mitigate
C. activated	F. a synthetic replication of	I. restrict

4. Although Harman has not produced _____ biography of Robert Louis Stevenson, her understanding of what it takes to write a book enables her to account for Stevenson's delirious sprints toward and away from publication.

- A. a controversial
- B. a flawed
- C. a definitive
- D. an idiosyncratic
- E. an unsound
- F. an authoritative

5. Despite the _____ amount of high-quality data on the issue of underrepresentation of women professors in math-intensive fields, particularly in upper-level positions, myths and misunderstandings prevail.

- A. appropriate
- B. suspicious
- C. significant
- D. overwhelming
- E. substantial
- F. dubious

6. An academic with a questionable record in either teaching, administration, or research may still be well regarded at many schools, but simultaneous failure in all three areas normally results in _____ by superiors. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. exculpation
- B. dismissal
- C. impeachment
- D. disapprobation
- E. censure
- F. acquittal

7. The sleight of hand of architects whose ambition is to add subtly and seamlessly to early twentieth-century Beaux Arts buildings contradicts a first principle of historic preservation; the _____ historical periods should be clear.

- A. changes within
- B. demarcation of
- C. essence of
- D. continuation of
- E. lines between
- F. explication of

test 101 section 2 (medium)

1. Dialogue exchanges indicating deep-seated rivalries among the characters abound in the novel, but they are almost always associated with _____ events—everyday commercial transactions, for instance, or the preparation of an evening meal.

- A. intimate
- B. sporadic
- C. quotidian
- D. contentious
- E. revelatory

2. In considering human behavior, theoreticians tend to emphasize cognition in spite of the fact that psychological research suggests the _____ of affect: it suggests that our behavior derives above all from fast, automated emotional judgements.

- A. inefficacy
- B. elusiveness
- C. spontaneity
- D. irrationality
- E. primacy

3. It is possible that the earliest terrestrial plants were (i) _____ natural enemies, such as herbivores. By the mid-Carboniferous period, however, there was abundant evidence in the form of fossil leaves with signs of bite marks—that plants were (ii) _____ animal attack.

A. free from	D. experiencing
B. influenced by	E. avoiding
C. overwhelmed by	F. exploiting

4. It appears that the terrestrial biosphere has been absorbing a significant fraction of anthropogenic CO₂, thereby slowing down the rate of global climate change. However, the (i) _____ of this (ii) _____ is not (iii) _____: if pushed too far, the biosphere might become a net source of CO₂, thereby accelerating climate change and causing a positive feedback loop.

A. complexity	D. additional information	G. imminent
B. actuality	E. formidable challenge	H. surprising
C. continuation	F. compensatory mechanism	I. guaranteed

5. One early sign of this new thirst for _____ is the fact that eight members of the committee on professional conduct have already recused themselves in the name of unbiased justice.

- A. enlightenment
- B. exactitude
- C. knowledge
- D. probity
- E. pugnacity
- F. integrity

6. Recent advances in the study of desert varnish have been a boon to geologists, allowing them to date surface features and establish regional climate histories in _____ detail.

- A. novel
- B. realistic
- C. unprecedented
- D. superfluous
- E. extraneous
- F. surprising

7. The breathless pace of the Broadway adaptation of Alice Walker's *The Color Purple* was _____, given the adaptation's determination to cram in so many of the incidents that appear in the original source. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. unremarkable
- B. inevitable
- C. surprising
- D. excessive
- E. unavoidable
- F. unexpected

test 102 section 1 (hard)

1. The development of junior high schools in American education was motivated by _____ rather than by pedagogical validity: these schools provided an efficient and inexpensive way to eliminate overcrowding in the high schools.

- A. idealism
- B. reform
- C. expediency
- D. privilege
- E. tradition

2. Although Kito Hiroshi's portrait of Edo Japan as (i) _____ is certainly (ii) _____, the fundamental factors of population stability and resource renewal generally did favor social maintenance and even economic growth. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. outwardly aggressive	D. derivative
B. perfectly harmonious	E. positive
C. slowly developing	F. overdrawn

3. When learners are engaged in mathematical problem-solving, their activity does not have from the outset the structure of what will be considered a mathematical proof. Instead, a tangle of intuitions, know-how, factual knowledge, and a variety of other mental constructs allows learners to entertain choices and make decisions. Nonetheless, (i) _____ such mental activity (ii) _____ is (iii) _____: in many situations this process works, although it can prove to be wrong as a result of overgeneralizations.

A. concealing	D. from scrutiny	G. uncommon
B. adapting	E. as confused	H. unintentional
C. describing	F. to the task	I. uncharitable

4. The automation of many of the functions performed at the factory, although initially inspiring _____ in many of the company's employees, has had none of the deleterious effects forecast either within and beyond the organization.

- A. trepidation
- B. avidity
- C. diligence
- D. pathos

- E. apprehension
- F. enterprise

5. The Federal Reserve Bank is one of the most _____ institutions in the United States, yet many are not aware of the important operations and activities it has carried out during its lifetime.

- A. distinguished
- B. secretive
- C. consequential
- D. indispensable
- E. misunderstood
- F. mysterious

6. Building the first United States transcontinental phone line required fundamental innovations: for example, engineers created an amplifier for the electric signals to prevent them from _____ after a few miles.

- A. propagating
- B. attenuating
- C. dissipating
- D. iterating
- E. deviating
- F. broadcasting

7. Cole's novel is as close to a diary as a novel can get, encompassing reflection, autobiography, stasis, and repetition, a daunting task even many accomplished novelists would _____, which, wonderfully, Cole does not do.

- A. sidestep
- B. attempt
- C. hazard
- D. botch
- E. complicate
- F. fumble

test 102 section 2 (hard)

1. While many books have emphasized the differences between Delaney and his father—and his need to differentiate himself from his father—Delaney takes pains in this memoir to _____ his closeness with his dad.

- A. underscore
- B. question
- C. repudiate
- D. sidestep
- E. trivialize

2. While catalogs of record labels that specialize in Native American music are useful indices of Native American consumers' preferences, their (i) _____ are also (ii) _____: some genres of Native American music have been deemed inappropriate to record because of their special cultural significance. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. strategies	D. telling
B. omissions	E. misleading
C. inconsistencies	F. surprising

3. Readers had little reason to (i) _____ what proved to be the rather uncanny (ii) _____ of Kaja Silverman's and Bell Hooks's polemics, given the two authors' contrary methodologies, interests, and audiences.

A. distinguish	D. convergence
B. anticipate	E. timeliness
C. dispute	F. dissonance

4. Paleoclimatic records recovered from land, the ocean, and glacial ice (i) _____ a (ii) _____ global climate over much of the last glacial cycle. Indeed, in many locations in the Northern Hemisphere, changes in climate spanning almost the full range of glacial to interglacial conditions were so (iii) _____ that the transition between climate states occurred in decades or less.

A. exaggerate	D. potent driver of	G. abrupt
B. confirm	E. simple fact about	H. unpredictable
C. redefine	F. lack of stability in	I. enduring

5. While some naive investors have been convinced by proponents of the merger that the two companies are natural partners, experienced analysts are less _____.

- A. optimistic
- B. credulous
- C. reliable
- D. gullible
- E. skeptical
- F. dismissive

6. The orthodox approach to legal decision making tends to be backward looking, asking which decision would have the better legal _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. outcome
- B. lineage
- C. consequence
- D. corollary
- E. standing
- F. pedigree

7. While some commentators see space tourism as being _____, Alice Gorman suggests that we should see a future that includes space tourism as simply one possible future among many.

- A. implausible
- B. inconsequential
- C. ineluctable
- D. inevitable
- E. impressive
- F. intriguing

test 103 section 1 (medium)

1. The ability of the Grand Banks cod fishery to sustain intensive cod harvesting for many years gave it a reputation for _____ that deceived even scientifically sophisticated observers.

- A. hazardousness

- B. insurmountability
- C. unpredictability
- D. inexhaustibility
- E. inscrutability

2. The title of Lee's 1964 textbook, *A History of For Eastern Art*, might seem to imply that the entire subject could be encapsulated in a single work. In fact, the treatment of art across Asian cultures and over millennia could never (i) _____ if it also aspired to be (ii) _____.

A. avoid anachronism	D. accessible
B. achieve coherence	E. comprehensive
C. justify digressions	F. groundbreaking

3. The (i) _____ in local coverage of a rabies outbreak in colonial Hanoi may be startling today, but it cannot be attributed solely to the (ii) _____ of the era's journalists. Rather, before the advent of modern public health systems, (iii) _____ the unpleasantness of the disease and its treatment was seen as a way to, ensure that the public remained vigilant against possible sources of contagion.

A. reliance on polite euphemisms	D. sycophancy	G. underscoring
B. deference to medical experts	E. squeamishness	H. minimizing
C. degree of gruesome detail	F. sensationalism	I. demystifying

4. Sweet's illustrations are playfully _____: the eye hops sparrowlike from leaf to leaf, uncertain where to settle.

- A. daunting
- B. distracting
- C. integrated
- D. educational
- E. diverting
- F. Informative

5. Archer is surprisingly _____ in failing to see her subjects' self-reported life histories for what they really are: the kinds of stories that pretty much all twenty-somethings tell.

- A. obstinate
- B. credulous
- C. arbitrary
- D. cautious
- E. unprincipled
- F. trusting

6. That she was unaffected by the _____ of the feudal past was evident in the style in which she wrote of it, a style completely devoid of nostalgia. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. allure
- B. cruelty
- C. prestige
- D. barbarity
- E. remnants
- F. magic

7. The World Health Organization has recommended that countries use artemisinin-based combination therapies to treat malaria patients, as continued use of artemisinin monotherapies could _____ the efficacy of artemisinin, the most successful antimalarial drug available.

- A. negate
- B. mask
- C. reduce
- D. conceal
- E. attenuate
- F. misrepresent

test 103 section 2 (medium)

1. It can be extremely difficult to uncover direct evidence of conspiracies, given that such activities are by their very nature _____.

- A. interminable
- B. laborious
- C. provocative
- D. illicit
- E. surreptitious

2. For the early years of the twentieth century, ecology remained essentially a _____ science: ecologists went into the field, counted plants and animals, made lists, and that was pretty much that.

- A. lay
- B. resilient
- C. descriptive
- D. theoretical
- E. pragmatic

3. Although the first exoplanet discovered was found to be orbiting too close to its star to support life, scientists quickly discovered exoplanets in more (i) _____ orbits, making the detection of potentially habitable exoplanets seem (ii) _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. compressed	D. likely
B. clement	E. unfeasible
C. superfluous	F. irregular

4. Documenting the lives of African Americans before Emancipation is (i) _____ undertaking even when printed accounts are (ii) _____, they are often (iii) _____ and details printed as fact may be merely speculative.

A. an urgent	D. contested	G. contradictory
B. a collaborative	E. illegible	H. disheartening
C. a difficult	F. available	I. revealing

5. The film's pat and occasionally preposterous story is really just a _____, a serviceable scaffolding for a handful of expert, satisfying individual performances.

- A. dodge
- B. prelude
- C. diversion

- D. pretext
- E. contrivance
- F. distraction

6. The author engages the subject from diverse perspectives, supports his argument well with many examples, and manages to avoid antagonizing others in dealing with a very _____ subject.

- A. contentious
- B. pedestrian
- C. controversial
- D. perplexing
- E. mundane
- F. intriguing

7. Because video game users control their character's actions, the distinction between media user and character is not as _____ in video games as it is in traditional media, where audience members simply witness characters' actions.

- A. fluid
- B. salient
- C. fraught
- D. elusive
- E. palpable
- F. charged

test 104 section 1 (medium)

1. The ancient Greek philosopher Socrates displayed great _____ in accepting his sentence of death for corrupting the morals of Athenian youth and for advocating religious heresies; he resisted efforts to save his life and willingly drank the cup of poison given him.

- A. elation
- B. stoicism
- C. elitism
- D. erudition
- E. skepticism

2. In a reflection of the senator's enduring popularity, the articles written in response to her impending retirement were less a (i) _____ evaluation than a (ii) _____ summary of her career.

A. valedictory	D. scathing
B. plodding	E. glowing
C. frank	F. schematic

3. When potentially disruptive change appears on the horizon, managers' approach should be to assemble the capabilities to (i) _____ that change before it affects the mainstream business. The (ii) _____ to run two businesses, one with processes attuned to the existing business model and another geared toward the new model. While apparently onerous, this parallel operation is far less dangerous than either (iii) _____ innovation irrevocably or remaining committed to tried-and-true methods that are threatened with obsolescence. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. obstruct	D. competition might have	G. jumping into
B. stimulate	E. requirement is	H. exploring

C. handle	F. mistaken approach is	I. rejecting
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4. Catherine's _____ made it nearly impossible to discuss beliefs with her that she didn't already hold.

- A. insularity
- B. parochialism
- C. ideology
- D. openness
- E. assertiveness
- F. receptiveness

5. Because the country's media are now operating freely and the electoral authorities have been changed, there should be no repeat of the _____ of last year's election, when media coverage and vote counts were manipulated by the intelligence agency.

- A. chicanery
- B. blundering
- C. ingenuousness
- D. naivete
- E. vindictiveness
- F. subterfuge

6. Many readers are bemused to discover that Ella Wheeler Wilcox's book Poems of Passion was thought to be _____ when it was published in 1883, as the book seems fairly innocuous.

- A. scandalous
- B. radical
- C. unseemly
- D. uninteresting
- E. pedestrian
- F. eccentric

7. While the rate at which absolute global sea level is rising may seem _____, it has been far from an incidental factor in human history.

- A. disconcerting
- B. intractable
- C. improbable
- D. imperceptible
- E. unnerving
- F. trivial

test 104 section 2 (medium)

1. In the Middle Ages, Europeans placed the holy city of Jerusalem at the center of maps, reflecting the prevailing _____ of the era. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. iniquity
- B. parsimony
- C. anthropocentrism
- D. cosmology
- E. proximity

2. Their remote jungle habitat and their extreme shyness have (i) _____ any thorough investigation of orangutans except in the (ii) _____ conditions of captivity.

A. subsumed	D. primitive
B. simplified	E. heightened
C. precluded	F. unnatural

3. Historians have been (i) _____ African American fraternal organizations, in part due to the (ii) _____ historical evidence: the relevant records are scarce and difficult to obtain.

A. hindered in studying	D. discrepancies in
B. confident in assessing	E. insufficiency of
C. eager to categorize	F. approach to

4. An innovative musician, accompanist extraordinaire, and protomodern hipster, Lester Young (1909-1959) remains a (i) _____ in the jazz firmament. Some of the reasons are obvious: although he dressed with conspicuous cool, he chose an artistic trajectory that seemed calculated to (ii) _____ the spotlight—his best work was in the bands of other musicians, such as Billie Holiday and Count Basie, rather than at the front of his own. Moreover, he was shy, subtle, and sensitive—traits not usually associated with great (ii) _____.

A. bright star	D. shun	G. imagination
B. lesser light	E. intensify	H. restraint
C. permanent fixture	F. exploit	I. celebrity

5. The author's description of the _____ contamination of ocean water with plastic materials—and the resulting threat to marine life—constitutes a valuable lesson in the urgency of managing trash more responsibly than we currently do.

- A. inadvertent
- B. ubiquitous
- C. perilous
- D. pervasive
- E. abating
- F. diminishing

6. However much people want to avoid physical pain and feelings of anxiety, both are _____ self-preservation in a dangerous world. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. compatible with
- B. essential for
- C. complementary to
- D. reliant on
- E. indispensable for
- F. noteworthy for

7. Katz's attitude toward Pancho Villa can hardly be called _____: a thesis runs through Katz's book to the effect that history has denied Pancho Villa his due.

- A. unsympathetic
- B. dogmatic
- C. inflexible
- D. judgmental
- E. neutral
- F. impartial

test 105 section 1 (medium)

1. The fact that there are so many varieties of youthful dissent indicates that there is considerably less _____ to this counterculture than has been suggested.

- A. hypocrisy
- B. relevance
- C. spontaneity
- D. degeneracy
- E. coherence

2. Discovering that cooler stars, which constitute three-quarters of our galaxy, can also be surrounded by habitable zones warm enough to harbor liquid water and, potentially, microbes and bacteria, has (i) _____ the (ii) _____ the search for extraterrestrial life.

A. assuaged	D. target territory in
B. expanded	E. popular discomfort with
C. jeopardized	F. primary motivation for

3. The unattractive hyena is unjustly (i) _____. It was long believed that when bob lions and hyenas were present at a kill, the latter invariably stole from the former, but this notion proved to be (ii) _____: we now know that the lion is just as (iii) _____ the hard-won prey of the hyena.

A. maligned	D. divisive	G. apt to pilfer
B. imperiled	E. convoluted	H. capable of overtaking
C. forgotten	F. untrue	I. likely to become

4. Since responsibility for content is often _____ in multiauthor papers, it is easy to suppose that such papers may contain more instances of questionable academic practices than do papers by a single author.

- A. ignored
- B. diluted
- C. disputed
- D. weakened
- E. highlighted
- F. foregrounded

5. When Kim Dae Jung was decisively elected South Korea's president in December 1997, he was considered something of _____, but nevertheless the right man for the time and the job.

- A. an unknown
- B. an expert
- C. a maverick
- D. a nonconformist
- E. a dilettante
- F. an authority

6. The author argued that the industrial agricultural system that prevails in the United States is unsustainable and, therefore, anything that _____ it should be questioned.

- A. streamlines
- B. reinforces

- C. encumbers
- D. buttresses
- E. endangers
- F. hampers

7. Whereas the original editor had sacrificed clarity for brevity and her successor had been too _____, the new editor took an intermediate approach, explicit as to the purport of each document and not too ambitious in detail. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. discriminating
- B. prolix
- C. bombastic
- D. verbose
- E. cryptic
- F. inscrutable

test 105 section 2 (medium)

1. The mountain pine beetle is not _____ like other major pests ravaging much of the American landscape: it is native to the western pine forests.

- A. an interloper
- B. a nuisance
- C. an anomaly
- D. a mystery
- E. a predator

2. While Zora Neale Hurston never avowed an affiliation with surrealism, an artistic movement celebrating the unconscious mind's creative power, French surrealist Guy Ducomet's citing her as an inspiration seems quite _____ given Hurston's intensely imaginative work.

- A. tenable
- B. arcane
- C. audacious
- D. prescient
- E. eccentric

3. While writers on Parker often present her as an avaricious stick figure, thus making her an object of (i)_____. Nash, by contrast, gives a more (ii)_____ and sympathetic portrait of the woman.

A. adulation	D. intense
B. praise	E. polemical
C. opprobrium	F. nuanced

4. Our contemporary preference for natural expression over artifice is (i)_____ the traditional Western view that the skill with which you expressed a position corresponded closely to the credibility of your argument. Rhetorical styles might vary, but style itself was never a matter of (ii)_____. And "style" was not just a well-turned sentence: poor expression, it was believed, (iii)_____ poor thought. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. a departure from	D. substance	G. ameliorated
B. a reflection on	E. indifference	H. elevated

C. an endorsement of	F. intention	I. betrayed
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5. Einstein called Amalie Noether the most significant mathematical genius produced since higher education of women began; so transformative was her theorem of mathematical symmetry that some consider the temporal qualification in Einstein's statement ____.

- A. disingenuous
- B. fawning
- C. expendable
- D. flattering
- E. superfluous
- F. manifest

6. A key characteristic in the author's presentation of his character's dreary life is _____, paragraphs are short, sentence are laconic, patterns of repetition and circularity are evoked by means of symbolic shorthand.

- A. redundancy
- B. economy
- C. hyperbole
- D. concision
- E. exaggeration
- F. restraint

7. Human hearing is remarkably _____.: an attentive listener knows if a band's drummer is as little as one thousandths of a second late on the beat.

- A. sophisticated
- B. adaptable
- C. independent
- D. sensitive
- E. versatile
- F. discerning

test 106 section 1 (medium)

1. Saturn's rings seem _____, but it now appears that several decades ago, the shape of the innermost rings was altered by a mysterious event that all our telescopes and spacecraft failed to detect.

- A. immutable
- B. fragmentary
- C. luminous
- D. unique
- E. concentric

2. Rocks of the Morrison Formation in the western United States yield many dinosaur fossils but few plant fossils. This apparent (i) _____ of plants leads some scientists to speculate that the region was once mostly barren. But others have (ii) _____, noting that the herbivorous dinosaurs there would have needed an abundant food supply. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. attrition	D. abdicated
B. dearth	E. acceded
C. attenuation	F. demurred

3. The general claim that artists are the preeminent specialists in (i)_____ is refuted by the obvious fact that the great mathematical and scientific discoveries of the past and present have been as much the result of (ii)_____ thinking as have great (iii)_____ discoveries.

A. revelation	D. original	G. historical
B. creativity	E. anachronistic	H. empirical
C. symbolization	F. systematic	I. artistic

4. Much honored for her work in both theater and film, the director was prolific-too much so, according to some critics who thought she sometimes took on projects _____.

- A. haphazardly
- B. unprofitably
- C. indiscriminately
- D. unflaggingly
- E. inappropriately
- F. prematurely

5. Some species of the genus *Daphnia* (commonly known as water fleas) are phenotypically _____, altering their diurnal migration behavior and developing exaggerated morphological defenses in response to predators.

- A. immutable
- B. methodical
- C. determinate
- D. plastic
- E. arbitrary
- F. pliable

6. Yang Hong's studies of ancient Chinese tombs transcribe the tombs' epitaphs and inscriptions, noting whether these texts corroborate available information about the deceased's life or ancestry or _____ it by presenting biographical material not found elsewhere.

- A. disseminate
- B. contradict
- C. supplement
- D. obviate
- E. augment
- F. promulgate

7. Wilkinson believes that the subversion of science is widespread, though generally more subtle than the particularly _____ cases he selected to draw attention to his book.

- A. blatant
- B. innocuous
- C. conspicuous
- D. controversial
- E. insignificant
- F. disconcerting

test 106 section 2 (hard)

1. In recent years, the country's farmers have been extremely _____, contributing a major portion of the disturbances and protests against government policies. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. discerning
- B. tractable
- C. restive
- D. mercurial
- E. circumspect

2. Sinden notes that in the face of warnings about the perils of climate change, the need to agree on strategies for reducing greenhouse-gas emissions is increasingly urgent. The question of who should reduce emissions is not (i) _____. Rather, according to Sinden, it is the question of who should bear the costs of these reductions that is (ii) _____.

A. particularly vexed	D. redundant
B. universally resolved	E. contentious
C. politically innocuous	F. prescient

3. Many elected officials have (i) _____ into believing that the new reforms represent a solution rather than (ii) _____ of the problem. Unfortunately, such self-deception is not uncommon among politicians.

A. conned others	D. an elucidation
B. deluded themselves	E. a resolution
C. persuaded some	F. an exacerbation

4. As theories, quantum field theory and theory of general relativity have been astonishingly (i) _____ that no experiment yet has shown a crack in either of them, even though both of them (ii) _____ wildly counterintuitive properties in physical reality. And yet even proponents note that the two theories are (iii) _____, a fact that has disallowed theorists—at least so far—from incorporating both into a self-consistent theory of quantum gravity. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. successful	D. downplay	G. difficult for laypeople to understand
B. popular	E. result in	H. deeply at odds with each other
C. implausible	F. posit	I. similar to earlier physical theories

5. Although torrential rains can sometimes be highly destructive, human survival generally proves much more _____ without rain than during periods of its overabundance.

- A. ponderous
- B. unmanageable
- C. onerous
- D. tedious
- E. arduous
- F. unlikely

6. The author's latest novel may _____ those who generally spurn her writing: its unvarnished prose has little in common with the labyrinthine interior explorations of her earlier work.

- A. entice
- B. gall

- C. surprise
- D. placate
- E. rankle
- F. appease

7. Many child development experts emphasize that the effects of a controlling parenting style are _____ individual differences in children's personality: for instance, such effects are less pronounced among children who are temperamentally agreeable.

- A. confounded with
- B. unaffected by
- C. sensitive to
- D. detrimental to
- E. damaging to
- F. modulated by

test 107 section 1 (medium)

1. Dr. Jack Kevorkian became a subject of controversy in the 1990s by assisting terminally ill people to commit suicide in contravention of Michigan statutes' _____ such actions.

- A. justifying
- B. proscribing
- C. presaging
- D. abjuring
- E. substantiating

2. In China, beginning in the 1920s, the field of geography was (i) _____ discourse, alive to indigenous Chinese traditions even as it (ii) _____ key elements of Western scientific geography.

A. an arcane	D. ignored
B. a hybrid	E. questioned
C. a subjective	F. absorbed

3. The current organization of agricultural production is certainly not (i) _____ addressing the problem of world hunger. Much of the corn and soy grown in the world feeds cattle, pigs and chickens being raised for meat. This despite the (ii) _____ that is (iii) _____ such a process: two to five times more grain is required to produce the same number of calories in meat as can be obtained through the direct consumption of grain. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. responsible for	D. pragmatism	G. discouraged by
B. optimal for	E. fecundity	H. regulated by
C. incapable of	F. inefficiency	I. inherent in

4. He opens in a style that is notably contentious for a scientific paper, _____ previous works that, in his dim view, have too quickly drawn analogies between human thought and animal thought.

- A. ignoring
- B. cataloging
- C. espousing
- D. endorsing
- E. disparaging
- F. belittling

5. Claire Tomalin's biography of Dickens offers a seamless application of "the life" to "the art" -and what _____ balancing act it is, in which, just barely, Dickens' art is not lost amid a smothering welter of facts.

- A. a perilous
- B. a daring
- C. an inadequate
- D. a successful
- E. an insufficient
- F. an unconventional

6. One of the incongruities of modern industry, according to Reck and Graedel, is that we manufacture modern products with the most sophisticated technologies available yet generally adopt relatively _____ approaches to recycling them.

- A. economical
- B. basic
- C. crude
- D. conventional
- E. inefficient
- F. inexpensive

7. The actor was quick to warn new members of the cast that the director's cherubic countenance belied _____ temperament.

- A. a deceitful
- B. a choleric
- C. a morose
- D. an imperious
- E. a vengeful
- F. an irascible

test 107 section 2 (medium)

1. Numerous studies have documented the influence of advertisers on media content, disproving the popular notion of a _____ between business and editorial operations.

- A. cooperation.
- B. separation
- C. competition
- D. collusion
- E. disaffection

2. While Fernandez-Armesto has amply documented the commercial, migratory, scientific, or religious motives of explorers throughout history, it is often harder to _____ the motives of modern explorer. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. generate
- B. penetrate
- C. extinguish
- D. utilize
- E. criticize

3. An affinity for (i) _____ is a characteristic of Bynum's work and of her rhetorical strategy as a historian, and it is often both refreshing and illuminating. But this predilection for (ii) _____ can be vexing, too, by appearing to eschew necessary distinctions.

A. paradox	D. daring hyperbole
B. humor	E. indiscriminate eclecticism
C. understatement	F. unresolvable ambivalences

4. A (i) _____ assumption of the model is that (ii) _____ the living standards of people living adjacent to a protected area will necessarily enhance conservation within the protected area. Studies of conservation attitudes of people in South Africa and Tanzania have found a positive correlation between affluence and conservation attitudes, but it is unlikely that an improvement in the living standards of communities near protected areas will inevitably (iii) _____ the long-term viability of many species within the protected areas.

A. misguided	D. raising	G. increase
B. conservative	E. discounting	H. inhibit
C. compelling	F. assessing	I. prevent

5. For all the _____ that would later come to plague the committee, the atmosphere when it was initially convened was one of optimistic camaraderie.

- A. acrimony
- B. controversy
- C. apathy
- D. rancor
- E. despair
- F. frustration

6. Agnita Tennant's three-volume translation represents only part one of Pak Kyung-ni's epic novel of Korean history, but, although seeded with intriguing premonitions of future events, the work reads as _____ narrative.

- A. an independent
- B. a dramatic
- C. a preliminary
- D. a self-contained
- E. an uncontrived
- F. an introductory

7. Scholars have learned from the demographic reconstructions of the precipitate population decline in the Caribbean after the Spanish conquest that we should be cautious before we treat early accounts of a large preconquest population as though they are _____.

- A. exaggerated
- B. accurate
- C. authentic
- D. persuasive
- E. hyperbolic
- F. deceptive

test 108 section 1 (medium)

1. To some extent, the relationship between nitrous oxide and methane in Earth's atmosphere could be described as _____: nitrous oxide releases oxygen when destroyed by ultraviolet radiation, while methane is an oxygen consumer. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. necessary
- B. ephemeral
- C. inverse
- D. anomalous
- E. ubiquitous

2. A Sociological jurisprudence has a (i)_____ rather than (ii)_____ focus: it is concerned with what actually goes on in the legal system, not with what ought to go on.

A. humanitarian	D. an elitist
B. descriptive	E. a normative
C. hypothetical	F. an applied

3. For decades scientists believed in the (i)_____ of long-term memories: they were unstable for a few hours but then became etched into the brain for good. Current research, however, suggests that recalling a memory causes it to revert temporarily to an insecure state in which the recollection can be (ii)_____. Thus, memory is much more (iii)_____ than scientists had previously thought it to be.

A. accuracy	D. instilled	G. reliable
B. immutability	E. modified	H. constrained
C. predictability	F. observed	I. fluid

4. While other authors surely _____ American novelist Toni Morrison's literary style, there really was no precedent for the sorts of books she conceived.

- A. appreciated
- B. dismissed
- C. influenced
- D. adopted
- E. analyzed
- F. informed

5. The dearth of _____ vocabulary reassures readers of the book that they are initiated in an exclusive sect. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. pretentious
- B. affected
- C. commonplace
- D. coarse
- E. riveting
- F. ordinary

6. It can be a daunting task to plunge into the disparate and extensive data sets on the carnivores and _____ meaningful patterns from their extraordinary morphological behavioral, and ecological diversity.

- A. distill
- B. conjure
- C. distinguish
- D. extract
- E. conceal
- F. hide

7. Land near Bangladesh's coastal rivers is ____: temporary islands, or chars, form in the main rivers as sediments are deposited and then disappear during floods.
- A. fecund
 - B. scant
 - C. ephemeral
 - D. exiguous
 - E. transitory
 - F. treacherous

test 108 section 2 (hard)

1. As British biochemist Joseph Needham became immersed in the study of China's history, he began to envision science as ____ endeavor, noting that "the peoples of the whole world have all made their contributions."

- A. an ecumenical
- B. a competitive
- C. a redemptive
- D. a misunderstood
- E. an underappreciated

2. During the decade 2000-2010 in the United States, the increase in self-employed Hispanic entrepreneurs (i)____ the increase in Hispanic workers overall. Historically, Hispanics have been (ii)____ in the self-employment sector, so this change reduced the amount by which the Hispanic self-employment rate trailed the overall self-employment rate.

A. catalyzed	D. underrepresented
B. tracked	E. undercompensated
C. exceeded	F. underappreciated

3. Unlike, say, locusts, which simply raze entire fields, stinkbugs wreak their havoc (i)____. The injury they do to corn, for instance, is (ii)____ the ear is husked, at which point certain kernels—the ones into which a stinkbug stuck its pointy mouth—will reveal themselves to be sunken and brown.

A. periodically	D. invisible until
B. insidiously	E. ameliorated when
C. instantaneously	F. apparent before

4. The traditional set of nine planets could have been retained by defining a planet as any object that has the unique combination of characteristics of any one of the nine objects that were considered planets in the late twentieth century. That definition would not be (i)____; that is, it does not contradict the evidence. Its (ii)____, however, renders it less (iii)____ than definitions based on astronomical criteria, such as orbit, size, and gravitation.

A. paradoxical	D. arbitrariness	G. expedient
B. subjective	E. inconsistency	H. stable
C. false	F. generality	I. defensible

5. Despite its stellar performances, the film is _____: it seems mysteriously incomplete in essential ways, yet feels repetitive at the same time. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. wanting
- B. dull
- C. offensive
- D. curious
- E. distasteful
- F. peculiar

6. It's when his technique is _____ rather than when he's trying his hardest to impress that Murakami's spell as a novelist is most persuasive.

- A. unconventional
- B. inconspicuous
- C. low-key
- D. polished
- E. clever
- F. unorthodox

7. Katherine's disobedient behavior earned her a _____ from her parents.

- A. eulogy
- B. rebuke
- C. panegyric
- D. mockery
- E. commendation
- F. reproof

test 109 section 1 (medium)

1. The research institute publishes new material on its Web site well in advance of its appearance in print; inevitably, there is a lot of dross, but fortunately, much of the material is both _____ and free.

- A. speculative
- B. specious
- C. copious
- D. valuable
- E. perplexing

2. At first glance, each of the stories in the anthology seemed (i)_____, upon closer inspection of their protagonists, implied morals, and fantasy elements, however, subtle similarities among the stories emerged to (ii)_____ this initial observation.

A. compelling	D. impugn
B. implausible	E. bolster
C. idiosyncratic	F. explain

3. During Nigeria's colonial period, the country's Igbo societies had (i)_____ sense of gender distinctions, but the idea of a strict division of labor along gender lines (ii)_____. Indeed, the social roles of women and men were quite (iii)_____, based on what people did rather than on existential categories like gender. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. an elastic	D. did not exist	G. fluid
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B. a well-developed	E. was emerging	H. dissimilar
C. a diminishing	F. hardly changed	I. traditional

4. Once deemed too _____ the big bang model of the birth of the universe has turned out to be one of the most robust scientific theories, with experimental verification going back billions of years.

- A. daring
- B. complex
- C. intractable
- D. audacious
- E. ambiguous
- F. unpopular

5. Gaige accomplishes a surprising feat: modeling her novel on one of the most _____ narratives in all of literature, she creates a remarkably understated tale.

- A. sensational
- B. revered
- C. extravagant
- D. imitated
- E. suspenseful
- F. chilling

6. When discussing the United States Army's 1876 campaign against the Sioux, Powers is occasionally _____ context: he describes General Crook's march to the Battle of the Rosebud but neglects to mention how it fit into the army's overall strategy.

- A. misinformed about
- B. obsessed with
- C. frugal with
- D. preoccupied with
- E. stinting with
- F. unscrupulous about

7. Judge Jones brought some welcome levity to the often tense, though sometimes _____, proceedings.

- A. humorous
- B. tedious
- C. stressful
- D. inconsequential
- E. fraught
- F. tiresome

test 109 section 2 (medium)

1. Ronald Ferguson, whose work is widely admired by policy makers, has never been profiled by the news media, perhaps because his views are _____ and therefore difficult to capture in a sound bite. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. nuanced
- B. controversial
- C. empirical
- D. influential
- E. unorthodox

2. Mathematical knowledge has long been regarded as being essentially stable and hence rooted in a world of ideas only superficially _____ to historical forces.

- A. indifferent
- B. superior
- C. susceptible
- D. extraneous
- E. oblivious

3. Xie proposes that sleep achieves its restorative function by switching the brain into a state that facilitates the clearance of waste products resulting from neural activity during wakefulness, indeed, the very (i) _____ of such waste products in the waking brain may (ii) _____ the switch to sleep state.

A. utilization	D. delay
B. accumulation	E. succeed
C. analysis	F. trigger

4. Books about humor are rarely funny. Their goal, after all, is to (i) _____ the workings of that which we find comic, not to (ii) _____ laughter, and understanding why jokes are funny is not in itself (iii) _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. celebrate	D. explain	G. amusing
B. analyze	E. occasion	H. helpful
C. improve	F. recall	I. admirable

5. Although technically their members were hunter-gatherers, many early Native California communities exhibited traits more typically associated with well-developed agrarian societies and, therefore, are often presented in the ethnographic literature as _____.

- A. archaic
- B. pragmatic
- C. anomalous
- D. exemplary
- E. exceptional
- F. utilitarian

6. The vast majority of universities in the United States promote themselves as institutions of free speech and thought, construing censorship as _____ their search for knowledge.

- A. subordinate to
- B. obviated by
- C. secondary to
- D. antipathetic to
- E. conducive to
- F. inconsistent with

7. Louise Gluck has long been a poet of _____ ideals; only in her later work does she veer toward a partial accommodation to human weakness and imperfection. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. admirable
- B. nontraditional
- C. uncompromising
- D. unorthodox
- E. absolute

F. lofty

test 110 section 1 (medium)

1. The watchword in astronomy is _____: all claims must be examined critically in the light of current knowledge, and one's mind should never be closed to the possibility that a theory could be wrong.

- A. implausibility
- B. imagination
- C. wariness
- D. determination
- E. incoherency

2. Lohr's (i) _____ the trappings of literary celebrity creates a Romantic aura for him: by distancing himself from all public discourse about himself or his work, Lohr becomes an even greater, albeit more (ii) _____, celebrity than most authors manage in all their interviews and memoirs.

A. refusal to wear	D. renowned
B. eagerness to understand	E. appealing
C. inability to renounce	F. mysterious

3. The latest encyclopedia (i) _____ the (ii) _____ made by many other books on how things work—giving (iii) _____ for every device, no matter how complicated—by taking just as long as is needed to explain things.

A. repeats	D. assumption	G. a brief historical background
B. exposes	E. mistake	H. an equal number of words
C. avoids	F. compromise	I. at least one illustration

4. In the early-twentieth-century United States, the enforcement of the "separate but equal" doctrine in the treatment of African Americans was _____: much attention was paid to separation but scant to equality.

- A. meticulous
- B. selective
- C. ruthless
- D. ineffective
- E. unwavering
- F. lopsided

5. Unlike French cuisine, which works as a conversation among regional variations but recognizes the _____ of Parisian cuisine, Italian cuisine affirms a system based on the sum of equally regarded local cuisines. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. preeminence
- B. versatility
- C. sophistication
- D. hegemony
- E. heaviness
- F. heterogeneity

6. Early natural history collections in eighteenth-century Europe were _____: a bear's tooth might sit incongruously alongside a piece of silverwork or, in the menagerie, a South American capybara might be housed next to an African baboon.

- A. painstakingly arranged
- B. impressively comprehensive
- C. meticulously organized
- D. highly exotic
- E. fundamentally miscellaneous
- F. thoroughly eclectic

7. The early stages of being trained to ride a motorcycle are all about developing muscle memory, repeating combinations of hand-foot movements until they are _____ and precise.

- A. aberrant
- B. innate
- C. reflexive
- D. inborn
- E. automatic
- F. calculated

test 110 section 2 (hard)

1. In general, the relationship between neural activity and behavioral output is _____: multiple behaviors can be associated with activation of the same neurons and multiple neurons can trigger the same behavior.

- A. deterministic
- B. hardwired
- C. random
- D. complicated
- E. cumulative

2. While the professor was once known for expressing herself (i) _____, that is no longer true. Her writing style is much more (ii) _____ than it was when she started her career over 30 years ago.

A. caustically	D. florid
B. idiosyncratically	E. acerbic
C. plainly	F. succinct

3. It is incorrect to think of eighth-century Japan as (i) _____. In western and central Japan, for example, there was considerable (ii) _____, with many inhabitants deriving their ancestry from the Wa and Yamato peoples and at least a third being descendants of Korean immigrants unrelated to those peoples. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. culturally conservative	D. tension
B. politically unstable	E. variation
C. ethnically homogeneous	F. obscurity

4. If a figure such as the editor and writer Pauline Hopkins presents (i) _____ challenges to a would-be biographer because of her confounding periods of science, largely unknown personal life, and (ii) _____ papers, the problems posed by John Edward Bruce are of the opposite kind: he published (iii) _____ throughout his life, had an extensive correspondence, and left a huge trove of materials at his death.

A. unpredictable	D. abundant	G. indefatigably
B. negligible	E. meager	H. sporadically
C. colossal	F. lucid	I. secretively

5. Khirigsuurs, distinctive stone-mounded monuments, are so _____ in central and western Mongolia that it has been argued that they were the defining features of the human landscapes of prehistoric Inner Asia.

- A. ubiquitous
- B. multifarious
- C. prevalent
- D. varied
- E. admired
- F. overwhelming

6. Artists such as Jimi Jones reveal how _____ art categories really are: Jones successfully uses materials relatively foreign to the hegemonic concept of fine art while working in a style commonly associated with high culture.

- A. fragmented
- B. contrived
- C. pervious
- D. prescriptive
- E. conventional
- F. artificial

7. The manufacturing company's swift maneuver enabled it to evade the full impact of the increasing cost of raw materials, which brought the downfall of firms that responded less _____.

- A. ruthlessly
- B. deftly
- C. adroitly
- D. carefully
- E. extravagantly
- F. cautiously

test 111 section 1 (medium)

1. It is ironic that the scientist's work was criticized recently for its _____ research methodology, since other researchers have argued for years that this same methodology was based absolutely on impeccable logic. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. fastidious
- B. esoteric
- C. abstruse
- D. impervious
- E. specious

2. For private fossil collectors, a fossil's value is (i) _____ the object itself. For scientists, however, the value of a fossil is usually (ii) _____. Most paleontological research focuses not only on the fossil itself, but also on the fossil's location, the kind of rock it was found in, its position in the historical sequence, and how the fossil is positioned relative to other fossils.

A. inherent in	D. enigmatic
B. distinct from	E. contextual
C. unknowable from	F. controversial

3. Arguments based on mere possibilities (i) _____ the difficulty of discussing future technology, not least since they (ii) _____ public debates on technological options. A mere possibility argument such as "Agricultural biotechnology can have serious effects on ecosystems that we still know nothing about" can be taken by opponents of the technology to be (iii) _____ whereas proponents tend to dismiss it completely.

A. epitomize	D. polarize	G. decisive
B. mitigate	E. forestall	H. empirical
C. outweigh	F. undergird	I. dogmatic

4. Ruth Carter's campaigns for Congress were pretty _____: as a liberal in a deeply conservative district, she was virtually certain to lose.

- A. conventional
- B. underhanded
- C. contentious
- D. quixotic
- E. indecorous
- F. unrealistic

5. To most ethicists, self-interested action connotes the opposite of moral conduct, and its _____ is for them a virtual prerequisite for serious ethical discourse.

- A. dispersion
- B. promulgation
- C. abjuration
- D. circumscription
- E. repudiation
- F. dissemination

6. The recognition of _____ the movements of the Sun, Moon, planets, and stars gave many ancient societies the ability to project the past into the future, lending a predictability to the variable cosmos.

- A. volatility in
- B. periodicity in
- C. reciprocity of
- D. perturbation in
- E. recurrence of
- F. uniformity of

7. The professional curator in Native American tribal museums ideally serves as _____, using her museological training to design exhibits that effectively convey to museumgoers the messages that the tribal community chooses to disseminate. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. a mediator
- B. an advocate

- C. a transcriber
- D. a translator
- E. a facilitator
- F. an ambassador

test 111 section 2 (hard)

1. For Confucius, names had _____ contents, no matter how time marched on and the affairs of the world changed, the proper names of things absolutely could not vary.

- A. largely transparent
- B. uniquely adaptive
- C. eternally stable
- D. dangerously slippery
- E. increasingly conventional

2. Astronomy dominated ancient science partly because it was _____ in a way that the physics and biology of the time were not: even in prehistory, people probably used the apparent motion of the Sun, for example, as a crude clock, calendar, and compass. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. precise
- B. exciting
- C. practical
- D. lucrative
- E. provocative

3. An architect of Koolhaas' (i) _____ might plausibly prefer designing on paper to building in concrete. Remaining within the realm of his own imagination, he need not worry about pesky clients who can dilute a project into mediocrity. But in fact, what Koolhaas enjoys most is the opportunity to engage with a client. When asked if he would consider designing a house for himself, he replied that the idea bored him, that it would feel too (ii) _____. For him, the whole point of architecture is the encounter with the other. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. unbridled ambition	D. sybaritic
B. unfettered originality	E. altruistic
C. unalloyed pragmatism	F. solipsistic

4. Belief in the harmful effects of the drug has all the hallmarks of a viewpoint that is not (i) _____ even though the notion that the drug has negative consequences has been (ii) _____ multiple epidemiological studies over the past decade. Yet the true believers have (iii) _____, critiquing each new study that challenges their views and continuing to lean on supporting research that was retracted long ago.

A. amenable to refutation	D. refined by	G. persisted
B. driven by self-interest	E. cited by	H. splintered
C. capable of propagation	F. upended by	I. capitulated

5. She criticizes the view that American democracy is _____, its strings pulled not by voters but by a power elite or ruling class.

- A. a sham
- B. an irrelevance

- C. a charade
- D. a success
- E. an achievement
- F. an enigma

6. Until fairly recently, hitchhiking was not an uncommon practice in the United States, but today's motorists are likely to see the occasional hitchhiker as _____, thinking "I didn't know people still did that!"

- A. a parvenu
- B. an adventurer
- C. an anachronism
- D. a daredevil
- E. a throwback
- F. an upstart

7. Legal scholars envision environmental politics as the pursuit of opposing and _____ interests and therefore likely to lead to confrontation rather than compromise.

- A. selfish
- B. fixed
- C. immutable
- D. competing
- E. irrational
- F. innocuous

test 112 section 1 (medium)

1. Since the fundamental frequency of an object's vibration is determined by its size and shape, a sequence of sounds having _____ pitch is perceived to have been produced by a single object.

- A. discernible
- B. predictable
- C. unusual
- D. identical
- E. melodious

2. The notion that scientists consider the work they do to be (i)_____ contradicts popular stereotypes that depict the work of scientists (and the scientists themselves) as being formal and rigid, following lockstep procedures in which the (ii)_____ elements of researchers' personalities fail to enter their labors. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. socially useful	D. affective
B. emotionally satisfying	E. cognitive
C. intellectually demanding	F. conjectural

3. A certain (i)_____ governs the way most of us think about routines. A routine is sometimes conceived as constraining—a self-made prison of inflexible habits that prevent people from changing their lives. But routine is also seen as (ii)_____ : activities that become routine (iii)_____, allowing us to expend energy on other things.

A. pessimism	D. liberating	G. are often tedious
B. misunderstanding	E. alterable	H. demand less attention

C. polarity	F. unintentional	I. encourage personal discipline
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4. One of the features of spoken discourse is that a speaker need not be maximally _____.: if an interlocutor is confused, he or she can interrupt and ask for clarification.

- A. honest
- B. forthcoming
- C. courteous
- D. meticulous
- E. explicit
- F. unambiguous

5. Enlightened thinkers in late-eighteenth-century Europe broadly endorsed the concept of progress, yet theories of progress were usually _____ a strong streak of pessimism, a sense of the challenges inherent in the human condition.

- A. rooted in
- B. requisite for
- C. essential for
- D. contradicted by
- E. tempered by
- F. moderated by

6. Voltaire's spirit was one of tolerant cosmopolitanism, even though he didn't have the _____ to see that one challenge for such a spirit would be whether it was able to endure those who had no wish to be cosmopolitan.

- A. hubris
- B. generosity
- C. ambition
- D. awareness
- E. arrogance
- F. insight

7. Islands harbor a disproportionate amount of Earth's biodiversity and are characterized by the presence of a great number of _____ plant and animal species; these species are often in danger of extinction by invasive predators.

- A. transplanted
- B. indigenous
- C. adaptable
- D. protean
- E. endemic
- F. anomalous

test 112 section 2 (medium)

1. The field suffers from being puffed up with its own importance, and that attitude of _____ seems to infect every professional utterance. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. self-justification
- B. self-abnegation
- C. self-congratulation
- D. self-persuasion
- E. self-castigation

2. Stigler brings a fundamental (i)_____ to his protagonists, somehow treating them with respect even while he reveals these sometimes prickly characters behaving in (ii)_____ ways.

A. sentimentality	D. spontaneous
B. sympathy	E. perceptive
C. baseness	F. petulant

3. The (i)_____ seen in most of eastern Eurasia is (ii)_____ on the Mongolian plateau, despite only 200 millimeters of annual precipitation, because evaporation decreases at higher altitudes and latitudes.

A. variability in temperatures	D. reversed
B. tendency toward aridity	E. discernible
C. complexity of ecosystems	F. exacerbated

4. William Newman and Lawrence Principe point out that prior to the seventeenth century the terms “alchemy” and “chemistry” were largely (i)_____ in European usage. It was from the third decade of the eighteenth century that the two terms began to (ii)_____. Newman and Principe suggest that a third term, “chymistry,” should be used to denote the transitional early modern phase when “alchemy and “chemistry” were becoming (iii)_____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. interchangeable	D. coalesce	G. increasingly more convoluted
B. absent	E. proliferate	H. steadily less synonymous
C. misapplied	F. diverge	I. fundamentally less significant

5. In mid-twentieth-century Japanese monster movies, a giant creature typically attacks Japan and is ultimately vanquished either by some fortuitous scientific discovery or by another equally _____ plot device.

- A. extravagant
- B. expedient
- C. tenable
- D. convenient
- E. plausible
- F. dubious

6. Strong chemical bonds and large energetic reactions are dramatic and easy to observe and understand, but a lot of the world around us and inside us operates on more _____ atomic and molecular interactions. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. pervasive
- B. delicate
- C. subtle
- D. dynamic
- E. conspicuous
- F. vigorous

7. By 2004 the idiosyncratic building had become _____ part of the city's urban landscape—hence the outrage when its owners announced that they planned to destroy its facade as part of a renovation.

- A. an integral
- B. a distinctive
- C. an imperfect
- D. a forgotten
- E. a disregarded
- F. a unique

test 113 section 1 (medium)

1. The philosophy of Zhuangzi, because it implied a spiritual elite who could transcend the bonds of the world and wander in a realm beyond life and death, appealed to a society dominated by _____.

- A. conventional morality
- B. aristocratic tastes
- C. dogmatic sensibilities
- D. a pragmatic outlook
- E. an egalitarian worldview

2. When Marx wrote, “the philosophers have only interpreted the world in various ways; the point, however, is to change it,” he was not only (i) _____ philosophers. He was (ii) _____ interpretation itself, as if thinking were an idle affairs compared with action, where real people make their mark on the world.

A. consoling	D. analyzing
B. slighting	E. extolling
C. praising	F. disparaging

3. Why investors found Internet companies so (i) _____ in the early to mid-1990s is a mystery: the market for online advertising at the time was(ii) _____, and while Internet start-ups were everywhere, most were offering (iii) _____ rather than real services, and none were making any money.

A. daunting	D. negligible	G. optimistic promises
B. alien	E. rebounding	H. sizable returns
C. appealing	F. untapped	I. captive markets

4. Throughout her life, Suzanne Césaire remained _____, articulating a greater awareness of the complexity of Caribbean identity than most of her peers had, with a focus on multicultural influences that anticipated later theorists' concerns. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. an iconoclast
- B. an outlier
- C. an idealist
- D. a visionary
- E. a trailblazer
- F. a romantic

5. Certainly, the system of peer review of academic articles submitted for publication has intrinsic biases, some of them _____ factors like the homogeneity of the research community.

- A. attributable to
- B. explained by
- C. exacerbated by
- D. unconnected to
- E. mitigated by
- F. commensurate with

6. Beavers can modify the landscape in dramatic ways that are often _____ humans, which is why media reports tend to emphasize what nuisances beavers are.

- A. surprising to
- B. derided by
- C. misunderstood by
- D. annoying to
- E. unexpected by
- F. unwelcome to

7. One can expect that future generations will steadily become less _____ as new technologies enable the substitution of online activities for social, work-and shopping-related travel.

- A. charitable
- B. itinerant
- C. peripatetic
- D. reticent
- E. munificent
- F. inquisitive

test 113 section 2 (medium)

1. Twentieth-century tussles in cosmology illustrate the _____ of science, for they highlight both the human drive to explore nature and the limits that our minds inevitably impose on our understanding.

- A. objective methodologies
- B. theoretical evolution
- C. cooperative nature
- D. psychological aspects
- E. serendipitous discoveries

2. Biologists traditionally thought that restricted gene flow was _____ the development of adaptations in a population, but empirical evidence shows that adaptation can be maintained despite very high levels of gene flow. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. an impediment to
- B. a consequence of
- C. a harbinger of
- D. a requisite of
- E. an aberration in

3. Although the university president can deploy considerable (i)_____, and her emotional reticence never seems rude, one nevertheless cannot help being aware of the (ii)_____ behind the affable public persona.

A. cunning	D. reserve
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B. charm	E. acumen
C. erudition	F. sagacity

4. For years, wine writers have (i)_____ the public's (ii)_____ the manifest charms of sherry. Why doesn't everyone love sherry, they asked, celebrating it as the most (iii)_____ wine in the world.

A. lamented	D. devotion to	G. fashionable
B. ignored	E. indifference to	H. underappreciated
C. exacerbated	F. curiosity about	I. notorious

5. Pop music continually recycles itself, building new hits around familiar themes, and successful new acts often do not even bother to disguise their _____.

- A. appropriations
- B. innovations
- C. influences
- D. pilferage
- E. originality
- F. complicity

6. To accommodate the _____ nature of clouds, pioneering meteorologist Luke Howard added compound nomenclature to his cloud classification system as a way of marking the regular transitions that occur among the three main cloud types.

- A. unusual
- B. essential
- C. solitary
- D. unstable
- E. dynamic
- F. scattered

7. Audiences in Edo, Japan, knew that no work appearing on the Kabuki stage was ever _____: if a Kabuki play outlived its first production, it would inevitably be reworked in subsequent performances.

- A. revised
- B. singular
- C. original
- D. fixed
- E. final
- F. recorded

test 114 section 1 (medium)

1. Some of the writers whose interviews with the Paris Review are included in this volume were caught in the final years of their lives, and these interviews thus lend _____ mood to the collection.

- A. an autumnal
- B. a scintillating
- C. a liberal
- D. an apolitical
- E. a cosmopolitan

2. Throughout his career he has never displayed a disinterested respect for the truth—for what was actually said and done rather than for what he wishes had been. Given such a (i) _____ historical fact, it will certainly be seen as (ii) _____ that he should now embark on publishing a magazine ostensibly dedicated to history. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. cavalier disregard for	D. unimportant
B. skeptical appreciation of	E. ironic
C. critical approach to	F. appropriate

3. Despite the (i) _____ nature of contemporary science, the (ii) _____ of many individuals (iii) _____: the work of women and minority scientists has too often been exploited or deemed rudimentary and unworthy of inclusion into science history books.

A. collaborative	D. motivations	G. manifest themselves
B. controversial	E. contributions	H. point to a solution
C. sophisticated	F. idiosyncrasies	I. remain overlooked

4. In the academic world, the peer-review process and editorial deliberations are largely _____, with only brief traces of these discussions appearing in acknowledgement sections or the occasional footnote that mentions a reviewer's critique.

- A. protracted
- B. contentious
- C. adversarial
- D. inconclusive
- E. invisible
- F. concealed

5. Cooper was one of the twentieth century's most _____ intellectuals: throughout a very long life he took up a great many causes, most of them unpopular.

- A. notorious
- B. eloquent
- C. controversial
- D. polarizing
- E. articulate
- F. detested

6. While some studies have made claims for dogs' superiority to cats in terms of intelligence (and other studies have made the opposite claim), it is more widely recognized that, because of the huge differences in these animals' instinctual priorities, such comparisons are _____.

- A. presumptive
- B. essential
- C. inconclusive
- D. baseless
- E. indispensable
- F. invalid

7. Throughout human history, intelligence and consciousness have been _____ concepts: those possessing much of the former are assumed, in some ill-defined way, to be more conscious than those less astute.

- A. disputed
- B. allied
- C. conflated

- D. loaded
- E. contested
- F. misjudged

test 114 section 2 (medium)

1. All biographies of ancient figures are necessarily _____, in that, in order to understand historical legends as human beings, there has to be some sort of translation into the categories of our own experience. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. anachronistic
- B. pointless
- C. comprehensive
- D. intrusive
- E. laudatory

2. In spite of its rather (i)_____ subject matter, Brinkley's is (ii)_____ work, one that is moderated by grace and restraint and tempered by a caution that in no way suggests timidity.

A. coarse	D. an indifferent
B. sophisticated	E. a subtle
C. endearing	F. an upsetting

3. We should (i)_____ a history built on need and desire. The present always uses the past for its own purposes, but the best historical writing attempts to (ii)_____ that inescapable impulse in order to understand history in its own terms.

A. be surprised by	D. embellish
B. be wary of	E. contain
C. not misconstrue	F. recognize

4. Anonymous sources have a tendency to (i)_____ the information content of news stories in which they are quoted. Most of these sources are (ii)_____ because they spin and leak selectively for political, personal, or institutional gain; all the balancing quotations from other sources can never remove their (iii)_____.

A. contradict	D. unreliable	G. transparency
B. corroborate	E. intransigent	H. taint
C. degrade	F. obsequious	I. obscurity

5. It was the Norman conqueror who introduced the forest law into England, but, as with so many institutions that developed after the Norman Conquest of England in 1066, there were some _____ this Norman law. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. archaisms in
- B. antecedents of
- C. innovations in
- D. precedents for
- E. derivations from
- F. novelties about

6. Those who _____ probabilistic risk assessment in structural engineering indicate that describing the safety of buildings is a matter of calculating probabilities, but that observation, though sound, does little to establish the superiority of probabilistic methodology.

- A. champion
- B. propound
- C. analyze
- D. disparage
- E. understand
- F. marginalize

7. In happier times, ours is a raucous, rude, cacophonous city, _____ cursing, good-natured complaining, and laughing aloud.

- A. an abyss of
- B. an oasis from
- C. a remainder of
- D. a hodgepodge of
- E. a refuge from
- F. a pastiche of

test 115 section 1 (medium)

1. Baron's book implores scientists to present their work in ways that are accessible to the general public in order to save the world at large from scientific illiteracy, _____ that is echoed in other recent publications.

- A. a query
- B. an analysis
- C. an exhortation
- D. an allurement
- E. an implication

2. By dramatizing the lives of her subjects with candor, sympathy, and a healthy strain of skepticism, director Esther Bell offers an (i) _____ the whimsy and solipsism (ii) _____ to much of what passes for independent filmmaking.

A. antidote to	D. antithetical
B. antecedent of	E. immaterial
C. affirmation of	F. endemic

3. In general, observational studies tend to (i) _____ the effect of diet on overall health because a healthy diet is often (ii) _____ a healthy lifestyle. People who watch what they eat probably exercise more, avoid smoking, and follow other behaviors (iii) _____ good health. Any of those behaviors might also help explain why these people have lower disease rates.

A. overstate	D. irrelevant to	G. caused by
B. clarify	E. a marker for	H. unrelated to
C. discount	F. a substitute for	I. linked to

4. It has long been thought that smell might have _____ relation with memory, and recent research does indeed confirm that recollections tied to smell can be stronger than memories of other types.

- A. an intimate
- B. an overstated
- C. a privileged
- D. a complex
- E. a favored
- F. an exaggerated

5. Coffee plants manufacture their own pesticide: caffeine, a chemical that is _____ to smaller organisms but stimulating to larger ones. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. anathema
- B. poisonous
- C. displeasing
- D. unsavory
- E. toxic
- F. soporific

6. Some critics, noting the power of photographs to manipulate perceptions, _____ the photographer's work for intentionally misrepresenting its subjects.

- A. lambasted
- B. exculpated
- C. lauded
- D. scrutinized
- E. censured
- F. shunned

7. This book indulges in a number of convenient _____, including its dubious timeline and its veneer of collective authorship.

- A. fictions
- B. contradictions
- C. analyses
- D. reminiscences
- E. refutations
- F. inventions

test 115 section 2 (medium)

1. The organization's parlous fiscal condition led its members to expect that their plans for expansion would be _____.

- A. justified
- B. abetted
- C. thwarted
- D. countenanced
- E. implicated

2. This artistic and literary movement reflected a widespread nihilistic protest against every aspect of Western culture and thus _____ the particular aesthetic values of that culture.

- A. exemplified
- B. revived
- C. recapitulated
- D. superseded
- E. repudiated

3. She may have been (i)_____ when she was finance minister, fighting deficits, but now as prime minister she is marked by her (ii)_____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. collaborative	D. discretion
B. austere	E. largesse
C. resourceful	F. platitudes

4. Some recent research shows that people tend to (i)_____ advice from (ii)_____ source, even to the point that we are willing to forgive an adviser's poor track record. This can drive those offering advice to (iii)_____ and bodes ill for advisers who try to be honest about gaps in their knowledge.

A. expect	D. an unfamiliar	G. check their facts
B. trust	E. a confident	H. disclaim their expertise
C. disregard	F. a candid	I. exaggerate their certainty

5. The fact that no single Cantonese dictionary is seen as _____ is one of the main reasons why most Hong Kong authors do not depend on formal reference tools when writing in Cantonese.

- A. dependable
- B. authoritative
- C. meticulous
- D. definitive
- E. topical
- F. comprehensive

6. Because connections made of the material are _____ to fail at high temperatures, it is particularly suited for sacrificial thermal cutoff switches; it is, of course, unsuited to applications where heat durability is needed.

- A. unlikely
- B. disinclined
- C. apt
- D. sure
- E. bound
- F. liable

7. On close reading, the poem comes across as _____, devoid of any real interest or substance.

- A. vapid
- B. curious
- C. insipid
- D. allusive
- E. singular
- F. problematic

test 116 section 1 (medium)

1. El Greco was one of the most fervent of painters, to the extreme of mania while Velazquez, by contrast, was one of the most _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. phlegmatic
- B. obstreperous

- C. edifying
- D. grandiloquent
- E. Fanciful

2. It is (i)_____ that the toucan's bill is (ii)_____ ; in fact it isn't particularly heavy and seems not to unbalance the bird especially.

A. an advantage	D. occasionally hazardous
B. a misconception	E. unusually strong
C. a surprise	F. uncomfortably bulky

3. It is true that the cost of human-based space infrastructures, such as the International Space Station (ISS), is much higher than the cost of unmanned missions. However, the (i)_____ such projects (ii)_____ their (iii)_____. The ISS is a major accomplishment for all countries involved: it is the largest on-orbit structure ever built as well as the largest multinational cooperative project in history.

A. expenditures for	D. reach beyond	G. scientific output
B. benefits of	E. detract from	H. unconventional design
C. doubts about	F. militate against	I. extended lifespan

4. In gases, connections between atoms or molecules are even more _____ than they are in liquids, as the particles move randomly and chaotically, bouncing off each other.

- A. energetic
- B. unpredictable
- C. tenuous
- D. robust
- E. intermittent
- F. loose

5. Given the important role that apologies can play in human relations and the almost daily news reports of the latest celebrity or political apology, the _____ of empirical research on the subject is surprising.

- A. weakness
- B. scarcity
- C. complexity
- D. impartiality
- E. want
- F. sophistication

6. The term "digital divide" is often _____: instead of a binary distinction between "haves" and "have nots," access to information technology varies along multiple dimensions, including the type of service and connection speed. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. ambiguous
- B. unhelpful
- C. scornful
- D. tendentious
- E. pejorative
- F. useless

7. The dating of the prehistoric monument Stonehenge necessarily entails a great deal of speculation, with the result that several rather _____ chronologies have been proposed.

- A. impenetrable
- B. meticulous
- C. disparate
- D. inconsonant
- E. confounding
- F. apposite

test 116 section 2 (medium)

1. The United States Constitution was intended to be adaptable to the demands of the various crises of human affairs, and judicial reinterpretation is the necessary means by which this _____ is preserved.

- A. flexibility
- B. reiteration
- C. misapprehension
- D. paradox
- E. contingency

2. The idea that arguments based on probability are deployed only by (i) _____ persons is (ii) _____ even among scientists. Perhaps such an evaluation has partly to do with the origins of the subject in the mathematics of gambling games, not generally regarded as pastimes for people of good character.

A. exacting	D. widespread
B. disreputable	E. controversial
C. prominent	F. deplored

3. Because the currents that flow back and forth between the Galapagos Islands and the Ecuadoran mainland create connections, the evolutionary (i) _____ of the sea creatures in the two areas, compared with that of the land dwellers, has been (ii) _____.

A. association	D. disguised
B. sophistication	E. derailed
C. separateness	F. diminished

4. Books that diagnose problems in democratic governance usually conclude with suggestions for procedural change. By contrast, the authors of this new study have, in their previous studies, always stuck closely to the data in their work, (i) _____ to propose measures that might (ii) _____ the circumstances they document. In this new study, however, in a break from their usual (iii) _____, they conclude by outlining some possible reforms. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. creating incentives	D. verify	G. reticence
B. forgoing opportunities	E. ameliorate	H. assiduity
C. anticipating reasons	F. exacerbate	I. tendentiousness

5. Even the most skeptical readers could hardly deny that the novelist's best books are remarkably _____: they thrum with energy, imagination, and something resembling white-hot inspiration.

- A. inventive

- B. engaging
- C. spirited
- D. compassionate
- E. vigorous
- F. warmhearted

6. The _____ list of interviewees included everyone from an oceanographer to a microbiologist, to a filmmaker.

- A. profligate
- B. sweeping
- C. circumscribed
- D. elite
- E. comprehensive
- F. meager

7. Because Latin American colonial societies were fundamentally organized along hierarchical bases, the spatial arrangement of the cities and towns was also _____ ranking.

- A. subordinate to
- B. imbued with
- C. equated with
- D. permeated by
- E. compromised by
- F. constrained by

test 117 section 1 (medium)

1. To write convincing fiction about the tedium of ordinary life may be one of the hardest challenges facing a novelist, who must find a way to engage the reader despite a focus on _____ events.

- A. distressing
- B. dubious
- C. quotidian
- D. unwonted
- E. nebulous

2. Much scholarship on the early Tana Tradition of coastal East Africa has been characterized by faith in the (i) _____ of that tradition, but detailed analysis of ceramics suggests that there were (ii) _____ the decorative motifs on early Tana Tradition jars, making it difficult to view the various Tana communities as a monolithic whole.

A. originality	D. regional differences in
B. homogeneity	E. practical reasons for
C. longevity	F. periodic revivals of

3. The obsidian found across the Pungaere-Upokorau area in New Zealand has previously been thought to come from two distinct sites (Pungaere and Waiare), but considering that the visual characteristics and chemical composition of the obsidian in the area are so (i) _____, there is no reason to continue regarding Waiare as (ii) _____ source, especially in view of the fact that finds of obsidian near Waiare settlement and in the Waiare Stream are (iii) _____.

A. diverse	D. a separate	G. rare
B. anomalous	E. the primary	H. varied

C. consistent	F. a declining	I. abundant
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4. Song, speech, and music are typically one in the blues: the instrument complements the voice, and though they may play instrumental solos, the most _____ blues artists sing through both voice and instrument. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. innovative
- B. exemplary
- C. original
- D. reminiscent
- E. representative
- F. nostalgic

5. The 1901 steel negotiations featured Morgan in his most famously _____ mode: knocking heads together, barking out prices for properties, and forcing titans to truckle to his will.

- A. quixotic
- B. eccentric
- C. histrionic
- D. theatrical
- E. chivalrous
- F. importunate

6. The Holy People in Navajo sacred narratives do not act as moral _____: when they teach, it is as often by what they do wrong as by what they do right.

- A. agents
- B. arbiters
- C. defenders
- D. paragons
- E. ethicists
- F. exemplars

7. Since it is an incredible challenge to detect dark matter directly, scientists have _____ its existence from its gravitational effects on shaping galaxies and other large-scale structures.

- A. isolated
- B. confirmed
- C. inferred
- D. surmised
- E. documented
- F. hypothesized

test 117 section 2 (easy)

1. Drug companies rarely pursue new pharmacotherapies for rare disease because of the high failure rates and the cost of research, which make the companies' chances of recovering their investments _____.

- A. tenable
- B. dubious
- C. invaluable
- D. sanguine
- E. expensive

2. The watchword in astronomy is ____: all claims must be examined critically in the light of current knowledge, and one's mind should never be closed to the possibility that a theory could be wrong. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. implausibility
- B. imagination
- C. wariness
- D. determination
- E. incoherency

3. Meegan Garber argues that the typical suburban lawn, which was originally designed to (i)_____ homes even as it enforced the distance between them, may be considered (ii)_____ domestic space: the whole neighborhood is invested in the appearance of each neighbor's yard.

A. beautify	D. utilitarian
B. connect	E. common
C. circumscribe	F. contested

4. Victories in intellectual battles in the human sciences are rarely (i)_____. While factionalism may persist, (ii)_____ also tend to occur, as reigning paradigms selectively (iii)_____ those revisionist contributions that offer greater analytical comprehension or enrich our range of empirical reference.

A. total	D. betrayals	G. incorporate
B. acknowledged	E. distortions	H. expunge
C. benign	F. accommodations	I. misrepresent

5. The North Atlantic Oscillation is seesaw of atmospheric pressure between a persistent high over Portugal's Azores islands and an equally _____ low over Iceland.

- A. enduring
- B. delimited
- C. abiding
- D. variable
- E. anemic
- F. bounded

6. Even though some governments are now expressing alarm over their nations' _____ birth rates, the planetary threat of human overpopulation has not ceased to concern many scientists and environmentalists.

- A. fluctuating
- B. incommensurate
- C. burgeoning
- D. flagging
- E. thriving
- F. languishing

7. At every turn in her novels, Patricia Highsmith eschews simple distinctions between good and evil, right and wrong, choosing instead to examine how _____ such distinctions can be.

- A. plastic
- B. palpable
- C. parochial
- D. arbitrary
- E. concrete
- F. malleable

test 118 section 1 (medium)

1. Accustomed to the author's ponderous prose, readers will likely be startled by the _____ that characterizes his new work. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. prolixity
- B. jocularity
- C. abstruseness
- D. predictability
- E. pessimism

2. The psychologist's new findings present the discipline with a (i)_____: although her results pose a problem for the standard theory, the alternative theories she proposes are (ii)_____.

A. predicament	D. unconvincing
B. paradigm	E. persuasive
C. prototype	F. versatile

3. Maupassant's own writings were often notable for their (i)_____, so there is something ironic in the publication of such a (ii)_____ new work devoted to his life: a densely packed compendium of detail about Maupassant's own forty-two-year existence, Johnston's 1,336-page biography is anything but (iii)_____.

A. inventiveness	D. rancorous	G. celebratory
B. concision	E. groundbreaking	H. original
C. ambition	F. sprawling	I. economical

4. Executives of successful companies frequently fail to exploit innovative new products because often they see only the difficulties and not the benefits of shifting financial and human resources from their profitable ongoing concern to something _____.

- A. impractical
- B. risky
- C. earthshaking
- D. vague
- E. speculative
- F. intangible

5. Stannard may be hoping to resurrect Spark's literary reputation with this book, given its _____ praise for her creative talents. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. unctuous
- B. genuine
- C. grudging
- D. reluctant
- E. unstinting
- F. generous

6. The tools of science are so specialized that we accept them as a kind of _____ machinery for producing knowledge: we know that they work, but cannot explain why.

- A. occult

- B. efficacious
- C. potent
- D. arcane
- E. impersonal
- F. reliable

7. The pupil had a reputation for obduracy, but the teacher found her to be, on the contrary, quite _____.

- A. zealous
- B. truculent
- C. bellicose
- D. tractable
- E. efficient
- F. complaisant

test 118 section 2 (medium)

1. Massive geological changes do not always happen gradually; for example, asteroid and comet impacts and volcanic eruptions cause _____ changes in Earth's environment.

- A. transitory
- B. precipitate
- C. predictable
- D. inconspicuous
- E. incalculable

2. The songwriter's (i)_____ nature can lead her audiences to forget that her songs are about painful experiences just as often as they are about (ii)_____ ones.

A. forthright	D. engaging
B. jocose	E. exultant
C. turgid	F. ponderous

3. Although weeds often (i)_____ and are (ii)_____ human activities, their cussedness and refusal to play by human rules makes them subversive and the very essence of wildness.

A. follow	D. unaffected by
B. thwart	E. impervious to
C. ignore	F. dependent on

4. Many perplexed observers find present-day museum design a choice between outlandishly sculptural structures that (i)_____ the proper display of art and neutral containers so (ii)_____ to art that all architectural presences is lost. But the New Museum persuasively demonstrates that honoring art and honoring architecture need not be (iii)_____ propositions.

A. ignore	D. submissive	G. carefully considered
B. enhance	E. demeaning	H. mutually exclusive
C. honor	F. impervious	I. entirely practical

5. The patrician old guard fancied itself _____ elite acting in ways that served the public interest; but in practice it proved to be intent on retaining its special advantages.

- A. a maligned
- B. a learned
- C. a benevolent
- D. an idealistic
- E. an impartial
- F. a disinterested

6. The removal of methane from transport emissions is a major _____ for automakers and catalyst suppliers: after decades, there has been little progress in developing catalysts that can initiate methane oxidation at the required temperatures. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. accomplishment
- B. challenge
- C. embarrassment
- D. triumph
- E. expense
- F. obstacle

7. The television network seems to regard its longest-running comedy show as _____, keeping it in the schedule even as the humor it churns out is notoriously hit-or-miss.

- A. flourishing
- B. outdated
- C. inviolable
- D. archaic
- E. sacrosanct
- F. immovable

test 119 section 1 (medium)

1. If we admire Winslow Homer as he wished to be admired, for his avoidance of claptrap and sentimentality, we may fear that Wood has done him a disservice by introducing _____ note into his discussion of the painter.

- A. an acerbic
- B. a supercilious
- C. an austere
- D. a maudlin
- E. an ironic

2. For many who are not philosophers, the word "metaphysics" still retains connotations of (i)_____, so that many hard scientists still use the term as a byword for (ii)_____ thinking.

A. impenetrability	D. innovative
B. amorphousness	E. imprecise
C. sterility	F. simplistic

3. According to linguists and cognitive scientists, the human mind specializes in producing analogies. Part of the reason cognitive scientists believe analogy is a (i)_____ cognitive process is that drawing analogies requires some sort of similarity mapping of one concept onto another, and

similarity mapping is a component of the inductive thinking we depend on. Another argument for the (ii)_____ of analogical reasoning in human reasoning is that metaphors, which are linguistically embedded analogies, are (iii)_____ language. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. creative	D. versatility	G. pervasive in
B. distinctive	E. centrality	H. expressed in
C. fundamental	F. difficulty	I. embellishments of

4. In Roth's fiction, politics is an element that doesn't naturally occur in _____ form but is always getting confused and mixed up with shame and anger, baseball and sex.

- A. an unalloyed
- B. an unbiased
- C. an uncontroversial
- D. an objective
- E. a neat
- F. a tendentious

5. For many centuries, bearing life's risks was supposed to be part of the human condition, and so any strategy for evading those risks was considered _____ of the natural order of things.

- A. a rejection
- B. a subversion
- C. a violation
- D. an overcoming
- E. an improvement
- F. an amelioration

6. One of the virtues of the essay collection is that it presents _____ views side by side, showing a wide range of thought and highlighting the contentious nature of many of the arguments within the discipline.

- A. dissonant
- B. congenial
- C. incongruent
- D. inconstant
- E. authoritative
- F. whimsical

7. For many readers, dissatisfaction with the book's contents will be _____ by the author's tone, which is decidedly immodest—though it might be said in his defense that given his professional success, he has much to be immodest about.

- A. aggravated
- B. mitigated
- C. exacerbated
- D. leavened
- E. confirmed
- F. contravened

test 119 section 2 (easy)

1. Unlike other rap artists, who often _____ behind the microphone, Drake writes out every word of his rhymes before he performs them. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. linger

- B. proselytize
- C. extemporize
- D. fulminate
- E. compromise

2. The employees' blithe natures were in sharp contrast to the _____ disposition of their manager.

- A. affable
- B. duplicitous
- C. apathetic
- D. lenient
- E. irascible

3. What is especially (i) _____ about the company's fiscal situation is that everybody knows the grim facts and (ii) _____ the implications, but nobody is willing to take any action to improve matters.

A. scary	D. misconstrues
B. unfair	E. ignores
C. understandable	F. concedes

4. Researchers claim that early mammals evolved a multistep process to synthesize vitamin C in their own bodies but that tens of millions of years ago some primates became so (i) _____ eating fruits rich in this vitamin that making their own became (ii) _____. Their physiology (iii) _____ their behavior. Consequently, their descendants, today's anthropoid primates, cannot make vitamin C.

A. accustomed to	D. a challenging task	G. adapted to
B. averse to	E. an unnecessary cost	H. interfered with
C. inefficient at	F. a practical solution	I. changed despite

5. Computational psychologists, since they take the operation of a computer as a model, _____ concepts from computer science to explain what the mind is and how it works.

- A. appropriate
- B. eschew
- C. emulate
- D. borrow
- E. covet
- F. reject

6. The late nineteenth century saw a shift in the production of African American history writing as works by _____ authors came to be outnumbered by the publications of professional African American academics.

- A. established
- B. literary
- C. lay
- D. erudite
- E. prominent
- F. avocational

7. There is a _____ in the author's writing: the words seem to stand almost in defiance of one another.

- A. discrepancy
- B. tension

- C. misconception
- D. discord
- E. delusion
- F. controversy

test 120 section 1 (medium)

1. El Greco was one of the most fervent of painters, to the extreme of mania, while Velázquez, by contrast, was one of the most _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. phlegmatic
- B. obstreperous
- C. edifying
- D. grandiloquent
- E. fanciful

2. Over the years, some researchers and educators have (i)_____ the argument for hands-on leaning of science, (ii)_____ that a more straightforward approach—known as direct instruction—has the potential to help students learn science more effectively.

A. challenged	D. conceding
B. evaluated	E. maintaining
C. refined	F. pretending

3. An innovative musician, accompanist extraordinaire, and protomodern hipster, Lester Young(1909-1959) remains a (i)_____ in the jazz firmament. Some of the reasons are obvious: although he dressed with conspicuous cool, he chose an artistic trajectory that seemed calculated to (ii)_____ the spotlight—his best work was in the bands of other musicians, such as Billie Holiday and Count Basie, rather than at the front of his own. Moreover, he was shy, subtle, and sensitive—traits not usually associated with great(iii)_____.

A. bright star	D. shun	G. imagination
B. lesser light	E. intensify	H. restraint
C. permanent fixture	F. exploit	I. celebrity

4. To say that John Adams was forthright was to be _____; friends as well as enemies were likely to characterize his stark honesty and direct manner as blunt and awkward.

- A. fickle
- B. charitable
- C. facetious
- D. unreasonable
- E. forbearing
- F. capricious

5. After landing on a flower, inexperienced bees show an _____ probing response, but they still must invest time in learning how to exploit flowers of increased complexity efficiently.

- A. immediate
- B. impressive
- C. inadequate
- D. ineffectual
- E. innate

F. intuitive

6. At the peak of the stock market's vertiginous rise, some corporate pension plans became overfunded: their assets _____ their liabilities. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. outstripped
- B. equaled
- C. matched
- D. encompassed
- E. inflated
- F. surpassed

7. Wang's book is the first attempt to define Chinese autobiography as _____ genre, that is, one distinct from other narrative modes of self-representation popular after the fall of the Qing dynasty in 1911.

- A. an imported
- B. a separate
- C. an influential
- D. a discrete
- E. an archetypal
- F. an consequential

test 120 section 2 (medium)

1. If dark energy is an energy field, it would not be _____: it might once have been stronger or weaker than it is now and could have affected the universe differently at different times.

- A. boundless
- B. directional
- C. invariant
- D. dynamic
- E. pervasive

2. George Eliot's novels were calculated to inspire sympathy in the reader for characters from a broad range of social classes, but her design was not (i) _____: Eliot hoped her fiction would have a (ii) _____ effect, spurting readers to show charity for those oppressed by the economic inequalities of her age. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. always obvious	D. pacifying
B. without complications	E. consoling
C. exclusively affective	F. galvanizing

3. The Cassini spacecraft initially found the bodies of liquid methane on Saturn's moon Titan to be very (i) _____, a surprising result since the reduced surface tension and viscosity of liquid methane, as compared to water on Earth, should make it (ii) _____ waves.

A. calm	D. easier to excite
B. deep	E. more difficult to measure
C. dense	F. more likely to distort

4. Aiken's (i)_____ regarding his own intellectual abilities—he has repeatedly attributed his academic success to luck and hard work rather than innate acuity—may have (ii)_____. If he feels he is surrounded by economists more (iii)_____ than he is, he may let their assertions, even the dubious ones, stand without challenge.

A. modesty	D. led him astray	G. brilliant
B. temerity	E. bolstered his success	H. determined
C. chagrin	F. embarrassed his admirers	I. boastful

5. Although streams of solar particles cause beautiful auroras —the northern and southern lights—sometimes their consequences are less _____: their electromagnetic effects, for instance, can overload power grids and damage orbiting satellites.

- A. spectacular
- B. significant
- C. benign
- D. consequential
- E. innocuous
- F. palpable

6. The so-called "sensation novel, popular in mid-nineteenth-century Britain, was dismissed by some as _____ form of fiction, partly because these spine-tingling novels often appeared as serials in cheap, disposable periodicals.

- A. an engrossing
- B. an ephemeral
- C. a macabre
- D. a transitory
- E. a captivating
- F. a debased

7. Hamlin Garland has tried to appeal to a wider audience by moving away from the gritty realism of his early writings, which often advanced populist political causes, and toward _____ mainstream fiction.

- A. demanding
- B. topical
- C. anodyne
- D. toothless
- E. derivative
- F. challenging

test 121 section 1 (medium)

1. Woody plant responses to herbivory were always thought to be _____; however, some scientists have reported localized responses to herbivory in certain woody plants.

- A. timely
- B. marginal
- C. unpredictable
- D. adequate
- E. systemic

2. Confidence in the nation's finances, barely nailed together by international financial institutions a few weeks ago, is still such a (i)_____ structure that the slightest disturbance could set it (ii)_____.

A. ramshackle	D. quivering
B. labyrinthine	E. ablaze
C. rigid	F. right

3. The antiestablishment comedy of the early 1960s developed in reaction to an age that was more (i)_____, a time when standing on a stage to make fun of a political leader or government official was a (ii)_____ act. In those days, the laughter of the audience was something for politicians to be afraid of, because it signaled a (iii)_____ in the public attitude toward the whole political class. Today, every politician is a target of satire and comedy, and laughter has become a reflexive, tired reaction to situations too depressing to evaluate clearly. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. humane	D. radical	G. developing moderation
B. austere	E. placatory	H. profound shift
C. deferential	F. prophetic	I. diminished resolve

4. The ear is much more _____ than the eye: only the ear can tell a source that oscillates 30 times a second from one that oscillates 60 times a second.

- A. stable
- B. efficient
- C. durable
- D. discerning
- E. accurate
- F. tenacious

5. Cash crops require committed, systematic cultivation; rubber tapping, on the other hand, is much more of _____ enterprise: it is largely a matter of stumbling upon a rubber plant that is ready for harvesting.

- A. a lucrative
- B. a contingent
- C. an arduous
- D. a conventional
- E. a profitable
- F. an uncertain

6. Like its protagonists, who are caught up in a historical moment that _____ the possibility of self-fulfillment, the novel Ready to Burst by Haitian writer Franketienne moves in disorienting circles, never progressing or achieving closure.

- A. celebrates
- B. downplays
- C. precludes
- D. romanticizes
- E. elevates
- F. frustrates

7. There are many contemporary composers who receive coveted commissions, only to see their creations _____ after one performance.

- A. dismantled
- B. redrafted
- C. plundered
- D. pilloried
- E. discarded

F. shelved

test 121 section 2 (easy)

1. An apparent paradox led the scientists to pursue their present line of research: they were struck by the fact that physical phenomena that are _____ in form can be described by a single mathematical formula. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. interchangeable
- B. rudimentary
- C. irreducible
- D. heterogeneous
- E. rare

2. In recent years, the country's farmers have been extremely _____, contributing a major portion of the disturbances and protests against government policies.

- A. discerning
- B. tractable
- C. restive
- D. mercurial
- E. circumspect

3. In the end, this odd, beautiful movie is emotionally remote and more (i)_____ than satisfying: a (ii)_____ film about catastrophe, made at a time when some of us might prefer an attempt at explanation.

A. suggestive	D. notably insightful
B. gratifying	E. viscerally immediate
C. instructive	F. coolly enigmatic

4. Pine stumps have been found in discrete layers in peat deposits throughout western Europe and thus represent brief but distinct episodes of bog colonization by pine. Their occurrence implies conditions on the bog surface suitable for colonization, followed by inhospitable conditions for trees that nevertheless facilitated preservation of stumps. Thus, the (i)_____ of pine stumps can (ii)_____ climate change, by(iii)_____ the inference that bog surfaces had dried sufficiently to allow colonization and then became too wet to support the trees.

A. loss	D. proceed undeterred by	G. supporting
B. resilience	E. vary independently of	H. repudiating
C. presence	F. function as a proxy for	I. articulating

5. He is most frugal in matters of business, but in his private life he reveals a streak of _____.

- A. parsimony
- B. profligacy
- C. immoderation
- D. deceit
- E. dissimulation
- F. indolence

6. People may be generally aware that media technologies employ toxic substances but maybe startled by the _____ of the environmental harms involved: humans, animals, vegetation, soil, air, and water are all affected. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. noxiousness
- B. permanence
- C. heterogeneity
- D. amplitude
- E. pervasiveness
- F. ubiquity

7. Atmospheric geoengineering, such as whitening clouds to cool Earth by reflecting more sunlight, is not an alternative to reducing carbon emissions, but it might _____ the beneficial effects of such a reduction.

- A. anticipate
- B. forestall
- C. engender
- D. reinforce
- E. duplicate
- F. complement

test 122 section 1 (medium)

1. Paradoxically, altruism may in fact be _____ if it aids only one's own clique.

- A. munificent
- B. counterproductive
- C. self-interested
- D. disproportionate
- E. beneficial

2. Environmental models are increasingly (i) _____ to the regulatory process. Computer modeling narrows the range of uncertainties related to pollution impacts, uncertainties that have (ii) _____ environmental policy making on all levels.

A. central	D. beset
B. inimical	E. justified
C. peripheral	F. advanced

3. There is a powerful tradition within French writing that has (i) _____ the bounds of conventional morality, (ii) _____ the dictates of Enlightenment reason, and expressed (iii) _____ violence. It is as if the culture that, perhaps more strongly than any other, celebrated reason and geometrical order, also provoked within itself a deep, wild, and willfully primitive reaction, a return of the repressed par excellence. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. clarified	D. expanded	G. a cautious skepticism toward
B. challenged	E. anticipated	H. an abiding fascination with
C. upheld	F. defied	I. a visceral distaste for

4. Picasso's habit of keeping every last scrap of paper was not entirely a good thing: he left so much of it that his own archives can seem to _____ any view of the man.

- A. corroborate
- B. reflect
- C. elucidate
- D. inspire
- E. confirm
- F. illuminate

5. The power of our Sun is _____.: more solar energy strikes the Earth's surface in one hour of each day than the energy used by all human activities in one year.

- A. prodigious
- B. ominous
- C. auspicious
- D. foreboding
- E. colossal
- F. sufficient

6. The author takes a decidedly _____ approach to fiction, ensuring that any assumptions a reader might bring to his stories will be subject to challenge and disruption.

- A. controversial
- B. nostalgic
- C. unpolished
- D. unorthodox
- E. experimental
- F. wistful

7. In a production process that is complex and often unpredictable, roles that start out discretely defined may become quite _____.

- A. unambiguous
- B. untenable
- C. fluid
- D. mutable
- E. explicit
- F. perfunctory

test 122 section 2 (medium)

1. Action cinema has a reputation for giving spectators all action and no plot, and that reputation for narrative _____ seems to have gained further traction with the increasingly ubiquitous use of digital effects. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. paucity
- B. homogeneity
- C. diffuseness
- D. predictability
- E. convolution

2. Ethical theorists often assume that the verb "ought" means roughly "has an obligation." This assumption, however, is (i) _____ the (ii) _____ of "ought" sentences in English: the word is used in too many ways to admit a single definition.

A. belied by	D. diversity
B. predicated on	E. importance

C. consequential for	F. conspicuousness
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3. Literary salons and coffeehouses (i)_____ the class-based systems of social hierarchies prevalent at the time. Meritocratic appreciation of wit and brilliance, wherever it might issue, replaced (ii)_____ to established power.

A. reaffirmed	D. indifference
B. broke down	E. deference
C. anticipated	F. affronts

4. One of the great misconceptions regarding Earth is that it is (i)_____. This is true only if your sense of connection depends on large chunks of physical matter moving from place to place. The dust and rocks that rain down from space are indeed (ii)_____, even if some of the larger rocks are occasionally a (iii)_____. Matter trickles in, trickles out. But matter is not everything: an unending spate of pure luminous energy pours down on Earth in a 170,000-trillion-watt torrent.

A. fragile	D. negligible	G. source of contention
B. isolated	E. terrifying	H. cause for concern
C. fixed	F. fascinating	I. boon to researchers

5. Earth may be considered a more _____ version of the other terrestrial planets: because Earth has developed and maintained plate tectonics over eons, its surface, unlike the other planets' surfaces, has continued to change.

- A. treacherous
- B. rugged
- C. unsettled
- D. weathered
- E. intricate
- F. inconstant

6. Although she is widely portrayed as being rather _____, Carson's letters to publishers reveal her complete confidence in her skills as a writer and naturalist along with her willingness to promote herself and her abilities.

- A. shy
- B. diffident
- C. pedantic
- D. loquacious
- E. capricious
- F. whimsical

7. Some researchers argue that archaeological evidence is too _____: depending on the background theory archaeologists bring to bear, they may interpret the significance of the unearthed artifacts as evidence very differently.

- A. incomplete
- B. inaccessible
- C. indeterminate
- D. controversial
- E. uncertain
- F. fragmentary

test 123 section 1 (medium)

1. There is a rather _____ reason for astronomers' sudden interest in comets: most other bodies in the solar system have been explored already.

- A. pedantic
- B. prosaic
- C. controversial
- D. untenable
- E. mysterious

2. Insects are often (i) _____ as the world's most versatile and (ii) _____ flying machines. Yet they shouldn't even be able to get off the ground, at least not according to a straightforward interpretation of the laws of aerodynamics.

A. ridiculed	D. contrived
B. overlooked	E. atypical
C. touted	F. maneuverable

3. Predators try to (i) _____ their ultimate energy intake by (ii) _____ the effort they expend searching for and handling prey relative to the energy the prey provides. Thus, a particular kind of prey would be (iii) _____ to a predator's diet only if it is worth the predator's time and energy—that is, if it increases the animal's overall energy profit during foraging. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. stabilize	D. deferring	G. deleterious
B. gauge	E. intensifying	H. added
C. maximize	F. reducing	I. unique

4. The term "borderline, coined in the 1930s to describe a psychiatric condition straddling the boundary between two other diagnoses, remained _____ until John Gunderson enumerated six identifying characteristics of the condition in the 1970s.

- A. equivocal
- B. stigmatized
- C. impracticable
- D. incontrovertible
- E. anomalous
- F. nebulous

5. In this otherwise _____ study, the internal tensions resulting from the increasing integration of the United States with the world economy are simply mentioned rather than analyzed.

- A. tedious
- B. thorough
- C. biased
- D. exhaustive
- E. superficial
- F. shallow

6. Although Ralph Ellison's *Invisible Man* has been heavily praised for over 50 years by a wide variety of critics and scholars, there have been _____ from the outset concerning the novel's political vision. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. rebukes
- B. doubts

- C. conjectures
- D. speculations
- E. reservations
- F. accolades

7. Egler's prediction in 1947 that the introduction of mangrove trees to the Hawaiian Islands would cause sweeping ecological change was _____.: extensive mangrove forests have come to displace many preexisting plant communities.

- A. accurate
- B. premature
- C. prescient
- D. foresighted
- E. optimistic
- F. precipitate

test 123 section 2 (easy)

1. Concerned about the growing tendency of universities to sometimes reward celebrity more generously than specialized expertise, many academics have deplored the search for _____ to which that practice leads.

- A. approbation
- B. collegiality
- C. erudition
- D. renown
- E. prowess

2. While Fernández-Armesto has amply documented the commercial, migratory, scientific, or religious motives of explorers throughout history, it is often harder to _____ the motives of modern explorers.

- A. generate
- B. penetrate
- C. extinguish
- D. utilize
- E. criticize

3. She was skeptical about the (i)_____ reviews of the latest production of the play, feeling that the production she had seen years earlier was (ii)_____, and that any successive attempts must undoubtedly fall short. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. lackluster	D. nothing less than definitive
B. rhapsodic	E. generally adequate
C. pithy	F. surprisingly conservative

4. Although Sapir and Whorf's notion that different languages may impart different cognitive skills met with (i)_____ early on, they had little evidence to support their claim. By the 1970s many scientists had become (ii)_____ their hypothesis, and it was largely (iii)_____ as a new set of theories claiming that language and thought are universal came to dominate the field.

A. skepticism	D. convinced of	G. revived
B. excitement	E. disenchanted with	H. corroborated

C. controversy	F. inured to	I. abandoned
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5. The archaeological record suggests that written literature is a _____ the administrative state: invented primarily to keep tax records and memorialize royal decrees, writing eventually got co-opted into preserving people's myths and legends.

- A. prerequisite for
- B. glorification of
- C. progeny of
- D. menace to
- E. celebration of
- F. byproduct of

6. In her literary criticism, eighteenth-century writer Elizabeth Montagu was _____, not only crossing swords with the illustrious Voltaire but also challenging a host of well-known English male commentators on Shakespeare, including Samuel Johnson.

- A. intrepid
- B. original
- C. cautious
- D. valiant
- E. flippant
- F. wary

7. As an aspiring politician, Gurstein aims to achieve _____ tone in her public addresses without falling into aristocratic overtones.

- A. a polemical
- B. an elevated
- C. an argumentative
- D. an expressive
- E. a lofty
- F. a dispassionate

test 124 section 1 (medium)

1. The preliminary analysis being on the whole, reassuring, its confirmation would _____ concerns about the dangers of the project.

- A. explain
- B. rationalize
- C. reflect
- D. assuage
- E. obscure

2. The new exhibition of Sophie Calle's work in San Francisco is (i) _____ but still (ii) _____: given Calle's international stardom and aesthetic reach, the French artist is deserving of a full-career retrospective in America.

A. politically charged	D. whimsical
B. quite extensive	E. insufficient
C. somewhat selective	F. overwhelming

3. Elephants are known to use a wide variety of calls, many of them infrasonic (below the level of human hearing), in coordinating group behavior. The infrasonic calls usually have a component that is (i)_____, but these higher frequency aspects of the calls (ii)_____ very quickly with distance, so that in the wild, human observers are often (iii)_____ sudden coordinated movements of large groups of elephants when no signal was apparent to the observer.

A. somewhat muted	D. attenuate	G. alert to
B. distinctly sonorous	E. repeat	H. ignorant of
C. humanly audible	F. differentiate	I. astonished by

4. Smi's analysis of climate change is even more _____ than that supplied by most well-informed writers, and thus deserves serious consideration. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. nuanced
- B. unoriginal
- C. complex
- D. derivative
- E. partisan
- F. compelling

5. While it is true that the tennis star has been defeated in recent years by some relatively obscure players, counting her out of any tournament, particularly if she is healthy, seems _____.

- A. foolhardy
- B. imprudent
- C. unnecessary
- D. audacious
- E. alarming
- F. gratuitous

6. The artist's apparently casual, improvisatory pictures are not the _____ renditions they may seem: her pictures are, in fact, the result of a highly disciplined style.

- A. calculated
- B. rigorous
- C. offhand
- D. precise
- E. extempore
- F. defiant

7. Party leaders hoped to find a single compelling issue that would _____ party members across the country, prompting them to turn out in significant numbers on election day.

- A. satisfy
- B. rouse
- C. intrigue
- D. animate
- E. hamper
- F. impede

test 124 section 2 (medium)

1. Because they were traditionally _____, Jain monks in sixteenth-century India particularly valued special dispensations from the royal court granting them freedom of movement.

- A. erudite

- B. ascetic
- C. apolitical
- D. peripatetic
- E. solitary

2. Though extremely secretive about her own plans, she allowed her associates no such (i) _____ and was constantly (ii) _____ information about what they intended to do next.

A. reticence	D. distorting
B. introspection	E. ignoring
C. mendaciousness	F. requesting

3. Svitlana Mayboroda's recent work, though (i) _____ pure mathematics, is already being (ii) _____ by physicists, distinguishing it from most mathematical advances, for which the development of any practical use is long delayed. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. largely irrelevant to	D. applied
B. familiar to scholars of	E. overlooked
C. in the realm of	F. questioned

4. The author of this (i) _____ memoir is notable for an unmitigated (ii) _____ that is matched only by an utter lack of self-awareness. Although that combination of personality traits is not uncommon, it is rare for a book that is so transparently an exercise in (iii) _____ to have the exact opposite of its intended effect.

A. self-critical	D. self-regard	G. self-examination
B. self-serving	E. self-abnegation	H. self-incrimination
C. self-effacing	F. self-consciousness	I. self-aggrandizement

5. Singer Nina Simone in many ways defied categorization, with her artist _____ evident in her early pieces that drew on disparate musical genres, including musical theater, blues, and jazz standards.

- A. inventiveness
- B. diligence
- C. hybridity
- D. assiduity
- E. eclecticism
- F. acumen

6. In the past, the exploitation of various categories of natural resources was done _____, but because of the hugely expanded scale of today's economy, exploitation of all the resources in many countries now occurs simultaneously.

- A. fruitfully
- B. rapidly
- C. hastily
- D. benignly
- E. sequentially
- F. successively

7. Though mathematics is _____, like language, it has its roots in the mud of everyday embodied experience; one such root is counting. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. essential
- B. indispensable
- C. abstract
- D. theoretical
- E. prescriptive
- F. functional

test 125 section 1 (medium)

1. Because the instructions they have been given are exhaustive and unequivocal, employees are now working without _____.

- A. recompense
- B. discretion
- C. monotony
- D. certitude
- E. limitation

2. In aging bees, cognitive decline is (i) _____ under certain social conditions--for example, when the colony divides by swarming or when foragers or young nurse bees are removed from the colony. Each of these circumstances causes older bees to become cognitively (ii) _____, while juvenile bees, by contrast, exhibit a faster age-related cognitive decline.

A. common	D. overactive
B. reversed	E. younger
C. dangerous	F. sluggish

3. Among the rising generation of concert pianists, a (i) _____ approach to performance is sadly (ii) _____. Too often, young pianists have acquired such an approach from their teachers, the very people who should be pointing out that the flailing arm, the contorted brow, the bulging eye, and the balletic upper torso are (iii) _____ work in a business best devoted to doing the most with the least.

A. histrionic	D. passé	G. extraneous
B. stately	E. endangered	H. respected
C. languid	F. pervasive	I. stylish

4. The _____ diction of the short Somali poetry form known as balwo was well suited for political purposes: invective could easily be hidden in an apparent love poem.

- A. cryptic
- B. enigmatic
- C. romantic
- D. iconoclastic
- E. irreverent
- F. nuanced

5. Scientists studying the stresses and strains accumulated in the Earth's crust have found that it is surprisingly easy to _____ earthquakes, even in regions that historically have been seismically silent or nearly so. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. detect
- B. trigger
- C. ignore
- D. cause
- E. disregard
- F. predict

6. The high seriousness of St. Aubyn's novel is not at all superficial; in fact, it is _____ the novel's ferociously comic vision.

- A. redolent of
- B. reminiscent of
- C. intrinsic to
- D. inimical to
- E. antagonistic to
- F. inextricable from

7. Surprisingly, although the textbooks are filled with pages of vocabulary and unnecessary detail, their treatment of some fundamentally important concepts is _____.

- A. prolix
- B. piecemeal
- C. verbose
- D. fragmentary
- E. abstruse
- F. succinct

test 125 section 2 (medium)

1. Contrary to what might be expected, having numerous relationships is not necessarily a _____ loneliness since loneliness is determined by the way people experience relationships subjectively.

- A. measure of
- B. bulwark against
- C. catalyst for
- D. consequence of
- E. substitute for

2. During Roosevelt's first meeting with President Harrison, Harrison seemed less _____ than usual: having just returned from a salubrious cruise down the Potomac, his characteristic sour silence was replaced by a ruddy, clear-eyed demeanor.

- A. propitiatory
- B. sanguine
- C. pensive
- D. dyspeptic
- E. belligerent

3. Whereas in the early nineteenth century phrenologists had seen every part of the brain surface as the seat of a specific intellectual or moral faculty, the 1830s and 1840s saw a (i) _____ of this belief, to such an extent that the brain came to be seen as (ii) _____.

A. popularization	D. hierarchical
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B. vindication	E. undifferentiated
C. reexamination	F. decipherable

4. One of the problems with recent books that perpetuate the view of Jane Austen as moral tutor, a sort of Miss Manners for the ages, is that they understand manners as (i)_____, as near-universal and timeless behavioral ideals or, worse still, a set of rules to be followed. It is crucial, however, to (ii)_____. In other words, one needs to resist (iii)_____ generic "manners" with more linguistically and historically precise designations, no least because Austen herself distinguishes.

A. trivial	D. deemphasize historical context	G. comparing
B. necessary	E. differentiate various behaviors	H. conflating
C. monolithic	F. apply moral precepts	I. augmenting

5. A telescope orbiting in space, above the unruly atmosphere, is able to detect ultraviolet and infrared emissions that are blocked by Earth's atmosphere and thus _____ to astronomers on the ground. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. unremarkable
- B. indiscernible
- C. exasperating
- D. undecipherable
- E. inconclusive
- F. imperceptible

6. Walking appears simple, yet every step forward is a _____ act: each step is essentially a fall that one must catch by swinging one's leg forward so that one's foot lands on the floor just in time.

- A. complicated
- B. skillful
- C. hasty
- D. risky
- E. deliberate
- F. precarious

7. Scholars of the civil rights movement have often characterized it as springing from social, political, and economic structures _____ the South, thus overlooking the tradition of civil rights activism in other regions of the country.

- A. originating in
- B. imposed on
- C. perpetuated by
- D. unique to
- E. characteristic of
- F. detrimental to

test 126 section 1 (medium)

1. In contemporary rhetoric, the environment has been _____; we now speak of "natural resources" rather than "nature," as though the natural world were something to be sold, bought, or discarded.

- A. presaged
- B. personified
- C. apotheosized
- D. depoliticized
- E. commodified

2. (i)_____ Kafka's halfhearted instruction that his unprinted manuscripts be destroyed after his death, his friend Max Brod set about publishing them immediately following the author's demise and thus became the (ii)_____ Kafka's belated fame.

A. Ignoring	D. arbiter of
B. Embracing	E. apologist for
C. Questioning	F. architect of

3. Some scientists speculate that changes in atmospheric methane were responsible for some abrupt global warming events in the past such as the one at the end of the geologic period known as the Younger Dryas. There is good evidence that large quantities of methane have been released quickly in the past through natural processes; however, methane is a relatively (i)_____ molecule in the atmosphere and thus (ii)_____ through chemical reactions with other compounds. The effect of even a large increase would therefore be (iii)_____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. important	D. not easily altered	G. accelerated
B. unstable	E. eventually regenerated	H. ephemeral
C. abundant	F. fairly quickly destroyed	I. catastrophic

4. The overall persuasiveness of the literary critic's analysis was occasionally marred by _____ generalizations that served only to distract attentive readers from the intended point.

- A. questionable
- B. vacuous
- C. broad
- D. dubious
- E. incisive
- F. trenchant

5. It is not exactly socialism that has _____ so much of the country's economic life with cumbersome regulations but a meddlesome governmental culture that has been in place for centuries.

- A. imbued
- B. betrayed
- C. animated
- D. energized
- E. stifled
- F. throttled

6. Many working physicists believe that general relativity, while _____, is itself only one aspect of a more comprehensive theory that embraces all the forces of nature.

- A. abstruse
- B. complete
- C. obscure
- D. correct
- E. accurate
- F. fascinating

7. Globalization has made ethnic entrepreneurship resilient in postindustrial economies: well represented in the small business sector in the United States, ethnic entrepreneurship has been _____ by the volatile tides of international migration. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. sustained
- B. perpetuated
- C. diversified
- D. vitiated
- E. overwhelmed
- F. attenuated

test 126 section 2 (medium)

1. In terms of energy consumption, the brain is quite _____: we humans, for example, have brains that account for slightly more than 2 percent of our biomass, but our brains burn up more than 15 percent of our basal metabolic energy.

- A. efficient
- B. typical
- C. ravenous
- D. unpredictable
- E. inscrutable

2. Although the committee's pronouncements are (i) _____, consultation with the committee is (ii) _____ and in some cases is even mandatory.

A. purely advisory	D. compulsory
B. legally binding	E. routine
C. rarely controversial	F. optional

3. With respect to environmental issues, most legal scholarship tends to envision politics as the pursuit of already fixed interests, a view that (i) _____ the ability of political communities to (ii) _____ their values and their interests through the process of democratic deliberation.

A. leverages	D. mask
B. overstates	E. transform
C. ignores	F. defend

4. Although the book's vast notes section (i) _____ the impressive breadth of Brzezinski's research, his (ii) _____ seems to fill in the gaps in what his absorption in memoirs and interviews enabled him to learn about the events leading up to the launch of Sputnik, leading him to make (iii) _____ claims in some of his descriptions.

A. foreshadows	D. scholarship	G. fanciful
B. documents	E. foreknowledge	H. vehement
C. subverts	F. imagination	I. cautious

5. Nowadays helium is _____ substance, but just a few generations ago it was an astrophysical conundrum: its spectral lines had been seen in the Sun, but it had never been detected in any other way.

- A. a volatile
- B. a mundane
- C. a voluminous
- D. a commonplace
- E. an abundant
- F. an economical

6. Although the establishment of risk exposure limits and other safety regulations is generally presented as _____, risk-related decisions often contain value-based judgments regarding which risks to accept.

- A. disinterested
- B. impartial
- C. necessary
- D. prudent
- E. preventative
- F. sensible

7. According to A. Elizabeth Arnold, fungi growing inside plant tissue are not causing disease and may in fact protect the plant: leaves of wild cacao trees with abundant internal fungi, for example, _____ colonization by disease-causing fungi. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. resist
- B. accelerate
- C. offset
- D. expedite
- E. withstand
- F. interrupt

test 127 section 1 (medium)

1. The publication of books in the vernacular in fifteenth-century England laid the foundation for a literary language that survives relatively unchanged and thus gives English literature a greater _____ than many other national literatures.

- A. sophistication
- B. diversity
- C. specificity
- D. flair
- E. continuity

2. At first glance, each of the stories in the anthology seemed (i) _____; upon closer inspection of their protagonists, implied morals, and fantasy elements, however, subtle similarities among the stories emerged to (ii) _____ this initial observation.

A. compelling	D. impugn
B. implausible	E. bolster
C. idiosyncratic	F. explain

3. If companies were taxed based on the amount of their atmospheric emissions of pollutants, they could make their own decisions about how to alter their operations. Firms could compare the cost of paying taxes with the cost of preventing the emissions in the first place and would, in most cases, do a bit of both. Firms that can reduce pollution (i)_____ would reduce it quite (ii)_____, while those that can only do so at great cost would (iii)_____.

A. cheaply	D. gradually	G. curtail less
B. materially	E. prudently	H. gain advantages
C. rapidly	F. substantially	I. anticipate losses

4. For a long time, painter V. S. Gaitonde's reputation, which barely existed in the West, _____ in his native India, partly because his abstract style was viewed as culturally irrelevant, even un-Indian. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. flagged
- B. endured
- C. languished
- D. burgeoned
- E. persevered
- F. metamorphosed

5. Millville has its share of suburban eyesores—cement-block strip malls, rows of fast-food restaurants, and _____ split-level homes marching up hillsides denuded of trees.

- A. magnificent
- B. superlative
- C. abysmal
- D. banal
- E. lackluster
- F. diminutive

6. Her poetry was marked by a tension between modernity and traditionalism: she adhered to classical modes of expression while deriving inspiration from _____ social themes.

- A. difficult
- B. contemporary
- C. challenging
- D. topical
- E. conventional
- F. controversial

7. Tycho Brahe had assigned Kepler the task of deriving parameters for the model of Mars, a particularly _____ problem, which had stymied others because the large eccentricity of Mars exposed the inadequacies of the model itself.

- A. novel
- B. recalcitrant
- C. intractable
- D. crucial
- E. profound
- F. treacherous

test 127 section 2 (easy)

1. With his winning personality and ingratiating manner, Arturo found it a simple matter to _____ the deed to the property for himself, though its original holder initially seemed impervious to persuasion.

- A. inveigle
- B. confiscate
- C. impound
- D. annul
- E. abrogate

2. The subjects who were engaged in more difficult tasks _____ deterioration in their performance over time, and therefore the need to concentrate apparently enhances long-term efficiency.

- A. elicited
- B. anticipated
- C. noticed
- D. displayed
- E. evaded

3. Despite its (i) _____, reductionism as a research strategy in biology has proved (ii) _____: the ascendancy of the life sciences over the past fifty years attests to the power of the reductionist approach. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. popularity	D. successful
B. attestation	E. controversial
C. deficiencies	F. uncommon

4. Materials expand and contract with temperature changes. This general concept has been exploited for thousands of years, for instance, to ensure tight rivets in blacksmithing by shrink-fitting. For precision instruments, however, (i) _____ materials are truly (ii) _____: hence the importance of Invar, an alloy notable for its (iii) _____ expansion and contraction over a range of temperatures.

A. dimensionally stable	D. unreliable	G. resistance to
B. mechanically durable	E. paramount	H. alternation between
C. thermally conductive	F. economical	I. toughness from

5. In a cross-cultural study of four hundred pre-industrial societies, social scientist James W. Prescott found that in societies in which little affection is shown to infants, there is a _____ of institutions devoted to organized religion and social hierarchy.

- A. miscellany
- B. deluge
- C. preponderance
- D. plethora
- E. shortage
- F. majority

6. A simplistic _____ of idealism is to assert that because physical reality appears solid and "real" to the senses, no other substances exist.

- A. refutation
- B. censure
- C. antithesis
- D. equivocation
- E. rebuttal

F. summary

7. Though the CEO was not in accordance with the board's decision to reward employees with a larger than expected annual bonus, she was hardly one to _____ workers their compensation.

- A. allow
- B. begrudge
- C. deny
- D. indulge
- E. grant
- F. entrust

test 128 section 1 (medium)

1. Once the disk of material around a star is gas-depleted, dust is removed efficiently by the stellar radiation field and wind; any observed dust in a gas-depleted disk must, therefore, have been produced _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. gradually
- B. rapidly
- C. recently
- D. vestigially
- E. intermittently

2. Business leaders who prefer centralized, pyramidal managerial structures to diversity and competition tend to (i)_____ dissent in the decision-making process. But this insistence on (ii)_____ can be dangerous in that it deprives decision makers of a full range of alternatives.

A. foster	D. spontaneity
B. deprecate	E. unanimity
C. overrate	F. ambiguity

3. The fantastic conceit of the film's plot is that global warming (i)_____ global freezing. After a chunk of Antarctic ice the size of Rhode Island suddenly melts, most of what follows—an instant ice age, for example—is impossible as science but not as metaphor. The data from the Greenland ice sheet show that, over the past hundred thousand years, temperatures have often (ii)_____ — so often that it is our own relatively static experience of climate that should now be seen as (iii)_____.

A. succeeds	D. swung wildly	G. humdrum
B. inhibits	E. changed gradually	H. exceptional
C. produces	F. seemed unvarying	I. authentic

4. While the kitchen may be free of the toxins polluting the outdoors, certain cooking implements, when heated at high temperatures, can release _____ vapors.

- A. rancid
- B. noxious
- C. evanescent
- D. targeted
- E. unorthodox
- F. dangerous

5. To any observer, ancient or _____, the night sky appears as a hemisphere resting on the horizon. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. antiquated
- B. perceptive
- C. modern
- D. astute
- E. contemporary
- F. archaic

6. Anthropologists contend that the ancient Mesopotamians switched from grain production to barley after excessive irrigation and salt accumulation made the soil _____ grains.

- A. indifferent to
- B. inhospitable to
- C. unsuitable for
- D. acrimonious to
- E. benignant to
- F. inured to

7. Researchers interested in the nature versus nurture debate use identical twins who were separated at birth to explore which personality characteristics are _____ and which arise through experience.

- A. intractable
- B. nascent
- C. erudite
- D. innate
- E. predilection
- F. inborn

test 128 section 2 (medium)

1. Heresy and schism are not restricted to the theologians: science also has its share of fields that are _____ sectarianism.

- A. resistant to
- B. riven by
- C. unified by
- D. buttressed by
- E. free of

2. Icelanders sometimes claim that everyone in Iceland is a writer. Sure, it's (i) _____ and as such is out of character for a literary tradition long characterized by (ii) _____. Still, approximately a thousand books are published each year in Iceland for a population of about 290, 000: one book per 290 persons.

A. hyperbole	D. understatement
B. sarcasm	E. intensity
C. clarification	F. diversity

3. As an essayist, Reed is an equal-opportunity combatant who pulls no punches. One strength in his approach is that this (i) _____ can be disarmingly refreshing. On the downside, however, Reed sometimes surrenders too quickly to his more (ii) _____ impulses.

A. coy self-deprecation	D. polemical
B. colloquial informality	E. ingratiating
C. aggressive frankness	F. analytical

4. Describing cosmopolitanism and provincialism as (i) _____ concepts misses part of their relationship. They are actually (ii) _____, both in the strictly semiotic sense that the idea of cosmopolitanism is (iii) _____ unless we can oppose it to something like provincialism and in a more practical sense: much of cosmopolitanism involves recombining elements of provincial cultures. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. empirical	D. entirely abstract	G. meaningless
B. antithetical	E. largely interchangeable	H. autonomous
C. evolving	F. mutually constitutive	I. transparent

5. The eccentric Canadian Prime Minister, Mackenzie King, often used stances to contact his dead pet dog for advice; despite this _____ behavior, the public had so much confidence in his ability as a leader that he was in power for 22 years.

- A. capricious
- B. lackluster
- C. poised
- D. unconventional
- E. repulsive
- F. decorous

6. The circulation of the blood makes human adaptability to the _____ conditions of life, such as fluctuating atmospheric pressure, level of physical activity, and diet, possible.

- A. inveterate
- B. dynamic
- C. timorous
- D. cowed
- E. turgid
- F. oscillating

7. A particular bacterium that has never encountered a particular virus will usually succumb to it, a _____ that may, surprisingly, be beneficial to the colony in which the bacterium lives.

- A. susceptibility
- B. theory
- C. characteristic
- D. juxtaposition
- E. collision
- F. hypothesis

test 129 section 1 (medium)

1. The results of the latest survey being _____, earlier results gave researchers little relevant experience for the new data's interpretation.

- A. superfluous
- B. inconsequential
- C. tedious

- D. unexampled
- E. familiar

2. All of these writers rely on (i)_____ and (ii)_____ to make their argument: they take a single idea and illustrate it with endless, rather overblown examples while avoiding any genuinely nuanced analysis. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. fabrication	D. exaggeration
B. equivocation	E. speculation
C. simplification	F. prevarication

3. Glaeser condemn the “agrarian utopianism” of those who (i)_____ rural life and (ii)_____ the environmental (iii)_____ of certain big cities, chiefly less driving and the greater energy efficiency of heating the multifamily structures that characterize many urban settings.

A. sentimentalize	D. fail to appreciate	G. virtues
B. satirize	E. rush to extol	H. risks
C. marginalize	F. refuse to disparage	I. compromises

4. Retrofitted with stabilizing devices, some of which _____ its aesthetics, the bridge has been reopened, no longer prone to excessive swaying but not quite the breathtaking structure it originally was.

- A. impair
- B. resist
- C. improve
- D. enhance
- E. restore
- F. compromise

5. Mr. Hirsch says he will aim to preserve the foundation’s support of _____ thinkers, individuals who are going against the trends in a field or an acknowledged set of opinions.

- A. iconoclastic
- B. integrative
- C. doctrinaire
- D. heterodox
- E. dogmatic
- F. synthesizing

6. In France cultural subsidies are _____: producers of just about any film can get an advance from the government against box-office receipts, even though most such loans are never fully repaid.

- A. ubiquitous
- B. invaluable
- C. sporadic
- D. scanty
- E. questionable
- F. omnipresent

7. Although it is loathsome to some people, slang often expresses ideas with great directness, avoiding the _____ of more refined language.

- A. circumlocution
- B. syntax
- C. ornateness

- D. obfuscation
- E. periphrasis
- F. opprobrium

test 129 section 2 (easy)

1. As tough as it looks, the Chihuahuan Desert is a _____ place: although few humans have been here, their footsteps have fallen heavily in the desert.

- A. forbidding
- B. fragile
- C. secluded
- D. beguiling
- E. hallowed

2. In general, the relationship between neural activity and behavioral output is _____: multiple behaviors can be associated with activation of the same neurons and multiple neurons can trigger the same behavior. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. deterministic
- B. hardwired
- C. random
- D. complicated
- E. cumulative

3. The philosopher held that art must perform a paradoxical task, simultaneously extricating itself from the (i) _____ even while (ii) _____ the realities of ordinary experience.

A. impersonal	D. largely transcending
B. prescriptive	E. casually dismissing
C. quotidian	F. forthrightly addressing

4. When we forgive a person, we (i) _____ our (ii) _____ his or her transgression but (iii) _____ certain punitive responses that we would ordinarily be justified in taking on the basis of that person's objectionable conduct.

A. relinquish	D. leniency toward	G. disguise
B. regret	E. uncertainty about	H. forgo
C. retain	F. condemnation of	I. initiate

5. The _____ of the Foundation novels by the noted science-fiction writer Isaac Asimov is that historians and psychologists succeed in finding laws that can successfully predict—based on collective human behavior—the broad outlines of future events.

- A. premise
- B. verisimilitude
- C. postulate
- D. paradox
- E. incongruity
- F. implication

6. What is remarkable about The Feminine Mystique is that it can seem, alternately, so antique and so _____, a reminder of what has changed and what has not.

- A. fresh
- B. obsolete
- C. scholarly
- D. learned
- E. obvious
- F. germane

7. Jane Austen belonged to the social class about which she mainly wrote, and although her novels offer abundant satire, one never has the sense that she viewed the basic elements of this social sphere as _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. laudable
- B. unfathomable
- C. ignoble
- D. reprehensible
- E. inviolable
- F. praiseworthy

test 130 section 1 medium

1. Although among currently available models Mestel's provides the most _____ account of how white dwarfs evolve, it captures the essentials of the physics of white dwarf evolution.

- A. cited
- B. realistic
- C. corroborated
- D. simplified
- E. comprehensive

2. As an intellectual trying to navigate the world of politics, Madison's problem was not, as some claimed, that he was too (i) _____ to respond to shifting political realities; indeed, he was intellectually quite (ii) _____, adapting to the demands of the moment.

A. impulsive	D. agile
B. doctrinaire	E. austere
C. ambivalent	F. engaged

3. A film adaptation so (i) _____ can make the original novel seem (ii) _____. Who hasn't thought, "I've seen the movie, why read the book?" But where the film of Empire of the Sun is generally faithful to its source, the novel offers less high drama but a more (iii) _____ view of the protagonist's growth and confusion. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. satisfying	D. pedestrian	G. multifaceted
B. drastic	E. exhilarating	H. conventional
C. pretentious	F. redundant	I. sensational

4. Evidence of the human brain's _____ abounds: violinists, for example, tend to have larger cortical areas devoted to processing signals from their fingering hands than do non-violinists.

- A. synchronicity
- B. flexibility
- C. complexity

- D. malleability
- E. vulnerability
- F. sensitivity

5. Vast, complex, and deeply entrenched, the administrative apparatus that answered to Egypt's Queen Cleopatra was _____ instrument with which to govern.

- A. an antiquated
- B. an efficient
- C. a modest
- D. a simple
- E. an unwieldy
- F. a cumbersome

6. With poetry seemingly forever composing its own _____, and the novel apparently writing its last chapter, science fiction writers are now similarly concerned that they face a future in which their writing could, ironically, be a thing of the past.

- A. saga
- B. chronicle
- C. critique
- D. inaugural
- E. elegy
- F. requiem

7. In mid-nineteenth-century Paris, some independent women survived economically by running small dressmaking businesses, though the displacement of custom-made clothing by factory-made garments _____ these needleworkers' economic opportunities.

- A. confounded
- B. curtailed
- C. diminished
- D. augmented
- E. destroyed
- F. disguised

test 130 section 2 easy

1. The prime minister's reputation for _____ was sullied when it was revealed that he had known of fraudulent activities taking place in the country's banking system but failed to report them.

- A. solicitude
- B. impassivity
- C. probity
- D. diplomacy
- E. forbearance

2. All countries have obvious incentives to learn from policy mistakes, but when a nation becomes (i) _____, it may be (ii) _____ to recognize and quickly correct errors. When it comes to learning the right lessons, nothing fails like prior success. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. ambitious	D. required
B. powerful	E. unable
C. diverse	F. willing

3. Because human emotions are behavioral complexes, they presumably took a very long time to develop. Therefore, a complete lack of any (i) _____ human emotions in ancestral species is (ii) _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. alternatives to	D. unquestionable
B. antecedents of	E. reassuring
C. understanding of	F. improbable

4. Recent research shows that although the overall parental involvement in education (i) _____ during adolescence, the (ii) _____ the nature and frequency of parents' involvement and adolescent educational outcomes are no longer (iii) _____: for some types of parental involvement, declines are appropriate, whereas increases may, in fact, have deleterious effects.

A. begins to wane	D. links between	G. satisfactory
B. continues to matter	E. conditions for	H. negligible
C. fails to improve	F. problems with	I. straightforward

5. The government has been able to _____ the country's most serious social, economic and political problems, but these problems remain and may be getting worse.

- A. redress
- B. sidestep
- C. champion
- D. dodge
- E. remedy
- F. investigate

6. Despite the rather _____ conditions required for its preservation, the evidence for glaciation during the late Proterozoic is found on every continent, suggesting that ice sheets were present throughout the globe.

- A. unusual
- B. hostile
- C. drastic
- D. stringent
- E. exacting
- F. complex

7. The movie's ponderousness is _____ by the gripping performance turned in by the lead actor.

- A. heightened
- B. exacerbated
- C. mitigated
- D. belied
- E. relieved
- F. symbolized

test 131 section 1 hard

1. Unlike the introductions to many other biographies, this one is not _____; in fact, it would be a stretch to call it evenhanded.

- A. evaluative
- B. contrived

- C. concise
- D. laudatory
- E. formal

2. No one (i)_____ that building a ship powered by black holes or dark matter would be a formidable task. Yet remarkably there seems to be nothing in our present understanding of physics that (ii)_____ our doing so.

A. believes	D. anticipates
B. admits	E. necessitates
C. disputes	F. precludes

3. The main (i)_____ for pianists playing the keyboard works of Couperin lies in the effusion of embellishments, which are much easier to toss off without overemphasis, let alone (ii)_____, on the harpsichord than on the piano. Yet pianist Angela Hewitt's handling of all those fleeting lilts and curlicues is a model of (iii)_____. As a result, little nothings like "Le Petit-Rien" are sheer rippling delights.

A. difficulty	D. ungainliness	G. fierce intensity
B. attraction	E. elegance	H. economy and languor
C. unknown	F. mastery	I. lightness and elegance

4. Koizumi's decision to stake his political career on postal reform was less _____ than it might sound because the postal system could pass along trillions of yen to government financial institutions, benefiting him politically. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. quixotic
- B. impractical
- C. calculating
- D. shrewd
- E. impulsive
- F. maladroit

5. Researchers who study pollinator behavior are increasingly interested in multicomponent floral signals, but they often focus on how individual components are learned by pollinators rather than on the benefit of signal _____ per se.

- A. complexity
- B. stability
- C. magnitude
- D. intensity
- E. variation
- F. intricacy

6. In her novel, the sea is _____ symbol: to the narrator, it clearly represents everything that is destructive in nature, but at other times it seems to stand for everything in nature that is serenely beautiful.

- A. an unorthodox
- B. an equivocal
- C. an unconventional
- D. a comprehensive
- E. an elusive
- F. an ambiguous

7. Frequently blamed for making _____ coverage decisions, insurance companies are eager to avoid additional bad press.

- A. heartless
- B. unfair
- C. parsimonious
- D. callous
- E. definitive
- F. conclusive

test 131 section2 medium

1. The standard wisdom now is that sciences undergo periodic ruptures so thorough that the generations of scientists on either side of the break express themselves in mutually _____ languages.

- A. intelligible
- B. influential
- C. translatable
- D. incomprehensible
- E. interconnected

2. The title of Felsenstein's book-Infering Phylogenies-is positively (i)_____. The volume achieves so much more than simply presenting methods for inferring phylogenies, being, in fact, (ii)_____ of how to analyze evolutionary data from a phylogenetic perspective.

A. grandiose	D. an admirably comprehensive discussion
B. misleading	E. a thoroughly outmoded treatment
C. fortuitous	F. an almost opaque account

3. Penrose is (i)_____ theoretical physicists for engaging in (ii)_____ by (iii)_____ what is implied by the known data. One of his favorite examples is inflationary cosmology, which, according to him, is treated as an established theory despite a lack of evidence.

A. indebted to	D. partisanship	G. experimenting with
B. critical of	E. plagiarism	H. combing through
C. singular among	F. conjecture	I. venturing beyond

4. Most movie sound tracks lean so heavily on a few preprocessed musical devices—those swells of strings and cymbals designed to manipulate our emotions in (i)_____ ways—that when a composer (ii)_____ a more personal language, the effect is (iii)_____ : an entire dimension of the film experience is liberated from cliché. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. unprecedented	D. resists	G. meaningless
B. predictable	E. adopts	H. revelatory
C. provocative	F. eschews	I. disappointing

5. A number of recent pieces of instrumental music are linked by a common feature: the considerable _____ left to the individual performer in the way he or she chooses to play the work.

- A. fidelity

- B. restraints
- C. keenness
- D. latitude
- E. leeway
- F. curbs

6. The fierce drought that is gripping the area-and imminent rationing and steep water price increases-is _____ the area's deep economic divide, as wealthy communities guzzle water while poorer communities nearby conserve by necessity.

- A. defining
- B. bridging
- C. highlighting
- D. exacerbating
- E. underscoring
- F. adjusting

7. Wilson sees the ideas that he presents in his new book as being notably _____, but his critics, by contrast, claim that they are actually rather conventional.

- A. understated
- B. iconoclastic
- C. subversive
- D. democratic
- E. egalitarian
- F. daunting

test 132 section1 medium

1. Establishing the exact boundaries of a piece of property can be _____ process; some of the bitterest battles in contemporary society are waged between neighbors fighting over small slivers of land.

- A. a definitive
- B. a scrupulous
- C. an expedient
- D. a fraught
- E. a deliberate

2. According to Adriana Craciun, many of the people who fled France because of opposition to the Revolution were (i) _____ by loyalty to the deposed royal family: almost a third of those who left France departed (ii) _____ the fall of the monarchy, so it is unlikely, claims Craciun, that fealty to the royal family was the decisive factor in their decision.

A. strongly galvanized	D. after
B. entirely unmoved	E. during
C. not simply motivated	F. before

3. Lava flows that erupt on Earth's surface cool rapidly, forming rocks that are very fine grained. But some lava remains in volcanic conduits deep in the ground where it cools slowly, and the slowly growing mineral grains get much bigger than their surface equivalents. Thus, rocks with (i) _____ can have (ii) _____ textures, depending on how quickly they (iii) _____.

A. diverse mineral components	D. recognizable	G. fracture
B. typical surface markings	E. disparate	H. spread
C. identical chemical makeup	F. unusual	I. congeal

4. With Duncan's ambitious study, Chesnutt appears finally to have outgrown the _____ treatment he once received from literary historians and critics for whom he typically served as a merely transitional figure in the African American tradition. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. cursory
- B. jocular
- C. heartfelt
- D. didactic
- E. fervent
- F. perfunctory

5. Despite his secure position as a writer, Samuel Richardson adopted a strangely _____ posture, soliciting advice on early drafts of his second novel from readers familiar with his earlier work.

- A. complaisant
- B. quarrelsome
- C. nonchalant
- D. deferential
- E. dispassionate
- F. perfunctory

6. The trilogy balance seriousness with brilliant special effects, a fundamental furious darkness with fast-paced and engaging storytelling, so that the books manage to be simultaneously disturbing and _____.

- A. intense
- B. fun
- C. melodramatic
- D. gloomy
- E. entertaining
- F. somber

7. In our solar system, Earth is the most _____ of the rocky, or terrestrial, planets, so when first searching beyond solar system, scientists were not accustomed to planets of similar composition but many times the mass.

- A. complex
- B. temperate
- C. clement
- D. sizable
- E. intricate
- F. substantial

test 132 section 2 hard

1. Throughout his book, Venter savors his reputation as _____, believing himself righteous and embattled, as when his choices to sequence genome fragments and to patent expressed sequence tags provoked outrage among fellow scientists.

- A. a tactician
- B. an iconoclast

- C. an opportunist
- D. a clairvoyant
- E. a dilettante

2. When in 1980 the father and son pair of Luis and Walter Alvarez and their colleagues linked the end-Cretaceous mass extinction to a catastrophic extraterrestrial impact, they were met with skepticism by most paleontologists, which was (i)_____ given that geological training since the mid-1800s had emphasized the primacy of (ii)_____.

A. unsurprising	D. discernible causes
B. unwarranted	E. gradual processes
C. prescient	F. reversible changes

3. When an ideologue of one persuasion reverses course and embraces the views of erstwhile opponents, those whose views the convert adopts may feel vindicated. Still, one wants a person making a political about-face to (i)_____ of his or her previous allegiances: a reversal without a (ii)_____ is less than satisfying. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. acknowledge the erroneousness	D. recantation
B. rationalize the value	E. reconciliation
C. downplay the importance	F. recapitulation

4. The student who will benefit most from this biography of Mark Twain is the one who wishes to study the phenomenon of the author as (i)_____. It clearly shows that Twain, contemptuous as he may have been of the acquisitive society in which he lived, was ever (ii)_____ money, but that his (iii)_____ was almost inversely proportionate to his avarice. Usually a man with a keen eye for fraud and imposture, he was easily lured to invest in numerous improbable schemes.

A. speculator	D. disdainful of	G. acumen
B. moralist	E. lucky with	H. enthusiasm
C. visionary	F. ravenous for	I. voracity

5. World music once represented the timeless and the _____, but now bands across the globe mix rock, dance music, and hip-hop with the sounds of their own cultures, creating new hybrids that are hard to resist.

- A. untranslatable
- B. superior
- C. inclusive
- D. unalloyed
- E. unrivaled
- F. unadulterated

6. Scientists have recently confirmed that Mercury possesses a lot of ice, _____ discovery for a place that ranks among the hottest in the solar system.

- A. a controversial
- B. a stunning
- C. a doubtful
- D. a counterintuitive
- E. a dubious

F. an unexpected

7. During the fifteenth century, the aspects of the mathematical science were usually singled out as _____: their preparatory value for the study of philosophy, their practical advantage for the community, and their antiquity.

- A. estimable
- B. superlative
- C. inflated
- D. praiseworthy
- E. unique
- F. adventitious

test 133 section 1 medium

1. Even though no other species in the Rana genus of frogs exhibits such _____ habits, once crawfish frogs have finally been located, they are relatively easy to film.

- A. furtive
- B. rigid
- C. aggressive
- D. eccentric
- E. complex

2. Carmen de Burgos' work was mass-produced popular fiction, and its (i) _____ nature allowed it to be (ii) _____ by critics until the 1970s, when feminist scholars began to reevaluate the merit of her texts and recognize her contributions to early-twentieth-century Spanish culture.

A. disposable	D. dismissed
B. innovative	E. debated
C. realistic	F. overesteemed

3. Among chess aficionados, there have been many doomsday scenarios about people (i) _____ the game as a result of the superiority of computer chess programs over human players. Others have replied to this with variations on the theme of how we still hold footraces despite cars going much faster, but this analogy is (ii) _____ since cars do not help humans run faster while chess computers undoubtedly have an effect on the (iii) _____ of human chess.

A. losing interest in	D. ineluctable	G. popularity
B. redoubling their efforts at	E. transparent	H. quality
C. struggling to master	F. spurious	I. accessibility

4. There are too many characters, too many subplots, and no one clearly defined protagonist, making for _____ story. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. an unfocused
- B. a maudlin
- C. a superficial
- D. a sentimental
- E. a complicated
- F. a diffuse

5. The _____ of cosmic rays remains mysterious because their paths are bent by the galaxy's magnetic field—meaning that the directions they come from do not point to whatever created them.

- A. structure
- B. origin
- C. velocity
- D. production
- E. provenance
- F. speed

6. While many of Florence Price's art songs suffer from an excess of emotionality, "To my Little Son" actually demonstrates some _____, which makes the song more approachable and ultimately more moving.

- A. self-assurance
- B. spunk
- C. intelligence
- D. restraint
- E. confidence
- F. moderation

7. The author's approach to her subject is less _____ than that of some of her predecessors in the field, though here and there she cautiously takes a stand on a potentially divisive issue.

- A. propitious
- B. auspicious
- C. portentous
- D. contentious
- E. pretentious
- F. tendentious

test 133 section 2 medium

1. Because it was exposed by a _____ fracture, the rock's structure could be seen free of weathering or lichen growth.

- A. primeval
- B. complex
- C. recent
- D. microscopic
- E. permanent

2. The word "hacker," applied to technology, initially meant an ingenious college student or a hobbyist exploring computers' capabilities. At worst, a hacker was a (i)_____. Over time, however, the term acquired a more (ii)_____ meaning: that of someone who attempts to gain illicit access to confidential information or crash the electronic grid.

A. revolutionary	D. condescending
B. prankster	E. transparent
C. hireling	F. sinister

3. A new report has found that while psychoanalysis—or what purports to be psychoanalysis—is alive and well in literature, film, history, and just about every other subject in the humanities, psychology departments and textbooks treat it as something (i)_____, a historical artifact instead of (ii)_____.

A. dead	D. a dubious achievement
B. controversial	E. an ongoing movement
C. nascent	F. an interesting episode

4. The potential (i) _____ exploiting mineral resources in the area combined with the (ii) _____ participation among local people in conservation efforts may lead to a (iii) _____ human appreciation for the landscape and eventually contribute to disadvantageous effects for conservation. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. rewards in	D. an increase of interest in	G. rise in
B. ban on	E. a lack of benefits for	H. shrinkage of
C. danger in	F. a shift in the direction of	I. dependency on

5. Evolutionary psychologists hold that mating patterns arise from individual strategies to _____ one's genetic qualities, either by producing more offspring or by adding the survival of one's relatives.

- A. ascertain
- B. transcend
- C. transmit
- D. propagate
- E. overcome
- F. regulate

6. Prunella Clough was by no means reclusive, enjoying an extensive social and teaching life, but she deliberately kept a low profile, being famously _____ biographical details.

- A. unreliable regarding
- B. untrustworthy regarding
- C. guarded with
- D. stinting with
- E. irritable about
- F. uninterested in

7. The tools of science are so specialized that we accept them as a kind of _____ machinery for producing knowledge: we know that they work, but cannot explain why.

- A. occult
- B. efficacious
- C. potent
- D. arcane
- E. impersonal
- F. reliable

test 134 section 1 hard

1. Given the extraordinary _____ of its arguments, it is surprising that the central thesis of the book can be stated so simply.

- A. nuance
- B. insensitivity
- C. lucidity

- D. spuriousness
- E. rationality

2. There has been a noticeable reversal from the time when (i) _____ was accepted as the essential characteristic of genuine science: now the role of (ii) _____ in scientific research is generating a great deal of interest.

A. disciplinary specialization	D. speculation
B. long apprenticeship	E. emotion
C. dispassionate inquiry	F. technology

3. Japan's first university was more (i) _____ than its Chinese counterparts in the same era, since the Chinese Tang system was highly (ii) _____. However, this changed over time. As Japanese court office became increasingly hereditary, the examination system, by which students from wide range of social classes were admitted into the universities, (iii) _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. prestige	D. aristocratic	G. became widely utilized
B. egalitarian	E. reputable	H. advantaged the proletariat
C. profitable	F. unsystematic	I. atrophied into insignificance

4. Pre-Columbian peoples had a significant impact on Amazonian forest diversity; at least 8,000 years ago, they must have begun domesticating plants recently found to be _____ around sites once occupied by humans.

- A. hybridized
- B. abundant
- C. uncommon
- D. preserved
- E. harvested
- F. dominant

5. It is often taken for granted by scholars that Emily Dickinson is _____ poet: her poems have a peculiar quality that makes understanding seem beyond the reader's ken.

- A. a melancholy
- B. an unusual
- C. a pensive
- D. a difficult
- E. a whimsical
- F. an enigmatic

6. For every _____ reader of Vestiges there were many more who became vocal critics, and the book aroused heated opposition from a broad range of British society.

- A. outspoken
- B. meticulous
- C. sympathetic
- D. well-disposed
- E. unenthusiastic
- F. candid

7. Unsurprisingly, the novelist's new work has been without its critics, drawing particularly attention from those who have _____ the vapidness of other novels of the same genre in a number of acerbic reviews.

- A. reprehended

- B. questioned
- C. ignored
- D. overlooked
- E. decried
- F. relished

test 134 section 2 medium

1. Some people might object to pairing art and physics, since art is considered to be relatively _____ and physics, until recently, scrupulously avoided any mention of the inner thoughts that related to the outer world.

- A. accessible
- B. subjective
- C. enigmatic
- D. detached
- E. conceptual

2. Carter is a difficult figure to see in the true proportion—his reputation has been stretched to the point of _____, as he is put forward as the prime example of a tyrannical CEO.

- A. caricature
- B. beatification
- C. verisimilitude
- D. obscurity
- E. self-contradiction

3. My (i) _____ Hansen's life-size sculpture for real people was memorable precisely because the work did (ii) _____ such a complete—if brief—deception, one that is exceptional in my experience as a viewer of representational art.

A. adapting	D. hinder
B. producing	E. effect
C. mistaking	F. confound

4. Most artists maintain an attitude of (i) _____ toward their own work. They know, better than any critic would know, how their art (ii) _____ their ambitions. The artist would demand admirer, "Do you really think this is the best I am capable of?" Henri Cartier-Bresson's dismissal of his work in photography, however, is (iii) _____: it seems almost contempt, or even hatred, not just for his achievement but for the medium itself. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. extraordinary hubris	D. fall far short of	G. entirely comprehensible
B. irremediable disdain	E. eventually transcends	H. at another level altogether
C. healthy disrespect	F. subtly realizes	I. at odds with his achievement

5. Proponents of xeriscaping, a method of landscaping designed to minimize irrigation, point out that grass planted in desert locations has _____ effect on the environment, sapping water that is valuable and already scarce.

- A. a benign
- B. a pernicious
- C. a superficial

- D. a trivial
- E. an inevitable
- F. a deleterious

6. Encompassing more than petty disagreements over order in the author list, arguments about attribution in science speak to _____ issues—for example, where do new ideas come from, and what constitutes a new idea?

- A. contemporary
- B. profound
- C. practical
- D. topical
- E. controversial
- F. weighty

7. Her success is not _____, for she writes clearly about complicated subjects and provides lucid explanations and penetrating insights.

- A. undeniable
- B. undeserved
- C. unanticipated
- D. unparalleled
- E. unsurpassed
- F. unexpected

test 135 section 1 hard

1. The professor explained that in order to make a complex phenomenon more _____, economists often reduce it to an abstract problem.

- A. tractable
- B. contemporary
- C. momentous
- D. tenebrous
- E. substantive

2. The great divide between science and the humanities appeared during the last decades of the nineteenth century: before then, most people had seen those realms of human thoughts as (i) _____. It would therefore be (ii) _____ us to study early or mid-nineteenth-century science as something completely separates from the art of the time.

A. recondite	D. prescient of
B. overlapping	E. uncharacteristic of
C. inapposite	F. anachronistic for

3. Despite its title and the recipes it provides, the main purpose of The Insect Cookbook is not (i) _____. Instead, the book seeks to (ii) _____ of entomophagy, i.e. the consumption of insects as food: it is composed of interviews with chefs, farmers, politicians, and United Nations figures, all of whom attempt to (iii) _____ the custom of eating insects. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. scientific	D. explore the history	G. promote
B. culinary	E. condemn the practice	H. discredit

C. educational	F. proselytize on behalf	I. reform
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4. According to Waters, Cheryl Fish's otherwise brilliant analysis of Mary Seacole is _____ by a postmodern penchant for inventive jargon and fuzzy metaphysics.

- A. negated
- B. marred
- C. dominated
- D. caricatured
- E. forestalled
- F. tainted

5. By avoiding hyperbole in her definitive account of one of the most influential but controversial banks of the modern era, Hurst show herself to be a _____ author.

- A. judicious
- B. brilliant
- C. compelling
- D. sensible
- E. sympathetic
- F. solicitous

6. In stark contrast to her earlier plays, which are noisily crammed with monologues and overlapping dialogue, Caryl Churchill's later theatrical works are notably _____.

- A. laconic
- B. inventive
- C. cogent
- D. resourceful
- E. spare
- F. bland

7. Attempts to restore carnivores to ecosystems from which they were eliminated have become _____: indeed, many species are even being introduced into areas where they did not previously roam. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. expensive
- B. controversial
- C. contentious
- D. commonplace
- E. effective
- F. widespread

test 135 section 2 hard

1. The film portrays a political period that was bitterly divisive but does so in such _____ way that the narrative never becomes polemical.

- A. a timely
- B. an involved
- C. a maladroit
- D. a nuanced
- E. an impassioned

2. Because we participate in the dynamics of ecosystems as we restore them, restoration practice is in essence antithetical to the idea of a _____ wilderness.

- A. managed

- B. developing
- C. rehabilitated
- D. pristine
- E. degraded

3. Maddox presents a more (i)_____ view of Franklin than the stereotyped rendering of her as the martyr whose data was stolen. By focus substantial attention on Franklin's achievements working on the molecular structure of coal and on virus research, Maddox (ii)_____ reducing Franklin's legacy to her involvement in the (admittedly central) scientific story of DNA. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. conventional	D. resists
B. facile	E. deplores
C. complex	F. invites

4. At 79, Wirtz remains charmingly and frustratingly (i)_____, giving only the briefest and most (ii)_____ of answers to questions about his work as a landscape architect. His son Peter, who is as (iii)_____ as his father is reticent, claims that the elder Wirtz, being a "natural talent," does not always articulate what makes him do things.

A. elusive	D. penetrating	G. literal
B. subtle	E. explicit	H. voluble
C. sophisticated	F. general	I. tractable

5. Recent advances in the study of desert vanish have been a boon to geologists, allowing them to date surface feature and establish regional climate histories in _____ detail.

- A. novel
- B. realistic
- C. unprecedented
- D. superfluous
- E. extraneous
- F. surprising

6. Traditionally, doctors have measured consciousness by getting response from patients, asking questions like, "Can you hear me?"—an approach that is _____ for people who are conscious but unable to respond.

- A. fanciful
- B. imprecise
- C. vague
- D. illicit
- E. inadequate
- F. ineffective

7. The essayist was known to suffer fools impatiently, but admittedly her vast intellect made that _____ largely justified.

- A. hauteur
- B. diffidence
- C. irritability
- D. imperturbability
- E. superciliousness
- F. timorousness

test 136 section 1 hard

1. The museum exhibit perplexing mixed significant cultural artifacts with gaudy trinkets, leading one critic to suggest that the exhibit's curator could not distinguish the important pieces from those that were _____.

- A. representative
- B. illustrious
- C. repugnant
- D. inscrutable
- E. meretricious

2. It was (i) _____ the candidate's insistence that there will be completely disclosure that she (ii) _____ probing questions from reporters.

A. contrary to	D. misunderstand
B. illustrative of	E. welcomed
C. peripheral to	F. analyzed

3. Critics of the company's senior management will be (i) _____ by Han's careful and meticulous account of its actions. Despite the book's (ii) _____ title, the author has no designs on scandal; in fact, if anything, her account tends toward (iii) _____, applauding the company's all-conquering success without reservation. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. emboldened	D. ominous	G. cynicism
B. disappointed	E. fawning	H. pretentiousness
C. charmed	F. insipid	I. hagiography

4. The scholars' hypothesis challenges the scope of human psychological and behavioral universal, but does not dispense with them entirely: the team remains confident that displays of pride, for instance, are _____.

- A. inherited
- B. pernicious
- C. ubiquitous
- D. symptomatic
- E. detrimental
- F. omnipresent

5. As some primate experts have argued, the finding that related species have similar social structures, presumably as a result of shared genes inherited from a common ancestor, _____ nongenetic explanations of social behavior.

- A. revitalizes
- B. anticipates
- C. undermines
- D. challenges
- E. predicts
- F. eludes

6. While spectroscopy may be an obscure tool, there is nothing correspondingly _____ about claims concerning its importance: it proved that the rest of the universe is built from the same kinds of atoms as we are.

- A. banal
- B. arcane
- C. esoteric
- D. prosaic
- E. equivocal
- F. self-evident

7. The legislators didn't merely sell out to business; they retreated to _____ style of governing whereby the interest group that is currently lobbying the hardest on an issue determines the party's position. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. a reckless
- B. a rigid
- C. a craven
- D. an unyielding
- E. an arrogant
- F. a cowardly

test 136 section 2 medium

1. The common archaeological emphasis on changes in the shape of prehistoric stone implements should not _____ the fact that other materials, such as wood, bone, and antler, were also used for tools throughout the Paleolithic era.

- A. confirm
- B. underscore
- C. obscure
- D. contest
- E. belabor

2. The paintings of the 1960s Photo-Realists were meticulously rendered by artists who eschewed abstraction for realistic representation and thus achieved a precisely detailed, impersonal _____.

- A. verisimilitude
- B. imagination
- C. idealization
- D. subjectivism
- E. grandiloquence

3. Angela Merkel was a genuinely new figure in politics, someone who could potentially bridge the two halves of Germany, which had drifted apart in recent years. And yet the (i) _____ circumstances of her victory (ii) _____ the reservations Germans had about her. She was chosen not with a rousing popular mandate but after protracted backroom negotiations.

A. auspicious	D. belied
B. breathtaking	E. resolved
C. unsettling	F. underscored

4. Pauline Kael's first movie review tore into Charlie Chaplin for taking up the mantle of comic artist rather than claiming his roots as a slapstick clown. It might seem strange that a reviewer with such highbrow reading tastes as Kael had would attack upward-reaching film entertainers for their

pretensions and champion films that were mainstream entertainments. Yet such a stance could itself be seen as (i)_____, as it (ii)_____ a certain idea of true art from (iii)_____, as if only literature should aspire to seriousness. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. ascetic	D. guards	G. enervating refinement
B. elite	E. redeems	H. popular encroachment
C. egalitarian	F. displaces	I. revolutionary claims

5. Responsibility for the nation's decline rest squarely with a people who take for granted their claims to preeminence but do not _____ interest in or commitment to actually maintaining it.

- A. foresee
- B. rebuff
- C. evince
- D. reject
- E. predict
- F. betray

6. Padilla is a contrarian by nature, so it is no surprise that the clothes she designs have consistently _____ established fashion trends.

- A. hindered
- B. challenged
- C. exacerbated
- D. worsened
- E. impeded
- F. flouted

7. Despite the critic's assertion that Willa Cather's place in the literary canon is now so entrenched that it scarcely matters if she were really a modernist, her reputation arguably remains_____.

- A. flawless
- B. uncertain
- C. impressive
- D. tenuous
- E. consequential
- F. steadfast

test 137 section 1 medium

1. Historians of medicine are resigned to doctors' _____ medical history: physicians offer hagiographic biographies of obscure nineteenth-century medical figures, triumphalist narratives of medical progress, and retrospective diagnoses of ailments afflicting historical characters.

- A. clarifications of
- B. disaffection with
- C. condescension toward
- D. incursions into
- E. indifference to

2. Reports of the destruction of island vegetation by human-introduced herbivores, such as goats and rabbits, are so (i)_____ that there can be no reason to (ii)_____.

A. dire	D. trace their provenance
B. prejudicial	E. doubt their veracity

C. consistent	F. dispute their ubiquity
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3. George Eliot's biographer can be highly inventive, but, at the same time, somewhat (i) _____ in her approach to Eliot. She will hoist an alluring psychological flag concerning Eliot and then scrupulously take it down again, because the evidence will not serve to (ii) _____ it. But she takes it down only after it has taken an entirely (iii) _____ flutter in the breeze.

A. sentimental	D. embroider	G. unwarranted
B. irresponsible	E. discount	H. accidental
C. scrupulous	F. support	I. justified

4. The museum's display of bandolier bags made by Ojibwa artists of the Mille Lacs community reinforces the idea that this community's culture is _____ one: early twentieth-century bandolier bags are displayed alongside others made recently.

- A. a historic
- B. an inventive
- C. an unfolding
- D. a living
- E. a resourceful
- F. a unique

5. At the core of science fiction is the notion of _____, of asking, "If this phenomenon continues, where will it lead?"

- A. generalization
- B. extrapolation
- C. projection
- D. compensation
- E. reparation
- F. theorization

6. Certainly, the drive to make safety a corporate priority is _____, but whether it will be enough to create the necessary change in corporate culture is another matter; organizational inertia can be a powerful force. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. revolutionary
- B. sound
- C. critical
- D. prudent
- E. irresistible
- F. inexorable

7. The idea that Antarctica's subglacial lakes are _____ has changed radically thanks to repeat-pass satellite altimetry technology, which has found evidence of water transfer between lakes at distances of more than 200 kilometers.

- A. sterile
- B. barren
- C. isolated
- D. discrete
- E. uniform
- F. obscure

test 137 section 2 hard

1. The depletion of soil and trees in southern West Virginia has resulted in frequent flash floods, since when the mountain slopes are _____, storms cause torrents of water to pour down them unimpeded.

- A. riven
- B. fecund
- C. denuded
- D. withered
- E. mutable

2. The methods for composting organic waste aim to (i) _____ nature's tendency toward decay — a process unfortunately often (ii) _____ in landfills, where organic materials are packed so tightly that they have little access to the oxygen necessary for decomposition.

A. obviate	D. impeded
B. precipitate	E. expedited
C. ameliorate	F. manifested

3. Unlike those glossy Architectural Digest photographs that are deliberately (i) _____ lest they distract from a focus on the building itself, Friedlander's architectural photography is the product of his insistence that he is an individual looking at buildings and scenes as they actually exist. Friedlander reminds us that everyday objects (ii) _____ or, more exactly, that the unimpeded visual scene of a building without cars or power lines or street signs is a highly (iii) _____ photographic artifact.

A. impersonal	D. are largely inessential	G. intriguing
B. offhand	E. resist interpretation	H. imprecise
C. evocative	F. normally interfere	I. contrived

4. Those whose professional lives spanned the rise of the feminist movement from the 1970s onward and who witnessed significant advances in gender equality in the workplace over the intervening four decades will not be (i) _____ Saval's account of the (ii) _____ female employees. However, the (iii) _____ women advancing in the workplace can seem astonishing to those who did not witness it firsthand. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. surprised by	D. growing opportunities available to	G. resistance to
B. aware of	E. striking accomplishments attained by	H. support for
C. impressed by	F. many tribulations experienced by	I. indifference to

5. Biographies can be _____ contrivances, often too long and too detailed for their own good.

- A. subtle
- B. ingenious
- C. extravagant
- D. vain
- E. wearisome
- F. onerous

6. Many types of rocks contain small voids that _____ vibrations: the greater the proportion of a rock's volume that is void, the more gradually vibrations travel through it.

- A. amplify
- B. dampen
- C. generate
- D. impede
- E. produce
- F. conceal

7. Even though it was the soprano's first major role with the company, there was no _____ in her masterful performance.

- A. flamboyance
- B. hesitancy
- C. tentativeness
- D. panache
- E. flaw
- F. exhibitionism

test 138 section 1 medium

1. Monumental changes taking place in the structures of world business match some equally _____ changes taking place in the relations of international companies to the governments with which they deal. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. ill-advised
- B. magnanimous
- C. portentous
- D. discreet
- E. overblown

2. The idea of traveling in order to find natural extremes and wonders was (i) _____ in eighteenth- and nineteenth-century Europe, and many European travelers of the period were drawn to Iceland and other North Atlantic countries as places where they might find these (ii) _____ landscapes.

A. rarely articulated	D. idyllic
B. losing favor	E. exotic
C. not uncommon	F. salubrious

3. Until recently superhero comics were seen as irredeemably (i) _____ ; they were widely disparaged for being so (ii) _____ in conception and execution, and anyone who was a fan was given plenty of reasons to be (iii) _____.

A. puerile	D. lowbrow	G. heartened
B. innocuous	E. shrewd	H. emulated
C. facetious	F. realistic	I. abashed

4. His lackadaisical approach to this project belies his well-known reputation for _____.

- A. skill
- B. assiduousness
- C. industry
- D. intelligence

- E. facility
- F. innovation

5. The most interesting discoveries in astronomy are often the things researchers could never have anticipated; new instruments enable scientists to make such _____ discoveries, which can then take years to understand.

- A. inscrutable
- B. quotidian
- C. provocative
- D. fortuitous
- E. inexplicable
- F. serendipitous

6. The simplicity of Ann Hamilton's sculpture, a single drop of water snaking its way down a vast white wall, _____ the elaborate technical apparatus hidden beneath its surface.

- A. minimized
- B. undermined
- C. belied
- D. contradicted
- E. conjured
- F. evoked

7. Critics of compost production often do not fully consider the potential environmental benefits of compost use—benefits that might _____ the energy consumption, gaseous emissions, and other negative environmental effects attributable to compost production. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. trigger
- B. offset
- C. intensify
- D. exacerbate
- E. eliminate
- F. counterbalance

test 138 section 2 hard

1. The _____ effectiveness of lithium as a mood-altering drug for both manic and depressive states cannot be completely explained; most mood-altering drugs can only be used to modify one state or the other.

- A. dubious
- B. neglected
- C. questionable
- D. paradoxical
- E. latent

2. Parker's model of human affairs reflects (i) _____ outlook, in stark contrast to the generally (ii) _____ analyses of her colleagues in the economics department.

A. a sanguine	D. methodological
B. an introspective	E. provisional
C. a technical	F. pessimistic

3. Lebrecht recounts many entertaining scandals, (i) _____ himself on some points in deference to the laws of libel. His anecdotes seem (ii) _____, but when carefully scrutinized, their accuracy is less than impressive. What rings false is his picture of the impresarios as unerring Machiavellian

schemers—villains who never (iii) _____ in their efforts to pile up a fortune and ruin the world of music. However, my experience in the concert and recording world suggests that there is more bumbling than sinister plotting.

A. restraining	D. banal	G. sympathize
B. indulging	E. plausible	H. blunder
C. deluding	F. capricious	I. dissemble

4. Whatever the level of the museum's past (i) _____ American art, it pales beside its current (ii) _____. Since opening its renovated and expanded building, the museum has relegated American paintings to hard-to-find corners of the museum. It is as if American art is (iii) _____ the overwhelmingly European narrative that dominates the permanent collection galleries.

A. advocacy of	D. craze	G. fundamental to
B. enthusiasm for	E. disdain	H. excluded from
C. neglect of	F. support	I. privileged over

5. Someone must have been _____, since by the time the conspirators were ready to act, knowledge of their plot was widespread. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. compromised
- B. warned
- C. indiscreet
- D. injudicious
- E. ignorant
- F. unaware

6. China has a long tradition of _____ the written word; whereas in Renaissance Europe, painting, sculpture, and architecture were viewed as the apex of artistic achievement, in China calligraphy was the preeminent art form.

- A. embellishing
- B. venerating
- C. preserving
- D. studying
- E. commodifying
- F. exalting

7. While dehydration during pregnancy does not affect asp viper's litter size, pregnant females lost 89 percent more mass than non-reproductive females did when water-deprived, suggesting that female snakes may _____ their own water balance to benefit their offspring.

- A. compromise
- B. restore
- C. regulate
- D. sacrifice
- E. preserve
- F. stabilize

test 139 section 1 medium

1. Readers are interested in Marx's life because of his ideas, but Sperber's book downplays his ideas to make room for his life, illustrating why intellectual biography can sometimes be a curiously _____ genre.

- A. self-reflexive
- B. self-glorifying
- C. self-defeating
- D. self-propagating
- E. self-absorbed

2. Testing alternate versions of web pages in real time can make Internet-based companies (i) _____ some user preferences, but that does not necessarily make those companies (ii) _____, as 10,000 ongoing tweaks to the company web site do not add up to a fundamental change of direction when one is needed.

A. severely constrained by	D. irresolute
B. rapidly responsive to	E. transparent
C. surprisingly indifferent to	F. agile

3. Why Zona Gale—a Pulitzer Prize-winning writer whose novels were both a critical and popular success—has fallen so far out of the literary canon is the fascinating subject of Deborah Lindsay Williams' recent book. Williams concludes that Gale's embrace of literary (i) _____ accounts for her eventual decline in reputation. Gale sought professional affiliation with other women writers of many stripes, and Williams contends that she has therefore been (ii) _____ by a later literary paradigm that favors (iii) _____ as a marker of artistic prowess.

A. fame	D. marginalized	G. sociological accuracy
B. conservatism	E. studied	H. bold risk-taking
C. sisterhood	F. overrated	I. individual exceptionalism

4. We might be much closer to building the next generation of observatories if competing groups of astronomers had not _____ repeated chances to collaborate; instead, three separate projects with common goals are fighting one another for funding. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. spurned
- B. avoided
- C. sabotaged
- D. rebuffed
- E. initiated
- F. commenced

5. Software makers typically write licensing agreements disclaiming responsibility for any negative consequences of using their products, but as computers become integrated into everything from cars to medical devices, that stance will become _____.

- A. ambiguous
- B. untenable
- C. disfavored
- D. indefensible
- E. unwarranted
- F. gratuitous

6. Those familiar with the insular conditions that once prevailed in Russia may be surprised by the _____ of eighteenth-century Russian composer Natalia Kurakina, who translated novels from French into Italian and composed songs in both languages.

- A. versatility
- B. worldliness
- C. dedication

- D. ingenuity
- E. cosmopolitanism
- F. industriousness

7. Like his fellow _____ covering the campaign tour, who rarely had the luxury of spending more than one night in one place, Tony had his bags packed well before the evening fund-raiser.

- A. roisterers
- B. itinerants
- C. peripatetics
- D. carousers
- E. oracles
- F. inquisitors

test 139 section 2 medium

1. Even though the survey course was designated as interdisciplinary, it involved no real _____ of subject matter.

- A. distillation
- B. explication
- C. encapsulation
- D. fusion
- E. dilution

2. Although all of the major characters in Mendez' play are historical figures who have been lampooned in many previous works, she (i) _____ this tradition in her avoidance of (ii) _____.

A. relies on	D. ceremony
B. deviates from	E. verisimilitude
C. defers to	F. caricature

3. Although it is quite probable that many small asteroids in the solar system's asteroid belt have (i) _____, the total mass of these objects cannot be (ii) _____, since the combined gravitational pull of all known asteroids is (iii) _____ to fully account for the asteroid belt's effect on the motion of nearby planets such as Mars. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. similar structures	D. diminishing	G. sufficient
B. formed by accretion	E. estimated	H. unlikely
C. escaped detection	F. substantial	I. required

4. Taruskin's history of Western music, (i) _____ its remarkable length, makes no claims to comprehensiveness. Taruskin is punctilious, and justifiably proud, in emphasizing that his book is a work of history, not a survey of the repertory. In fact, he (ii) _____ criticism on grounds of omission by cheerfully admitting he has (iii) _____ such side-branch composers as Vaughan Williams, who maintained the British symphonic tradition into the mid-twentieth century.

A. owing to	D. disarms	G. extolled
B. despite	E. attacks	H. refuted
C. reflecting	F. obscures	I. ignored

5. Theses defended by contemporary philosophers under the banner of metaphysics typically _____ the claims of science; that is, they cannot be borne out by experiment as the claims of science are expected to be.
- A. derive from
 - B. originate in
 - C. contravene
 - D. challenge
 - E. transcend
 - F. go beyond
6. In medieval China, the Confucian emphasis on rites as an outward manifestation of virtue explains Chinese bureaucrats' _____ the accurate performance of tributary rituals by foreigners at the imperial court.
- A. ambivalence toward
 - B. preoccupation with
 - C. proficiency with
 - D. obsession with
 - E. regard for
 - F. anticipation of
7. The journalist seems to have _____ attitude about truth and falsehood, as exhibited, for example, in a disdain for fact-checking and a repeated failure to correct errors in articles once they are pointed out.
- A. a self-righteous
 - B. a capricious
 - C. an impulsive
 - D. an unethical
 - E. a cavalier
 - F. a dismissive

test 140 section 1 medium

1. Identifying the age of a human cell is tricky because of frequent _____ its biological and chronological ages: a cell that has existed for a relatively short time could function erratically, as if elderly. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. disagreement over
- B. correlation between
- C. underestimation of
- D. misalignment of
- E. inattention to

2. For millennia, remembering was hard and costly, and people had to choose deliberately what should be remembered, allowing most things to be forgotten. The digital age has brought about an (i) _____ of the balance of remembering and forgetting. Committing information to digital memory has become (ii) _____.

A. attenuation	D. the default
B. inversion	E. a burden
C. extension	F. an excuse

3. Thorough cleanings or restorations that try to return much-loved old master paintings to their original condition (i) _____. Quite apart from a reasonable wariness of paint loss, sheer loyalty to the (ii) _____ look of a work, dirt and all, prejudices many. There are also academics who (iii)

_____ the removal of retouches and even of overpaintings, holding that even though they may date from years after the original composition, they embody history in themselves.

A. generally take years to complete	D. accustomed	G. argue for
B. are increasingly science based	E. refined	H. vacillate about
C. invariably face opposition	F. pristine	I. militate against

4. While lunar geology may appear to be a relatively _____ area of planetary science, it is important to realize that the Moon's surface and interior retain records that shed light on the histories of all terrestrial planets. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. parochial
- B. insignificant
- C. narrow
- D. new
- E. straightforward
- F. novel

5. Maintaining a tolerant attitude toward pseudoscience might be considered _____, but it could be argued that such a disposition lowers our defenses against more dangerous delusions that are based on similar confusions and fallacies.

- A. naïve
- B. benign
- C. broad-minded
- D. indulgent
- E. credulous
- F. innocuous

6. At public appearances the leader was remarkably taciturn, typically making _____ observations before turning the floor over to a colleague.

- A. trite
- B. insightful
- C. inflammatory
- D. shrewd
- E. perfunctory
- F. brief

7. The rate of sediment deposition may be _____ desertification in Central Asia: data from a Tajik site show the rate to have increased during Pleistocene glacial periods as aridity increased.

- A. a restraint on
- B. a gauge of
- C. an indicator of
- D. a factor in
- E. a hedge against
- F. a consequence of

test 140 section 2 medium

1. Adapting to its changing environment and building its own ecological niche in interactions with other disciplines, the scientific discipline of ecology can be seen as highly _____.

- A. anarchic
- B. cerebral

- C. opportunistic
- D. speculative
- E. competitive

2. Political debates supposedly exist to inform viewers, who watch them with open minds to learn about the candidates and decide how to vote. Of course, given the (i) _____ that routinely permeates most debates, it is hard to (ii) _____ that they fulfill their purpose.

A. heated discussion	D. deny
B. ideological division	E. maintain
C. notorious disingenuousness	F. complain

3. The guarantee of academic freedom to professors is intended to encourage intellectual independence. But so long as faculty members receive training in a specific academic discipline and are appointed to positions defined by discipline, and so long as colleges and universities are organized by departments that (i) _____ long-standing disciplinary traditions, academic freedom will also (ii) _____ unique discipline-specific expectations. Yet the right to (iii) _____ disciplinary paradigms is also fundamental to academic freedom.

A. flout	D. tend to embody	G. resist
B. inherit	E. fail to communicate	H. delineate
C. reinvent	F. begin to transcend	I. perpetuate

4. Eventually, the framed painting looked as Easton had hoped it would, the frame offering a subtle rebuke to some of the more ostentatious baroque confections on display. Easton believed that it was more (i) _____ than any other frame in the exhibition, despite its (ii) _____ quality. That apparent simplicity, however, was so much more difficult to realize than something more obviously (iii) _____.

A. nondescript	D. unassuming	G. sumptuous
B. ornate	E. inexpensive	H. fashionable
C. striking	F. representative	I. outmoded

5. The action in Zadie Smith's novel *On Beauty* is mediated by an unabashedly _____ narrator who does not hesitate to inform us, as one upon a time the narrators of novels were wont to do, how we behave in general and how society usually works. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. knowing
- B. obtrusive
- C. conspicuous
- D. antiquated
- E. mysterious
- F. secretive

6. The second group of volunteer excavators was far more _____ than the first, and consequently the obstructing material was removed much more rapidly during the second shift.

- A. diligent
- B. incapacitated
- C. experienced
- D. punctual
- E. debilitated
- F. industrious

7. Tender yet never _____ the memoir engages the reader without resorting to clichés.
- A. saccharine
 - B. unsentimental
 - C. cloying
 - D. long-winded
 - E. pragmatic
 - F. affecting

test 141 section 1 medium

1. One of the reasons why so many rodent species live in rocky habitat is because it is _____: it contains plenty of crevices and cavities in which animals can nest, seek shelter, and find shade.
- A. ecologically stable
 - B. readily accessible
 - C. hydrologically variable
 - D. topographically complex
 - E. geographically widespread

2. Most of the bank-efficiency literature suggests that bank mergers culminating in larger, more complex organizations (i) _____ significant economies of scale or scope that are (ii) _____ to consumers. Indeed, some of this literature suggests diseconomies, which would lead to higher loan rates or lower deposit rates for consumers. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. fail to provide	D. beneficial
B. seek to create	E. responsive
C. cannot but generate	F. transparent

3. When reviewing a book that advertises lying as its subject, the critic has a duty to screen the title for possible (i) _____, and it is therefore necessary to report that The Concise Book of Lying is not concise. If the book were making a case for deception, the mismatch might not matter: a (ii) _____ title might suit a book designed to disabuse us of our respect for (iii) _____. But the book is not an apology for lying; it is on the side of truth.

A. ambiguity	D. misleading	G. brevity
B. mendacity	E. dependable	H. pedantry
C. partiality	F. verbose	I. veracity

4. So effective are inhaled steroids at staving off asthma attacks that doctors now regard them as _____ therapy.
- A. a mainstay of
 - B. a precursor to
 - C. a supplement to
 - D. a complement to
 - E. a foundation of
 - F. an antithesis to

5. Interest in the recovery of lost works by Brazilian women writers is growing as scholars increasingly recognize writing by Brazilian women as inherently worth study, not as _____ writing by Brazilian men.
- A. divergent from

- B. ancillary to
- C. interchangeable with
- D. antithetical to
- E. subsidiary to
- F. complimentary to

6. The sum of money needed to pay for the additional vaccines may not sound _____, but for developing countries even a small increase in the healthcare budget may prove a very big drain on resources. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. burdensome
- B. paltry
- C. negligible
- D. onerous
- E. sufficient
- F. adequate

7. In contrast to today, when many readers consider the moral sentiments expressed in the ancient writer's work to be quite sophomoric, in the writer's own time, these sentiments were regarded as remarkably _____.

- A. abstruse
- B. misguided
- C. insightful
- D. ill conceived
- E. sagacious
- F. sanguine

test 141 section 2 medium

1. Much as our taste for sugar and fat served us well in a world of scarce nutrition but has become _____ in a world of plenty, where we satisfy it to the point of obesity, our memories can work against us in our contemporary information age.

- A. symptomatic
- B. atrophied
- C. maladaptive
- D. nugatory
- E. heritable

2. When the columnist wrote about controversial issues, her own position was not always (i) _____ her analysis of the arguments being put forth on either side. If she (ii) _____ the reasoning of proponents of one side, that did not mean that she rejected their position.

A. immune to	D. favored
B. inferable from	E. summarized
C. influenced by	F. challenged

3. Letters present an awkward stumbling block to those who take a high line about literature as a custodian of moral values. The letters of accomplished poets and novelists are—as often as not—about drinking and infidelity, about sponging and wasting time. Consequently, one's (i) _____ the writer as (ii) _____ can often come in for a rude shock on contemplation of the writer's correspondence: the soul that composed the poems and the self that wrote the letters can seem (iii) _____.

A. doubts about	D. feckless	G. irreconcilable
-----------------	-------------	-------------------

B. familiarity with	E. exemplary	H. inspirational
C. reverence for	F. idiosyncratic	I. exotic

4. For a philosopher of the analytic tradition, Williams' approach is somewhat (i) _____. Unlike most analytic philosophers, Williams has not kept himself (ii) _____ the rest of the humanities; in fact, he wishes to address colleagues in other fields in terms that will make sense to them. In particular, he objects to the (iii) _____ character of analytic philosophy: the amount it tries to accomplish by conceptual analysis and a priori argument alone. Williams is convinced that philosophy must use history, including historical imagination, to understand and defend values of any kind.

A. oracular	D. aloof from	G. meticulously inclusive
B. unorthodox	E. conversant with	H. strongly ahistorical
C. bland	F. exposed to	I. overly contentious

5. Egyptologists' recent classification of a cavity found in the Great Pyramid as _____ seems premature: the inside of the Great Pyramid is filled with stones of irregular sizes, so small gaps appear unavoidable. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. eroded
- B. deliberate
- C. accessible
- D. ceremonial
- E. purposeful
- F. penetrable

6. Magazines use superlatives to generate excitement and make stories seem worth reading, and not even the most punctilious fact-checkers at the most principled magazines can fight off all the _____ claims.

- A. uncategorizable
- B. unwarranted
- C. dubious
- D. idiosyncratic
- E. innocuous
- F. noteworthy

7. Hugh Trevor-Roper's series of essays on the Puritan Revolution are considered to be the _____ of the genre: though these essays have exerted a welcome influence on the work of many subsequent historians, their quality has never been equaled.

- A. embodiment
- B. apogee
- C. forerunner
- D. acme
- E. precursor
- F. paradigm

test 142 section1 easy

1. The effect of the film's expansive, darkly mournful opening sequence was magnified by a score that was similarly _____ and unrelenting.

- A. iridescent
- B. volatile

- C. equivocal
- D. plangent
- E. blithe

2. Humans can have (i) _____ tastes: crab brains and squeezable cheese are delicacies to many people, even as others find them repulsive. The preference for sweet and abhorrence of bitter is (ii) _____, however.

A. self-indulgent	D. explicable
B. refined	E. strong
C. idiosyncratic	F. universal

3. There is a clear trend away from automobile ownership and solo driving among young people. One view holds that these young people will (i) _____ as they age, but Willson argues that the trend is (ii) _____ one. As a result, car-free lifestyles will become more (iii) _____.

A. support mass transit	D. a durable	G. onerous
B. reject the automobile entirely	E. a noticeable	H. expedient
C. increase vehicle ownership	F. an illusory	I. common

4. The Chippewa regarded their treaties with the federal government as solemn covenants and therefore, throughout the twentieth century, met efforts by governmental officials to _____ those treaties with both open and hidden resistance. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. replicate
- B. abrogate
- C. respect
- D. renegotiate
- E. nullify
- F. honor

5. The reader does well to approach claims in this autobiography with a certain amount of friendly skepticism, but the overall impression it conveys is that veracity wins out over _____.

- A. blame
- B. invention
- C. contrivance
- D. censure
- E. venom
- F. concern

6. The artist reworked certain of his etchings in order to make the scenes they depict more logical, yet, paradoxically, the pictorial space seems to become more _____ the more realistically it is defined.

- A. austere
- B. cogent
- C. lucid
- D. fanciful
- E. ominous
- F. chimerical

7. Hoping to build a broader audience, the museum has mounted several exhibitions based on popular culture, but their impact on attendance has been negligible, and some complain that this direction has _____ the museum's stature.

- A. protracted
- B. undermined
- C. burnished
- D. augmented
- E. diminished
- F. perpetuated

test 142 section 2 medium

1. The growth of kelp in the kelp bed communities of the North Pacific Ocean is _____ sea otters: the otters prey on kelp-eating sea urchins, keeping the urchin population in check.

- A. impeded by
- B. detected by
- C. invisible to
- D. facilitated by
- E. disruptive for

2. The garments created by Tunisian fashion designer Salah Barka, though not understated in style, are (i) _____ in their references to local cultures and histories: Barka evokes Africa without (ii) _____ readily discernible indigenous stylistic elements.

A. subtle	D. direct reproduction of
B. commanding	E. obvious departure from
C. inconsistent	F. imaginative adaptations of

3. Despite the apparently natural—if not essential—relationship between insult and (i) _____, for some people the experience of getting insulted may cause (ii) _____: instead of lashing out at the offender, they end up (iii) _____. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

A. self-esteem	D. outrage	G. reacting swiftly
B. injury	E. dejection	H. suffering inwardly
C. anger	F. confusion	I. recovering easily

4. Statistics is the branch of applied mathematics that studies ways of drawing inferences from limited and imperfect data. Of course, if all data sources were totally (i) _____, statisticians could do little but (ii) _____ every conclusion with "but we could be wrong about this." A mathematical science of statistics is possible because, although repeating an experiment numerous times may not yield uniform results, some results are more (iii) _____ than others.

A. empirical	D. qualify	G. dubious
B. capricious	E. affirm	H. unexpected
C. defensible	F. substantiate	I. common

5. Nancy Weiss Malkiel's painstakingly detailed history of coeducation at elite universities is an invaluable _____ the amnesia that has come to envelop even such a relatively recent—but critically neglected—development.

- A. antidote to

- B. summary of
- C. reinterpretation of
- D. corrective to
- E. diagnosis of
- F. addition to

6. The attempt by some nineteenth-century physicists to reduce ordinary matter to electromagnetic fields was _____, but once it was one of the biggest hopes of theoretical physics.

- A. counterproductive
- B. unsuccessful
- C. ill-conceived
- D. ridiculed
- E. overambitious
- F. futile

7. While traditional Chinese historiography ostensibly described events in a neutral manner, early historians did not always _____ tendentiousness, sometimes offering moral judgments about the historical figures they discussed. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. eschew
- B. forgo
- C. denounce
- D. descry
- E. defend
- F. justify

test 143 section 1 medium

1. Rather than use the traditional therapy, the physician employed unorthodox treatments _____ by her more conventional colleagues.

- A. engendered
- B. repudiated
- C. developed
- D. espoused
- E. adopted

2. Science is so good at what it does that many people feel a (i) _____ to apply it to social and political issues, yet experience shows that science may add little to or even (ii) _____ social and political questions.

A. provocation	D. augur
B. temptation	E. occlude
C. reluctance	F. abet

3. The rural Renaissance villas were working buildings. The agricultural world they served is now gone. To see it you therefore have to (i) _____ it, but that can be aided by the nineteenth-century photographs taken just before the agricultural revolution destroyed the old order. Not that those photographs themselves are always completely(ii) _____: Virginia creeper growing up a Renaissance villa is a botanical anachronism and also (iii) _____ piece of planting (rats climb up the creepers and get at the grain stored in the attic).

A. imagine	D. exhaustive	G. an ornamental
B. improvise	E. undamaged	H. a foolish

C. visit	F. germane	I. an imitative
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4. The climate researchers' _____ method of presentation caused a stir among those who felt that scientific papers should be dispassionate in their delivery of evidence.

- A. prejudicial
- B. slapdash
- C. tendentious
- D. perfunctory
- E. meticulous
- F. incohesive

5. Astute and incisive, the essayist's work was nevertheless civil and polite: the essayist either had no gift of _____ or else never felt any.

- A. vitriol
- B. clairvoyance
- C. theatricality
- D. prescience
- E. mimicry
- F. obloquy

6. The idea that Jim was _____, that he loved fighting for the sake of fighting, was a mistake; in reality he was a kind and gentle person. 【微信公众号：张巍GRE】

- A. truculent
- B. audacious
- C. brazen
- D. obtuse
- E. pugnacious
- F. disobedient

7. James Baldwin (1924-1987) recognized that American writers, who are inescapably products of American politics, do not _____ the terms of the national conversation, but he emphasized their capacity to reshape the language in which it occurs.

- A. ordain
- B. transcend
- C. disseminate
- D. rectify
- E. dictate
- F. amend

test 143 section 2 hard

1. Other company insiders have recently offered testimony that _____ several of the more lurid anecdotes found in Belmer's account, though that testimony hardly minimizes the company's culture of malfeasance and mismanagement.

- A. tempers
- B. corroborates
- C. outdoes
- D. exploits
- E. foreshadows

2. Cells (i) _____ glucose if they are (ii) _____ it, but conversely they destroy glucose-creating enzymes upon return to glucose-replete conditions.

A. detect	D. supplied with
-----------	------------------

B. redirect	E. deprived of
C. synthesize	F. signaled by

3. Often evasive and at times even (i) _____, the gubernatorial candidate came off (ii) _____ at her press conference today in ways that should give voters cause to (iii) _____ her, regardless of whether they agree with the substance of her views.

A. humorous	D. badly	G. reject
B. blunt	E. convincingly	H. champion
C. mendacious	F. unexceptionally	I. emulate

4. A prospective reader may well wonder whether the book would not be better classified as a somewhat unorthodox biography, but the author stands firm on its status as a work of fiction. She has drawn inspiration from the facts, the author tells us, but has (i) _____ them, editing and rearranging events. Also, she has felt free to (ii) _____ what her characters were feeling and what was going on in their minds—to invent, within the limits of plausibility, what could not be (iii) _____.

A. reshaped	D. ignore	G. believed
B. expunged	E. deny	H. ascertained
C. verified	F. imagine	I. described

5. One of the reporter's central themes is that health care concerns were a secondary consideration to the reformers in their drive to limit if not completely _____ the consumption of cigarettes.

- A. indulge
- B. proscribe
- C. damage
- D. spurn
- E. disallow
- F. impair

6. Because the fundamental nature of language is so intangible, because there is no agreed-upon way to determine its existence, it is easy to dismiss new evidence of ostensible animal language as inadequate—quite _____, but insufficient.

- A. equivocal
- B. intriguing
- C. controvertible
- D. provocative
- E. viable
- F. dubitable

7. Whether the film is _____ adaptation of the legend is debatable: the author of the screenplay claims that it was based on the original tale, but admits taking some interpretive license with the story.

- A. an inspired
- B. a rigorous
- C. an unsentimental
- D. a successful
- E. a sober
- F. a faithful

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